TEK-UP University

GLSI — Software Engineering and Information Systems

End-of-Studies Project Report

Submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of

National Engineering Diploma in Computer Science (GLSI)

Inkwell.ai

An AI-powered writing marketplace connecting independent writers and magazine publishers

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Abstract

Independent writers have tools to publish but few ways to be paid for quality, and magazines that want to commission them have no objective way to judge a writer before buying. This report presents **Inkwell.ai**, a two-sided web platform that addresses both sides. Writers draft in a rich-text editor beside an AI assistant grounded in their own published work and in reference documents they upload; it answers in a panel or writes directly into the document, cites its sources by page, and accepts spoken prompts. Every published article feeds an event-based analytics pipeline whose audience, content and quality signals, together with AI-generated portfolio insights, form an evaluation report that magazines use to decide. Magazines subscribe, receive monthly credits, preview an article for 10% of its price and buy the remainder for exclusive republication rights, every credit movement being recorded in a ledger whose invariants are tested after each operation.

The platform was built over nine two-week Scrum sprints grouped into four releases, with a Next.js 16 frontend, a NestJS 11 backend and worker, PostgreSQL 16 with pgvector, Redis and BullMQ, MinIO object storage and nginx, all containerised with Docker Compose, and with Groq and Gemini models orchestrated through the Vercel AI SDK. The backend suite counts 796 passing tests. Measured on a labelled set, retrieval returns a relevant passage in its top five for 89% of questions, hybrid search keeps every relevant article in its top ten even for paraphrased queries that defeat keyword search, and the publish-time moderation classifier reaches a precision of 0.93 and a recall of 1.00.

Keywords: writing marketplace, AI-assisted writing, retrieval-augmented generation, hybrid search, pgvector, analytics, article licensing, Scrum, NestJS, Next.js.

Résumé

Les rédacteurs indépendants disposent d'outils pour publier, mais de peu de moyens d'être rémunérés pour la qualité de leur travail, et les magazines qui souhaitent leur confier des articles n'ont aucun moyen objectif d'évaluer un rédacteur avant d'acheter. Ce rapport présente **Inkwell.ai**, une plateforme web biface qui répond aux deux besoins. Les rédacteurs écrivent dans un éditeur de texte enrichi, aux côtés d'un assistant d'intelligence artificielle ancré dans leurs propres articles publiés et dans les documents de référence qu'ils déposent ; l'assistant répond dans un panneau ou écrit directement dans le document, cite ses sources à la page près et accepte des consignes dictées à la voix. Chaque article publié alimente une chaîne d'analyse fondée sur des événements, dont les indicateurs d'audience, de contenu et de qualité, complétés par une synthèse générée par l'IA, constituent un rapport d'évaluation sur lequel les magazines s'appuient pour décider. Les magazines s'abonnent, reçoivent des crédits mensuels, débloquent un aperçu pour 10 % du prix et achètent le reste pour obtenir des droits de republication exclusifs ; chaque mouvement de crédits est inscrit dans un grand livre dont les invariants sont vérifiés après chaque opération.

La plateforme a été réalisée en neuf sprints Scrum de deux semaines, regroupés en quatre releases, avec un frontend Next.js 16, un backend et un worker NestJS 11, PostgreSQL 16 avec pgvector, Redis et BullMQ, le stockage objet MinIO et nginx, le tout conteneurisé avec Docker Compose, les modèles Groq et Gemini étant orchestrés par le Vercel AI SDK. La suite de tests du backend compte 796 tests réussis. Mesurée sur un jeu de données annoté, la recherche de passages renvoie un passage pertinent parmi les cinq premiers pour 89 % des questions, la recherche hybride conserve tous les articles pertinents parmi les dix premiers résultats, y compris pour des requêtes reformulées que la recherche par mots-clés ne trouve pas, et le classifieur de modération atteint une précision de 0,93 et un rappel de 1,00.

Mots-clés : place de marché d'écriture, rédaction assistée par l'IA, génération augmentée par la recherche, recherche hybride, pgvector, analytique, licence d'articles, Scrum, NestJS, Next.js.

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List of acronyms

Acronym	Meaning
AI	Artificial Intelligence
API	Application Programming Interface
CI/CD	Continuous Integration / Continuous Deployment
CLS	Cumulative Layout Shift (Lighthouse metric)
CRUD	Create, Read, Update, Delete
DOCX	Office Open XML word-processing document format
DSDM	Dynamic Systems Development Method
DTO	Data Transfer Object
ESN	Entreprise de Services du Numérique (IT services company)
FR / NFR	Functional / Non-Functional Requirement
GHCR	GitHub Container Registry
HNSW	Hierarchical Navigable Small World (approximate nearest-neighbour index)
HTML	HyperText Markup Language
JSON	JavaScript Object Notation
JWT	JSON Web Token
LCP	Largest Contentful Paint (Lighthouse metric)
LLM	Large Language Model
MoSCoW	Must, Should, Could, Won’t (prioritisation)
MRR	Mean Reciprocal Rank
nDCG	normalised Discounted Cumulative Gain
OAuth	Open Authorization (delegated authorisation protocol)
OpenAPI	OpenAPI Specification (machine-readable description of a REST API)
ORM	Object-Relational Mapping
PDF	Portable Document Format
PFE	Projet de Fin d’Études (end-of-studies project)
RAG	Retrieval-Augmented Generation
REST	Representational State Transfer
RRF	Reciprocal Rank Fusion
S3	Simple Storage Service (object storage protocol)
SQL	Structured Query Language
SSE	Server-Sent Events
TLS	Transport Layer Security
TTS	Text-to-Speech
UI	User Interface
UML	Unified Modeling Language
US	User Story
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines

General introduction

Writing has never been easier to publish and never harder to be paid for. Blogging platforms and newsletter services let anyone reach readers in minutes, and large language models now help with drafting, rephrasing and editing. Yet the market that pays writers is narrow: of the roughly fifty million people who create content for an audience, only about four percent earn more than a hundred thousand dollars a year, and most of the income comes from brand deals rather than from the writing itself [1]. Publications that would pay for good work struggle to find it and, once they find it, to judge it on anything firmer than a few samples and intuition.

This end-of-studies project starts from that double gap. On one side, writers need an assistant that helps them write *in their own voice*, not a generic text generator; on the other, magazines need objective signals — who reads a writer, how far, how often they come back — before they commit money. Between the two, a market is missing: a place where a magazine can browse, evaluate and license an existing article directly from its author, with clear terms and a trustworthy record of who paid what.

Inkwell.ai is the platform built to fill that gap. It combines three pillars:

1. **AI-collaborative writing** — an assistant integrated into the editor as chat, inline actions and voice input, grounded in the writer's published corpus and in reference documents the writer uploads, able to write directly into the draft;
2. **decision-support analytics** — every published article generates audience, content and quality signals that feed dashboards for the writer and an evaluation report for magazines, completed by AI-generated portfolio insights;
3. **an article licensing marketplace** — magazines are a distinct account type that subscribes, receives monthly credits, previews an article for a tenth of its price and buys the rest for exclusive republication rights.

The work was carried out over six months, from February to July 2026, following the Scrum framework in nine fixed two-week sprints grouped into four releases. This report follows that structure:

- **Chapter 1** presents the context of the project, studies the existing solutions, justifies the development method, and then analyses and specifies the requirements: actors, functional and non-functional requirements, the global use case and class diagrams, the product backlog and the release plan.
- **Chapter 2** describes the working environment, compares the technological choices with their alternatives, justifies the main parameters of the system, and presents its logical and physical architecture.
- **Chapters 3 to 6** present the four releases sprint by sprint — the sprint backlog, the analysis, the design and the realisation — from the functional foundation to the marketplace, testing and deployment, and finally to the reworked assistant and the document library.
- **Chapter 7** evaluates the result: the retrieval behind the assistant, the hybrid search, the moderation classifier, the performance and accessibility of the platform, the test coverage and the delivery itself.

A general conclusion summarises the results, states the limitations of the work and opens perspectives for the platform. Two annexes give the full functional requirements and the full product backlog.

CHAPTER 1

Project context and requirements analysis

Introduction

This chapter sets out what the project is and what it must do. Its first part places the project in its context: the host organisation, the observations that motivated it, the existing solutions, the problem and the proposed solution, and the development method adopted and how it was adapted. Its second part specifies the requirements: the actors, the functional and non-functional requirements, the global use case and class diagrams, and the organisation of the work as a product backlog and a release plan.

1.1 Project context

1.1.1 Host organisation

This project was carried out at **Intuitiv Group**, a company with a dual culture: at once an IT services company (*Entreprise de Services du Numérique*, ESN) and an interactive agency. It works with large national and international groups while keeping a human-scale structure, and positions itself on reactivity, reliability and quality of service. That dual culture suits Inkwell.ai, which is as much a software engineering effort — architecture, data, security, delivery — as a product and interface design effort.

1.1.2 Context and motivation

The project was proposed as an end-of-studies engineering project with a product-shaped scope: not a prototype of one feature, but a complete two-sided platform with real accounts, real data flows, an AI layer and money-like transactions. Three observations motivated it.

- **Writing assistants are generic.** Mainstream assistants draft, shorten and change the tone of a text from a description of what is wanted [2], [3], [4]; none of those cited learns from what the writer has already published, so they write *for* the writer rather than *like* the writer.
- **Engagement data is collected, but not offered as evidence.** Platforms measure reading in detail — Medium pays its writers according to members' reading time, read ratio and engagement [5] — yet these signals are shown to the writer or used to rank content, never presented to a buyer judging the writer.
- **Paid writing is a narrow market.** About four percent of creators earn more than a hundred thousand dollars a year, and most creator income comes from brand deals [1]. None of the publishing platforms studied below offers a publication a way to license an article that already exists.

1.1.3 Study of existing solutions

The solutions close to the project fall into five families. **Publishing platforms** such as Medium pay writers from a pool of reader subscriptions [5]. **Newsletter platforms** — Substack, Ghost and beehiiv — let a writer charge readers directly [6], [7], and beehiiv adds an AI writing assistant to its editor [4]. **Freelance marketplaces** such as Contently and Upwork connect clients with writers for *commissioned* work: the article

does not yet exist when it is bought, and the platform holds no engagement data on the writer's published pieces [8], [9]. **AI writing assistants** such as Grammarly and Notion AI improve or generate text inside a document [2], [3]. Finally, **source-grounded assistants** — NotebookLM, ChatGPT with uploaded files, Perplexity Spaces — answer from documents the user uploads and cite the passages they used [10], [11], [12].

Table 1.1 compares these families on the criteria the project targets. Each cell records what the product's own documentation states; "partial" means the capability exists in a restricted form, explained below the table.

Table 1.1 – Comparison of existing solutions, from each product's public documentation

Criterion	Medium	Newsletter platforms[1]	Freelance markets[2]	Writing assistants[3]	Grounded assistants[4]	**Inkwell.ai**
Publishing and public reading	✓	✓	—	—	—	✓
AI assistance in the editor	—	partial	—	✓	—	✓
Assistant grounded in the writer's published work	—	—	—	—	partial	✓
Answers citing uploaded documents	—	—	—	—	✓	✓
Engagement analytics for the writer	✓	✓	—	—	—	✓
Analytics exposed to a buyer as evidence	—	—	—	—	—	✓
Licensing of existing articles to publications	—	—	—	—	—	✓
Traceable payments	✓	✓	✓	—	—	✓

[1] Substack, Ghost, beehiiv. [2] Contently, Upwork. [3] Grammarly, Notion AI. [4] NotebookLM, ChatGPT with files, Perplexity Spaces.

Two cells need a word. beehiiv is the only newsletter platform of the three with an assistant in its editor, hence "partial" for that family. The source-grounded assistants could be grounded in a writer's published work only if the writer uploaded it by hand, and they are separate from any editor or publishing workflow.

The decisive cells are the last three rows. Citing uploaded documents, taken alone, is **not** distinctive: the source-grounded assistants already do it, and Inkwell.ai borrows the idea. What no family offers is the *combination* — an assistant grounded in the writer's own published corpus inside the editor where the writing happens, analytics presented to a buyer as evidence, and a market in which a publication licenses an existing article. Each family covers one or two of these needs; the platforms that pay writers do not give buyers evidence, and the tools that ground answers in sources do not publish or pay.

1.1.4 Problem statement and proposed solution

The study shows a problem on three levels. On the **supply side**, writers lack an assistant that writes in their own voice from what they have published and the material they are working from, and a direct path to be paid for quality. On the **demand side**, magazines lack objective, comparable signals about a writer's audience, consistency and quality. Between them, the **market** is missing: there is no self-service place where a publication can discover, evaluate, preview and license an existing article, with the money recorded in a way both parties can trust.

Inkwell.ai answers the three levels with one platform: an **editor with an AI assistant** that retrieves passages from the writer's own articles and attached documents, decides per request whether to answer or to write into the draft, and cites its sources by page; an **analytics pipeline** that turns reading events into per-article and per-writer metrics, presented to the writer and, as an evaluation report with AI portfolio insights, to magazines; and a **marketplace** where subscribed magazines preview an article for 10% of its price, buy the remaining 90% for exclusive rights and publish it under their own masthead, every credit movement being

written to a ledger inside one database transaction.

1.2 Development methodology

1.2.1 Sequential and agile approaches

A **sequential (waterfall) process** runs requirements, design, implementation, testing and delivery once each, in order; its classic description already warned that testing at the end exposes design errors when they are most expensive to correct [13]. An **agile process** builds the product in short iterations, each delivering working software that is reviewed before the next is planned, and values responding to change over following a plan [14], [15]. Figure 1.1 contrasts the two.

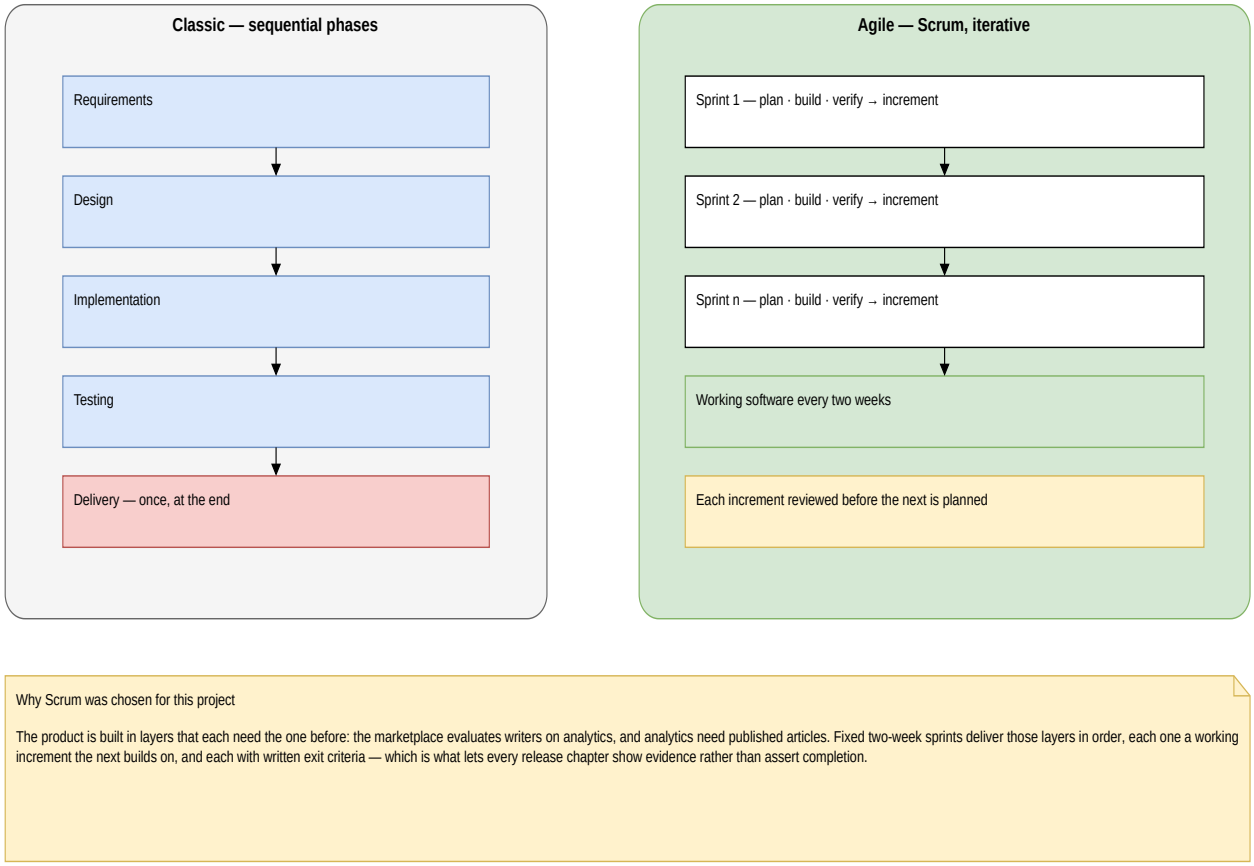


Figure 1.1 – Classic and agile approaches compared

The figure makes the deciding difference visible: in the sequential process the first working software appears in the last phase, while in the agile process it appears at the end of the first iteration. Inkwell.ai is built in layers that each depend on the one below — the marketplace evaluates writers on analytics, analytics need published articles, articles need accounts and an editor — so a defect in a lower layer must be found before the next is built on it. Short iterations that end in working, tested software are what that layering requires.

1.2.2 Scrum, and its adaptation to a one-person project

Among agile frameworks, **Scrum** was chosen for its fixed-length sprints and its explicit artefacts and events [16], which give an individual project the regular checkpoints a supervisor can follow. Figure 1.2 shows the framework as it was applied.

The figure reads from left to right: the product backlog feeds sprint planning, the sprint backlog is built

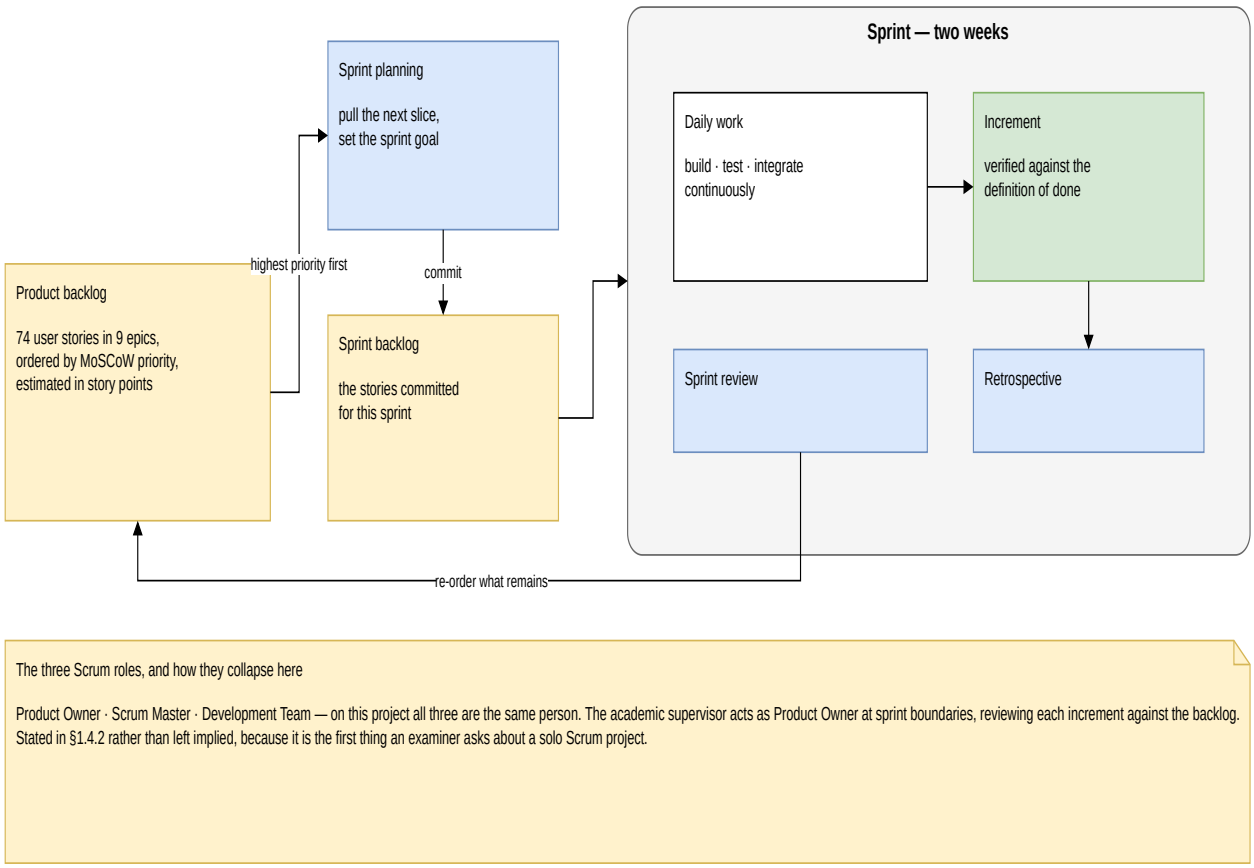


Figure 1.2 – The Scrum framework, as practised in this project

during a fixed two-week sprint, and every sprint ends with an increment checked against the definition of done, reviewed, and followed by a retrospective whose actions return to the next planning. What it implies for this project is that the unit of progress is the increment, not the document: each sprint must leave the platform runnable and tested.

Scrum is designed for a team of ten or fewer people holding three accountabilities — Product Owner, Scrum Master and Developers [16] — and this project has one person. The adaptation, and its limits, were the following.

- **Roles.** The author held the Developer and Scrum Master accountabilities. The academic supervisor acted as Product Owner at sprint boundaries, accepting or returning each increment against the backlog. The limit is that one person both estimates and executes the work: there is no team discussion to correct an optimistic estimate, which shows in the uneven sprint loads discussed in Section 7.7.
- **Events.** Sprint planning, the sprint review and the retrospective were kept; the daily scrum, which synchronises a team, has no purpose for one person and was replaced by a written log of what was done and what blocked. Its limit is the loss of a daily outside view.
- **Artefacts.** The product backlog, the sprint backlogs and the increment were kept unchanged, with a written **definition of done**, given with the evaluation in Section 7.7: code reviewed against the specification, the type check and linter passing with no warning, the backend tests passing in the container, and the feature demonstrated in a browser.

With one person, the value of Scrum lies in the discipline it imposes — a fixed cadence, a written goal per sprint, an increment that must work — rather than in coordination.

1.2.3 Prioritisation and estimation

Requirements and user stories are prioritised with **MoSCoW** — Must, Should, Could, Won't — the prioritisation technique of the DSDM agile framework, in which the Must items form the minimum usable subset that the delivery guarantees [17]. Stories are estimated in **story points** on a Fibonacci-like scale (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13), relative to the simplest story: the gaps between values grow with size because estimating larger work is less precise, which is the reason for the scale [18]. Points measure relative size, not hours; their sum per sprint gives the velocity reported in Section 7.7.

1.2.4 Modelling language

Analysis and design use **UML 2.5** [19]: use case diagrams for the functional scope of each sprint, class diagrams for the data model, sequence diagrams for the main interactions, and activity and state diagrams where a decision or a lifecycle is the subject. The diagrams are kept as text sources (PlantUML) or generated (draw.io) in the project repository, versioned beside the code they describe.

1.3 Identification of the actors

The platform has eight actors. Table 1.2 lists them with the way each is represented in the data model, because the actors are not invented for the analysis: they follow from the three independent properties every account carries — its **account type** (personal or magazine), its **role** (reader, writer or administrator) and its **plan** (free or premium) — plus the writer's marketplace eligibility.

Table 1.2 – Actors of the system

#	Actor	Data-model representation	Definition
A1	Visitor	no account	Unauthenticated. Sees the public feed and free article bodies; cannot interact.
A2	Free reader	personal account, free plan	Reads free public articles, interacts socially, has no AI allowance.
A3	Premium reader	personal account, premium plan	Everything A2 has, plus premium articles and the daily AI allowance.
A4	Writer	personal account, role writer	A2 or A3 plus drafting, publishing and editing their own articles.
A5	Eligible writer	writer marked eligible	A4 plus the right to publish premium articles and to list on the marketplace.
A6	Magazine (unsubscribed)	magazine account, no active subscription	Registered magazine stopped at the subscription wall.
A7	Magazine (subscribed)	magazine account, active subscription	Browses writers, reads evaluation reports, spends credits to preview and purchase.
A8	Administrator	personal account, role admin	Moderation queue, user management, manual eligibility grants.

Each generalisation in the table follows one of the three properties, so the table also fixes which generalisations hold. On the **plan**, the premium reader specialises the free reader; on the **role**, the writer specialises the free reader and the eligible writer specialises the writer; on the **subscription**, the subscribed magazine specialises the unsubscribed one. Two actors specialise no other. A **magazine** is a different account type with no role and no plan — a database constraint enforces it — so it inherits nothing from the readers or writers; a person who runs a magazine and also writes uses two accounts. The **administrator** holds a role that cannot be obtained through the interface and is granted in the database; its capabilities are moderation and management, not an extension of reading, so it is not drawn as a specialised reader either.

1.4 Functional requirements

The functional requirements are stated per actor, each with a stable identifier, a MoSCoW priority and the sprint that delivers it. Identifiers are stable rather than sequential: a requirement added later keeps the next free number and is listed beside the feature it belongs to. Table 1.3 summarises them; the full statements are given in Annex A.

Table 1.3 – Functional requirements by actor and priority

Actor	Requirements	Must	Should	Could	Sprints
Visitor (A1)	11	9	2	0	1, 4, 5, 8
Free and premium reader (A2, A3)	21	16	3	2	1, 2, 3, 5, 7, 8
Writer and eligible writer (A4, A5)	31	24	6	1	1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 8, 9
Magazine (A6, A7)	15	14	1	0	1, 3, 4, 5
Administrator (A8)	5	3	2	0	5
Cross-cutting	4	3	1	0	5
Total	**87**	**69**	**15**	**3**	

The platform counts 87 functional requirements, of which 69 are Must: four in five requirements belong to the minimum the delivery guarantees, which is expected for a platform whose three pillars depend on one another — dropping a Must from one pillar would break another. The Should and Could requirements are the comforts that make each feature pleasant rather than possible: search and browsing by tag, live comment previews, voice, sharing. The writers carry the most requirements (31), because the editor, the assistant, the analytics and the earnings all belong to them; the administrator carries the fewest (5), all delivered in one sprint. A requirement listed under two sprints is delivered in two steps, the second sprint completing the rule the first one prepared; Chapters 3 to 6 say which part each sprint delivers.

1.5 Non-functional requirements

Each non-functional requirement is stated as a property together with the mechanism that provides it and the way it is verified: by an automated **test** of the backend suite, by a **measurement** reported in Chapter 7, by **inspection** of the code or the configuration, or not at all when it is not met. Table 1.4 groups them by quality attribute. Identifiers are stable, as for the functional requirements.

Table 1.4 – Non-functional requirements and how each is verified

ID	Requirement	Mechanism	Verified by
	Security		
NFR-01	Passwords stored as bcrypt hashes, cost factor 12	authentication module, following [20]	inspection
NFR-02	Access tokens expire after 15 minutes, refresh tokens after 7 days	signed JWTs [21]	inspection
NFR-03	Every protected route passes one composed guard stack	one `@Auth()` decorator composing six guards	inspection
NFR-04	Authorisation is decided server-side; the client is told the verdict	the article access decision; locked content arrives as `null`	test
NFR-05	Per-address rate limits, tighter on credential routes	60 requests/min, 10/min on sign-in, 5/min on registration	measurement
NFR-06	Financial operations are idempotent under retry	a unique idempotency key on every ledger transaction	test

ID	Requirement	Mechanism	Verified by
NFR-07	Uploads are presigned, time-limited and never routed through the API	10-minute presigned upload URL	inspection
NFR-08	Datastore ports bind to the loopback interface only	Compose port bindings on `127.0.0.1`	inspection
NFR-09	A ban takes effect within 15 minutes at most	refused at sign-in, Google sign-in and refresh; an access token lasts 15 minutes	test
NFR-10	No stored HTML is ever rendered as markup	no raw-HTML rendering in the frontend	inspection
	Performance		
NFR-11	Semantic retrieval stays sub-linear as the corpus grows	HNSW index (m = 16, ef_construction = 64) [22]	measurement
NFR-12	Full-text search is index-backed with weighted ranking	weighted `tsvector` column and GIN index [23]	measurement
NFR-13	Prompt context is bounded	at most 5 passages, a memory block under 200 tokens	inspection
NFR-14	Feed pagination is cursor-based, stable under insertion	—	**not met**: pagination is by offset
NFR-15	Dashboard totals and rates read pre-aggregated rows	four rollup tables refreshed by the worker	measurement
NFR-16	Analytics aggregation is incremental and idempotent	each run reads only the events since the last one	inspection
NFR-17	Expensive AI output is cached and invalidated by what changes it	insights cached 24 h, dropped when the writer publishes	inspection
NFR-18	Streaming responses are never buffered end to end	nginx `proxy_buffering off`, 300 s read timeout	inspection
	Reliability		
NFR-19	Every denormalised balance equals the sum of its ledger rows	three invariants asserted after every money-moving test	test
NFR-20	Concurrent purchases cannot double-spend	`SELECT … FOR UPDATE` on the balance-owning row	test
NFR-21	Schema changes are versioned and applied before the application starts	a one-shot migration service	inspection
NFR-22	The vector extension exists before any migration that needs it	the migration runner creates it first	inspection
NFR-23	Failed background jobs retry with exponential back-off	—	**not met**: jobs run once
NFR-24	An AI provider outage degrades AI only	a model chain falling back from Groq to Gemini	test
NFR-25	Every service reports liveness and readiness	`GET /health` and `GET /ready`	partly met: readiness checks PostgreSQL only
	Scalability		
NFR-26	The API holds no session state	identity carried by JWT claims	inspection
NFR-27	Long-running work never runs in the request path	six BullMQ queues consumed by a separate worker	inspection
NFR-28	API and worker scale horizontally behind the proxy	stateless containers, one Compose service each	not measured
	Maintainability		
NFR-29	Both code bases compile in strict mode with zero lint warnings	`tsc --noEmit`, `eslint --max-warnings=0`	continuous integration
NFR-30	The API contract is generated from OpenAPI	client types generated from the backend's OpenAPI document	inspection

ID	Requirement	Mechanism	Verified by
NFR-31	Business rules are tested, not asserted	796 backend tests	test
NFR-32	The build fails when schema and migrations disagree	a schema-drift check	continuous integration
NFR-33	Errors are captured in every runtime without personal data	Sentry in API, worker, Next.js server and browser	inspection
	Usability		
NFR-34	Two breakpoints are designed and implemented	375 px and 1280–1440 px	measurement (accessibility at both)
NFR-35	One design system, applied consistently	39 design tokens and 87 components in Figma	inspection
NFR-36	A complete dark mode	theme switch across every screen	inspection
NFR-37	Lighthouse score above 90 and no critical accessibility violation on article pages	production build audited	measurement: partly met

Of the 37 requirements, seven are verified by an automated test and six by a measurement in Chapter 7; two are enforced by the continuous-integration pipeline. The others rest on inspection — they are properties of configuration (port bindings, nginx buffering, Compose dependencies) rather than of behaviour, and a test would only restate the configuration. Five are not fully met and are stated as such: NFR-14 (offset pagination), NFR-23 (no queue is configured with retries, so a failed job is not attempted again), NFR-25 (readiness ignores Redis), NFR-28 (horizontal scaling is designed for but was never exercised) and NFR-37 (met on desktop and for critical violations, not on mobile — see Section 7.5). They return as limitations in the general conclusion.

1.6 Global use case diagram

Figure 1.3 gives the global use case diagram. It is deliberately coarse: each use case stands for a family of interactions refined in the per-sprint diagrams of Chapters 3 to 6. The actors are drawn in three separate groups — the personal accounts on the left, the magazines and the administrator on the right — so that only the generalisations of Section 1.3 appear.

Every authenticated use case includes *Sign in*. *Sign in with Google* and *Create an account* both extend it: a visitor reaches registration from the sign-in page, and Google sign-in creates the account on first use. Listing on the marketplace extends publishing; unlocking a preview extends acquiring an article; grounding answers in uploaded documents extends the use of the assistant, which always includes retrieval from the writer's own corpus. The administrator's three use cases — reviewing the report queue, managing users and granting eligibility — are the concrete operations that the administration console offers. The diagram shows that the system has a single entry point for every privileged action, *Sign in*, which is where the guard stack of NFR-03 applies, and that only two use cases depend on external providers: the assistant on the language model and retrieval on the embedding model.

1.7 Global class diagram

The data model counts thirty persisted tables. Drawn in a single diagram they form an unreadable strip, because `User` is related to most of the others, so the global class diagram is split by domain into two figures. Attributes are shown with domain types (`Json`, `Vector`, `Timestamp`); audit columns are omitted. Each class shows the main **operations** it supports; they are implemented by the service of the same domain (for instance

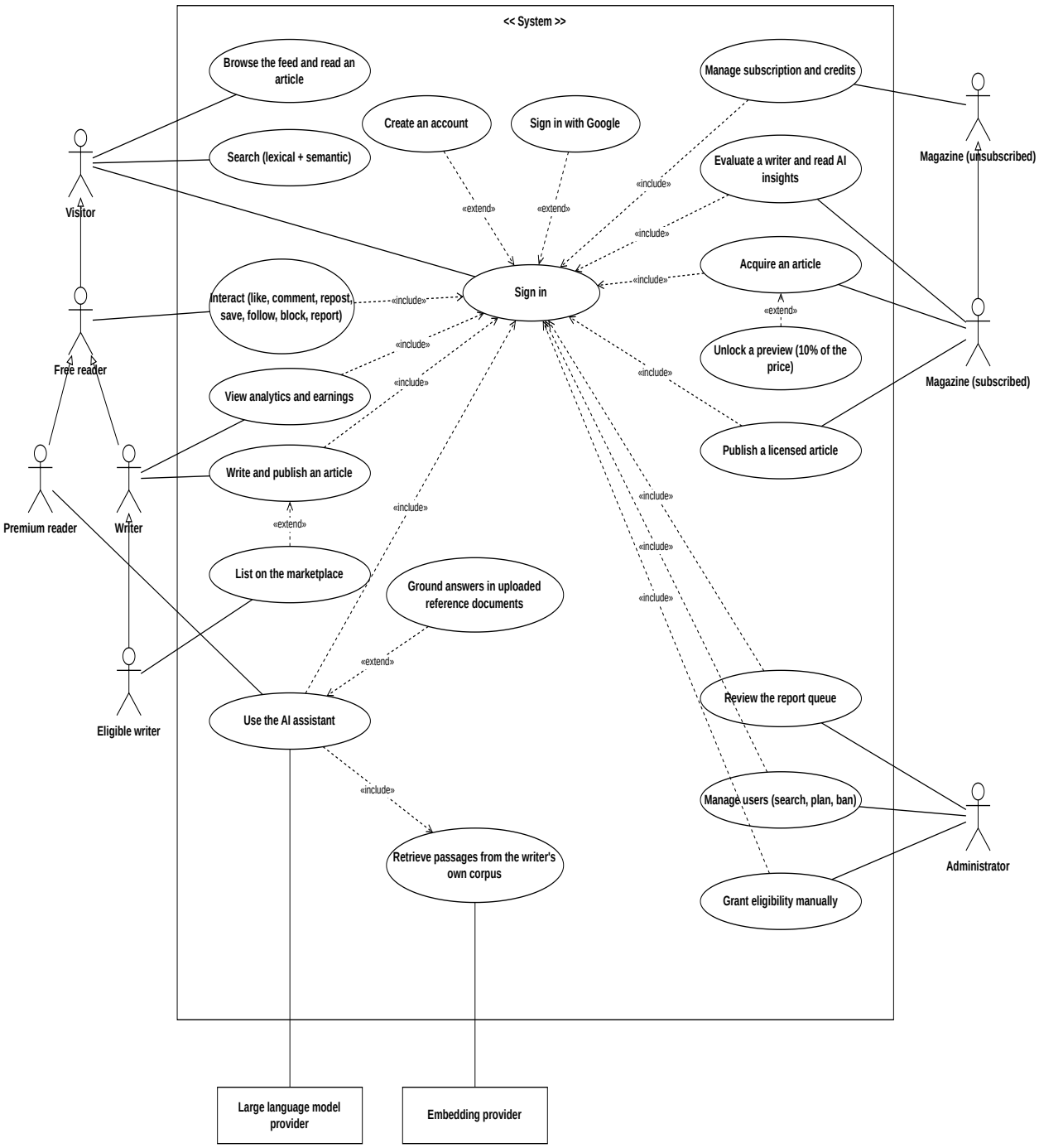


Figure 1.3 – Global use case diagram

`Article.publish()` by the articles service), because the classes are persisted records and the behaviour lives in the service layer. Relationships that carry nothing but a pair and a date — likes, comment likes, reposts, saves, follows, blocks, tags — are drawn as many-to-many associations; each is stored as a join table with a unique constraint on its pair.

Core domain. Figure 1.4 shows accounts, articles and their social layer: the `User` and its optional `MagazineProfile`, the `Article` with its placement, visibility and price, tags, threaded comments, notifications and reports.

The diagram shows that the social layer adds no entity of its own: every interaction is an association between a user and an article, a comment or another user. That is what makes interactions cheap to count for analytics and impossible to duplicate, since the unique pair constraint turns a repeated like into a no-op.

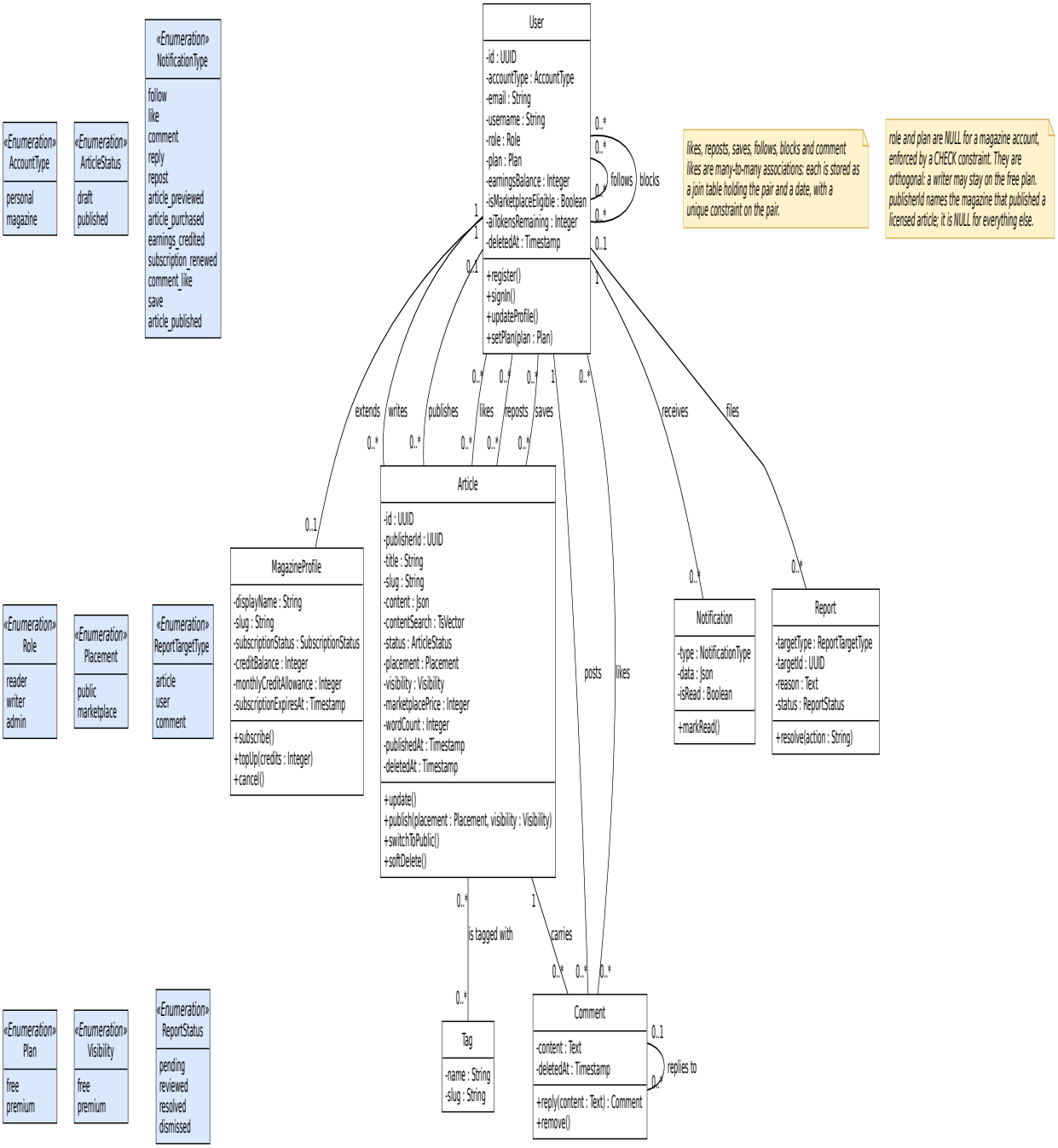


Figure 1.4 – Class diagram: core domain

`Article.publisherId` names the magazine that published a licensed article and is empty for every other article; it is the single attribute through which the marketplace changes the core model.

AI, marketplace and analytics. Figure 1.5 shows the remaining tables: the article chunks embedded for retrieval, the writer memory, the cached portfolio insights and the AI interaction log; the private document library and its chunks; purchases, ledger transactions, magazine subscriptions and the eligibility audit log; and the raw analytics events with the four metric rollups.

Two properties follow from this diagram. Money is never a single number: a `Purchase` records two to three `Transaction` rows, and every balance can be recomputed from them, which is what the ledger invariants of NFR-19 check. And the analytics are layered: raw `AnalyticsEvent` rows are written once and never read by a dashboard, which reads only the rollups, so a dashboard's cost does not grow with the event log (NFR-15).

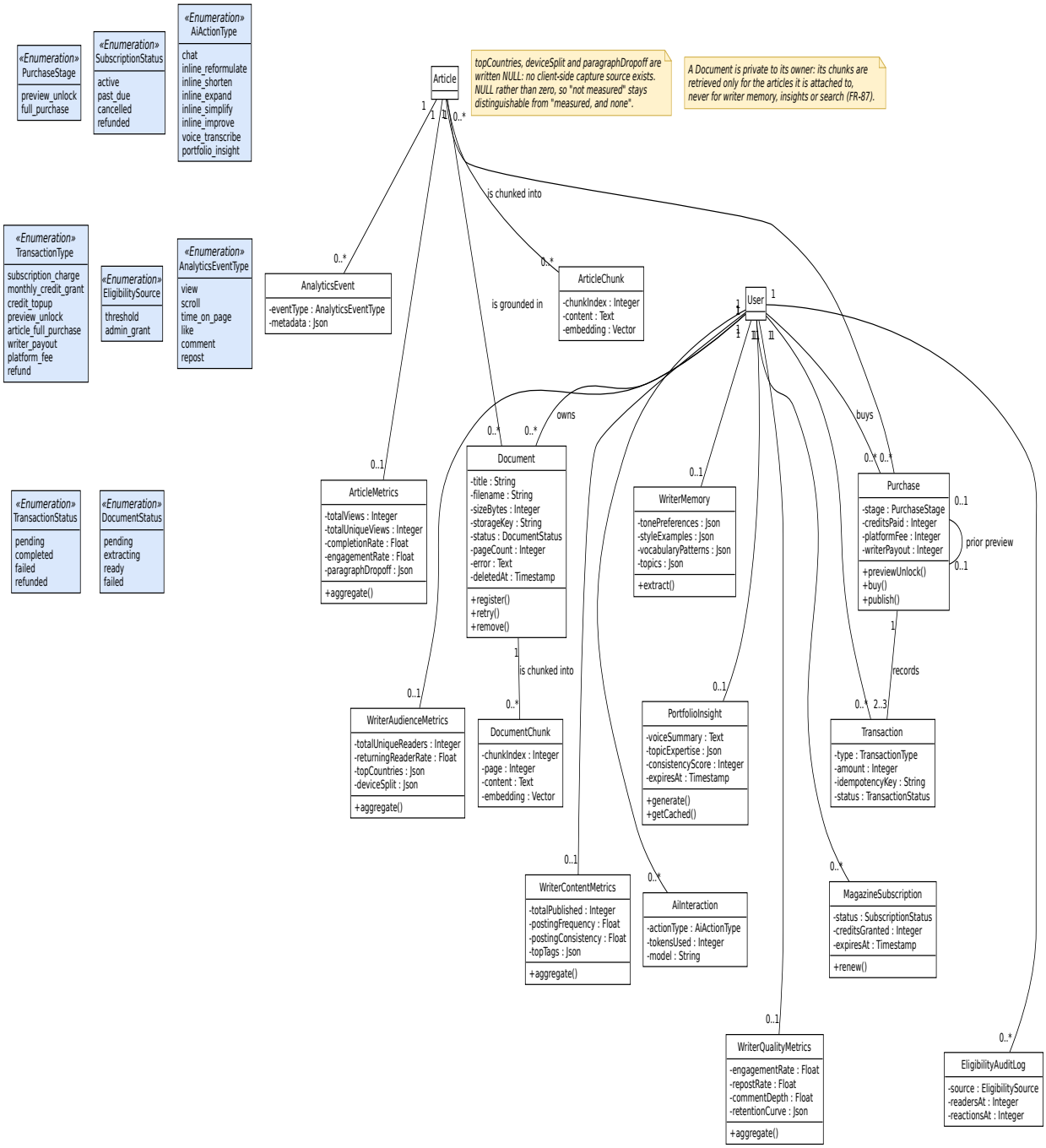


Figure 1.5 – Class diagram: AI, marketplace and analytics

1.8 Product backlog

The product backlog expresses the requirements as user stories of the form *"As an ⟨actor⟩, I want ⟨goal⟩ so that ⟨benefit⟩"*, grouped into nine epics, prioritised with MoSCoW and estimated in story points relative to the simplest story (US-01). The backlog counts **74 stories for 350 points**. Table 1.5 summarises it by epic; the full backlog is given in Annex B.

Table 1.5 – Product backlog by epic

Epic	Stories	Points	Share of points
E1 — Accounts and authentication	5	17	5 %
E2 — Writing and publishing	8	30	9 %

Epic	Stories	Points	Share of points
E3 — AI assistance	13	73	21 %
E4 — Discovery and search	4	18	5 %
E5 — Social interactions and notifications	15	52	15 %
E6 — Analytics	4	32	9 %
E7 — Marketplace and subscriptions	12	63	18 %
E8 — Moderation and administration	6	24	7 %
E9 — Quality and operations (technical stories)	7	41	12 %
Total	**74**	**350**	100 %

The distribution of points shows where the effort lies. The AI assistance epic is the heaviest (21% of the points) although it is not the largest in stories: its stories — retrieval grounded in the writer's corpus, writing into the document, voice, the document library — are few but each is large, because each joins a model call to the editor and to the data model. The marketplace comes next (18%), for the same reason applied to money: a small number of stories, each guarded by transactions, locks and ledger checks. The social epic has the most stories but small ones, and the technical epic E9 (12%) is the price of a platform that runs, migrates and is tested with one command. In short, the effort follows the product's ambition: two of its three pillars, AI and the marketplace, take almost two fifths of the points.

1.9 Release plan and schedule

The stories are delivered in four releases of two or three sprints each, every sprint lasting two weeks. Table 1.6 gives the plan with the points committed per sprint. The foundation week and the three-sprint design track are not sprints, because they deliver no user-facing increment; they are presented with the working environment in Chapter 2.

Table 1.6 – Release plan

Release	Sprint	Dates	Goal	Points
R1 — Functional foundation	Sprint 1	09/02 – 20/02	Schema, authentication, article core, ledger invariant harness	45
	Sprint 2	06/04 – 17/04	Editor, AI chat and inline actions, analytics event capture	45
R2 — Social, analytics and AI	Sprint 3	20/04 – 01/05	Social interactions, notifications, aggregation, dashboards	44
	Sprint 4	04/05 – 15/05	Retrieval-augmented generation, portfolio insights, hybrid search, writer memory	52
R3 — Marketplace, testing and deployment	Sprint 5	18/05 – 29/05	Marketplace, subscriptions, premium, moderation, administration	85
	Sprint 6	01/06 – 12/06	Tests, demonstration corpus, deployment, CI/CD	20
R4 — Social depth, assistant and documents	Sprint 7	15/06 – 26/06	Comment likes, follower lists, block, save, share	18
	Sprint 8	29/06 – 10/07	Live card controls, reposts, byline preview, assistant writing into the document, voice	38
	Sprint 9	13/07 – 24/07	Document library, ingestion, attachment, citations	16

The order of the releases follows the layering argued in Section 1.2: each release needs the data the previous one produces. The loads are uneven. Sprint 5 commits 85 points against an average near 40, because the marketplace stories — subscription, credits, preview, purchase, publication, earnings — share one transaction

model and were planned together rather than split across two sprints. Sprints 6, 7 and 9 are light, for two different reasons: Sprint 6's real work, the test suite that proves the business rules, is not expressed as user stories, and Release 4 runs alongside the writing of this report. How this plan compares with what was delivered is measured in Section 7.7.

Figure 1.6 places the work on the project window, from 2 February to 31 July 2026: the foundation week and Sprint 1, the design track, Sprints 2 to 9 in four releases, and the writing of this report alongside the last sprints.

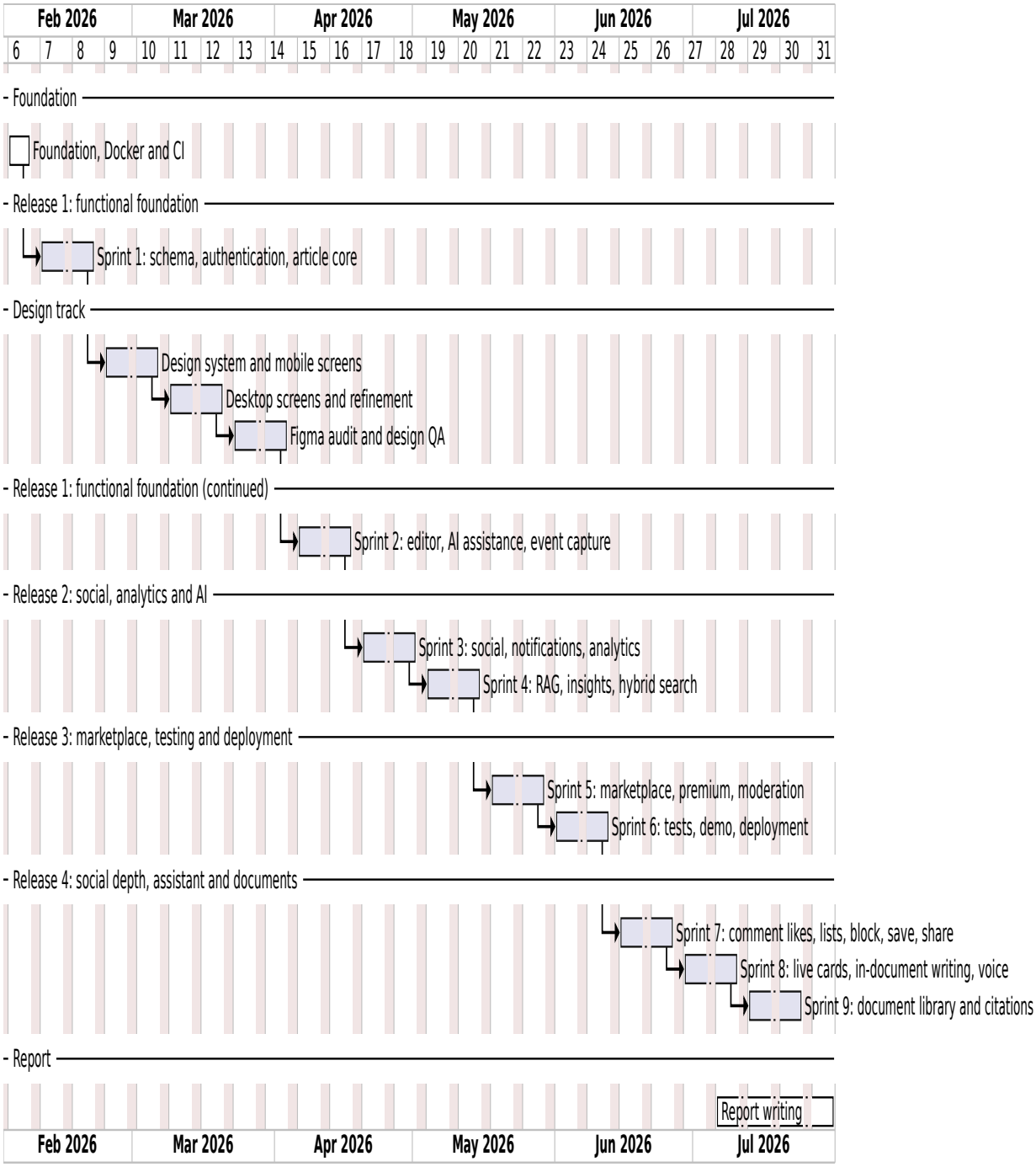


Figure 1.6 – Gantt chart of the project

The chart shows the one break in the rhythm of the sprints: the six weeks of the design track between Sprint 1 and Sprint 2. Placing them there was deliberate — the editor and the social features of Sprint 2 onwards were built from finished screens rather than designed while being coded — and it is the reason the first release

spans two months instead of one.

Conclusion

This chapter situated the project, showed that no existing family of solutions combines AI writing grounded in the writer’s own work, buyer-facing analytics and a licensing market, and justified the use of Scrum and its adaptation to a one-person project. It then identified the eight actors, specified 87 functional and 37 non-functional requirements with the way each is verified, presented the global use case and class diagrams, and organised the work into a backlog of 74 user stories delivered by nine sprints in four releases. The next chapter describes the environment in which the work was done, the technological choices and the architecture of the system.

CHAPTER 2

Working environment and architecture

Introduction

Before the release chapters, this chapter describes the environment the platform was built in: the hardware and software used, the work that preceded the feature sprints, the technological choices compared with their alternatives, the main parameters of the system and their justification, and the architecture of the system — its logical decomposition on the frontend and the backend, its physical deployment and its delivery pipeline.

2.1 Working environment

2.1.1 Hardware environment

The project was developed and every measurement of Chapter 7 was taken on a single workstation, described in Table 2.1. A mid-range laptop is a deliberate baseline: the whole stack of eight containers runs on it, so the performance figures reported later are those of commodity hardware, not of a server.

Table 2.1 – Hardware environment

Component	Specification
Machine	Lenovo ThinkPad
Processor	Intel Core i7-1355U
Memory	24 GB RAM
Graphics	NVIDIA GeForce MX550
Storage	512 GB NVMe SSD
Operating system	Ubuntu Linux

2.1.2 Software environment

Table 2.2 lists the tools used outside the application code itself. They share a principle: every artefact — code, diagrams, this report — is kept as text under version control, and everything that runs, runs in a container.

Table 2.2 – Software tools

Tool	Use
JetBrains IDE	code editor
Git and GitHub	version control, pull requests, continuous integration (GitHub Actions) and container registry (GHCR)
Docker and Docker Compose	containers for every service, in development and in production [24]
Figma	design system and screen design
PlantUML and draw.io	UML and architecture diagrams, kept as versioned sources
Swagger UI	exploring the REST API through the OpenAPI document the backend generates
Playwright	end-to-end tests and the capture of this report's screenshots [25]
Pandoc and LuaLaTeX	assembling and typesetting this report from its Markdown sources

2.1.3 Foundation and design track

Two blocks of work preceded the feature sprints and are presented here rather than as sprints, because neither delivers a user-facing increment.

- **Foundation (one week).** The three repositories, their Docker images, the Compose stack, the reverse proxy and the continuous-integration pipeline were set up first, so that every later sprint started from a stack that builds, tests and runs with one command.
- **Design track (three sprints).** The user interface was designed in Figma before the editor and the social features were built: a design system of **39 tokens and 87 components**, then the full screen set at two widths — **375 px for mobile and 1280–1440 px for desktop**, 58 screens — then an audit of the screens against the specification. The release chapters implement these designs.

2.1.4 Repository organisation

The source code lives in four Git repositories. `docker.inkwell.ai` is the superproject: it holds the Compose files, the nginx configuration, the deployment workflow and the developer Makefile, and it carries the three others as **Git submodules** — `backend.inkwell.ai`, `frontend.inkwell.ai`, and `spec.inkwell.ai`, which holds the specifications, the diagrams and this report. A commit of the superproject therefore identifies one exact, deployable revision of the whole system.

2.2 Technological choices

Each choice below is compared with the alternatives that were considered and the criteria that decided between them, with a source for every claim that is not a property of the project itself.

2.2.1 Frontend

Table 2.3 gives the frontend stack. Its central decision is the web framework: the platform's public pages — the feed, articles, profiles — must be rendered on the server so that search engines and link previews see their content, while the editor and the assistant are interactive applications.

Table 2.3 – Frontend technologies compared with their alternatives

Choice	Alternatives considered	Deciding criteria
Next.js 16 (App Router) with **React 19**	Remix, Nuxt (Vue), a client-only React application	server rendering per route for public pages and a request proxy for protected routes, in the most used React framework [26], [27]; a client-only application would serve empty HTML to search engines
TypeScript (strict)	JavaScript	one typed language from the database schema to the browser; the API client types are generated from the backend (NFR-30)
Tailwind CSS 4 with accessible headless primitives	CSS modules, a component library such as MUI	the Figma tokens map directly to utility classes; headless primitives give accessible dialogs and menus without imposing a visual style
TipTap 3	Lexical, Slate, Quill	built on ProseMirror, stores the document as JSON, and accepts custom extensions — the protected range the assistant writes into needs one [28]
TanStack Query 5 and **Zustand 5**	Redux Toolkit	server state (caching, invalidation, optimistic updates) and client state handled separately, with far less code than a single global store

Vercel AI SDK (React bindings)	hand-written stream parsing	consumes the assistant's typed stream of text, status and write parts [29]

2.2.2 Backend

Table 2.4 gives the backend stack. Its two structuring decisions are the framework, which must host both an HTTP API and a background worker, and the data store, which must hold relational data, full-text search and vector search.

Table 2.4 – Backend technologies compared with their alternatives

Choice	Alternatives considered	Deciding criteria
NestJS 11	Express or Fastify alone	modules, dependency injection, guards and OpenAPI generation built in [30]; the same modules serve the API and the worker. Fastify is faster in raw benchmarks [31], but the API's latency is dominated by the database and the model calls (Section 7.5), not by the HTTP layer
PostgreSQL 16 + pgvector	PostgreSQL with a separate vector database (Qdrant, Pinecone)	relational data, full-text search and vector search in one database [23], [32]: an article and its embeddings change in one transaction and are never out of sync, and there is one service less to run. HNSW, the index pgvector offers, is among the best recall-per-latency trade-offs in public benchmarks [33]
Drizzle ORM	Prisma, TypeORM	SQL-shaped, type-safe queries with explicit migrations [34]; the purchase transaction needs `SELECT … FOR UPDATE` and the search needs `ts_rank` and vector operators, which Drizzle writes directly
Redis 7 + BullMQ	RabbitMQ, PostgreSQL-based queues	repeatable jobs, priorities and a separate worker process on one Redis instance [35]; Redis also carries the notification fan-out
MinIO	storing files in PostgreSQL, a cloud bucket	the S3 API, so the same presigned-upload code runs against a cloud bucket in production; files never pass through the API
Passport (JWT, Google OAuth 2.0) and **bcrypt**	an external identity provider	standard strategies [21], [36] with the session data kept in the platform's own database

2.2.3 Artificial-intelligence services

Table 2.5 lists the models and why each was chosen. Two constraints shaped all of them: the project runs on providers' free tiers, and a model that is slow to *start* answering makes the assistant feel broken, whatever its quality.

Table 2.5 – AI models, their alternatives and the reasons for the choice

Use	Model	Alternatives considered	Deciding criteria
Chat, writing, inline actions, insights, writer memory	Groq `gpt-oss-120b`, then `gpt-oss-20b`, then Google `gemini-3.5-flash`	OpenAI API, a single provider	Groq serves open-weight models on dedicated inference hardware with a generous free tier [37]; a second provider makes an outage degrade the assistant only (NFR-24)

Use	Model	Alternatives considered	Deciding criteria
Embeddings	Google `gemini-embedding-001`, 1,536 dimensions	OpenAI embeddings, a local model	separate task types for queries and documents [38]; its free tier covered the corpus
Speech-to-text	Groq `whisper-large-v3-turbo`	browser speech recognition	same provider as the chat; multilingual; works in every browser
Text-to-speech	Google `gemini-2.5-flash-preview-tts`	browser speech synthesis	a natural voice, identical in every browser
Moderation at publish	Groq `gpt-oss-20b`	a dedicated safety model (`gpt-oss-safeguard-20b`)	measured: precision 0.93 and recall 1.00 on a labelled set, while the dedicated model exceeded the time budget (Section 7.4)

The chain of chat models is what makes a provider outage degrade the assistant only: the first chunk of a response is pulled before anything is sent to the browser, so a refusal from one model can still be answered by the next. The moderation classifier is the one choice settled by measurement rather than by documentation; Chapter 7 reports the measurement.

2.2.4 Infrastructure and quality

Docker Compose runs eight services — nginx, web, api, worker, a one-shot migration service, PostgreSQL, Redis and MinIO. **nginx** terminates TLS and routes traffic. **GitHub Actions** runs the quality gates and builds the images; **GHCR** stores them. **Jest** tests the backend against a real PostgreSQL database, **Playwright** drives a real browser end to end, and **Sentry** captures errors in the four runtimes. Kubernetes was considered and rejected: a single host with Compose is enough for the expected load, and the containers are already stateless (NFR-26) should the platform ever need an orchestrator.

2.3 Main parameters and their justification

The behaviour of the platform depends on a few numbers. Table 2.6 gives each, with its value and the reason for it — a source, a measurement, or a product decision stated as such.

Table 2.6 – Main parameters of the system and their justification

Parameter	Value	Justification
Passages retrieved per question	5	enough context for an answer while keeping the prompt near 2,000 tokens (NFR-13)
Similarity floor for retrieval and search	0.60	measured: relevant passages score 0.66–0.84 and off-topic ones 0.52–0.66 (Section 7.2)
Chunk length	120 – 1,200 characters, prefixed by the nearest heading	a paragraph is the unit of meaning; shorter fragments embed poorly, longer ones mix topics
Fusion constant of RRF	k = 60	the value recommended by the method's authors [39]; confirmed in Section 7.3
HNSW index	m = 16, ef_construction = 64	pgvector's defaults, a balanced recall–build-time setting [22], [32]
Embedding width	1,536	supported output width of the model [38]; fixed by the schema
Premium AI allowance	20,000 tokens a day	product decision: about twenty long replies or sixty inline edits, a working day
Voice billing	200 tokens per started minute, at most 5 minutes	product decision, so that dictation consumes the same allowance as typing

Parameter	Value	Justification
Preview price	10% of the article's price	product decision, credited towards the purchase
Platform fee	20% of each stage, rounded down	product decision; computed in integer basis points so that no amount is ever a float
Monthly credits	500 per subscription	product decision; unspent credits roll over
Eligibility thresholds	5,000 unique readers and 1,000 reactions	product decision: high enough that eligibility signals a real audience
Token lifetimes	15 minutes (access), 7 days (refresh)	a short access token bounds how long a ban or a stolen token stays valid (NFR-09)
Rate limits	60/min, 10/min on sign-in, 5/min on registration	enough for a reader, too few for password guessing
Password hashing	bcrypt, cost 12	about 250 ms per hash: slow enough to make an offline attack expensive [20]
Presigned upload lifetime	10 minutes	long enough for a slow mobile upload, short enough that a leaked URL is stale
Document limits	10 MB, 200 pages, 20 per writer	bound the cost of ingestion and the size of the library

The table shows three kinds of justification. The retrieval parameters are set by measurement or by the literature, and Chapter 7 checks them. The security parameters follow published guidance. The economic parameters — prices, fee, credits, thresholds — are product decisions: they have no "correct" value, and they are named constants in one place in the code precisely so that they can be changed as a decision rather than discovered in a calculation.

2.4 Logical architecture

2.4.1 Frontend

Figure 2.1 shows the logical architecture of the frontend, organised in layers from the routes down to the network.

The **routes** (28 pages) compose **feature modules** (18, among them the editor, the assistant, documents, the marketplace and the evaluation report). A **state and data** layer holds the query cache, the client stores, the HTTP interceptors that refresh an expired access token and retry the request, and the analytics tracker. A **request proxy** protects private routes before a page renders. Two channels bypass the REST API: an **SSE client** for live notifications, and **direct uploads** from the browser to object storage. The figure shows that no feature module talks to the network directly: they go through the data layer, which is why token refresh and error handling are written once.

2.4.2 Backend

Figure 2.2 shows the backend, which runs as two processes from the same image.

The **API** is a modular NestJS application: a global rate-limiting guard runs on every route, then the guards composed once by the `@Auth()` decorator — authentication, role, plan, account type, subscription and AI quota. The feature modules cover authentication and users, articles, social interactions, AI, analytics, the marketplace, search, moderation and uploads, and documents. The **worker** consumes six queues: `embeddings` (chunking and embedding articles, extracting writer memory), `analytics` (article and writer rollups), `marketplace` (eligibility and subscription renewal), `ai-tokens` (the nightly allowance reset), `documents` (ingesting uploaded documents) and `ai-models` (a daily check that every model still answers).

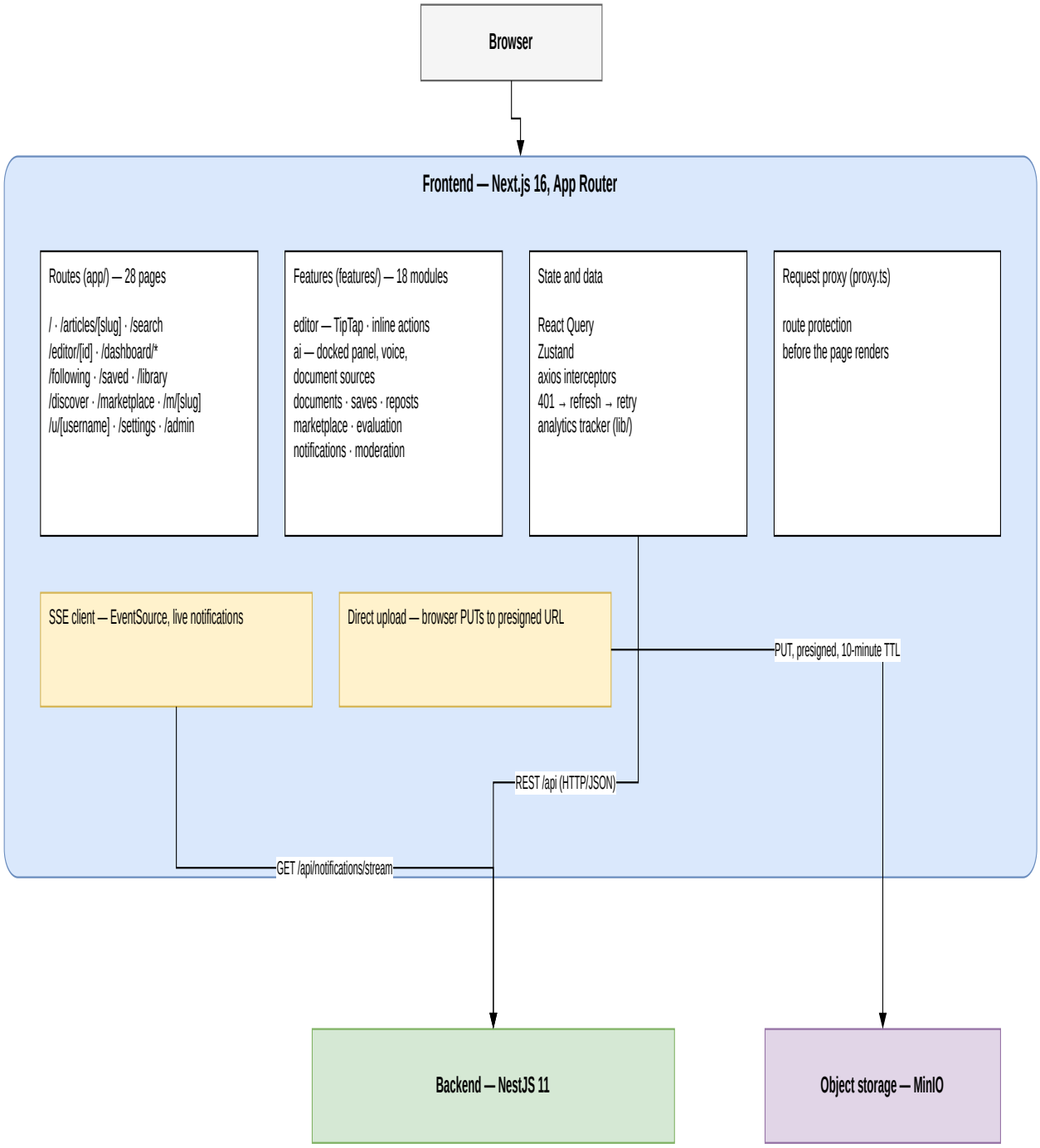


Figure 2.1 – Logical frontend architecture

The figure makes the split visible: everything slow or scheduled lives in the worker, so the API's response time never includes a model call made on behalf of a background task (NFR-27).

2.5 Physical architecture

Figure 2.3 shows the deployment of the eight services on one host.

nginx is the only service published, on ports 80 and 443: it terminates TLS, proxies `/` to the Next.js server and `/api` to the NestJS API, keeps server-sent events unbuffered, and serves the public image bucket at `/storage`. Private documents never take that path; they are read through the API, which checks ownership. The datastores are reachable only from inside the Compose network. The figure therefore shows a single

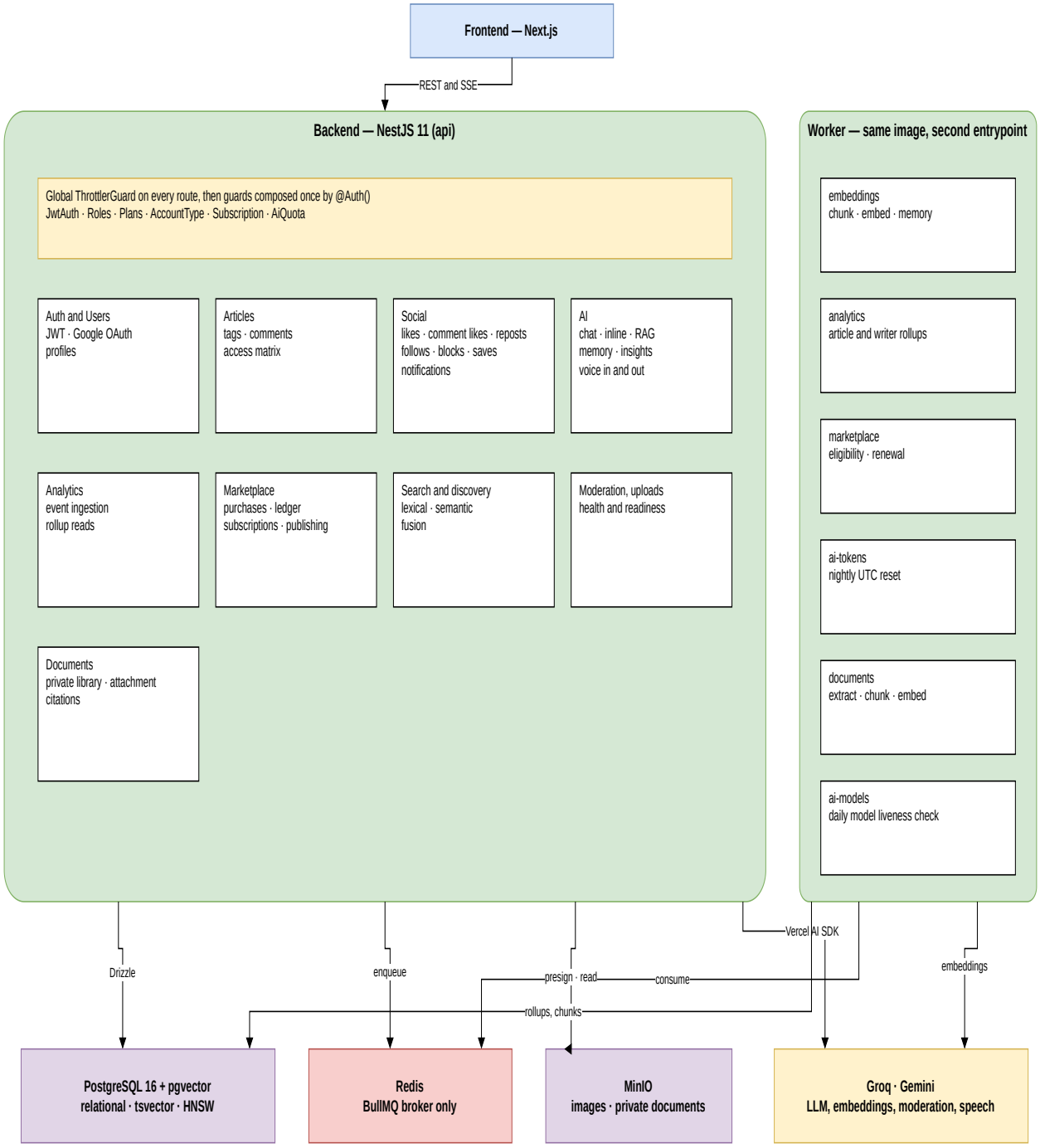


Figure 2.2 – Logical backend architecture

attack surface — one proxy — and a single place where TLS, buffering and timeouts are configured.

2.6 Continuous integration and delivery

Figure 2.4 shows the pipeline from a push to a running service.

A push to `main` on either application repository runs the quality gates — install, lint with zero warnings, type-check, the backend tests, a schema-drift check — then builds a multi-stage image and pushes it to GHCR, tagged both `latest` and with the commit hash. A repository dispatch then triggers the deployment workflow of the superproject, which pulls the images on the server, runs the migrations (which must succeed before the API and worker start), restarts the services, verifies the health and readiness endpoints and reloads nginx.

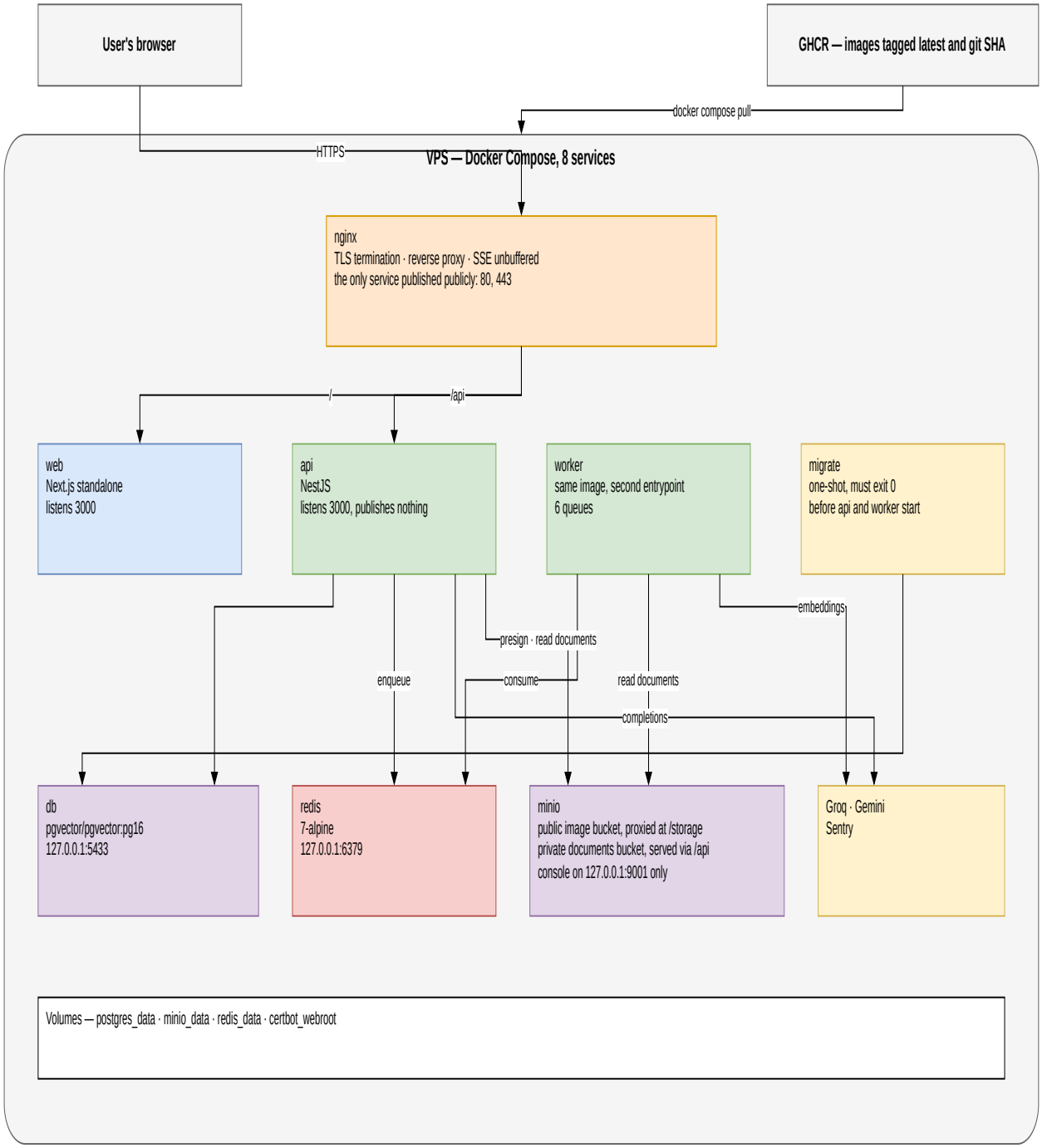


Figure 2.3 – Physical architecture

The pipeline guarantees that no image reaches the registry without passing the gates, and the commit-hash tag means any deployed version can be traced to its source and redeployed.

Conclusion

This chapter presented the working environment, compared the technological choices with their alternatives, justified the main parameters of the system, and described its logical and physical architecture and its delivery pipeline. The following chapters present the four releases, starting with the functional foundation.

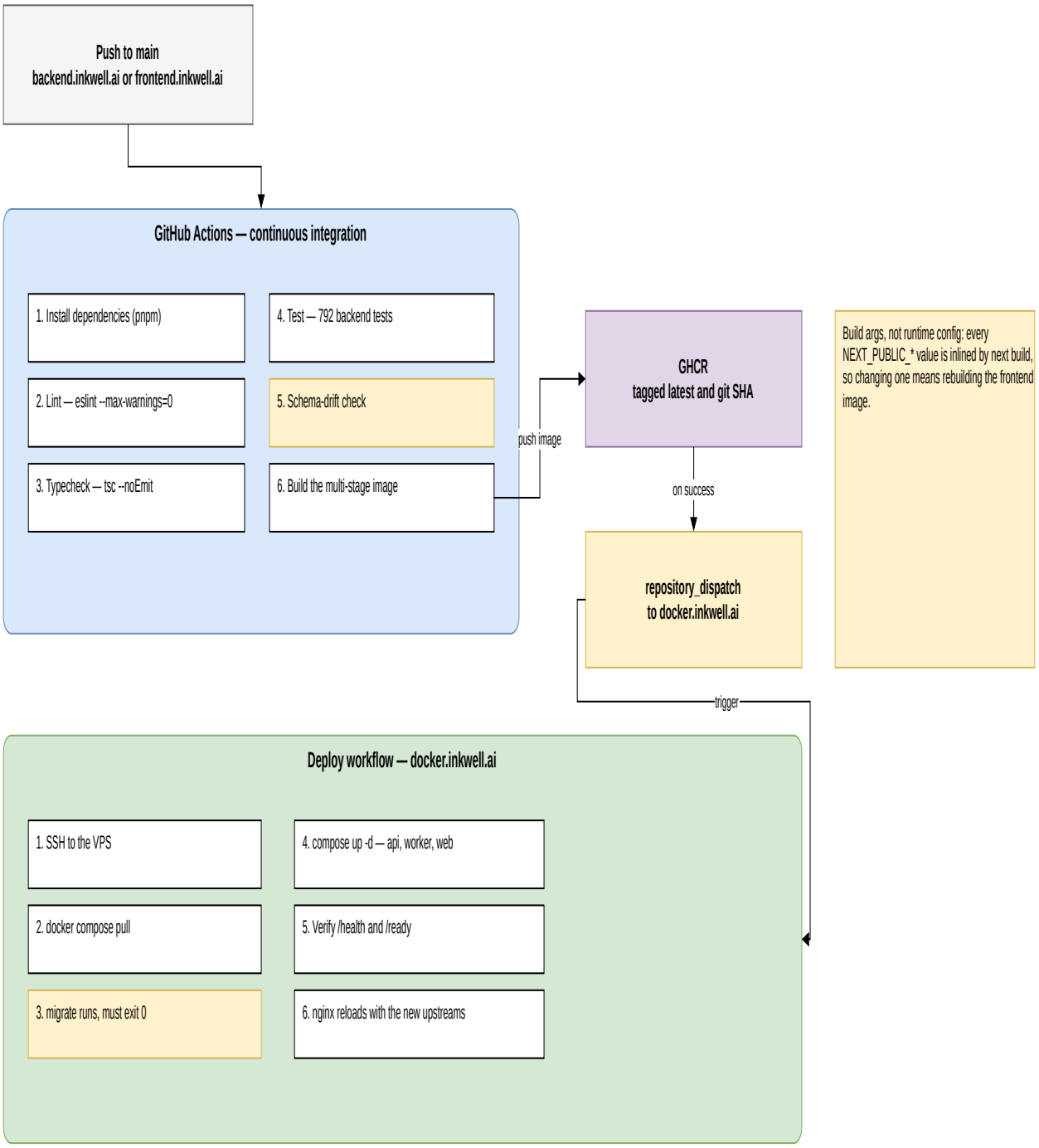


Figure 2.4 – CI/CD pipeline

CHAPTER 3

Release 1: functional foundation

Introduction

The first release lays the foundation every later feature depends on. Sprint 1 delivers the data model, authentication and the core of article management; Sprint 2 delivers the rich-text editor, the first version of the AI assistant and the capture of reading events that the analytics of Release 2 will aggregate. Each sprint is presented in the same four steps: its backlog, the analysis, the design and the realisation.

3.1 Sprint 1 — Schema, authentication and article core

3.1.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 1 is that a visitor can register and sign in, by password or with Google; that a writer can create, edit, publish and delete articles, choosing their placement and visibility; that a visitor can browse the public feed and read free articles; and that the ledger invariant harness exists before any feature moves money. Table 3.1 lists the stories committed.

Table 3.1 – Sprint 1 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-01	Register with an email and a password	Must	3
US-02	Sign in with Google	Should	3
US-03	Register as a magazine with my branding	Must	5
US-04	Stay signed in across a long writing session	Must	3
US-05	Edit my profile and avatar	Should	3
US-10	Tag an article	Should	2
US-11	Choose at publish time whether an article is public or for sale	Must	5
US-49	Prove that every balance equals its ledger sum, after every money-moving operation	Must	8
US-50	Bring the whole stack up with one command, reproducibly	Must	8
US-51	Fail the build on a lint error, a type error, a failing test or schema drift	Must	5
	10 stories		**45**

The sprint commits 45 points, close to the average of the project. Almost a fifth of them (US-49, US-50, US-51) produce nothing a user sees — the invariant harness, the one-command stack and the quality gates — and were placed first on purpose: every later sprint is built and verified with them.

3.1.2 Analysis

Use case diagram. Figure 3.1 refines the global diagram for the scope of Sprint 1.

Registering specialises into registering as a reader or as a magazine; managing one's own articles specialises into creating a draft, editing, publishing and deleting; publishing includes choosing a placement and a visibility. The diagram shows that from the first sprint every account is one of two types and every article has a placement: the two properties on which the marketplace of Release 3 rests are in place before the marketplace itself.

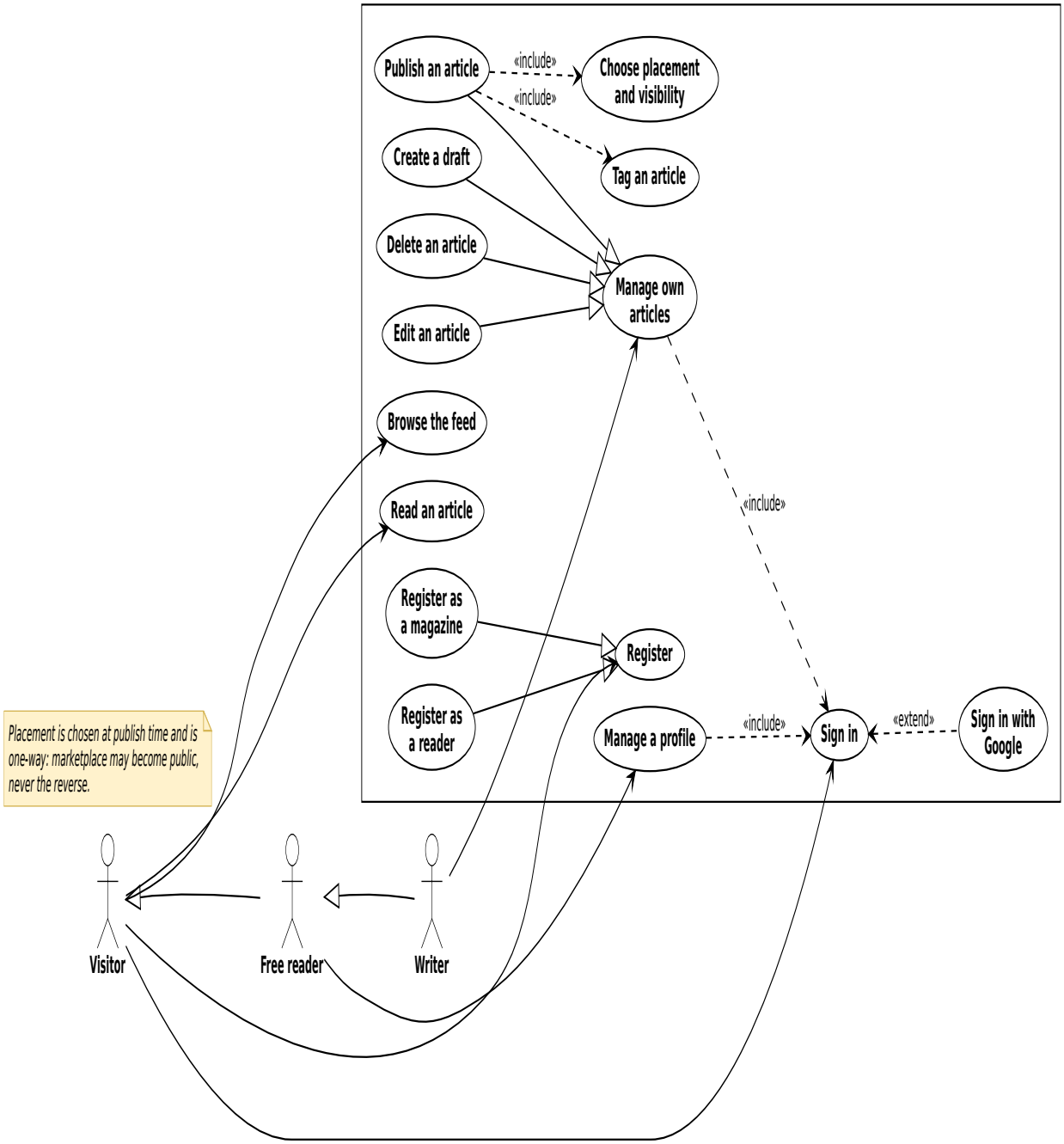


Figure 3.1 – Use case diagram, Sprint 1

Textual description. Table 3.2 details the central use case of the sprint.

Table 3.2 – Textual description of “Publish an article”

Item	Description
Use case	Publish an article
Actor	Writer (A4)
Pre-condition	The writer is signed in and owns a draft
Post-condition	The article is published with its placement, visibility, slug and reading time

Item	Description
Main scenario	1. The writer opens the publish dialog. 2. The writer chooses a placement (public or marketplace) and, for a public article, a visibility (free or premium), and sets the cover, tags and excerpt. 3. The system checks the choices. 4. The system publishes the article and computes its word count and reading time. 5. The article appears in the feed (public) or is kept for the marketplace (marketplace).
Alternative scenario	3a. A marketplace placement without a price: the system refuses and keeps the draft.

The description shows the scope of Sprint 1 for publishing: the placement and the visibility are stored and validated, but nobody yet acts on them. From Sprint 5, the premium visibility and the marketplace placement are reserved to eligible writers (FR-35, FR-36), which adds a refusal at step 3; FR-23 and FR-24 are therefore delivered in two steps, and the backlog records both sprints.

3.1.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 3.2 shows the classes of Sprint 1.

The `User` carries its account type, authentication provider, role and plan; the `MagazineProfile` extends a magazine account with its name, slug and branding; the `Article` carries its status, placement, visibility and generated search vector; tags are a many-to-many association and comments form a thread. The diagram shows the single-table design of accounts: one `User` class for every kind of account, the differences carried by attributes, and a database constraint that keeps role and plan empty for a magazine. That is what lets one authentication path serve every actor.

Sequence diagram — sign in. Figure 3.3 shows signing in and the silent refresh that keeps a session alive.

Sign-in is rate-limited per address — ten attempts a minute, five for registration, against sixty for other routes — and answers 429 before the account is even read. On success the system issues a 15-minute access token and a 7-day refresh token; when a later request meets an expired access token, the client refreshes it, rewrites both the client store and the cookie the route proxy reads, and retries the original request transparently. The diagram shows why a long writing session is never interrupted (US-04) while a stolen or revoked access token is useful for at most fifteen minutes (NFR-02, NFR-09).

The ledger invariant harness. Money-like data appears from Sprint 5 onwards, but its correctness rule is set here: every denormalised balance — a magazine's credit balance, a writer's earnings — must equal the sum of its ledger rows. Three invariants encode that rule and are asserted after every test that moves credits. The harness is itself tested by sabotage: fixtures build a coherent purchase, then corrupt one column at a time and check that the right invariant fails. Writing the check before the feature means that no purchase code was ever written without it.

3.1.4 Realisation

The realisation of Sprint 1 is what a visitor sees first. Figure 3.4 shows the public feed reached without an account.

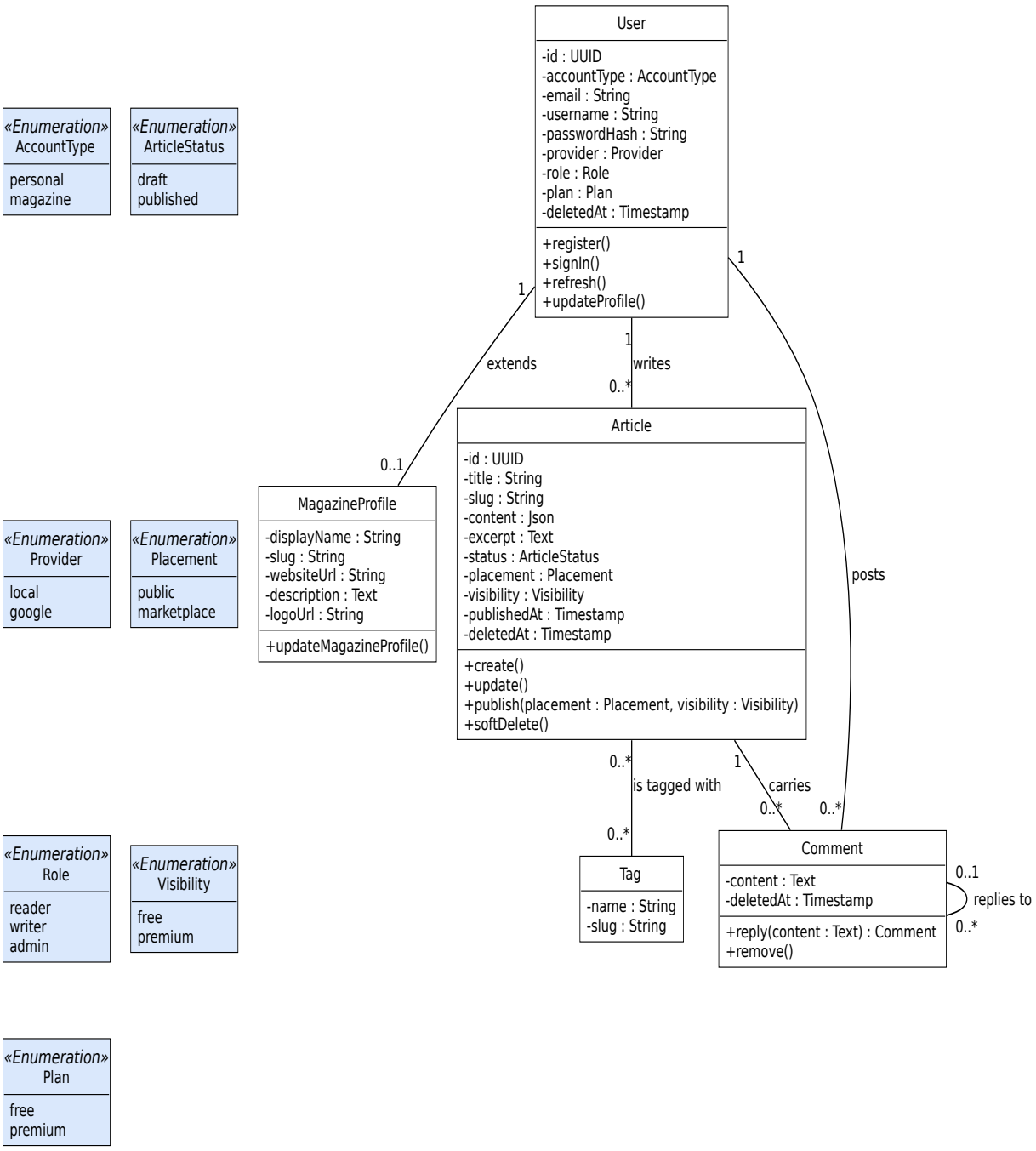
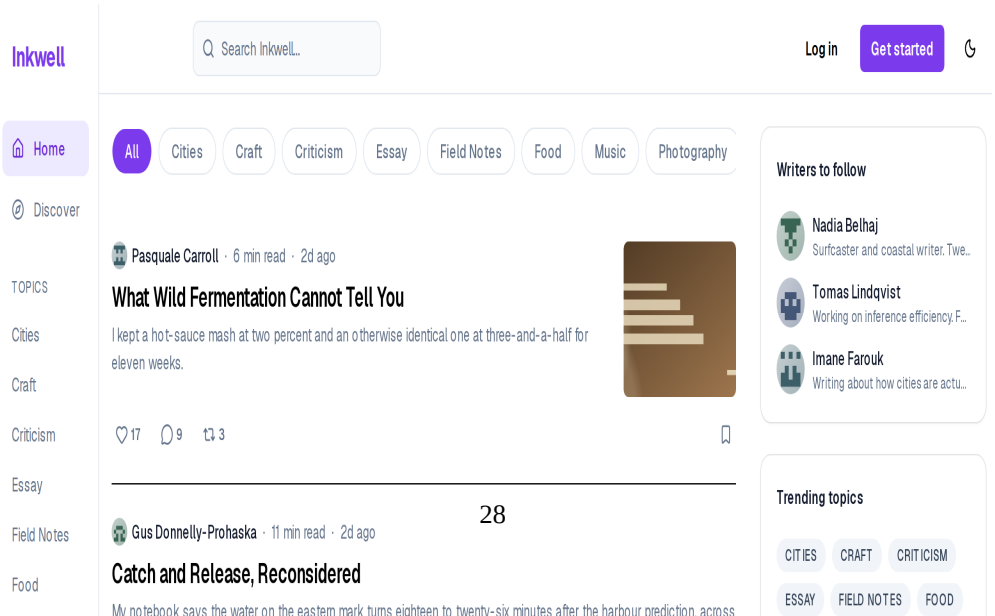


Figure 3.2 – Class diagram, Sprint 1



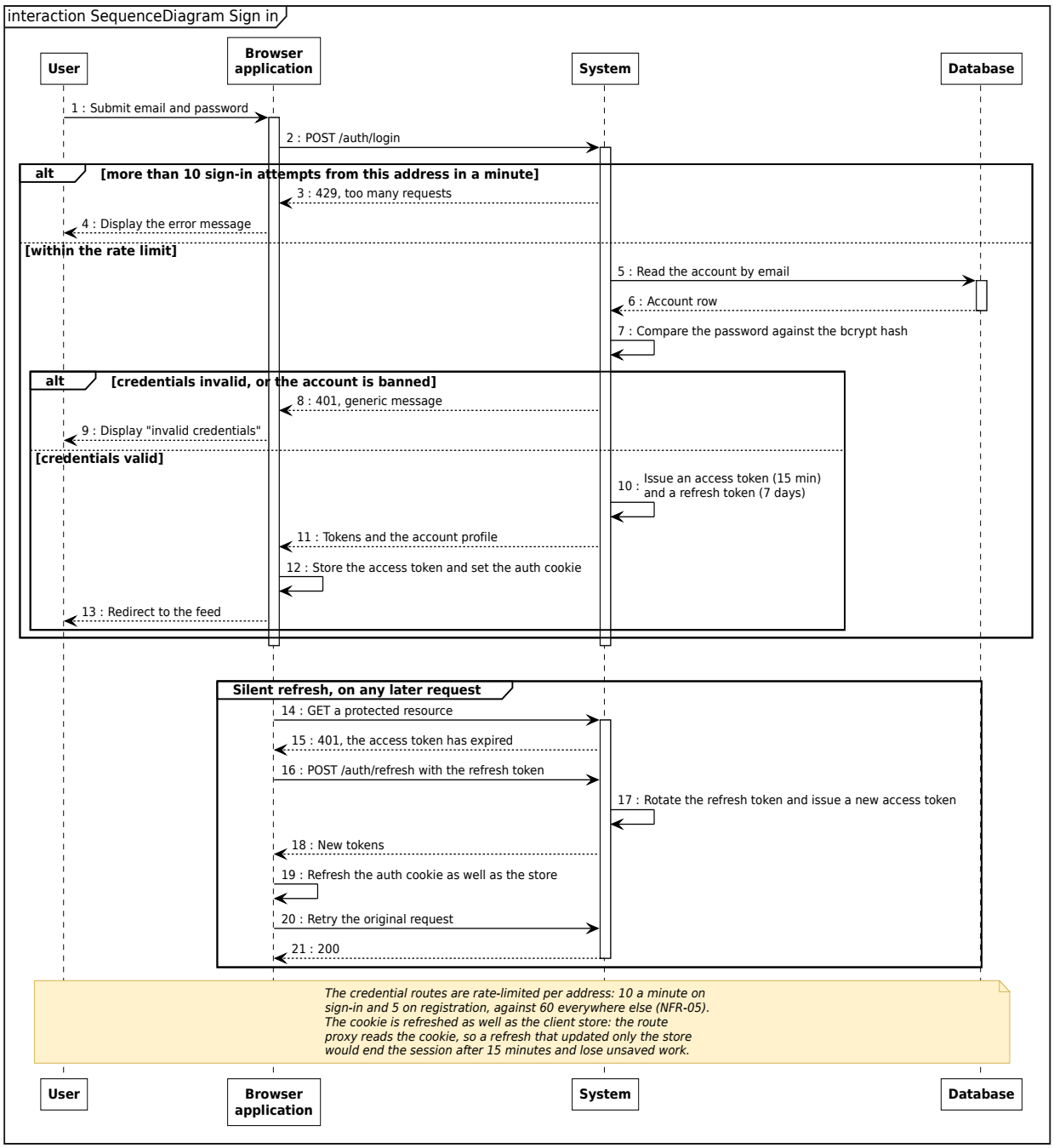


Figure 3.3 – Sequence diagram: sign in and silent refresh

The feed lists published public articles with their author, reading time, excerpt, cover and reaction counts, filtered by topic along the top (FR-01). The header offers only *Log in* and *Get started*: a visitor can read and browse but every interaction leads to an account, which is the boundary between actor A1 and the others. Figure 3.5 shows the sign-in page.

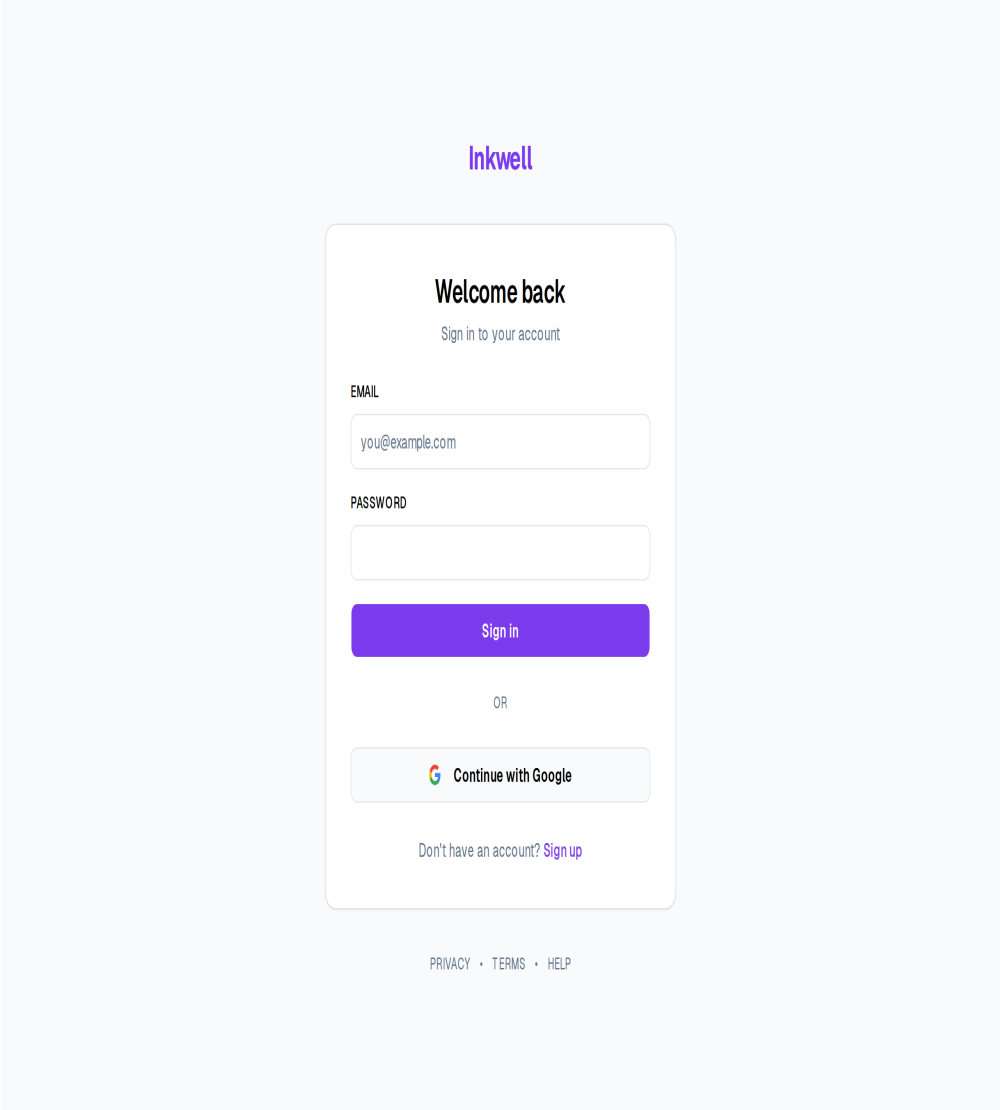


Figure 3.5 – Sign-in, with Google sign-in

It offers the two authentication methods of FR-05 side by side — e-mail and password, and *Continue with Google* — and the link to registration that Figure 1.3 draws as *Create an account* extending *Sign in*.

Registration differs by account type. Figure 3.6 shows a personal account and Figure 3.7 a magazine account.

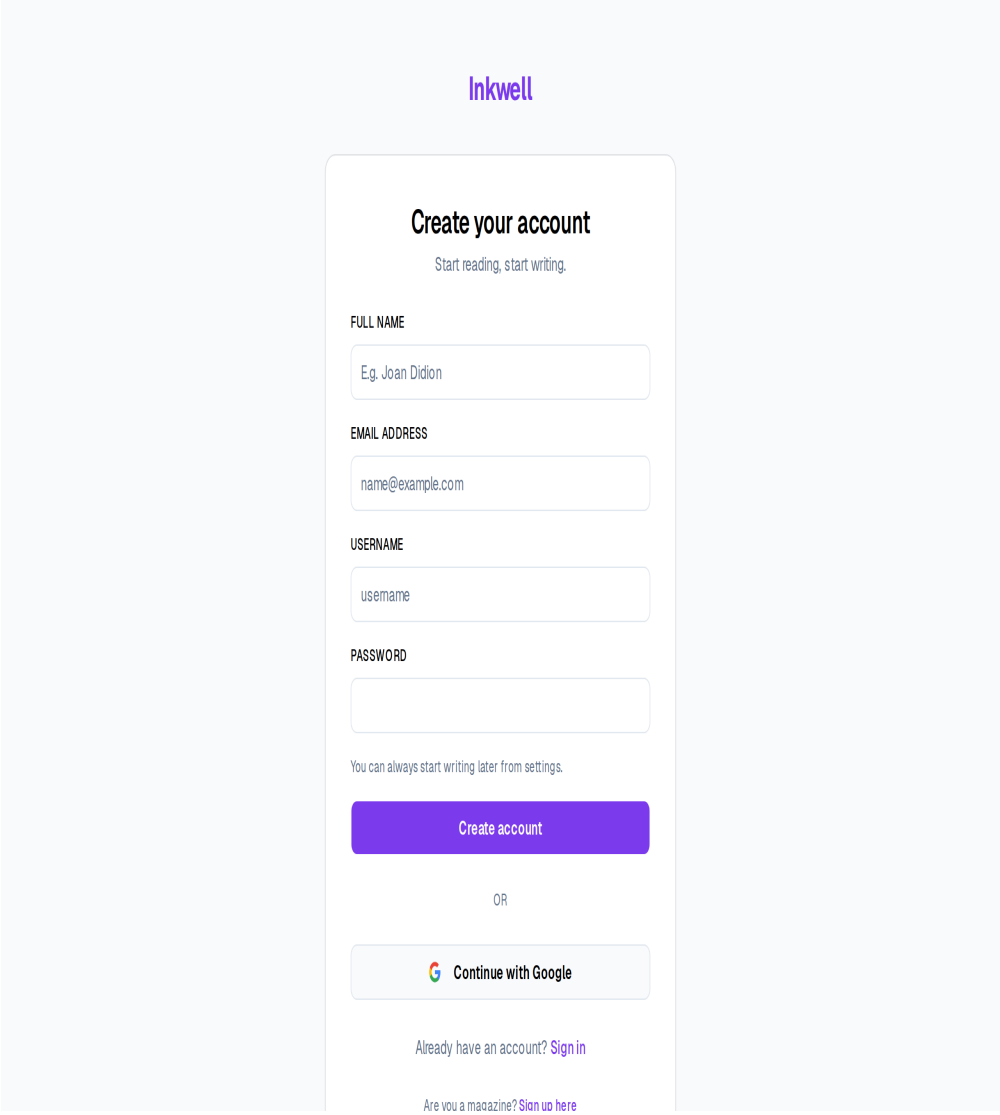


Figure 3.6 – Registering a personal account

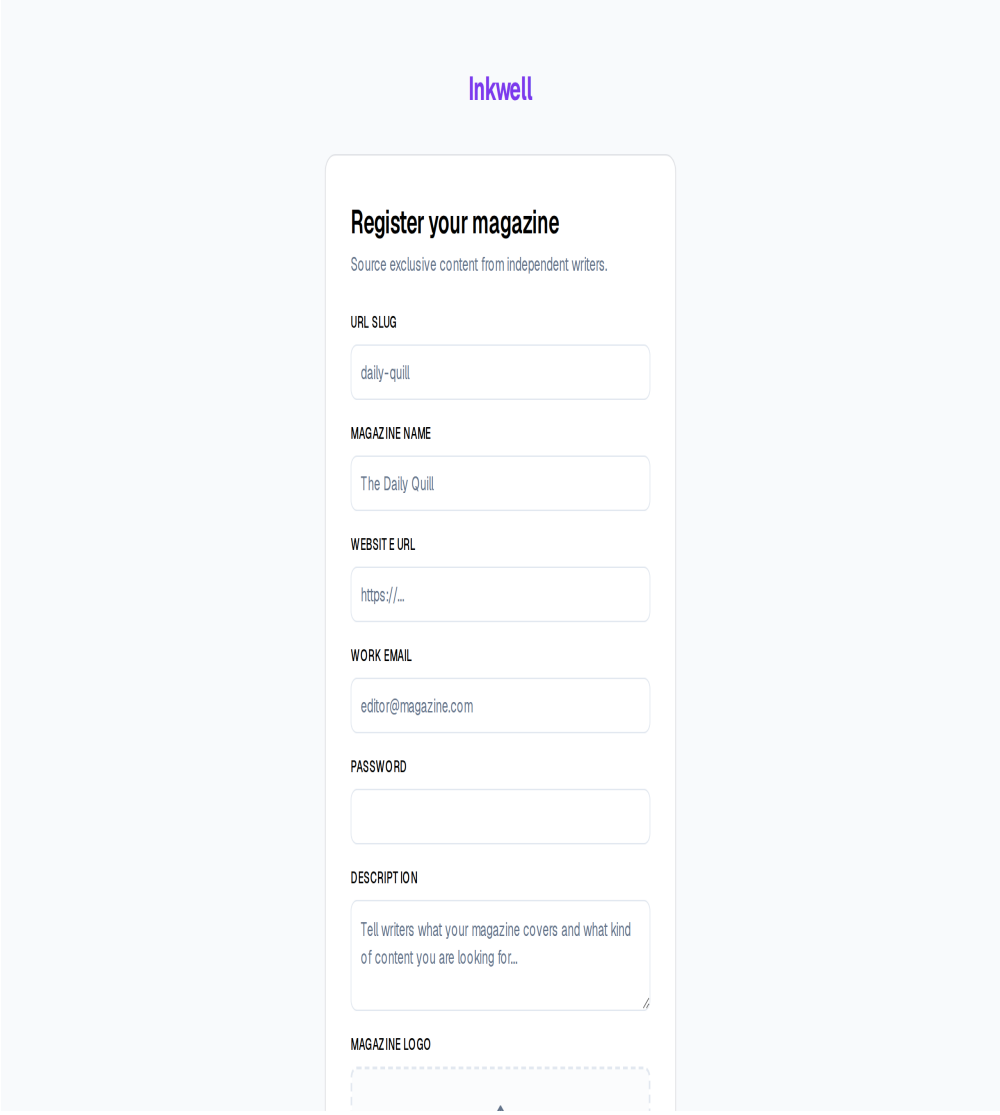


Figure 3.7 – Registering a magazine account

The magazine form asks for what a writer will see of the buyer — the slug that becomes the magazine's public address, its name, website, description and logo — and none of the personal fields. The two forms are FR-04 and FR-39: one platform, two kinds of account from the first screen, which is why a magazine never inherits a reader's capabilities.

Figure 3.8 shows a free article opened by a visitor.

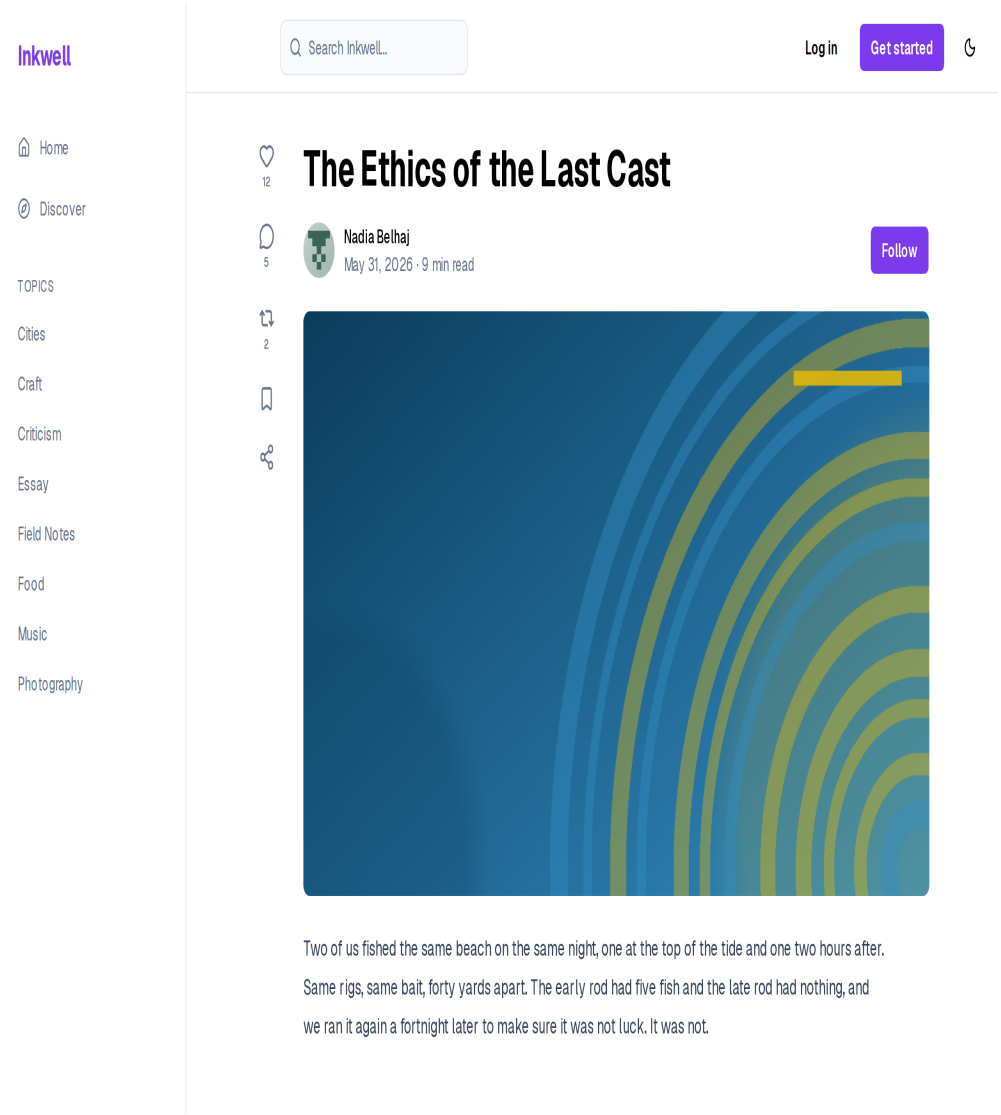


Figure 3.8 – A free article, readable without an account

The full body is readable without an account (FR-02). This was a deliberate decision: gating free articles would contradict the public feed and hide the content from search engines, so the only articles a visitor cannot read are premium and marketplace ones, for which Release 3 adds the paywall.

Figure 3.9 closes the sprint with the profile settings.

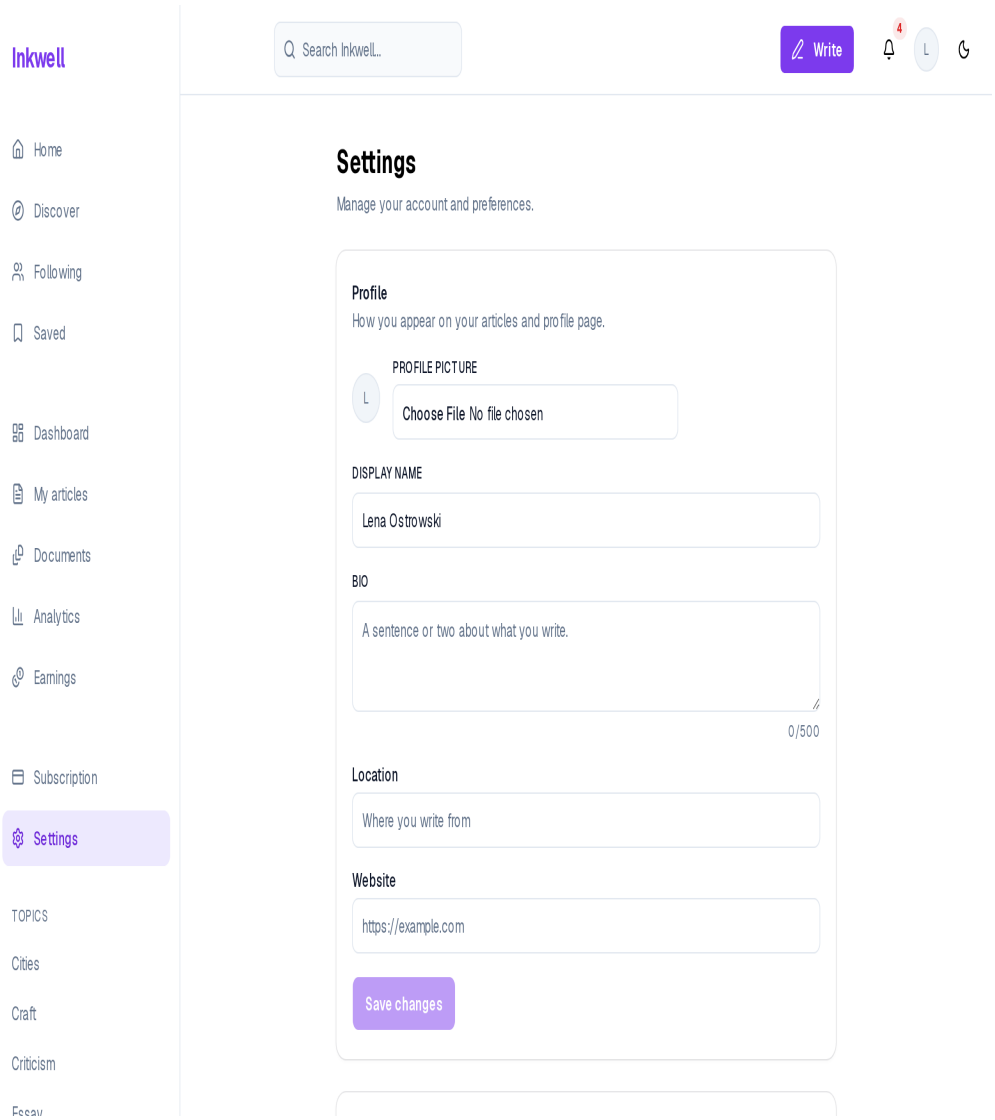


Figure 3.9 – Profile settings

A signed-in user edits the display name, bio, location, website and profile picture (FR-07); the picture is uploaded straight to object storage through a presigned URL (NFR-07). *Save changes* stays disabled until something changes, so a click never sends an empty update.

3.2 Sprint 2 — Editor, AI assistance and event capture

3.2.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 2 is that a writer drafts in a rich-text editor with automatic saving and images; that a premium writer converses with an AI assistant and applies inline AI actions to a selection, within a daily token allowance; and that every article page records reading events. Table 3.3 lists the stories.

Table 3.3 – Sprint 2 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Prior-ity	Points
US-06	Write in a rich editor	Must	8
US-07	Have my draft saved as I type	Must	3
US-08	Paste or drag an image into the article	Must	5

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-09	Set a cover image	Should	3
US-13	See word count and reading time	Could	1
US-14	Ask an assistant that has read my published work	Must	13
US-15	Reformulate, shorten, expand, simplify or improve a selection	Must	8
US-16	Insert an answer into my document	Must	2
US-18	See my remaining allowance	Must	2
	9 stories		**45**

The sprint commits 45 points, and its single largest story, US-14 (13 points), is split across two sprints: Sprint 2 delivers the conversation with the assistant, Sprint 4 the retrieval that grounds it in the writer's corpus. The editor stories (US-06 to US-09) come straight from the screens of the design track, which is why they could be estimated with confidence.

3.2.2 Analysis

Figure 3.10 gives the use cases of Sprint 2.

Writing in the editor specialises into formatting, inserting an image and setting a cover image, and includes saving the draft automatically. Using the assistant specialises into chatting and applying an inline action, and includes consuming the daily allowance; inserting the answer into the document extends the chat. Reading an article includes recording reading events. The diagram shows that every AI use case passes through the allowance: there is no path to a model that is not counted. The allowance belongs to the premium plan (FR-17); in this sprint premium accounts are created by the seed, and upgrading from the interface arrives with the plans of Sprint 5.

3.2.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 3.11 adds the classes of Sprint 2.

Each AI call is logged as an `AiInteraction` with its action type, tokens used and model; reading is recorded as `AnalyticsEvent` rows (view, scroll, time on page, like, comment, repost); and the user carries the remaining daily token allowance and the time of its last reset. The diagram shows that cost and reading are both recorded as append-only rows: the allowance can be audited from the interaction log, and every metric of Release 2 is computed from events written from this sprint on.

Sequence diagram — inline AI action. Figure 3.12 shows an inline action on a selection.

The editor captures the selected range once, before anything is streamed, so that a click elsewhere cannot move it. The system checks the daily allowance and refuses with 403 and a plan-aware notice when it is exhausted; otherwise it builds the prompt from the action, the selection and the surrounding article, streams the suggestion to the editor as it is generated, and records the interaction and its cost. The allowance is checked once, before the call: a reply may cost more than what remained, and the balance then stops at zero. The diagram shows the trade-off chosen — the writer is never cut off in the middle of a reply, at the price of a small overrun on the last call of the day.

Event capture. The article page observes scroll depth and engaged time and sends batched events — every ten events, every five seconds, or when the page is left — to `POST /analytics/events`. The server, not the client, attaches the reader's identity from the access token, the country and the device, so a reader cannot forge another reader's events. Capture starts in this sprint so that real reading data accumulates before the dashboards of Release 2 aggregate it.

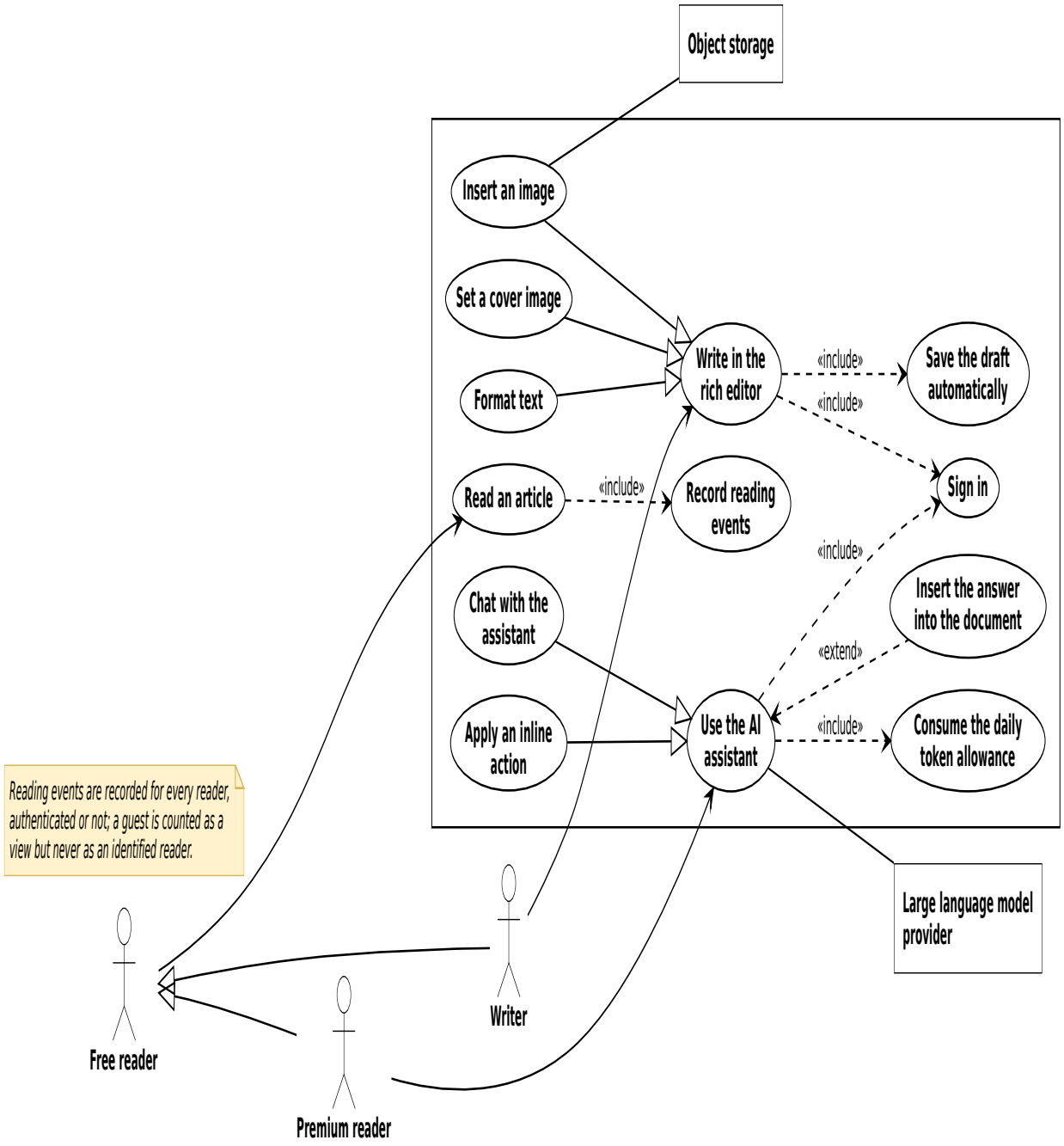


Figure 3.10 – Use case diagram, Sprint 2

3.2.4 Realisation

Figure 3.13 shows the editor, where a writer spends most of their time.

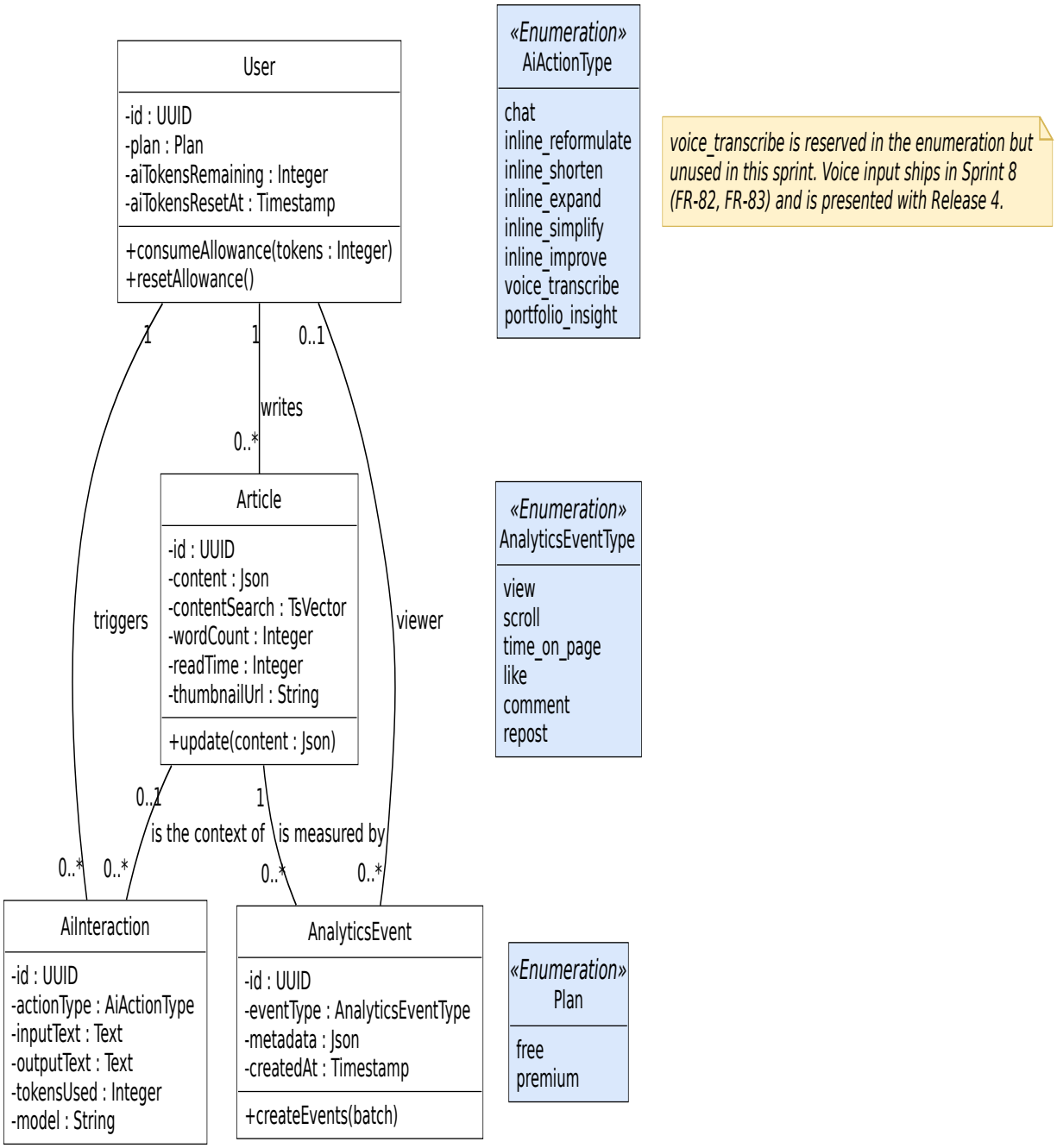
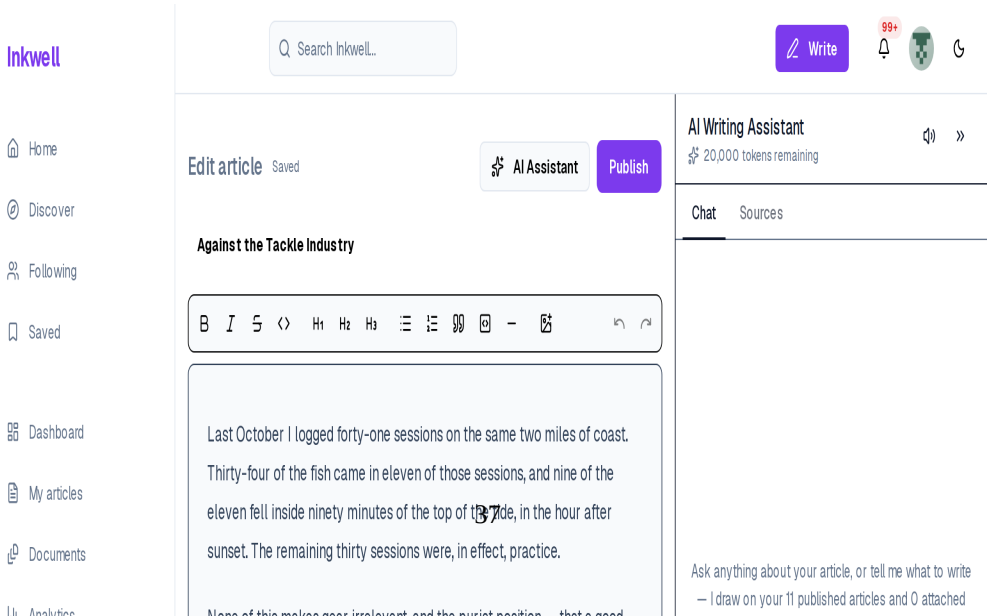


Figure 3.11 – Class diagram, Sprint 2



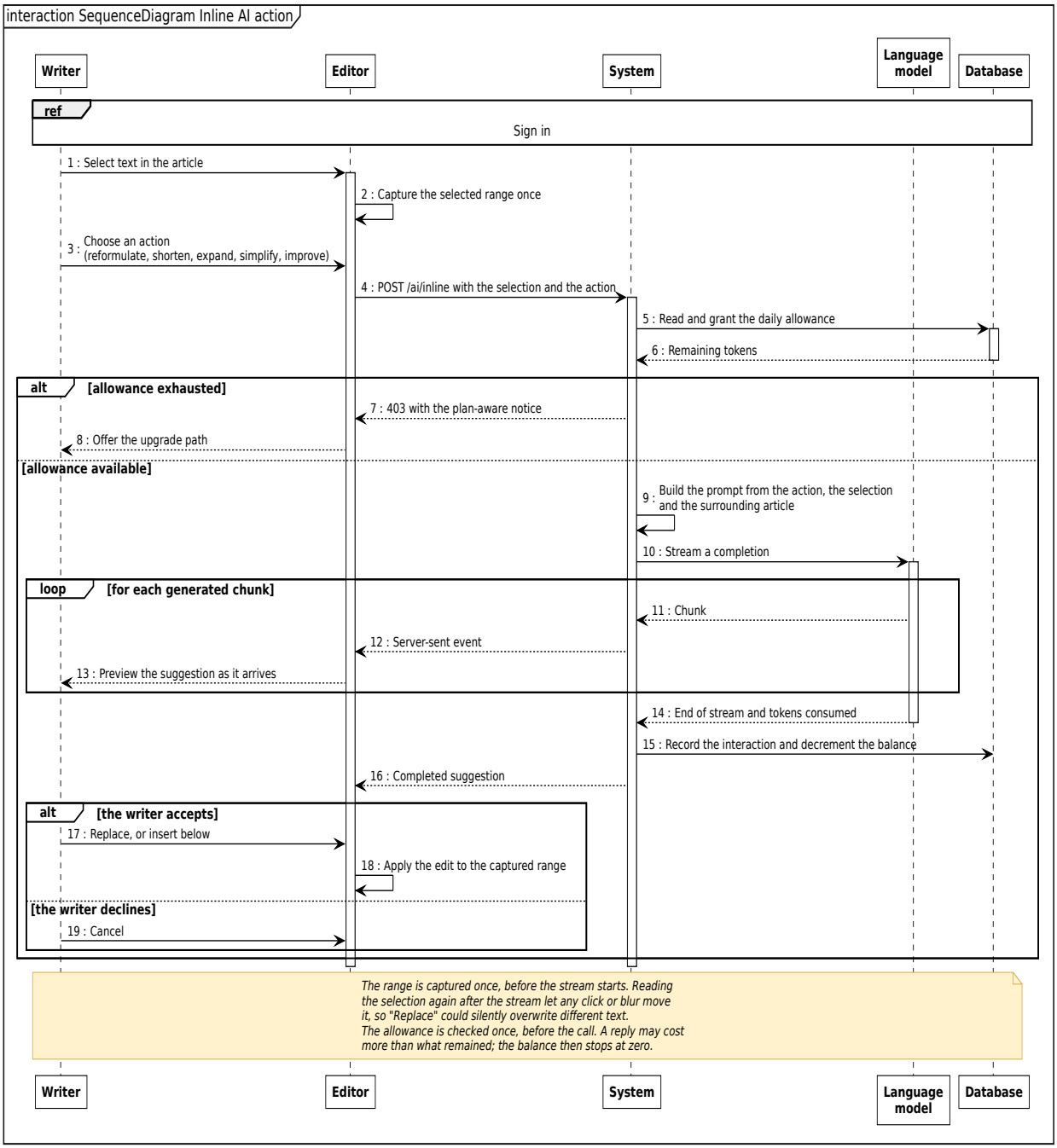


Figure 3.12 – Sequence diagram: inline AI action

The draft is edited as rich text, with a toolbar for emphasis, three heading levels, lists, quotes, code and images (FR-18, FR-20); the *Saved* label beside the title reports the automatic save that replaces a save button (FR-19). The assistant sits beside the text rather than in another page, which is the premise of the whole product: help arrives where the writing happens.

Figure 3.14 shows the publish dialog designed in Sprint 1 and used here.

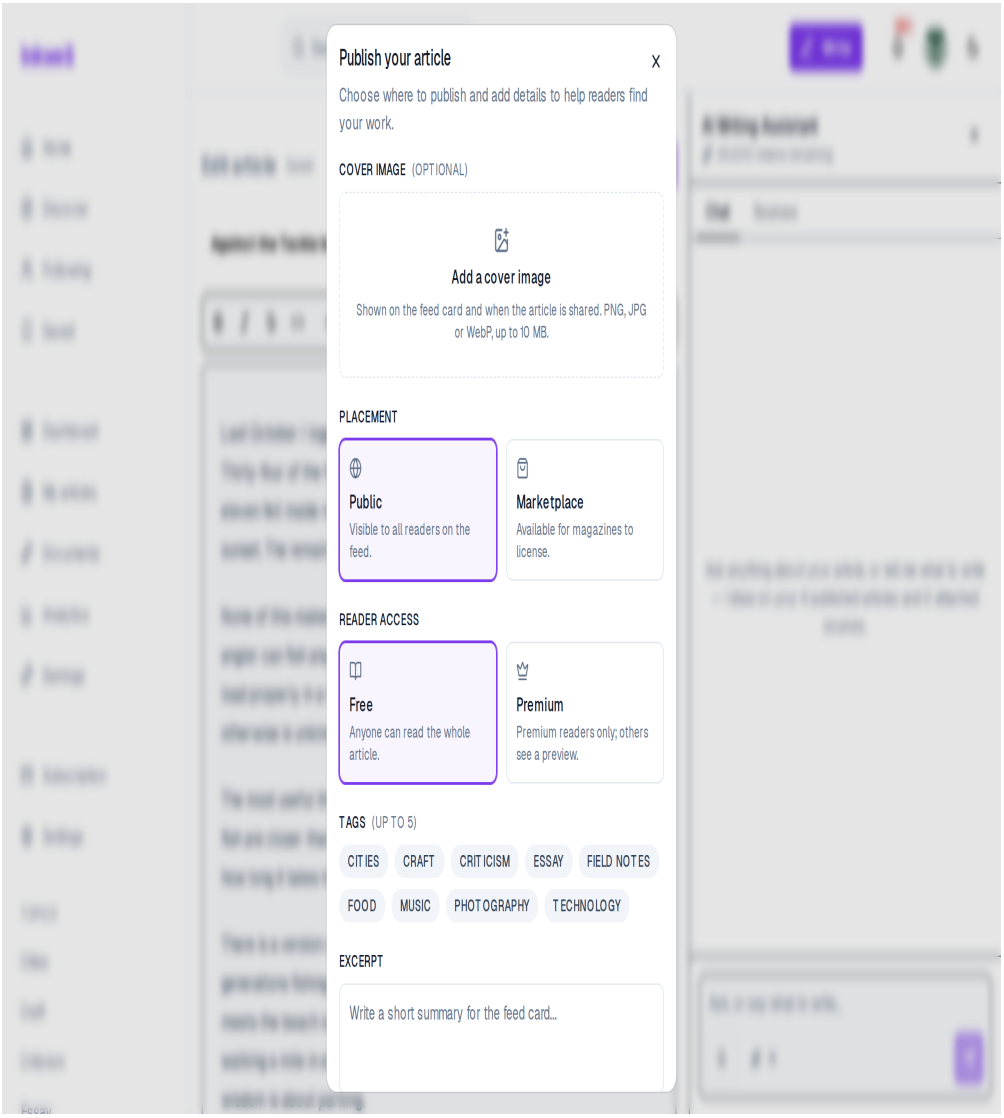


Figure 3.14 – The publish dialog: placement, visibility, tags and excerpt

Every choice of Table 3.2 is on one screen — placement, visibility, cover, tags and excerpt (FR-21, FR-23, FR-24) — so publishing is a single confirmed act and not a sequence of settings pages.

The assistant is shown in two states. Figure 3.15 shows the panel before a question and Figure 3.16 an answer.

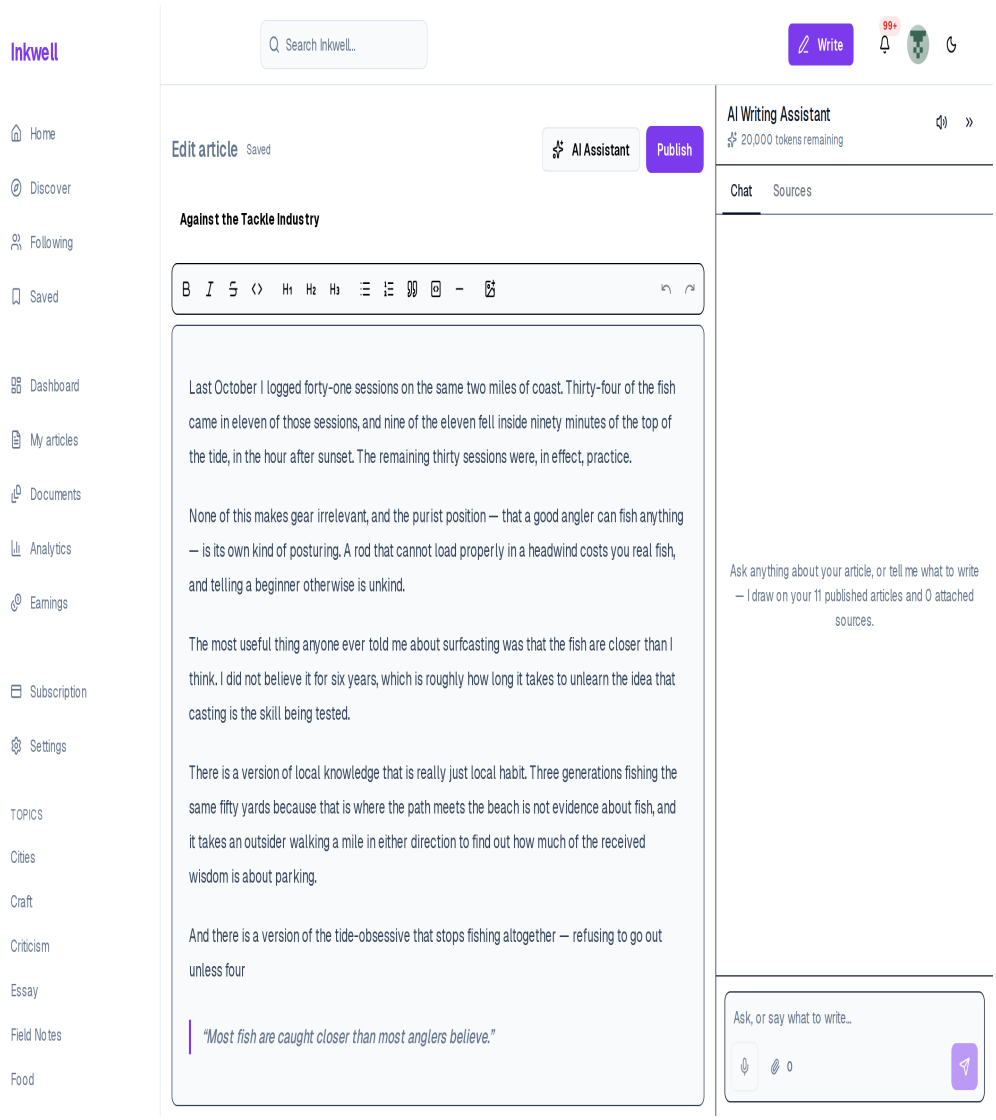


Figure 3.15 – The AI assistant panel

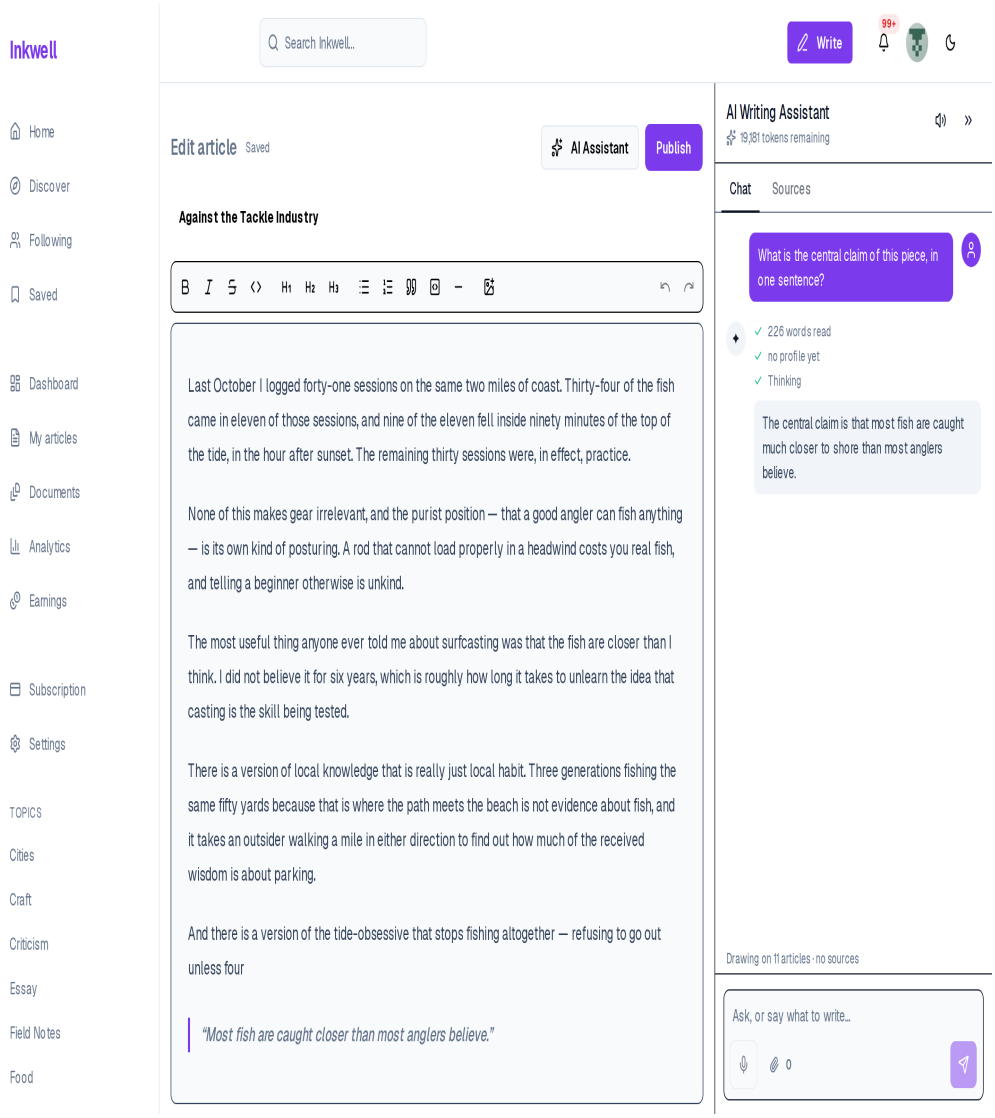


Figure 3.16 – An answer from the assistant

The panel shows the remaining allowance — 20,000 tokens at the start of the day — before the writer asks anything (FR-31), so the cost of a question is never a surprise. The answer is streamed as it is generated and can be inserted into the document at the cursor (FR-27, FR-30); Sprint 8 later replaces this manual insertion by an assistant that writes into the document itself.

The inline actions are the second way to use the assistant. Figure 3.17 shows the menu on a selection and Figure 3.18 its result.

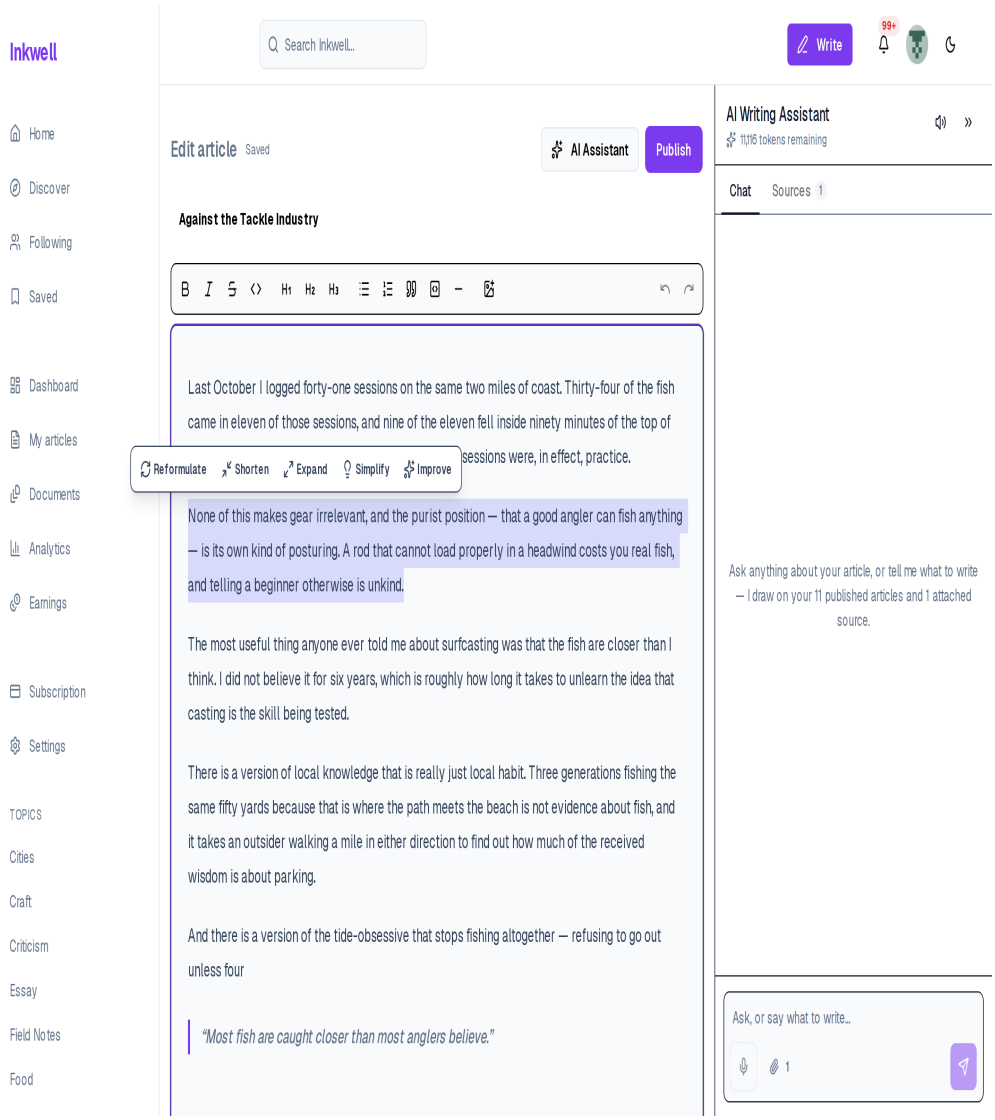


Figure 3.17 – The inline actions on a selection

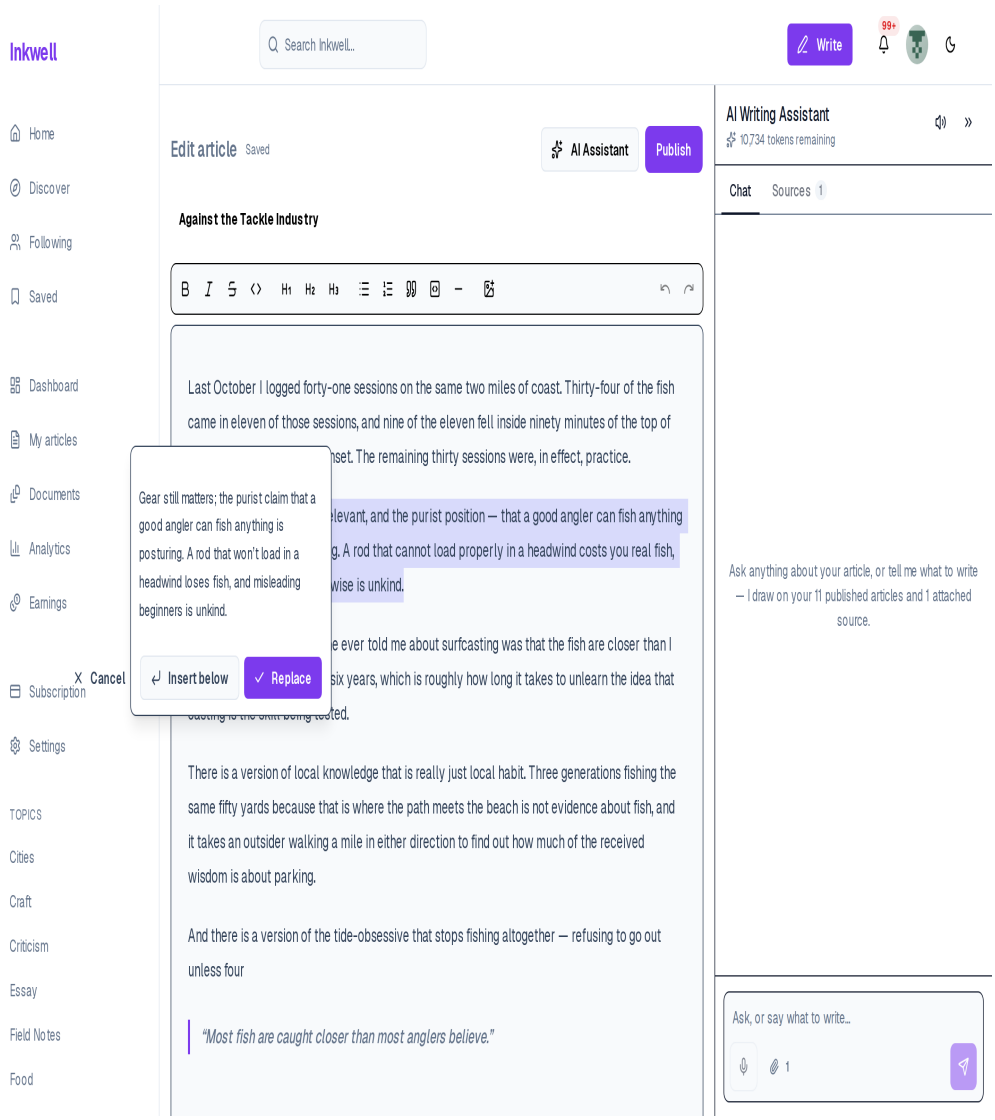


Figure 3.18 – An inline suggestion, ready to replace the selection

Selecting text opens the five actions of FR-28 — reformulate, shorten, expand, simplify, improve. The suggestion appears in a popover over the highlighted original rather than replacing it, with three choices: *Replace*, *Insert below* or *Cancel*. The allowance in the panel has dropped accordingly. The assistant proposes and the writer decides, which is the rule the whole assistant follows.

Conclusion

Release 1 delivered the foundation: accounts of two types with rate-limited authentication and a silent refresh, article management with placement and visibility, a rich-text editor, the first AI assistant with inline actions under a daily allowance, the capture of reading events, and the ledger harness that every later money-moving feature is tested against. Release 2 builds the social layer and the analytics on top of it.

CHAPTER 4

Release 2: social interactions, analytics and AI

Introduction

The second release turns a publishing tool into a platform. Sprint 3 adds the social layer — likes, threaded comments, reposts, follows, reports — with live notifications, and aggregates the reading events captured since Release 1 into the metrics behind the writer's dashboards and the magazine's evaluation report. Sprint 4 adds the platform's retrieval layer: published articles are embedded, the assistant answers from the writer's own passages and voice profile, magazines can request AI portfolio insights, and search combines keywords with meaning.

4.1 Sprint 3 — Social interactions, notifications and analytics

4.1.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 3 is that readers interact with articles and writers and the author is told live; that writers see how their articles are read; and that magazines browse writers and read an evaluation report built on audience, content and quality metrics. Table 4.1 lists the stories.

Table 4.1 – Sprint 3 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Prior-ity	Points
US-24	Like an article	Must	2
US-25	Comment and reply in a thread	Must	5
US-26	Follow a writer	Should	3
US-27	Repost an article	Could	2
US-28	Be told the moment someone reacts to my work, without reloading	Must	5
US-29	Review notifications I missed	Must	3
US-30	See how many people read an article and how far they got	Must	8
US-31	Rank my articles by performance	Should	3
US-32	Evaluate a writer on audience, content and quality	Must	13
	9 stories		**44**

The sprint commits 44 points. Its weight is concentrated in two analytics stories, the writer's per-article analytics (US-30, 8 points) and the evaluation report (US-32, 13 points): the social stories are small and similar to one another, while the evaluation needs the aggregation pipeline that every metric depends on.

4.1.2 Analysis

Figure 4.1 gives the use cases of Sprint 3.

Interacting with an article specialises into liking, commenting, replying, reposting, following and reporting, and includes notifying the recipient. On a marketplace listing, liking, commenting and reposting are refused while saving stays available, because a listing is a private commercial offer rather than a publication (FR-70). Viewing article analytics and reading a writer evaluation both include the aggregation of raw events

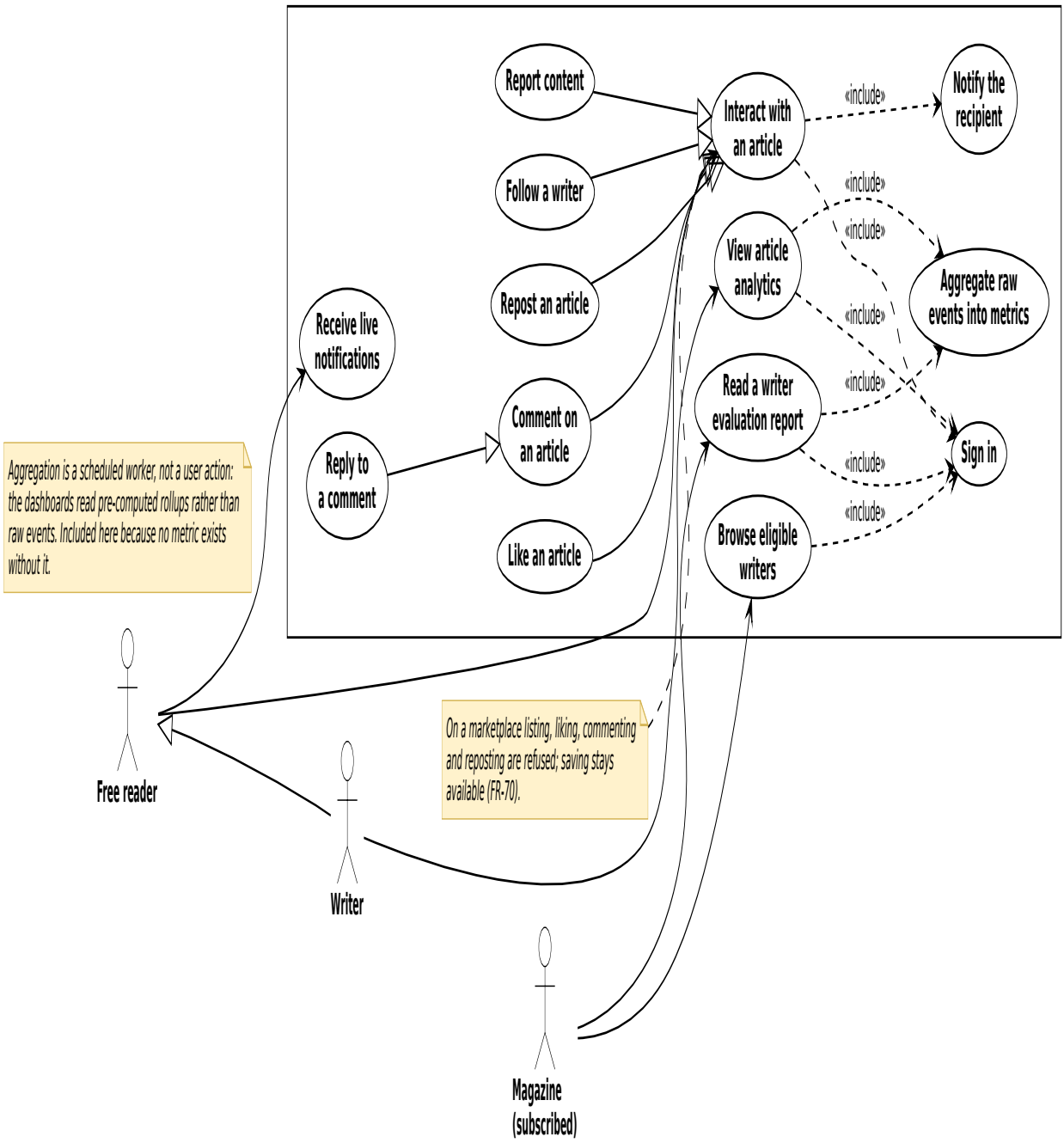


Figure 4.1 – Use case diagram, Sprint 3

into metrics — a scheduled job rather than a user action, drawn because no metric exists without it. The diagram therefore shows the two halves of the sprint joined at one point: interactions produce events, and the aggregation turns events into the numbers both the writer and the magazine read.

4.1.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 4.2 adds the classes of Sprint 3.

Likes, reposts and follows are many-to-many associations; comments and notifications are classes because they carry content and state. The four rollup tables are `ArticleMetrics` per article, and `WriterAudienceMetrics`, `WriterContentMetrics` and `WriterQualityMetrics` per writer. The diagram shows that the metrics are stored separately from the events they summarise: each rollup has one

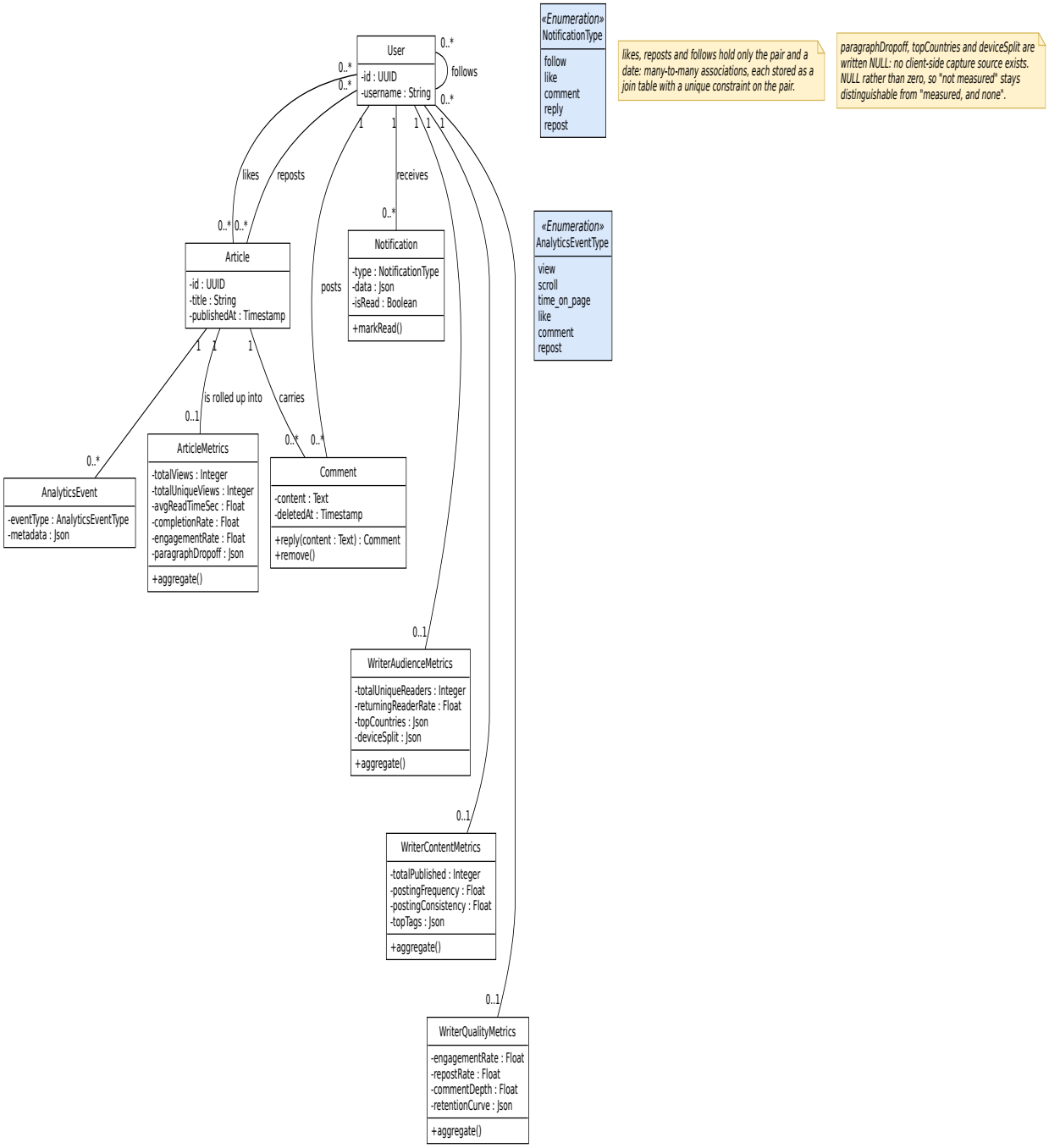


Figure 4.2 – Class diagram, Sprint 3

row per article or per writer, rewritten by the aggregation, so reading a dashboard costs the same whatever the number of events behind it.

Sequence diagram — from reading events to metrics. Figure 4.3 follows a reading event to the dashboard. The browser batches events; the API takes the reader's identity from the access token when one is sent — never from the request body — and attaches the time and device server-side before appending the event. Every five minutes the worker reads only the events since the last run and upserts the per-article metrics; just after, it computes the three per-writer rollups and rechecks marketplace eligibility. Dashboards read the rollups, never the raw events, so they stay fast as the event log grows (NFR-15, NFR-16). The diagram shows the one place where freshness is traded for speed: a metric can be up to five minutes behind the events.

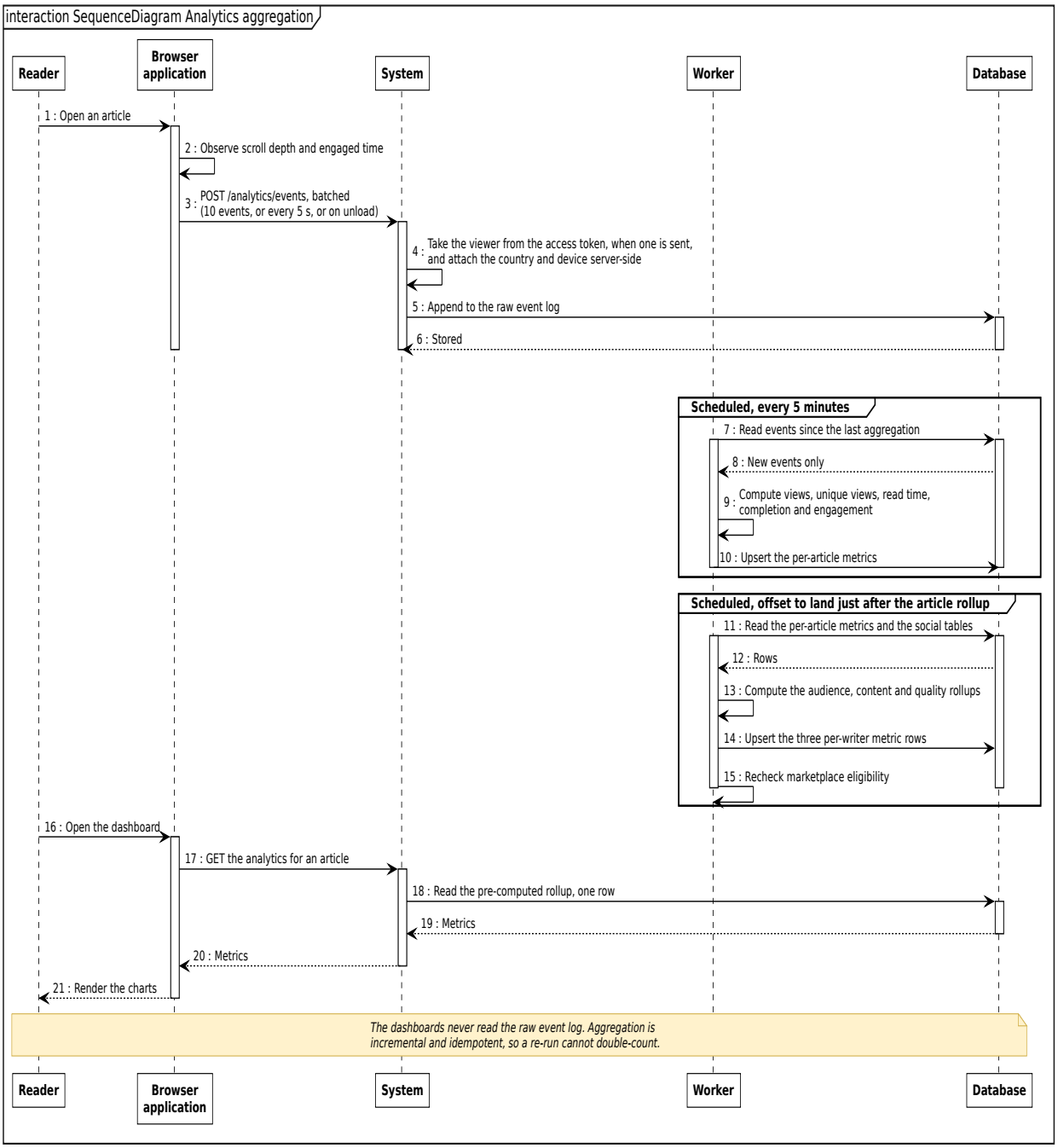


Figure 4.3 – Sequence diagram: analytics aggregation

The metrics the aggregation produces are those of the evaluation report, defined in Table 4.2. Each definition is the one the aggregation computes.

Table 4.2 – Main metrics of the evaluation report

Panel	Metric	Definition	Why this definition
Audience	Unique readers	distinct identified readers over the last 30 days	reach now, not since the writer joined
Audience	Returning-reader rate	share of those readers seen on more than one day	a reader who refreshes twice is not loyal; one who comes back another day is
Content	Posting frequency	articles per week	regularity is what a magazine commissioning a series needs

Panel	Metric	Definition	Why this definition
Content	Consistency	1 − coefficient of variation of the gaps between articles, clamped to [0, 1]	1 is perfectly regular; near 0 is bursts and silences
Content	Topics	distribution of the writer's articles over tags	the range a magazine can draw on
Quality	Engagement rate	(likes + comments) per view	interaction per reader; it exceeds 100% when articles collect more reactions than views
Quality	Completion rate	share of views that scroll to 90% of the article	90% rather than 100%, because footers and comments sit below the text
Quality	Repost rate, comment depth	reposts per view; replies per top-level comment	whether readers pass the work on and discuss it
Quality	Retention curve	share of views reaching 25%, 50%, 75% and 90% of the page	where readers stop, at the granularity page scroll supports

The table shows that every metric is a ratio or a distribution rather than a raw count, so that a writer with a small but attentive audience can compare with a writer with a large and indifferent one. It also shows the limit of the capture: the retention curve has four points because the browser records the deepest scroll, not the paragraph being read.

Sequence diagram — live notifications. Figure 4.4 shows how a notification reaches its recipient.

The client keeps a server-sent-events stream open; when a reader likes an article, the like and the notification row are written first, and only after the commit is the event pushed to the recipient's open streams. If the connection drops, the client reconnects with the identifier of the last event received and the server replays what was missed. The diagram shows why a notification is never lost and never announces something that did not happen: the database is the record, and the live push is only a faster way to read it.

4.1.4 Realisation

Figure 4.5 shows the feed of a signed-in reader.

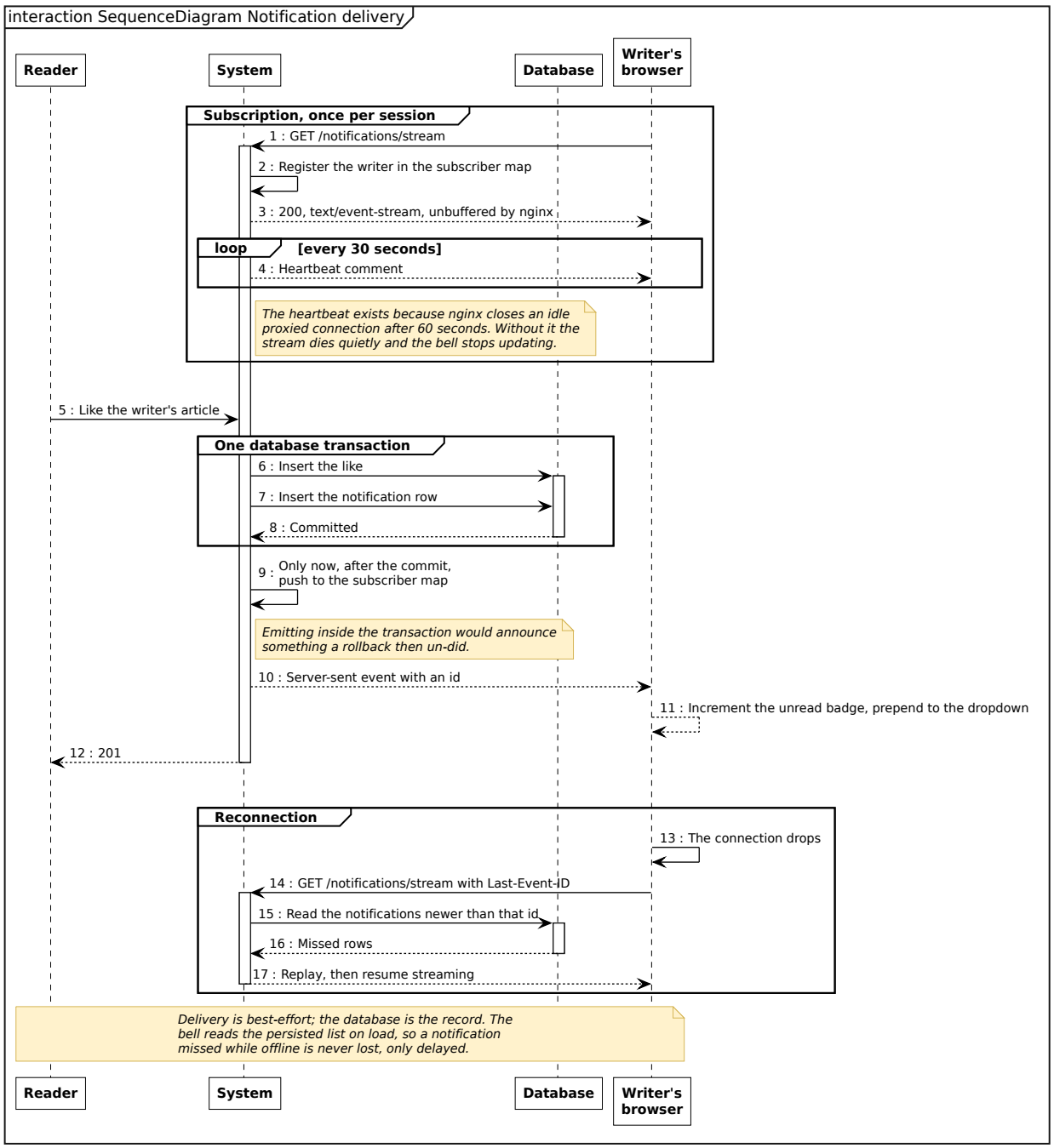
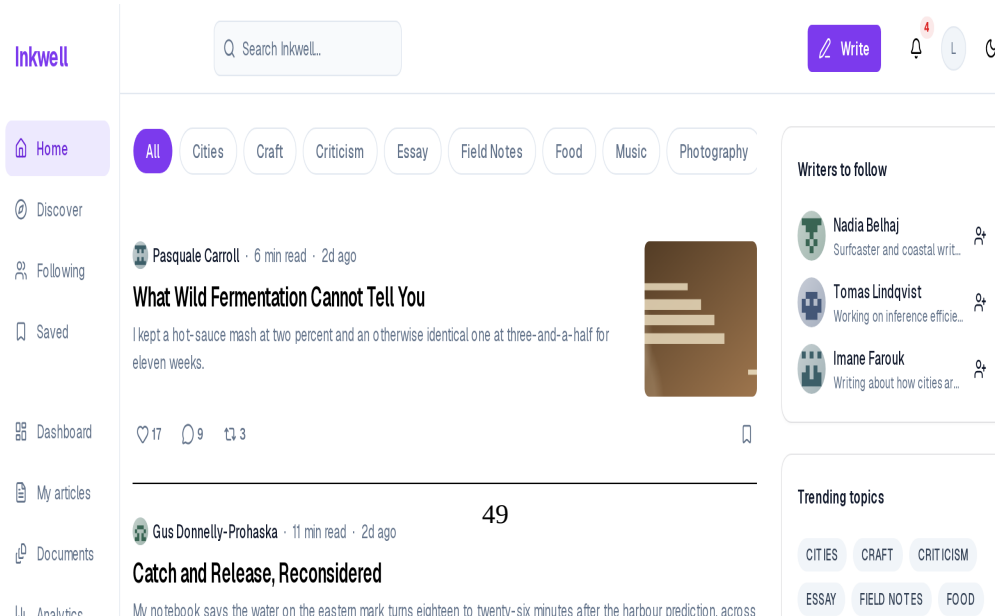


Figure 4.4 – Sequence diagram: live notification delivery



Compared with the visitor's feed of Figure 3.4, the header now offers *Write*, the notification bell and the account; each card carries like, comment, repost and save controls with their counts, and the side panel suggests writers to follow (FR-08, FR-09, FR-11, FR-12). The latest comment under a card is the live preview added in Sprint 8.

Figure 4.6 shows the notifications of a writer.

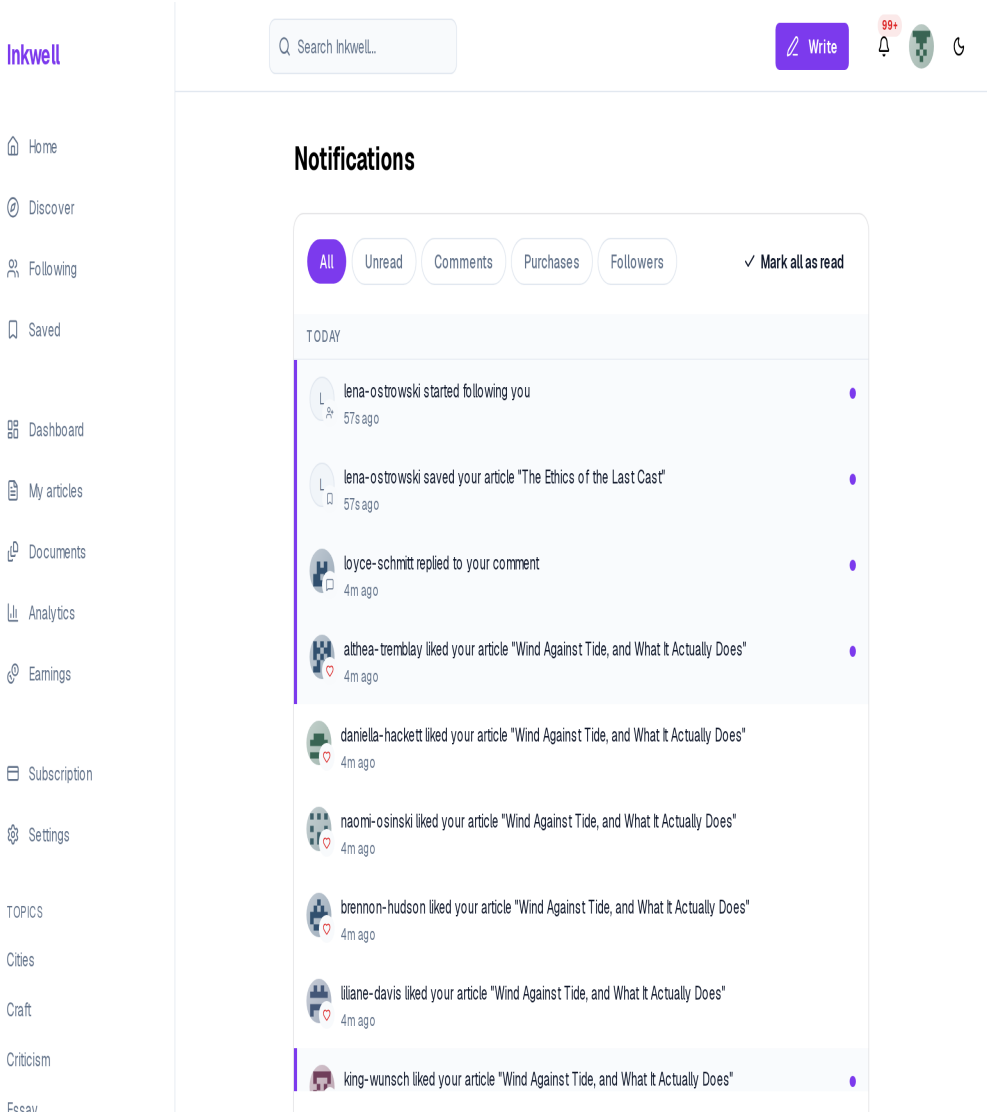


Figure 4.6 – Notifications, filtered and grouped by day

Notifications are grouped by day, filtered by kind — unread, comments, purchases, followers — and unread ones are marked by a bar and a dot until *Mark all as read* (FR-13, FR-14). The list mixes social events with marketplace ones, so a writer follows both the conversation around their work and its sales in one place.

The writer's view of their own work is shown in three screens. Figure 4.7 is the dashboard, Figure 4.8 the list of articles and Figure 4.9 the analytics.

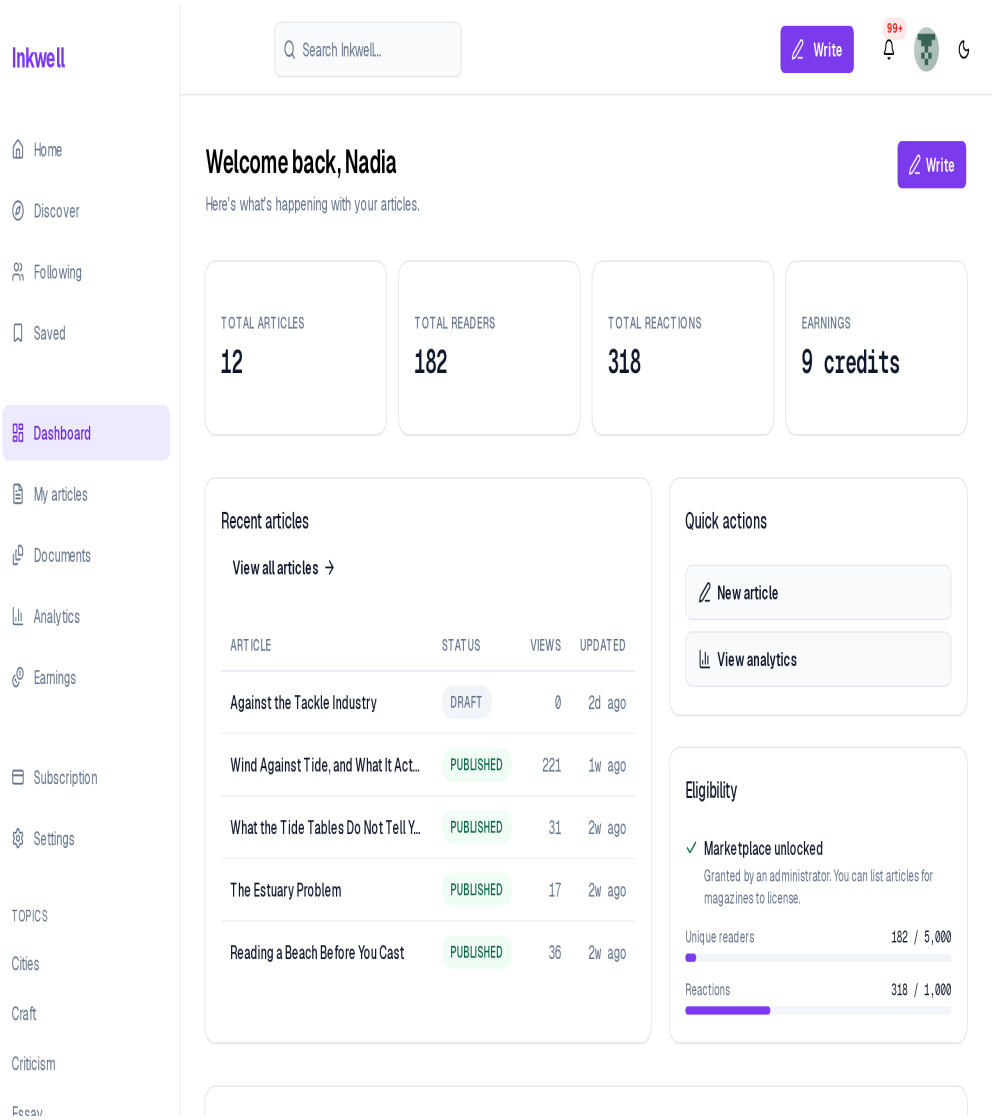


Figure 4.7 – The writer's dashboard

The dashboard summarises articles, readers, reactions and earnings, lists the recent articles with their status and views, and shows the eligibility panel: 182 of 5,000 readers and 318 of 1,000 reactions, with the marketplace already unlocked by an administrator's grant (FR-34, FR-55). It answers the writer's first question — how am I doing — on one screen.

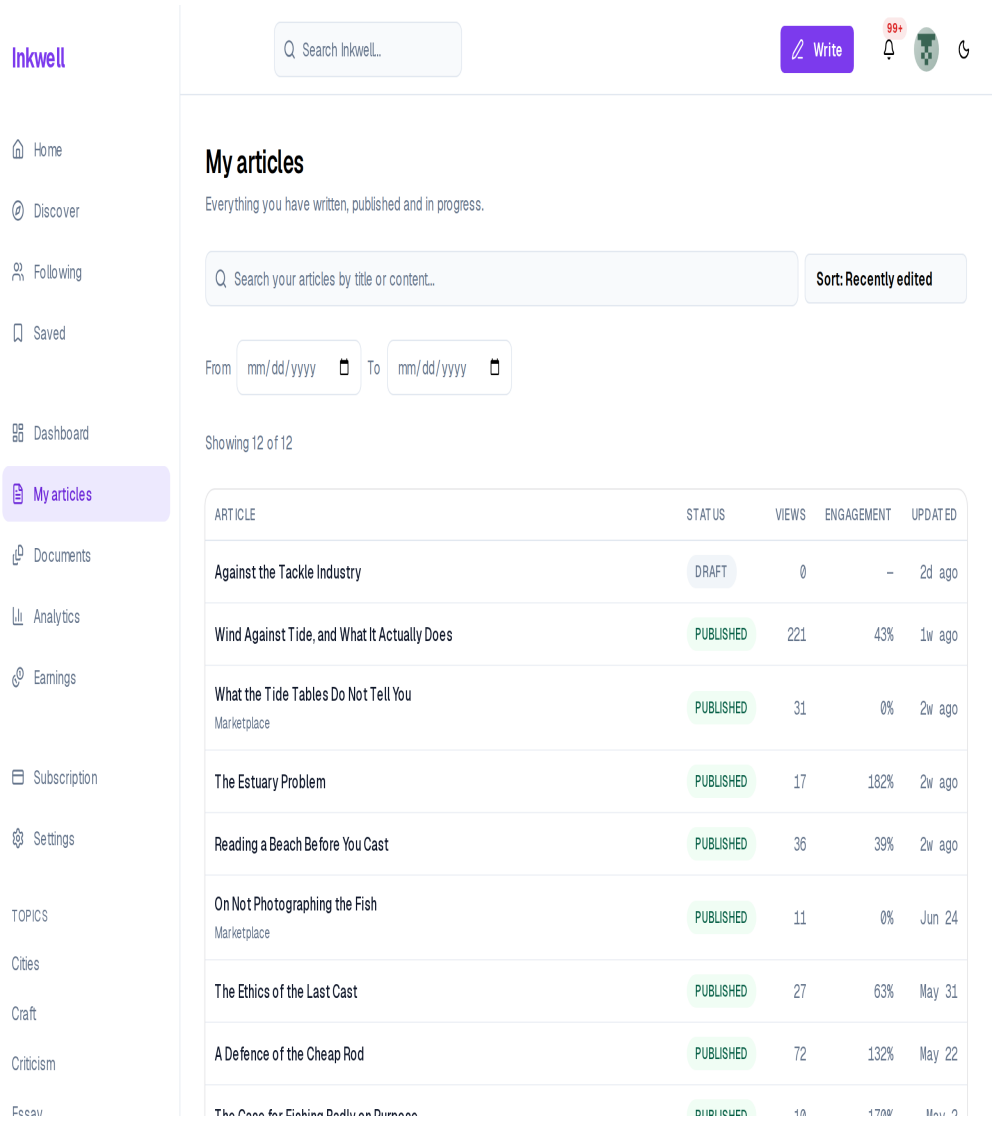


Figure 4.8 – “My articles”: every article, sortable by performance

“My articles” lists every article, drafts and marketplace listings included, searchable by content and filterable by date, with its views and engagement (FR-33). The engagement column is the per-view rate of Table 4.2, which is why values above 100% appear on articles whose seeded reactions outnumber their recorded views. Sorting happens on the server across the whole body of work, not on the page shown.

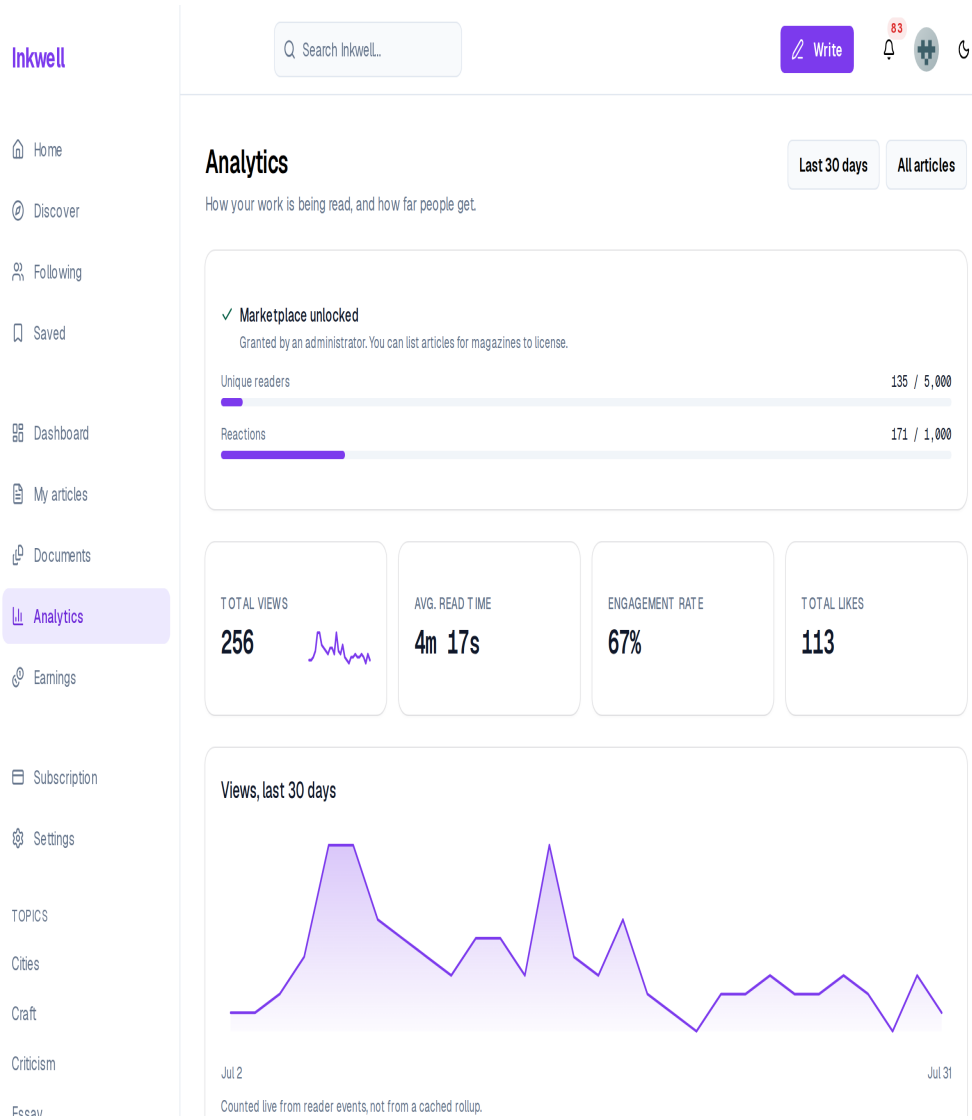


Figure 4.9 – The writer's analytics: views over the last 30 days

The analytics page gives the totals — views, average read time, engagement rate, likes — and the daily views of the last 30 days (FR-32). The note under the chart says that it is counted from the events, not from a rollup: a daily series is the one panel that may read the event log directly, bounded to thirty days, as NFR-15 allows.

Figure 4.10 shows a writer's public profile.

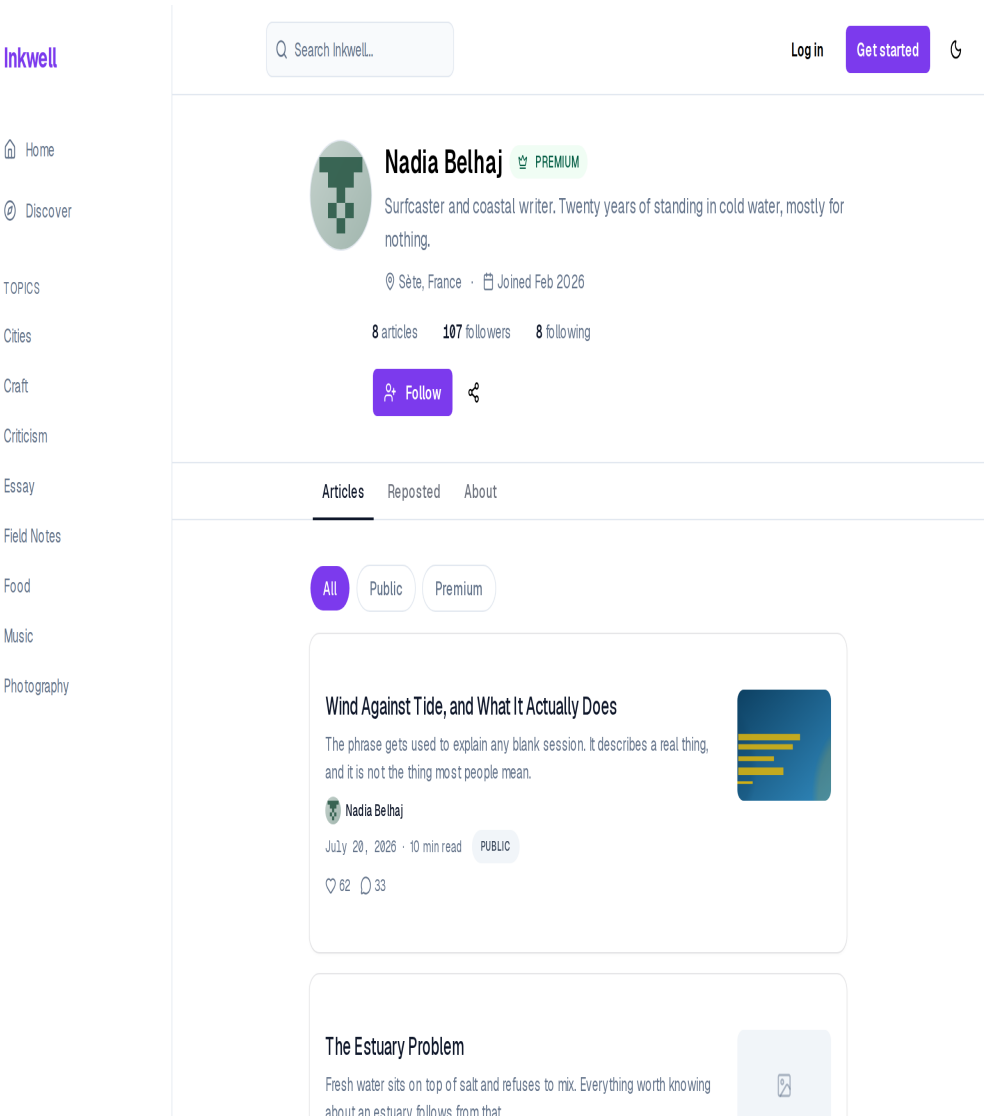


Figure 4.10 – A writer's public profile

The profile shows the writer's bio, location, join date, article and follower counts and published articles to any visitor, filterable by public and premium, with a *Follow* control and a share button (FR-12). It is the public face of the portfolio that a magazine evaluates in more depth.

Figure 4.11 shows the magazine's side of the same data.

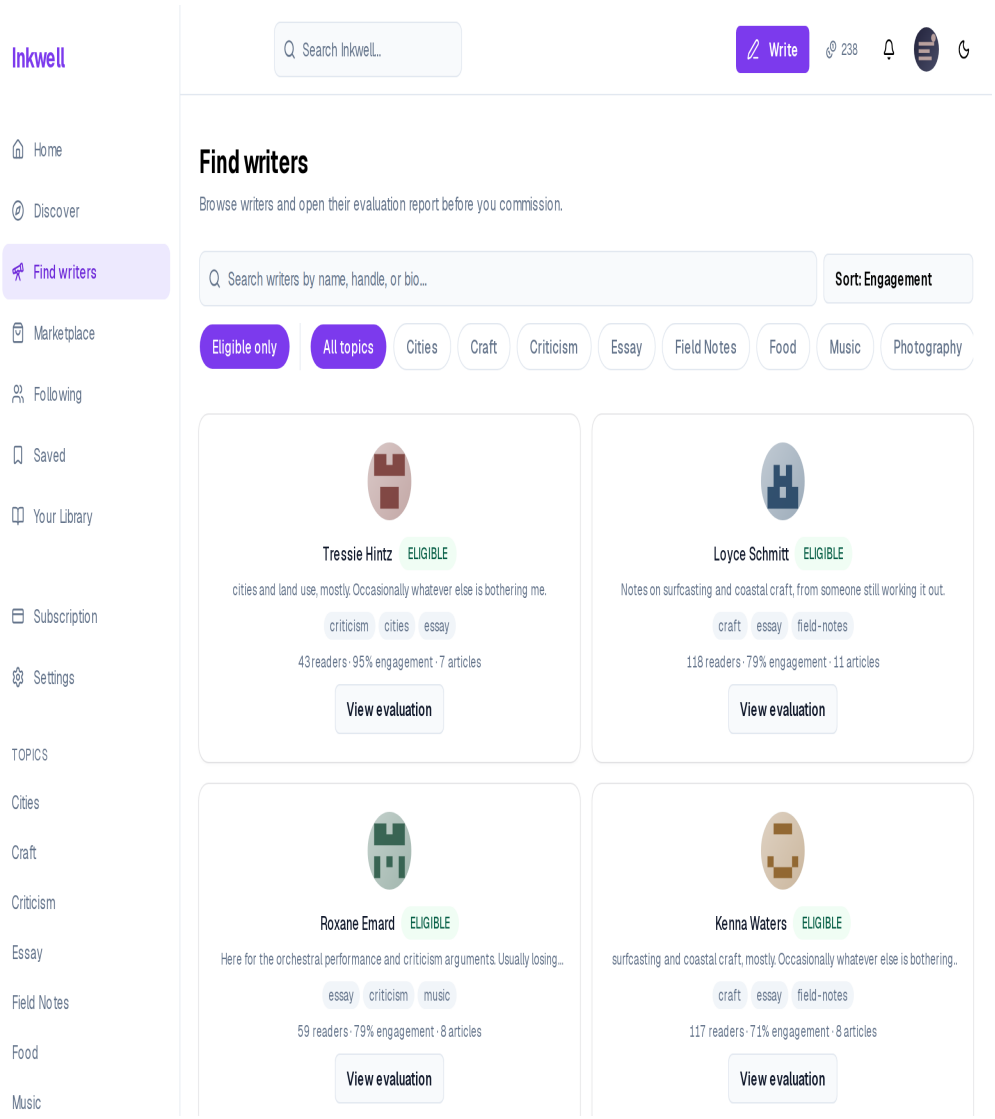


Figure 4.11 – A magazine browsing eligible writers

A magazine browses writers filtered to the eligible ones and by topic, searches them by name or bio, and sorts them — here by engagement (FR-44). Each card already gives readers, engagement and article count, and *View evaluation* opens the full report. In this sprint the page is reachable by any magazine account; from Sprint 5 it sits behind the subscription wall, which is why FR-44 is attributed to both sprints.

4.2 Sprint 4 — Retrieval, portfolio insights and hybrid search

4.2.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 4 is that published articles become a retrievable corpus; that the assistant answers from the writer's own passages and shows them; that each writer gets an automatically extracted voice profile; that magazines request AI portfolio insights; and that search finds articles by meaning as well as by keyword. Table 4.3 lists the stories.

Table 4.3 – Sprint 4 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Prior-ity	Points
US-14	Ask an assistant that has read my published work	Must	13

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-17	See which of my passages the assistant used	Should	5
US-19	Have my voice profile extracted from my corpus	Should	8
US-20	Search by keyword	Must	5
US-21	Find articles that match my meaning even when they share none of my words	Must	8
US-22	Browse by tag	Should	2
US-23	Find writers, not only articles	Should	3
US-33	Read an AI assessment of a writer's voice and range	Must	8
	8 stories		**52**

The sprint commits 52 points, the second heaviest load of the project. Its stories share one new component — the embedding of published articles — and could only be estimated once it existed, which is why the sprint begins with it.

4.2.2 Analysis

Figure 4.12 gives the use cases of Sprint 4.

Searching specialises into searching by keyword and by meaning and includes merging the two result sets; using the assistant includes retrieving passages from the writer's own corpus and showing the sources used; publishing includes embedding the article, extracting the writer's voice profile and invalidating the insights cache; reading a writer evaluation is extended by generating portfolio insights. The diagram shows that publishing has become the trigger of the whole AI layer: every capability of the sprint depends on what happens after a writer clicks *Publish*.

4.2.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 4.13 adds the retrieval corpus.

An `ArticleChunk` is a passage of a published article with its 1,536-dimension embedding; the `WriterMemory` holds the extracted voice profile (tone, style examples, vocabulary, topics); the `PortfolioInsight` caches the AI assessment of a writer; the `AiInteraction` log records every call. The diagram shows that the AI layer adds data derived from articles and never modifies them: every chunk, profile and insight can be deleted and rebuilt from the published articles, which is what the re-embedding on every publication does.

Sequence diagram — what publishing sets in motion. Figure 4.14 shows the background pipeline a publication starts.

The API writes the article and enqueues an embedding job. The worker deletes the article's previous chunks, splits it into passages of 120 to 1,200 characters — each prefixed with its nearest heading, so that a short paragraph embeds near its subject — embeds them, stores the vectors and drops the writer's cached insights. It then chains the extraction of the voice profile from the most recent articles, which the model returns as a schema-validated object. The diagram shows that publishing returns immediately: the writer never waits for an embedding, and a failure of the provider delays retrieval without blocking publication.

Sequence diagram — a chat turn grounded in the writer's corpus. Figure 4.15 shows retrieval-augmented generation, the technique of conditioning a language model on passages retrieved for the question [40], [41], as delivered in this sprint.

The question is embedded; the five passages of the writer's own work closest to it by cosine similarity are retrieved, provided they score above 0.60; the voice profile is read; the prompt is assembled from role, memory, passages and question; the answer is streamed, and the passages used are shown as sources. The

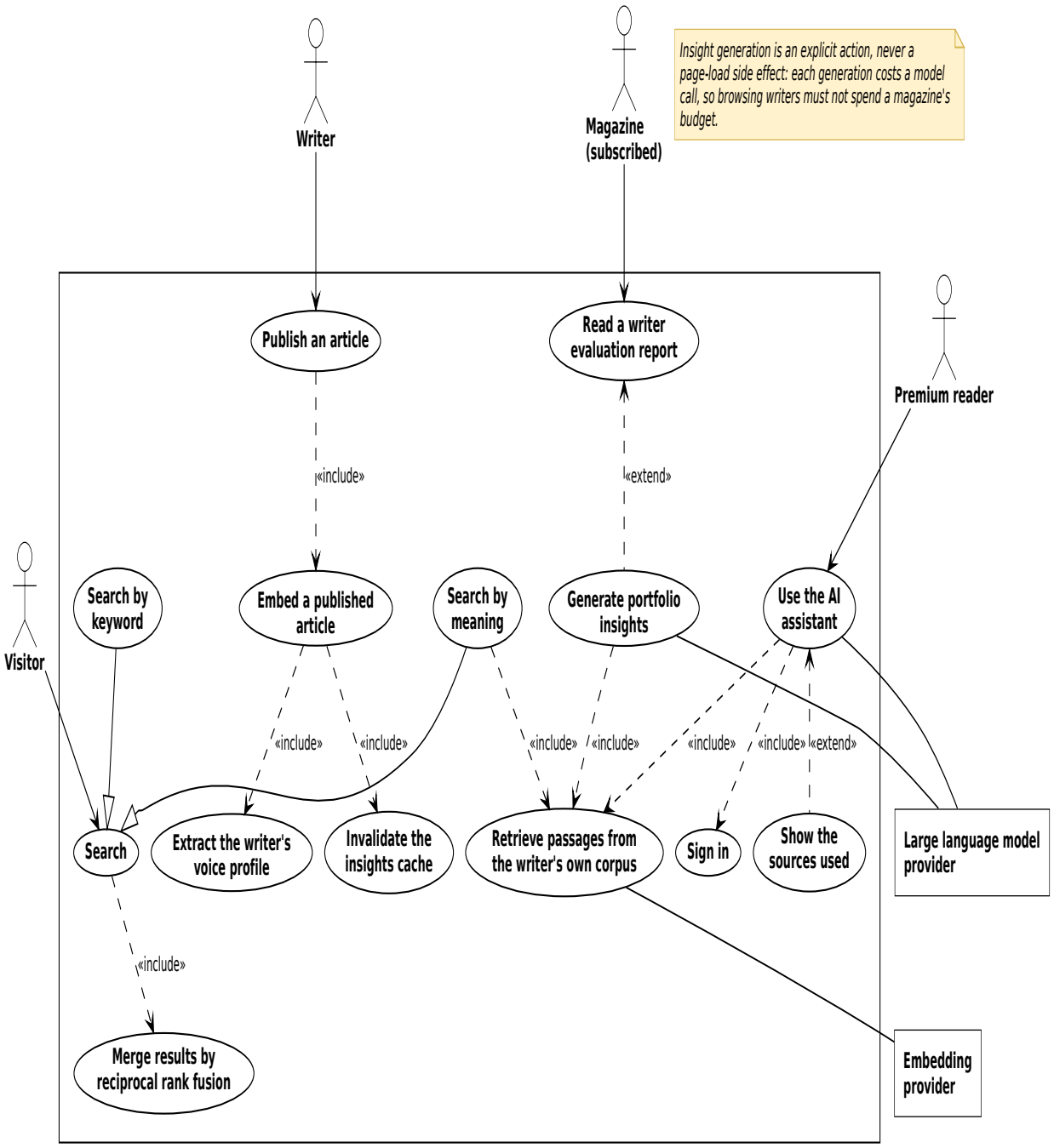


Figure 4.12 – Use case diagram, Sprint 4

similarity floor lets retrieval return *nothing* rather than five irrelevant passages, and the voice profile keeps the answer in the writer's style even then. Section 7.2 measures how well this retrieval finds the right passage and how often the floor correctly returns nothing.

Sequence diagram — hybrid search. Figure 4.16 shows search.

The query is ranked lexically with `ts_rank` over the article's weighted search vector [23], and semantically by cosine similarity, keeping the best passage per article. Because the two scores are on unrelated scales, the rankings are fused by position with reciprocal rank fusion — each article scores Σ 1/(60 + rank) over the two lists [39] — so an article that never uses the searcher's words can still be found by meaning. The diagram shows that the two rankings are independent and run in parallel: if the embedding provider fails, search degrades to keyword search instead of failing. Section 7.3 compares the three rankings on the same queries.

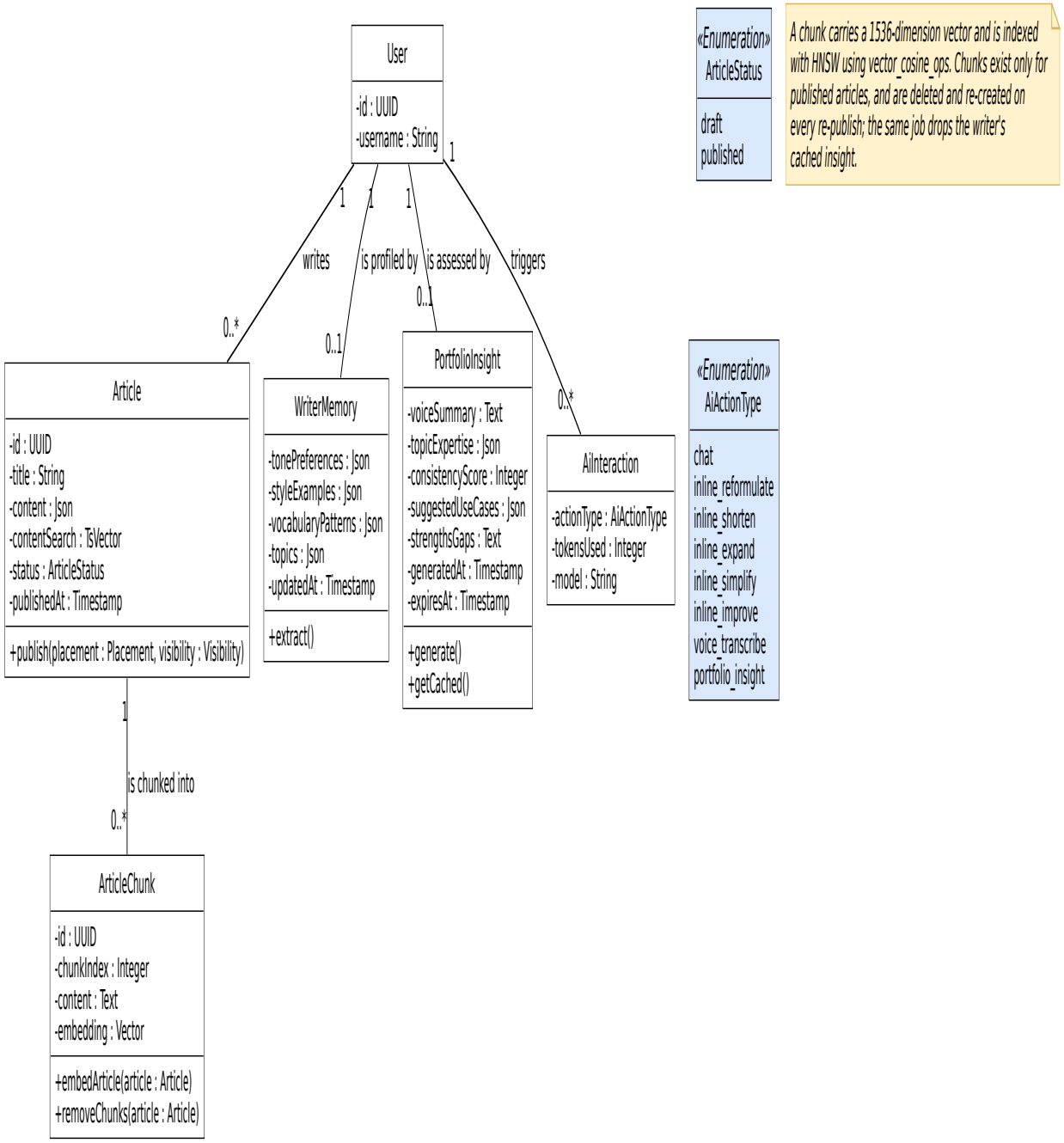


Figure 4.13 – Class diagram, Sprint 4

4.2.4 Realisation

Figure 4.17 shows search results for a visitor.

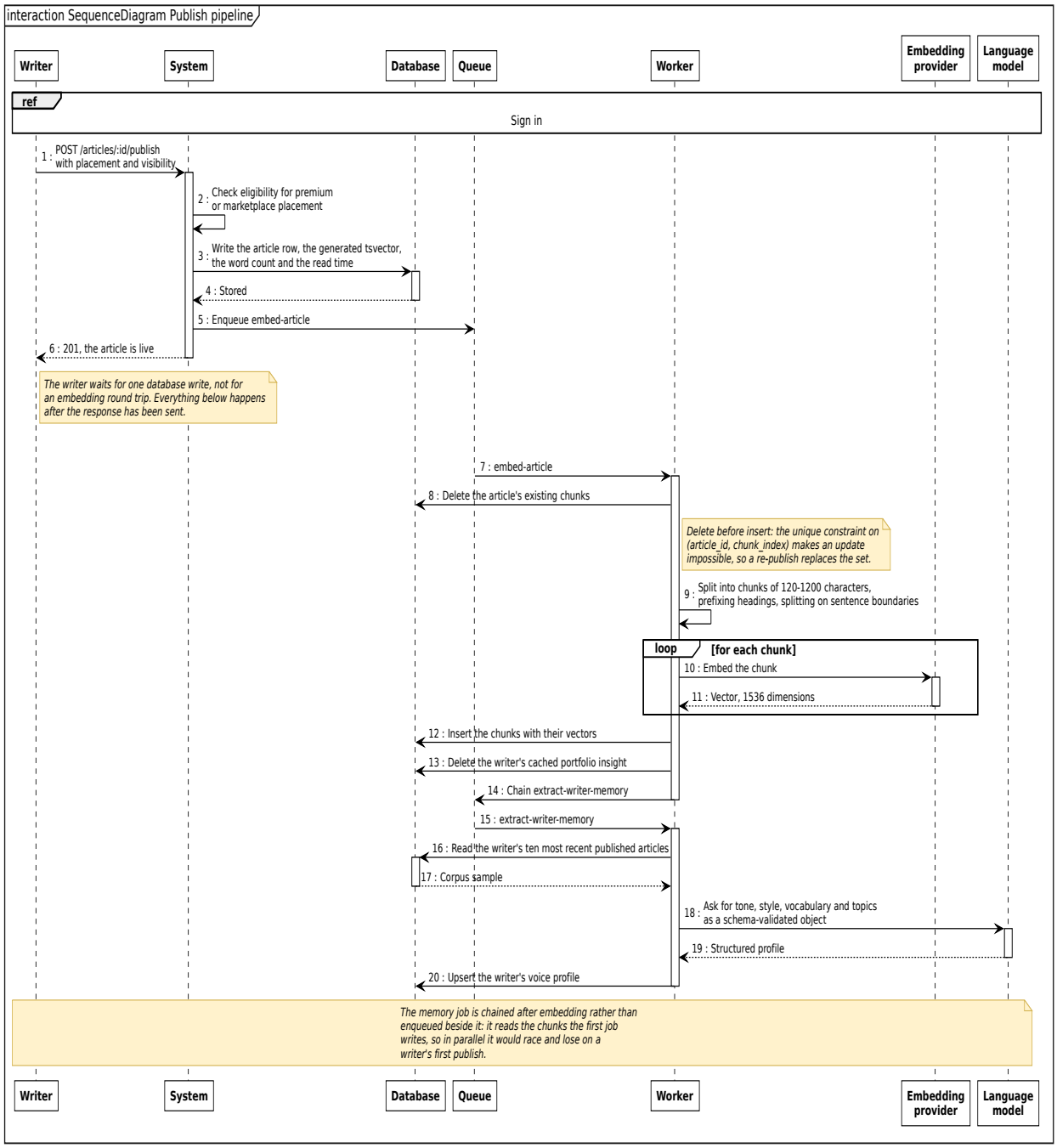
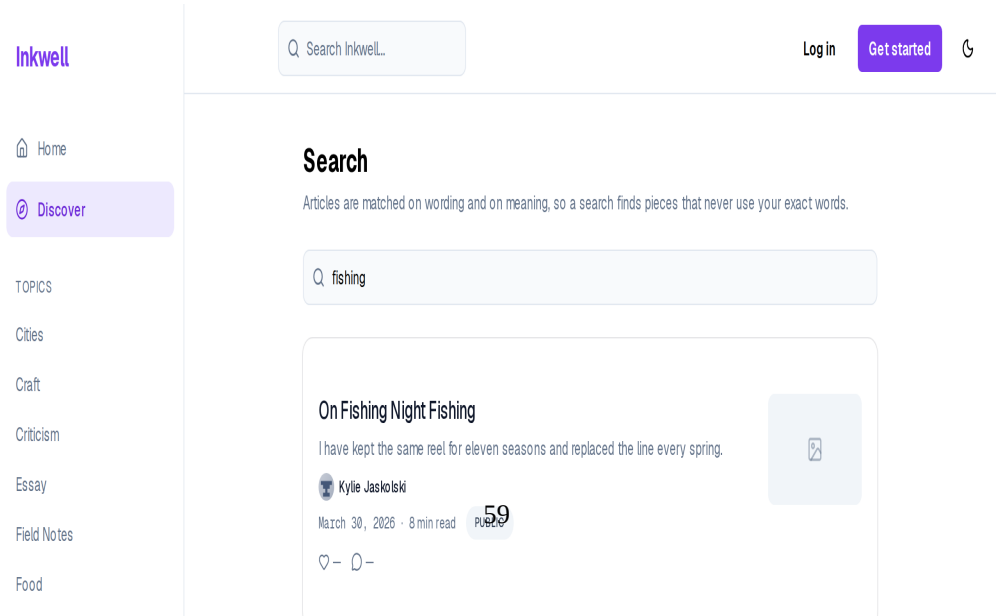


Figure 4.14 – Sequence diagram: the publishing pipeline



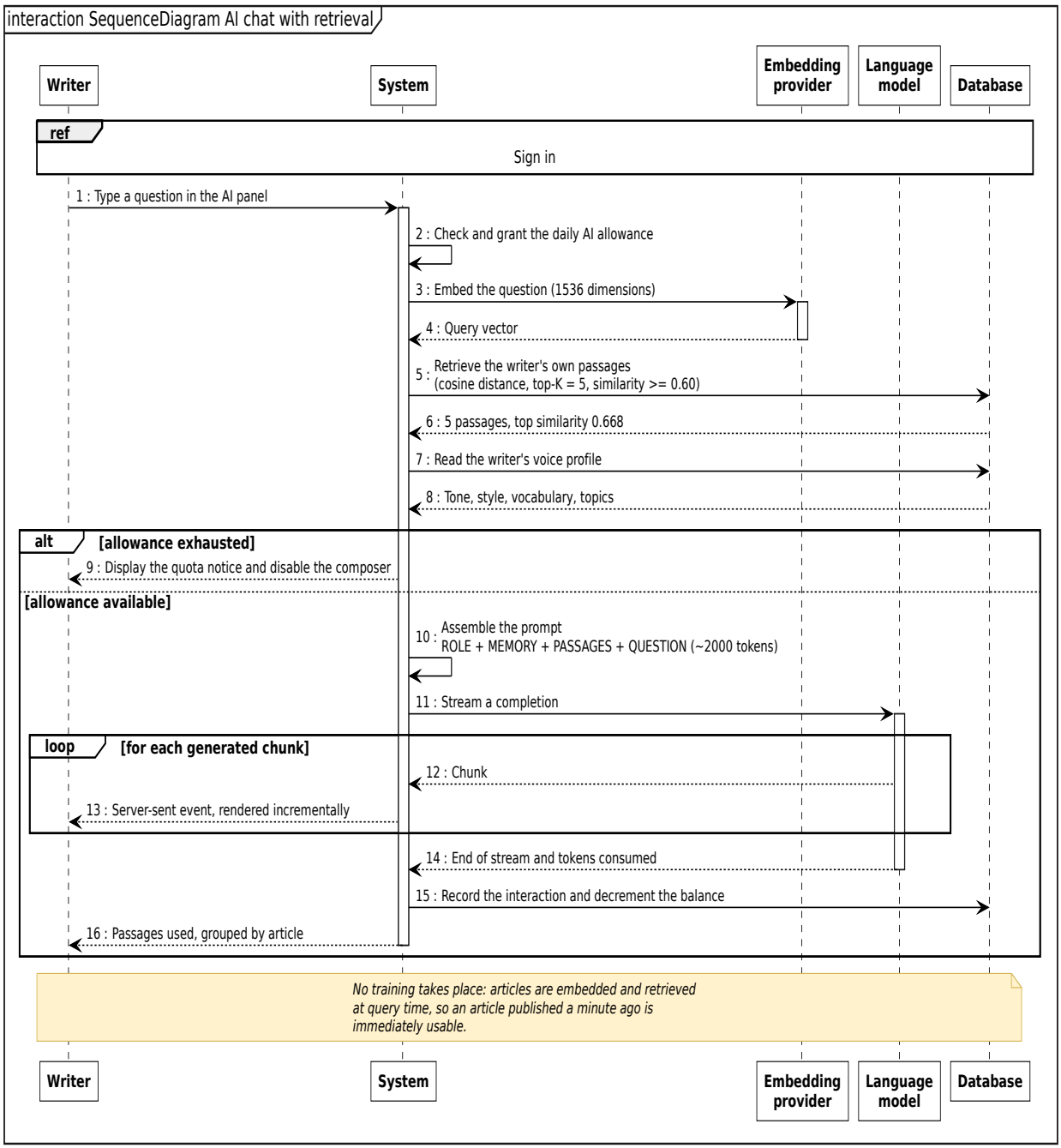


Figure 4.15 – Sequence diagram: AI chat with retrieval

The page says how it works — articles are matched on wording and on meaning (FR-06). For “fishing”, the first results are articles whose titles contain the word: they rank high in both the lexical and the semantic list, and reciprocal rank fusion rewards agreement between the two. Search is available without an account, like the feed.

Figure 4.18 shows the evaluation report that a magazine reads before buying.

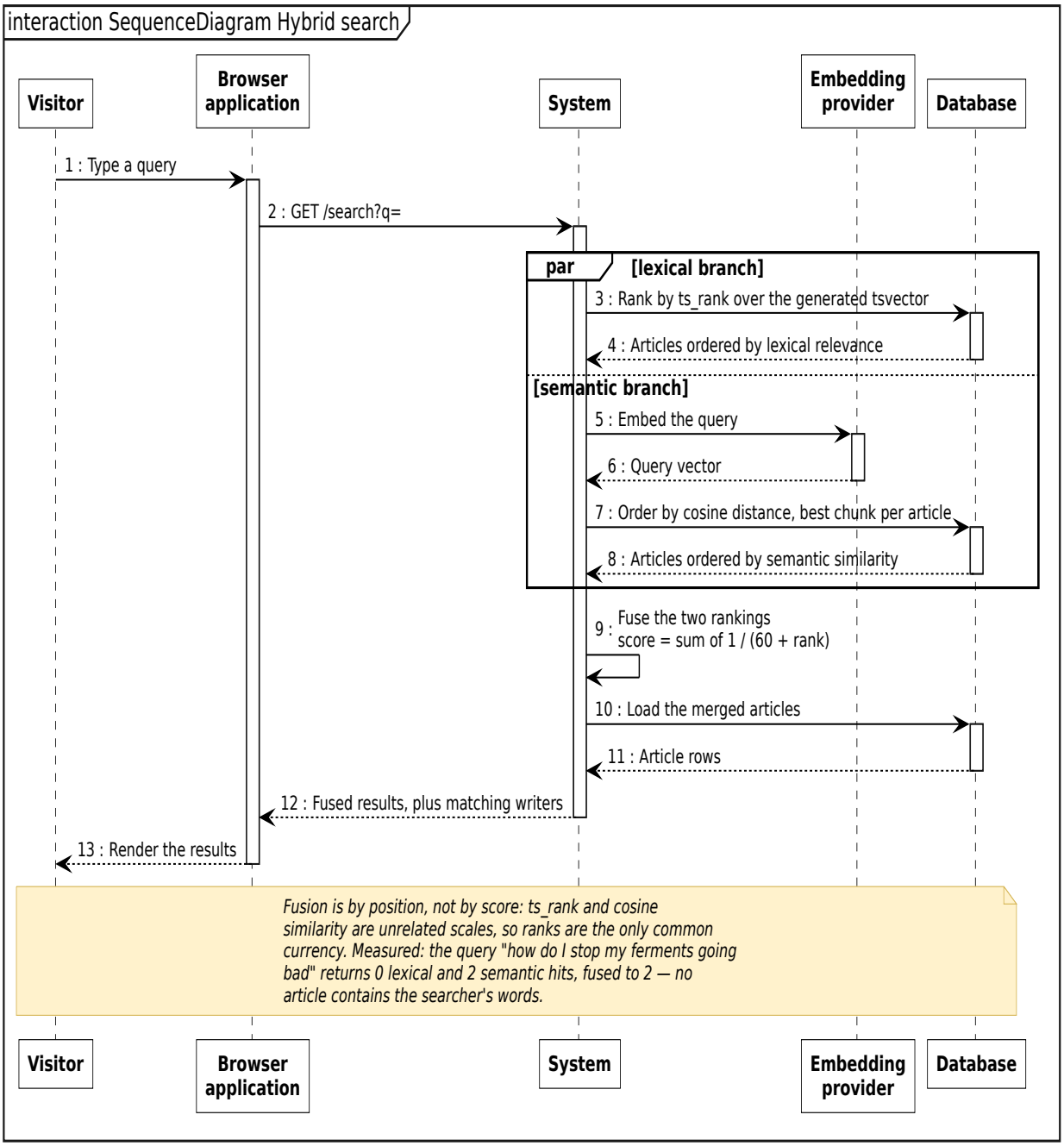
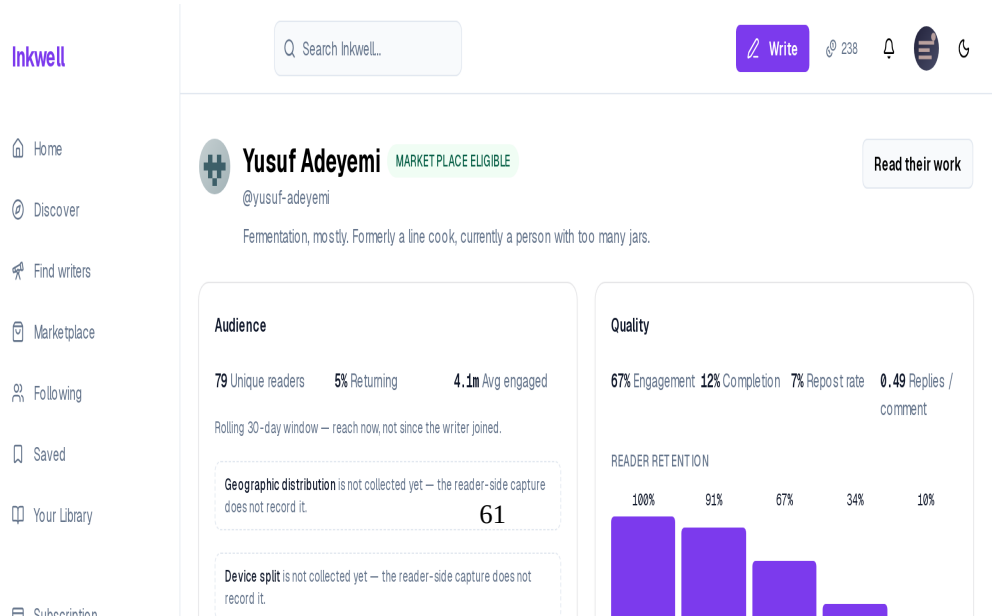


Figure 4.16 – Sequence diagram: hybrid search with reciprocal rank fusion



The report gives the three panels of Table 4.2 — audience, quality with its retention curve, and content with its topics — and the portfolio insights generated by the model, here a description of the writer's voice, with *Regenerate* as the explicit action of FR-46 (FR-45, FR-46). Two fields the capture cannot measure, geographic distribution and device split, are stated as not collected rather than shown as zero. The screen is the reason the analytics exist: it turns reading into evidence a buyer can weigh.

Conclusion

Release 2 made Inkwell.ai social and measurable: interactions with live notifications, reading events aggregated into per-article and per-writer metrics, an evaluation report for magazines, and a retrieval layer that grounds the assistant in the writer's own work, produces portfolio insights and powers hybrid search. Release 3 builds the marketplace those signals were designed for.

CHAPTER 5

Release 3: marketplace, testing and deployment

Introduction

The third release delivers the reason the analytics exist: the marketplace. Sprint 5 adds the premium plan, magazine subscriptions and credits, the eligibility gate, the two-stage purchase with exclusive rights, the magazine's own act of publishing, and the moderation console. Sprint 6 is a technical sprint: it delivers no new screen, but the test strategy that proves the business rules of Sprint 5, a demonstration corpus, and a deployable production stack. Both sprints follow the same four steps as the others.

5.1 Sprint 5 — Marketplace, subscriptions, premium and moderation

5.1.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 5 is that readers upgrade to premium; that magazines subscribe and receive monthly credits; that eligible writers list articles; that magazines preview, buy and publish them under their own masthead, every credit movement recorded in a ledger; that writers see their earnings; and that administrators moderate. Table 5.1 lists the stories.

Table 5.1 – Sprint 5 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Prior-ity	Points
US-12	Restrict an article to premium readers	Should	3
US-34	Upgrade to premium	Must	5
US-35	Subscribe as a magazine	Must	8
US-36	Receive a monthly credit budget	Must	5
US-37	Top up credits	Should	3
US-38	Pay 10% to read an article in full	Must	8
US-39	Pay the remainder to acquire republish rights	Must	8
US-40	Keep purchased articles in a library	Must	3
US-41	List an article for sale at my own price	Must	5
US-42	See my earnings itemised by preview and purchase	Must	5
US-43	See how far I am from eligibility	Should	3
US-44	Report content	Must	3
US-45	Work a queue of reports	Must	5
US-46	Remove an article or ban an author	Must	3
US-47	Grant eligibility manually	Must	3
US-48	Search and filter users	Should	5
US-63	Publish an article I have bought when I am ready, rather than the purchase publishing it for me	Must	5
US-64	Have the articles I publish appear on my public profile under my masthead	Must	5
	18 stories		**85**

The sprint commits 85 points, about twice the average of the other sprints. The load was accepted rather than split because the marketplace stories form one transaction model: a preview, a purchase, a publication and an earnings line are four views of the same ledger rows, and delivering half of them would have left money

that could be spent but not accounted for. The ledger harness of Sprint 1 and the screens of the design track had removed most of the uncertainty in advance. How far this estimate held is discussed with the velocity in Section 7.7.

5.1.2 Analysis

Use case diagram. Figure 5.1 gives the use cases of Sprint 5.

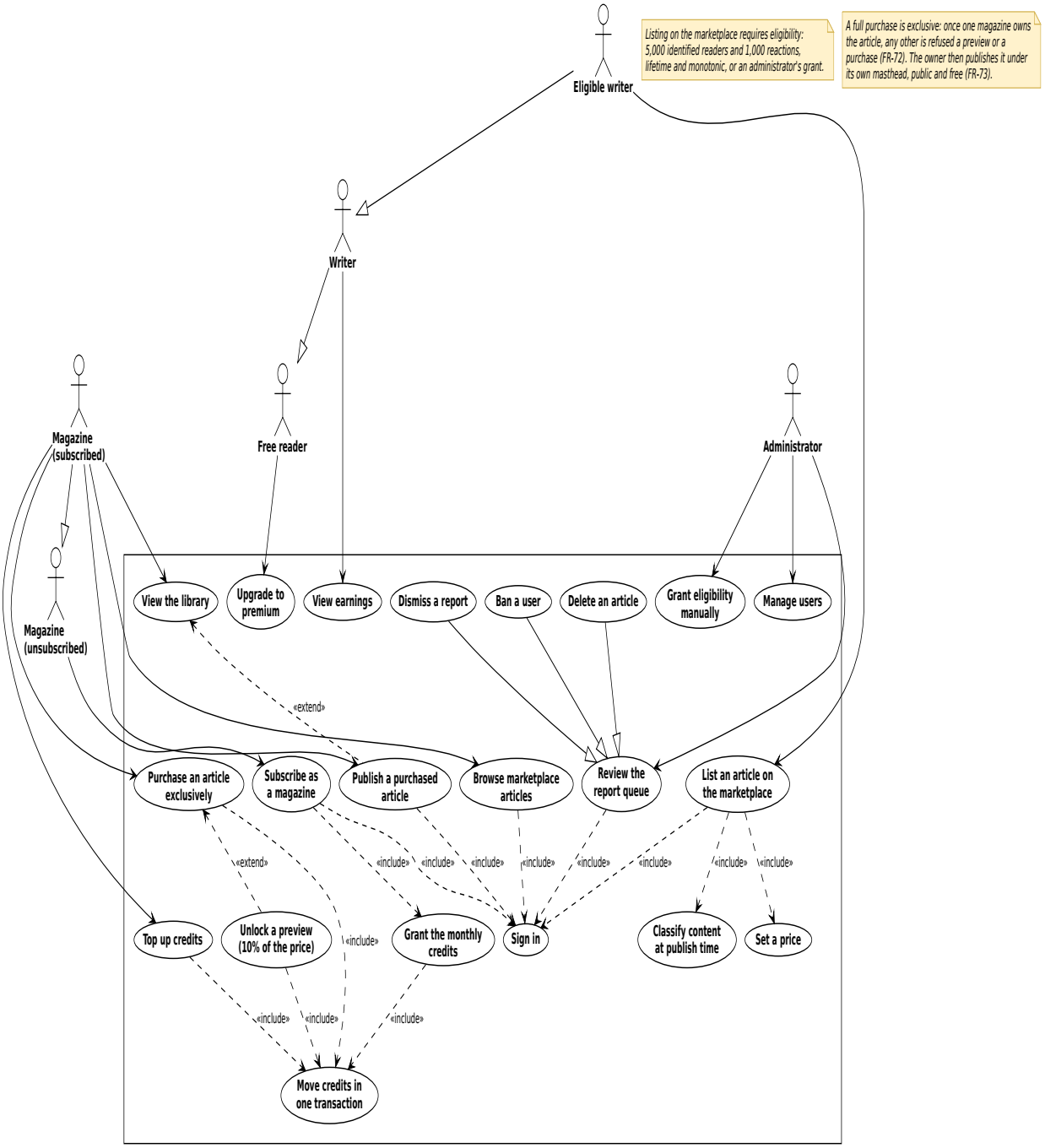


Figure 5.1 – Use case diagram, Sprint 5

An unsubscribed magazine can only subscribe; a subscribed magazine browses the marketplace, purchases an article exclusively — unlocking a preview extends the purchase — tops up credits, views its library and publishes a purchased article from it. Every credit movement includes moving credits in one transaction. An eligible writer lists an article, which includes setting a price and classifying the content at publish time;

the administrator reviews the report queue, grants eligibility and manages users. The diagram shows that the subscription is the gate of every magazine use case but one, which is what the actor split A6 / A7 of Section 1.3 expresses.

Business rules. The marketplace is governed by the rules of Table 5.2. They are part of the analysis because every screen and every test of the sprint applies them.

Table 5.2 – Marketplace rules and their justification

Rule	Value	Justification
Eligibility to list or publish premium	5,000 identified unique readers **and** 1,000 reactions (likes and comments) across the writer's public articles, lifetime; or a manual grant by an administrator; never revoked automatically	both an audience and a response to it, so neither a viral article nor a small circle of friends qualifies alone; never revoked, so a writer's listings do not disappear in a quiet month
Magazine subscription	monthly; 500 credits a month; unspent credits roll over	a predictable budget (US-36); roll-over, so a magazine is not pushed to spend
Preview unlock	10% of the article's price, credited towards the purchase	cheap enough to read before deciding, and never lost if the magazine buys
Full purchase	the remaining 90%; exclusive	exclusivity is what a publication pays for; the preview is deducted so the total is the price
Platform fee	20% of each stage, rounded down; the writer receives the rest	rounded down so that the writer, not the platform, keeps the indivisible credit
Publication	a separate act of the owning magazine: the article becomes public and free, its price is cleared and the magazine is recorded as publisher	buying is not publishing; the magazine decides when its masthead appears (US-63)

The rules have one property in common: each is an integer computation with a single rounding, so the sum of what the writer, the platform and the magazine see always reconciles to the credit. The values themselves — 10%, 20%, 500, 5,000 and 1,000 — are product decisions, kept as named constants (Section 2.3).

5.1.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 5.2 shows licensing and the ledger.

A `Purchase` records a stage — preview unlock or full purchase — with the credits paid, the platform fee and the writer's payout, and a full purchase links to the preview that preceded it. Each stage writes three `Transaction` rows: the magazine's debit, the writer's payout and the platform fee; amounts are always positive and their direction comes from the type, enforced by a constraint. The diagram shows that no balance is stored without its explanation: the magazine's credit balance and the writer's earnings are caches of the transaction rows, which is exactly what the ledger invariants check (NFR-19).

Sequence diagram — the purchase. Figure 5.3 shows the three calls of a licence.

Each purchase stage opens one database transaction: it locks the article row and reads its owner, refusing with 409 if another magazine already owns it, then locks the magazine's credit balance, refuses with 402 when it is insufficient, debits the magazine, credits the writer, and writes the purchase and its three ledger rows. The full purchase charges only what the preview has not already paid, and leaves the article in the magazine's library, owned and unpublished; publishing is a third call. The diagram shows the two guarantees of the design: the row lock rules out two magazines buying the same article or one magazine spending the same credits twice (NFR-20), and the idempotency key on every request rules out a retried request charging twice (NFR-06).

Activity diagram — the eligibility gate. Figure 5.4 shows how a writer becomes eligible.

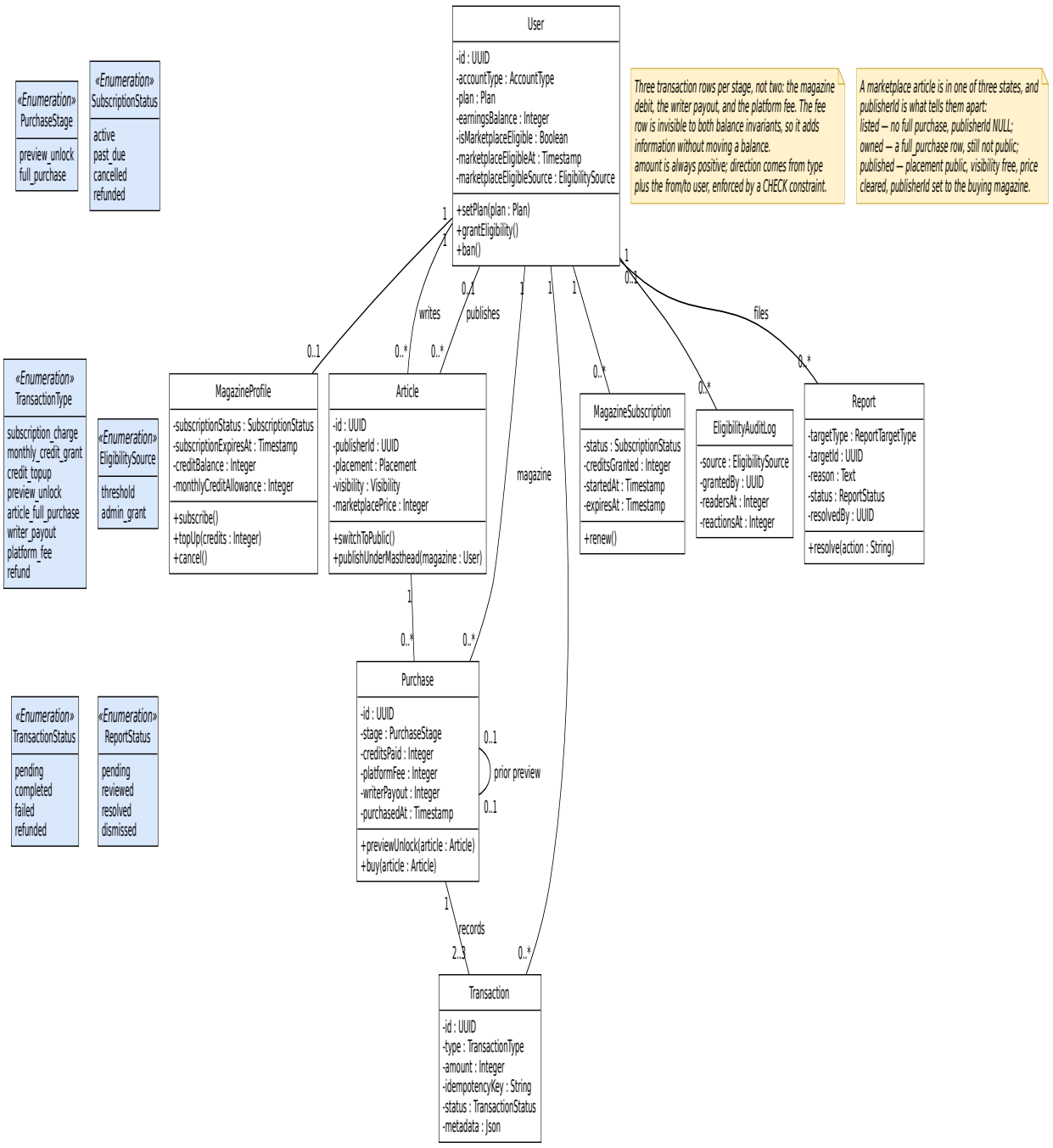


Figure 5.2 – Class diagram, Sprint 5

After each aggregation the worker checks the writers above both thresholds who are not yet eligible, marks them eligible and writes an audit-log entry with the metric snapshot; an administrator can grant eligibility directly, with the same audit trail. Comment likes and reposts are deliberately not counted as reactions, so that other people's activity cannot move a writer's threshold. The diagram shows that both paths end in the same audit entry, so every eligible writer can be traced to the numbers or the person that made them eligible.

Sequence diagram — moderation. Figure 5.5 shows the two sources of reports.

After publication a classifier model reviews the article; a flag files a pending report with no reporter but never blocks publication. Readers report articles, users or comments. The administrator works the queue: dismiss the report, remove the article or ban the author, a ban taking effect within fifteen minutes (NFR-09). The diagram shows the policy behind the design: the classifier only *files* a report, because refusing publication on

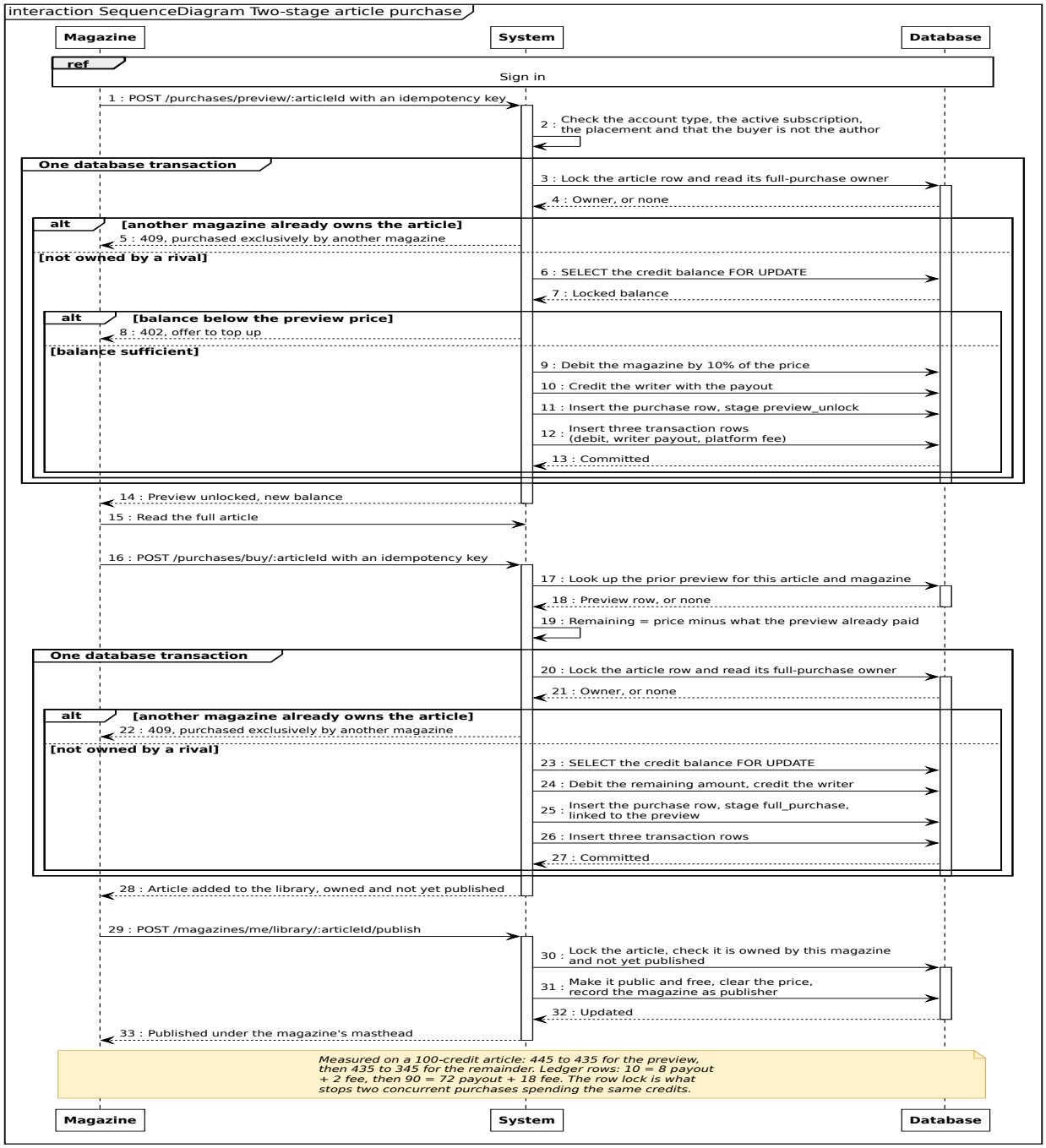


Figure 5.3 – Sequence diagram: preview, purchase and publication

a false positive would be worse than a human clearing it from the queue. Its precision and recall are measured in Section 7.4.

Activity diagram — the article access decision. Figure 5.6 shows the decision taken server-side for every article body.

The author and administrators always read. A marketplace article is visible only to a magazine with an active subscription, and its body only once that magazine has previewed or bought it — otherwise it receives the title, excerpt and price with the content set to `null`. A premium public article requires the premium plan or a subscribed magazine. A free public article is readable by everyone. The diagram is the rule of FR-56 and NFR-04: the browser is told the verdict and never computes it, so a modified client cannot read what it has not paid for.

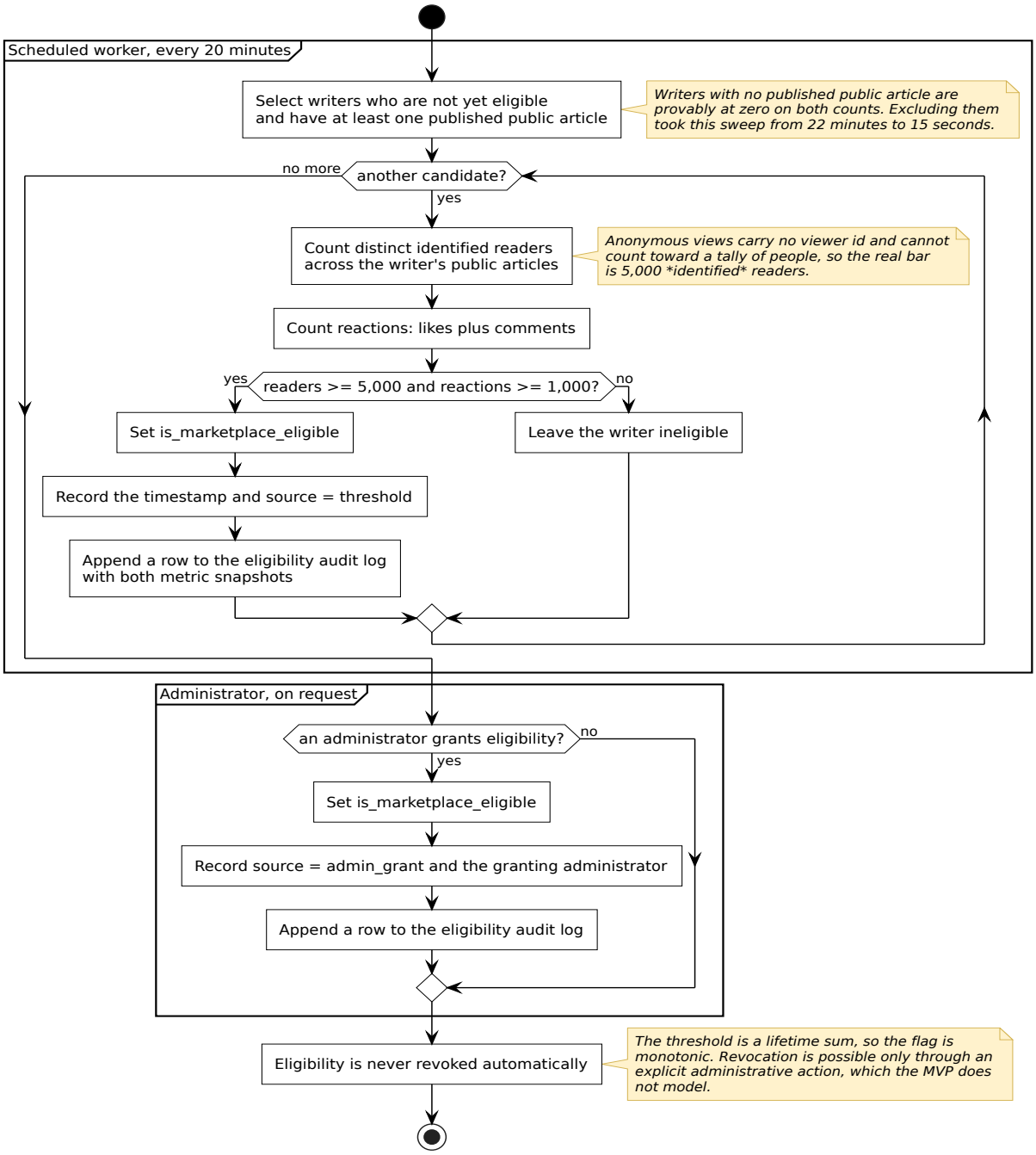


Figure 5.4 – Activity diagram: the marketplace eligibility gate

State diagram — the article lifecycle. Figure 5.7 shows the states an article goes through.

A draft is published as free, premium or listed on the marketplace. A listed article can be withdrawn to public — never the reverse, because an article the public has read has no exclusivity left to sell — or deleted, as long as no magazine owns it. Its first full purchase makes it *owned*, after which the writer can neither withdraw nor delete it; the magazine's publication makes it *published by a magazine*, public and free. The diagram shows that every transition that could destroy what a magazine paid for is absent, which is what makes the exclusivity of Table 5.2 enforceable.

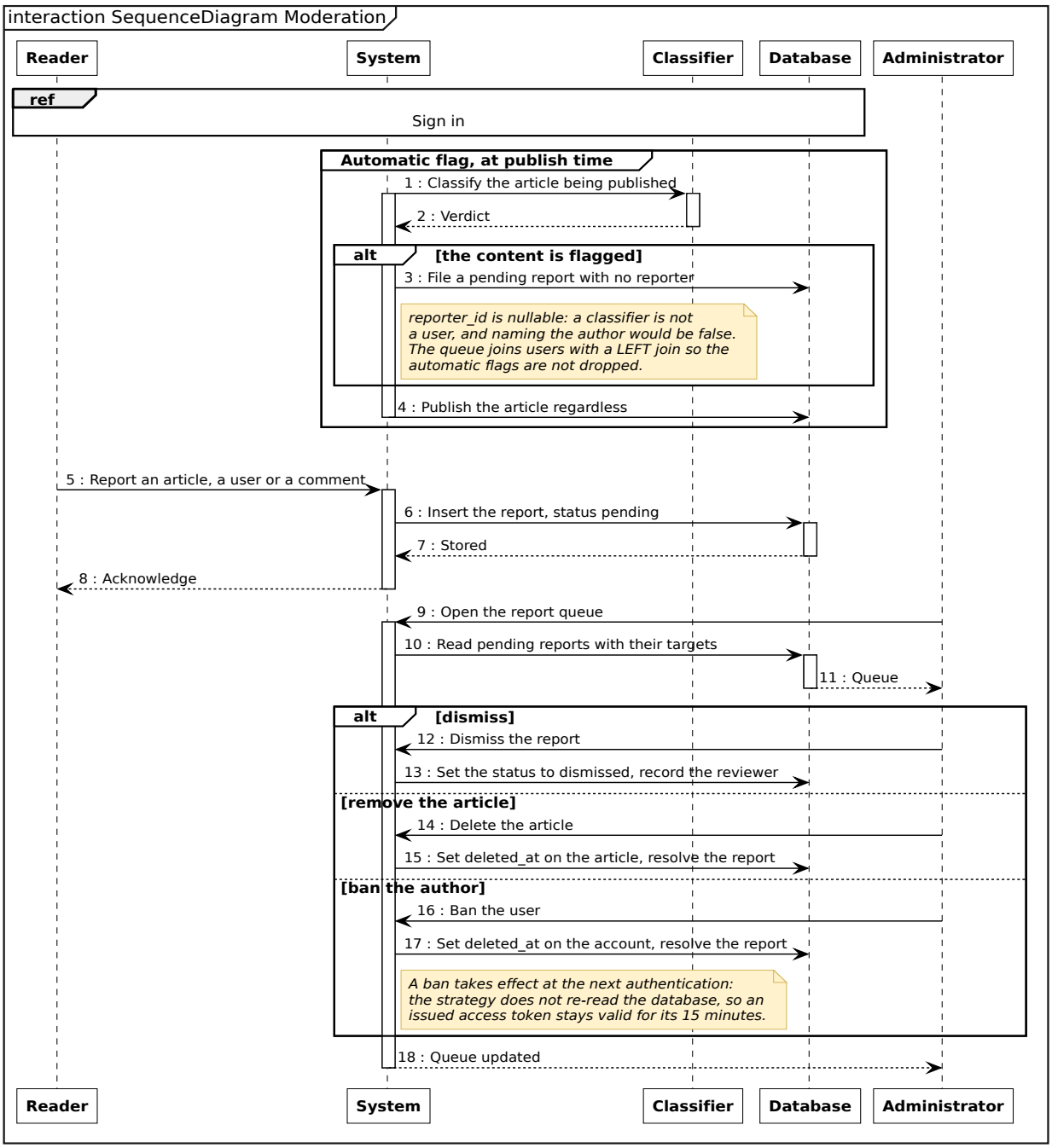


Figure 5.5 – Sequence diagram: reporting and moderation

5.1.4 Realisation

The premium plan comes first, because it is what a reader meets. Figure 5.8 shows a premium article opened by a visitor.

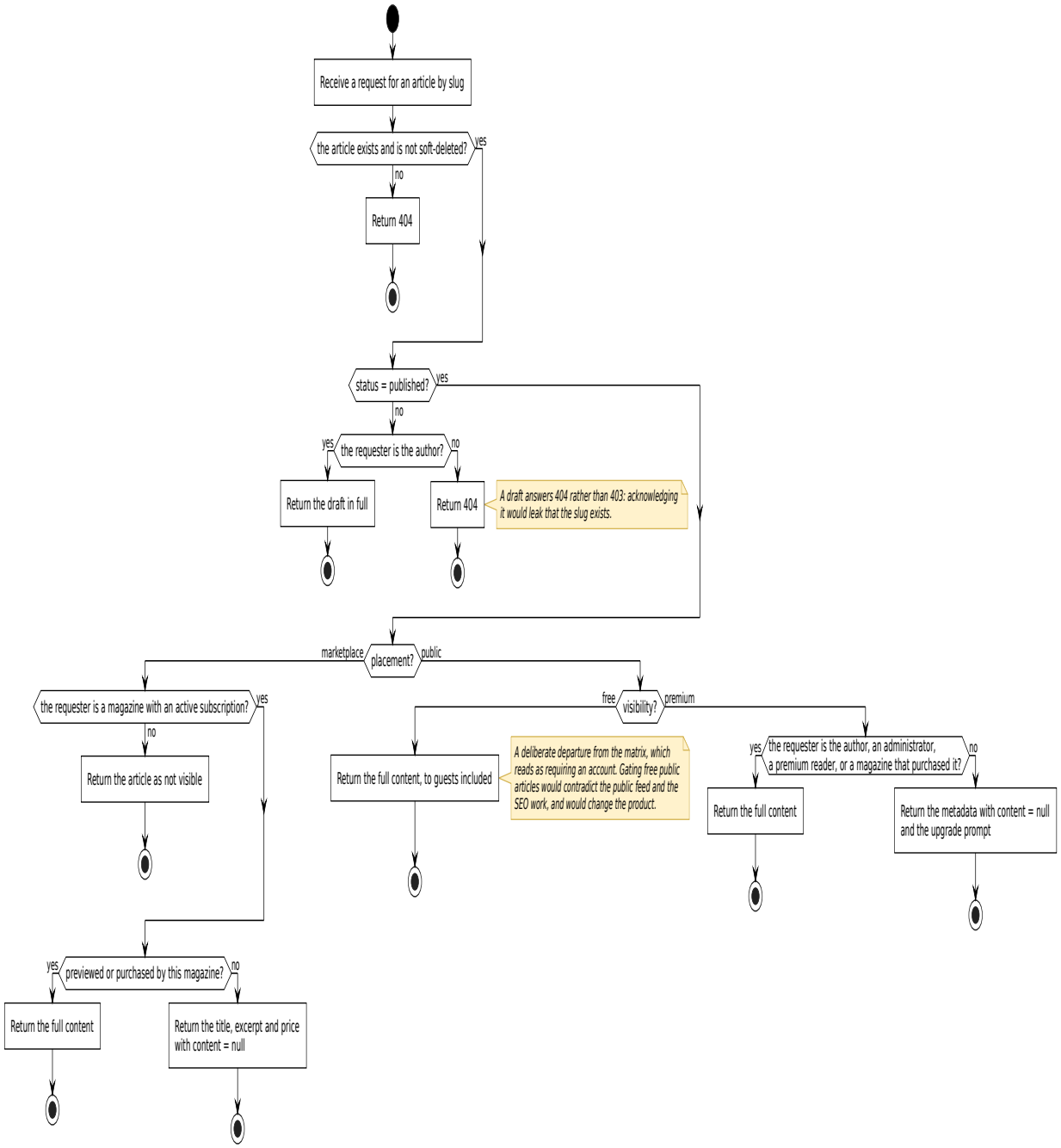
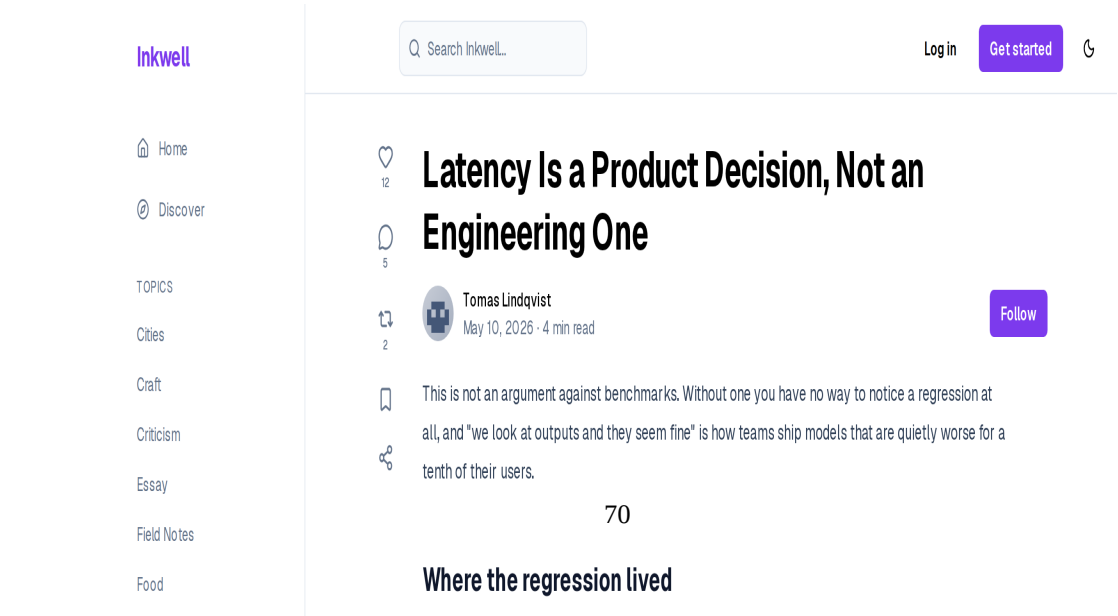


Figure 5.6 – Activity diagram: the article access decision



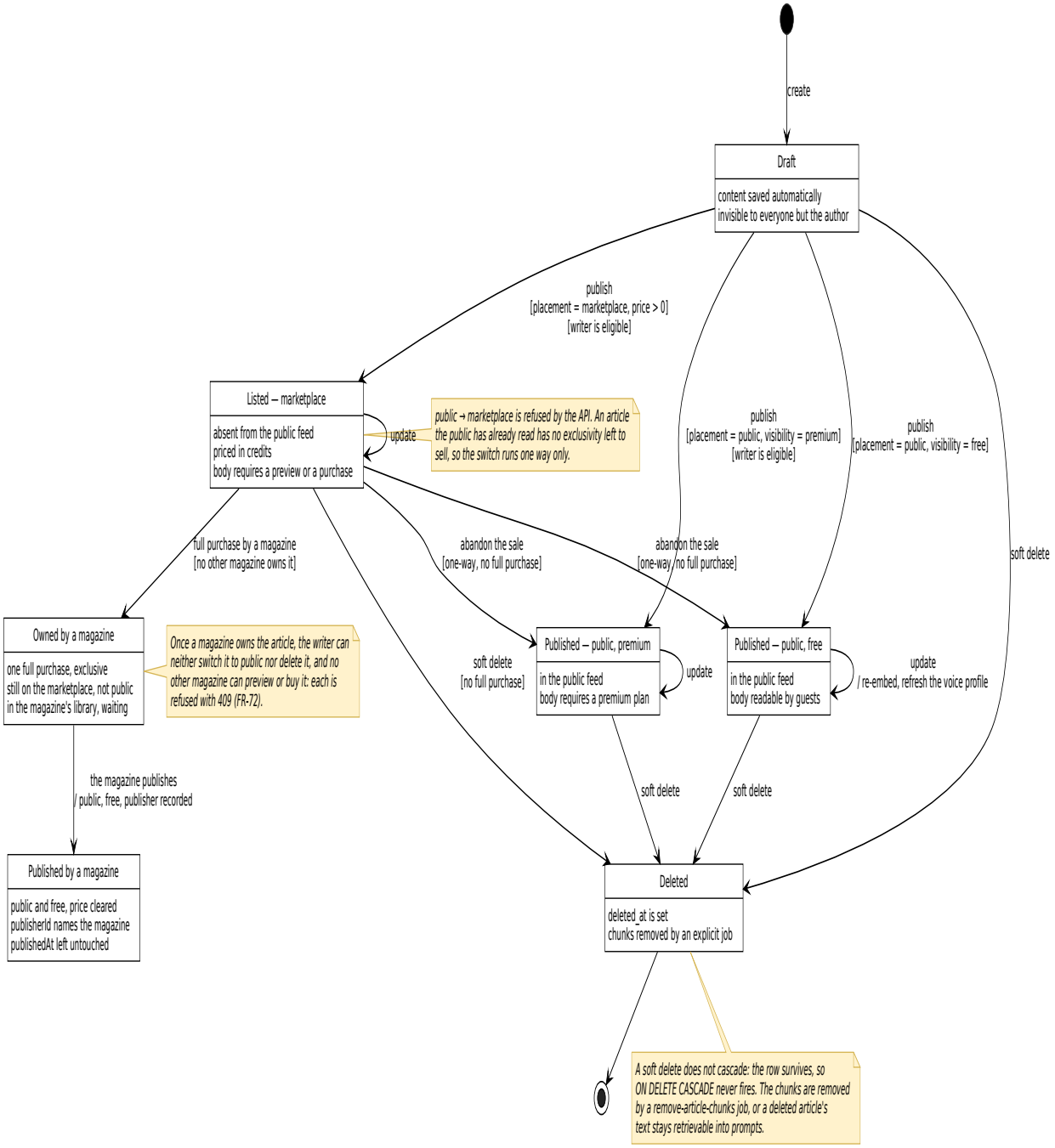


Figure 5.7 – State diagram: the article lifecycle

The visitor reads the title, the author and the opening of the article; the rest of the body is withheld by the access decision of Figure 5.6, and only a premium reader or a subscribed magazine receives it (FR-03, FR-16). What the screen does not show is as important as what it shows: the body never reaches the browser, so it cannot be revealed by inspecting the page.

Figure 5.9 shows the plans offered to a reader.

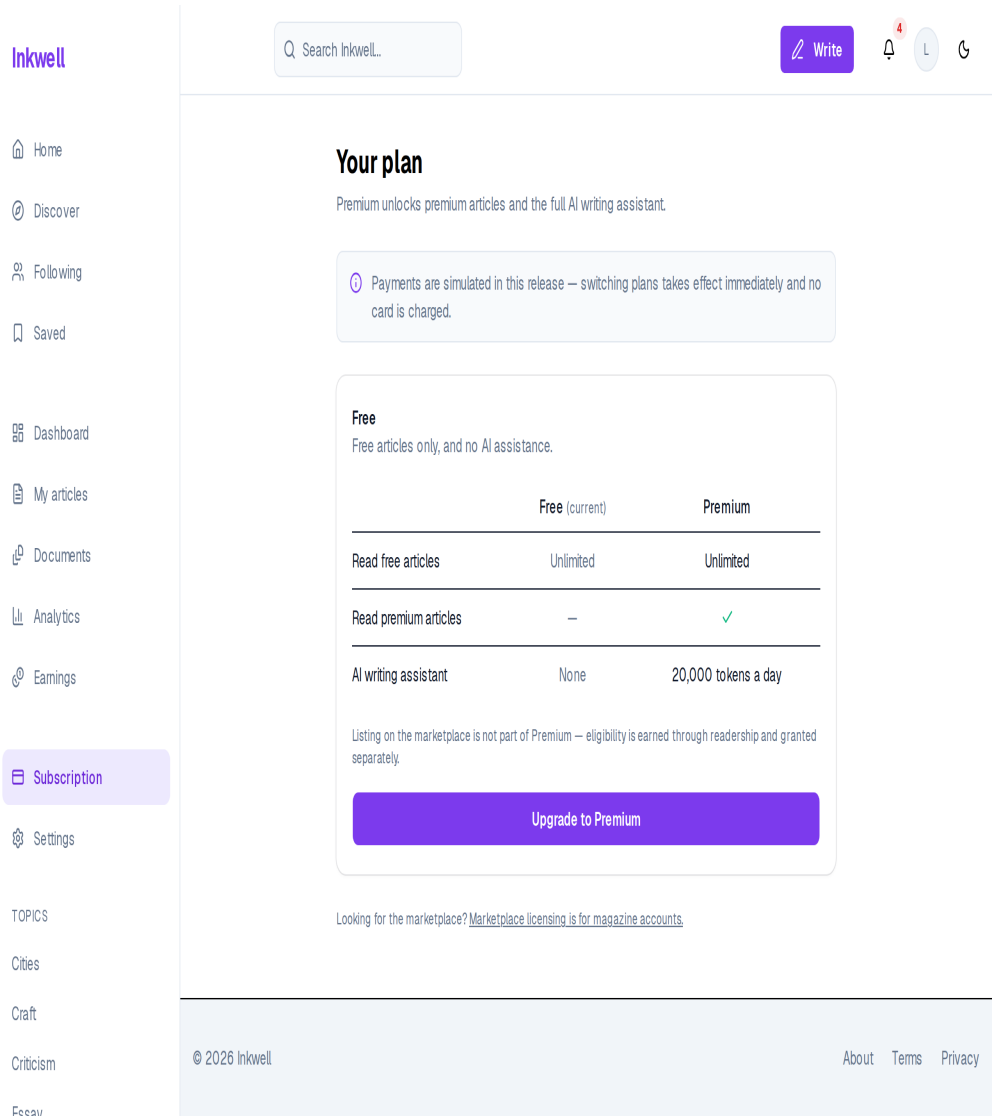


Figure 5.9 – The plans: free and premium

The comparison states the difference between the plans — premium articles and the AI assistant with 20,000 tokens a day — and the banner states that payments are simulated in this release (FR-15). The page also says that listing on the marketplace is not part of premium: eligibility is earned, not bought, which is the rule of Table 5.2.

The magazine's side starts with its subscription. Figure 5.10 shows a subscribed magazine.

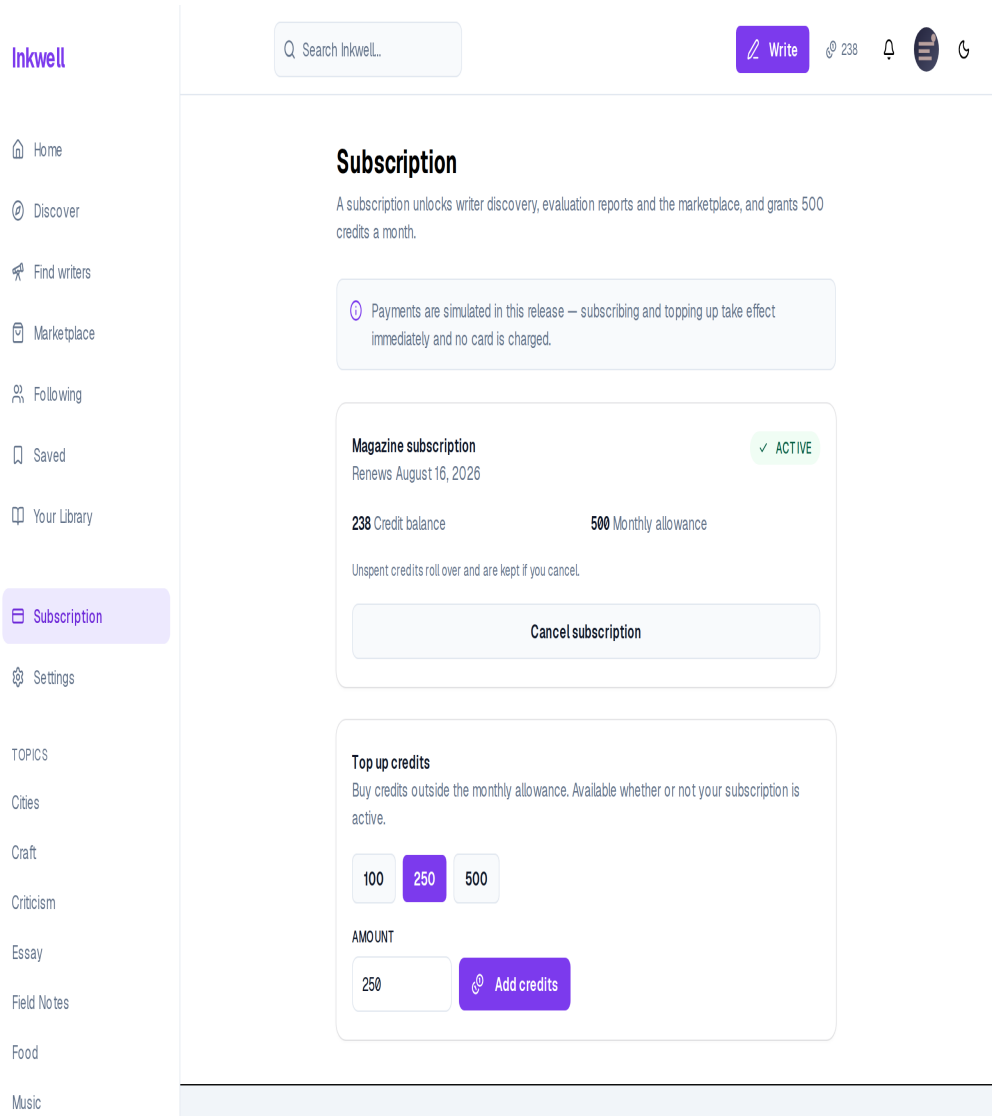


Figure 5.10 – A magazine's subscription and credits

The page shows the active subscription and its renewal date, the credit balance (238) and the monthly allowance (500), and offers a top-up of 100, 250 or 500 credits (FR-41, FR-42, FR-43). The note that unspent credits roll over and are kept on cancellation is the subscription rule of Table 5.2, stated where the magazine decides.

Figure 5.11 shows the marketplace and Figure 5.12 a listing before preview.

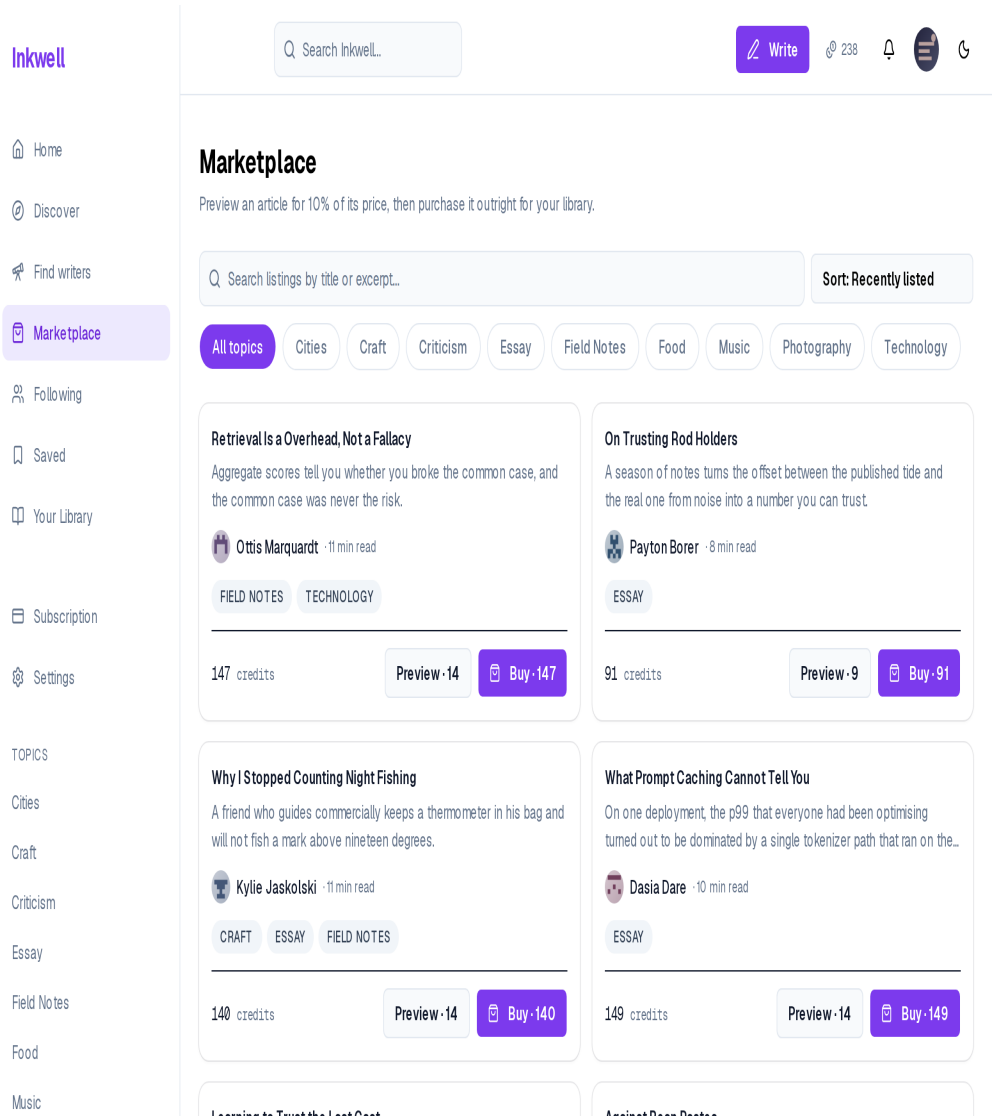


Figure 5.11 – The marketplace, with preview and purchase prices

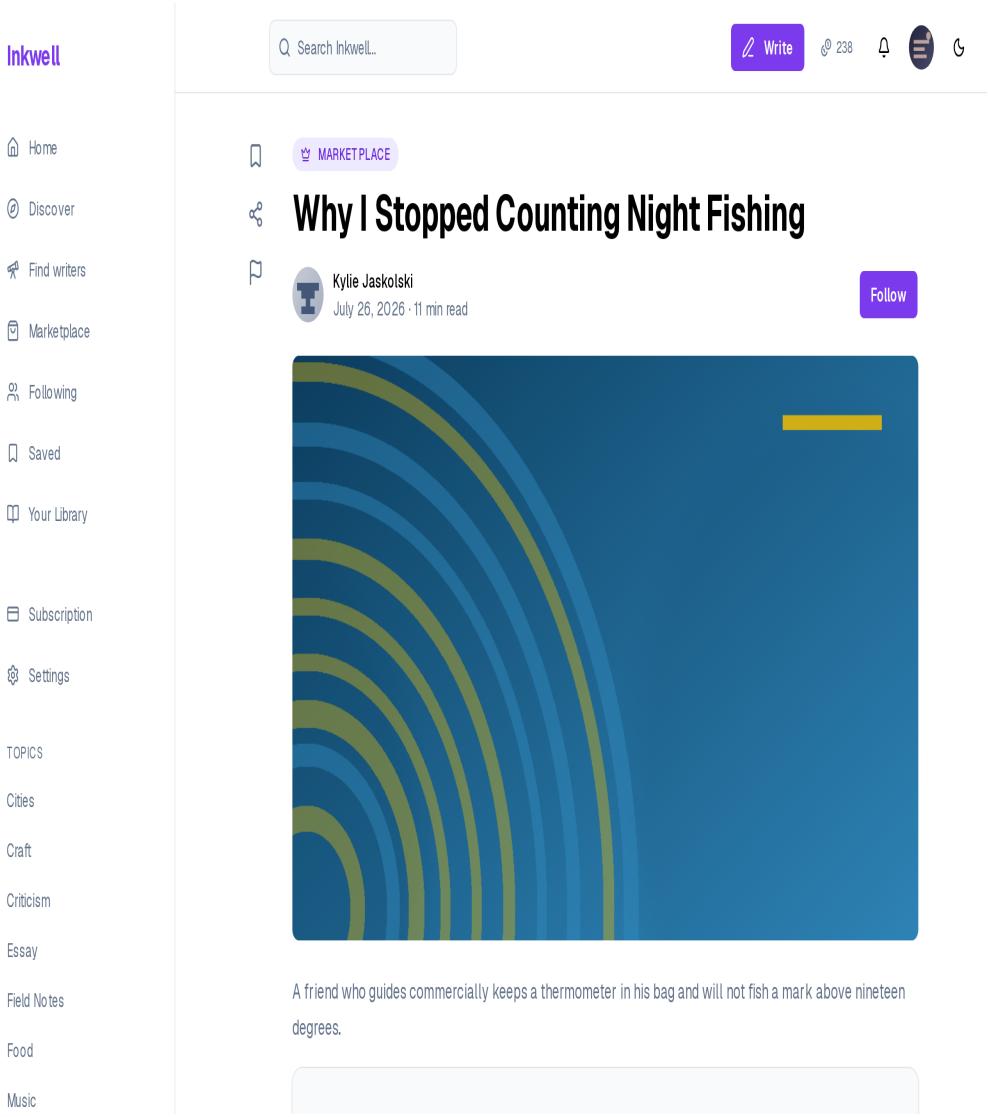


Figure 5.12 – A listing before preview

Each listing shows its writer, topics and price, and two buttons: *Preview* at 10% of the price — 14 credits for an article at 140 — and *Buy* at the full price (FR-47). The listing page shows the excerpt only; the body stays locked, as Figure 5.6 requires, until the magazine pays.

Figure 5.13 shows the confirmation of a preview unlock.

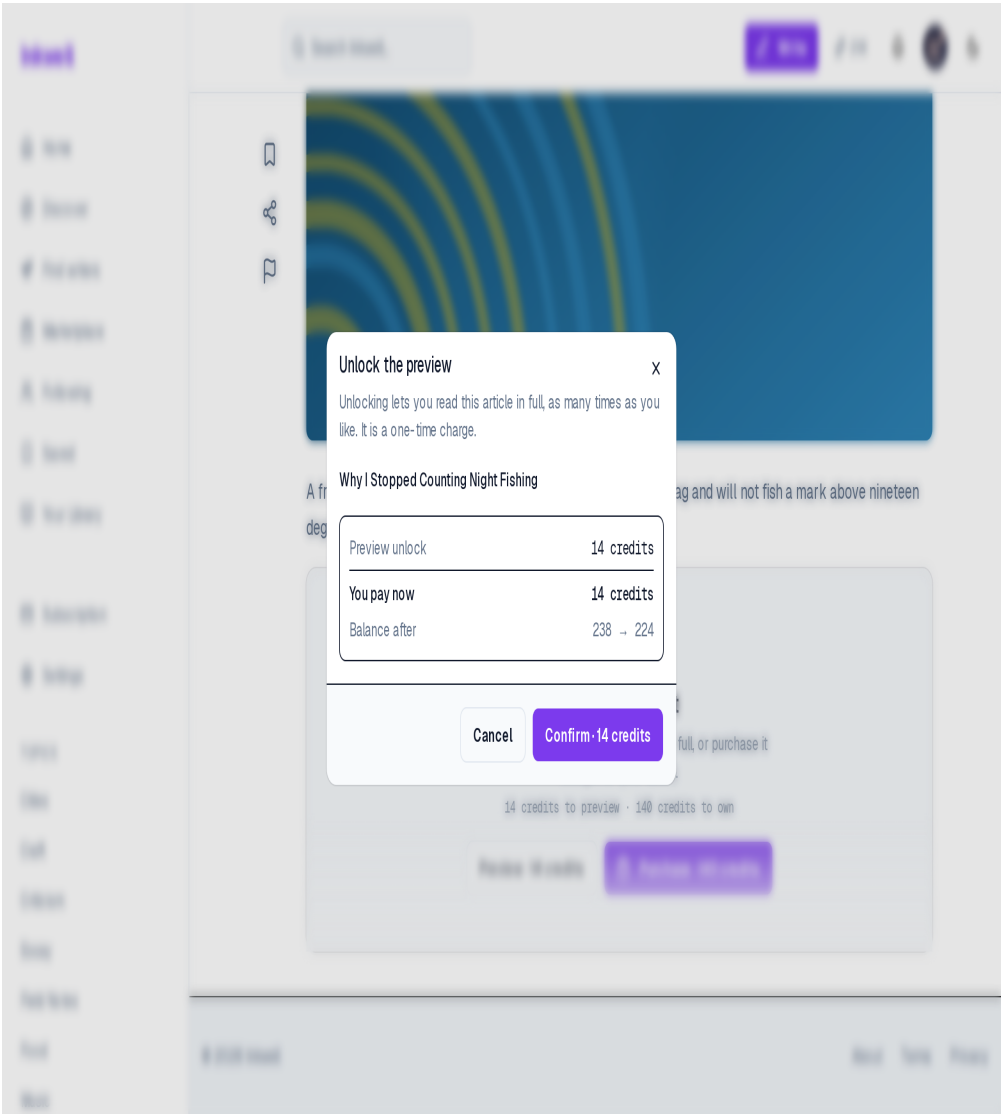


Figure 5.13 – Confirming a preview unlock: price and balance after

Before any credit moves, the dialog states what is bought, what is paid now and the balance after — 238 → 224 — and requires an explicit *Confirm* (FR-48). It is the screen of the first call of Figure 5.3: the figures it shows are the ones the transaction will write, so the magazine never discovers a charge after the fact.

After a full purchase the article lands in the magazine's library. Figure 5.14 shows it and Figure 5.15 the act of publishing from it.

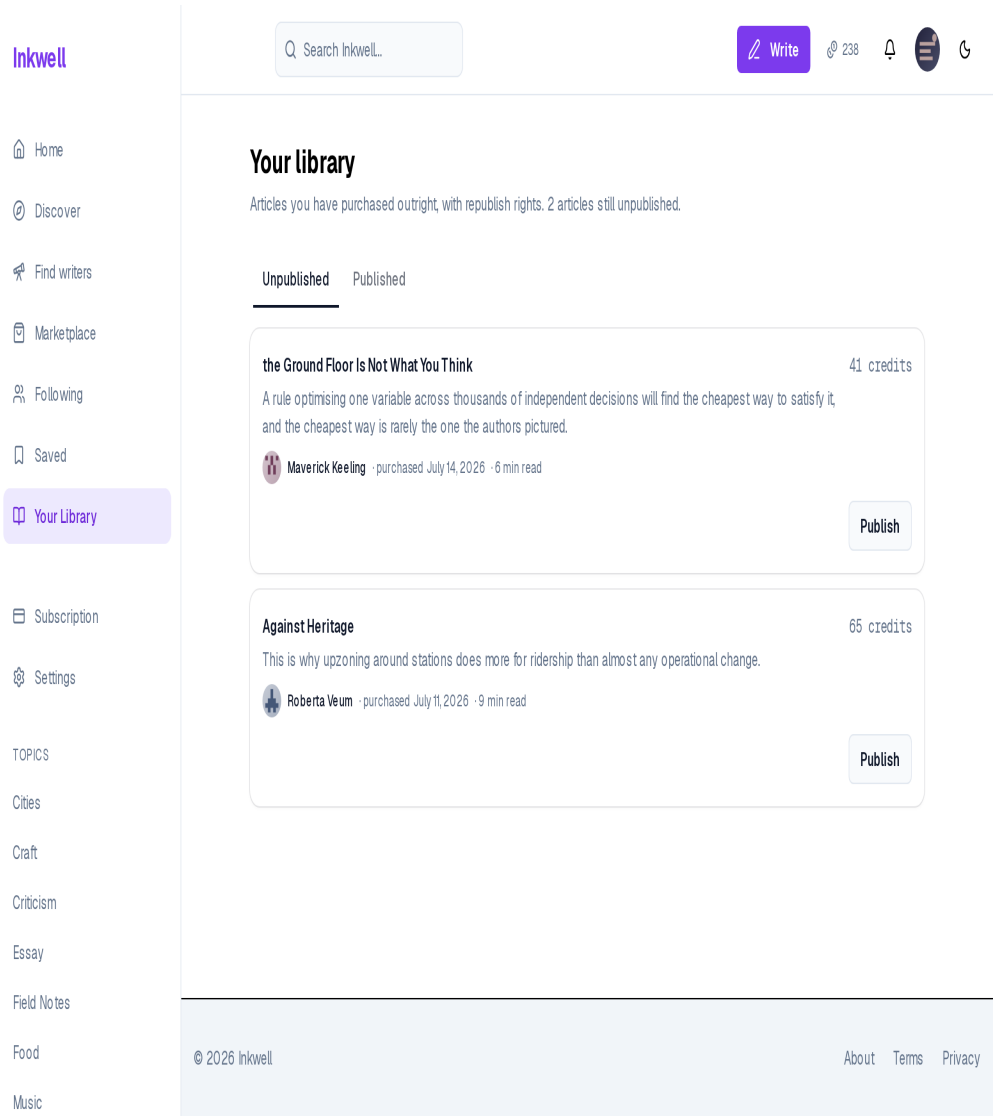


Figure 5.14 – The magazine's library: unpublished and published

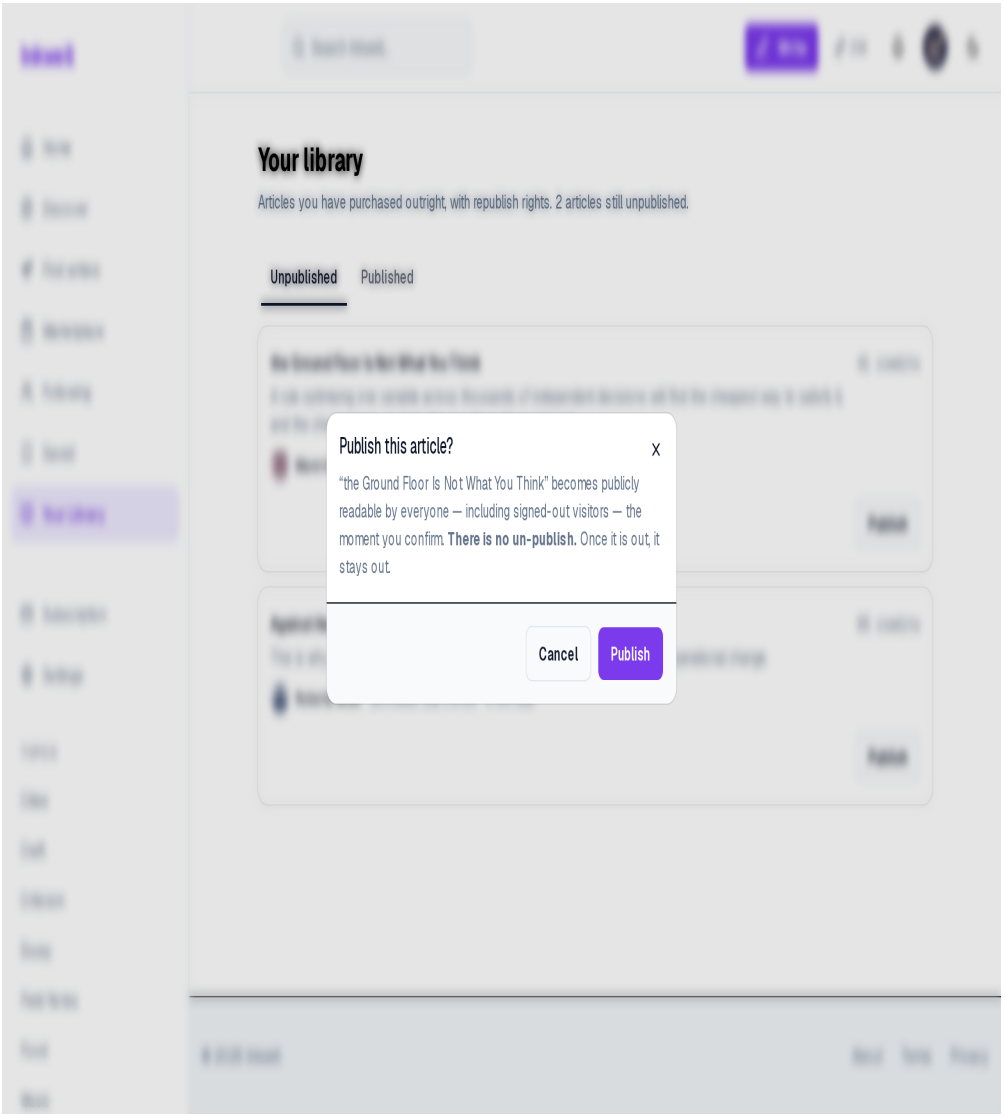


Figure 5.15 – Publishing a purchased article under the magazine's masthead

The library separates what is owned but unpublished from what has been published, with the price paid and the purchase date of each article, and offers *Publish* only on the first tab (FR-50, FR-74). Publishing is confirmed separately (FR-73): buying and publishing are two decisions, as Table 5.2 requires.

Once published, the article becomes public. Figure 5.16 shows it, and Figure 5.17 the magazine's public profile.

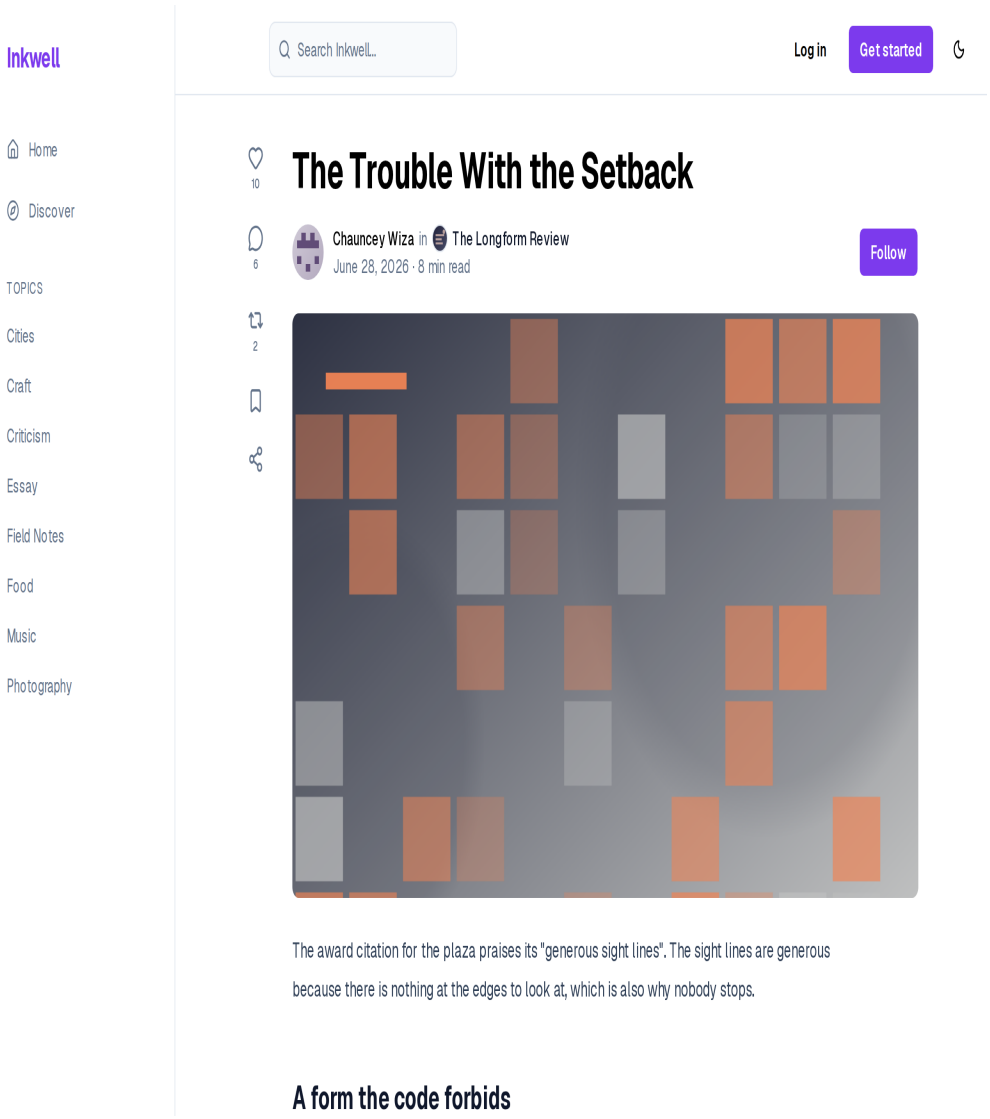


Figure 5.16 – A licensed article naming both the writer and the magazine

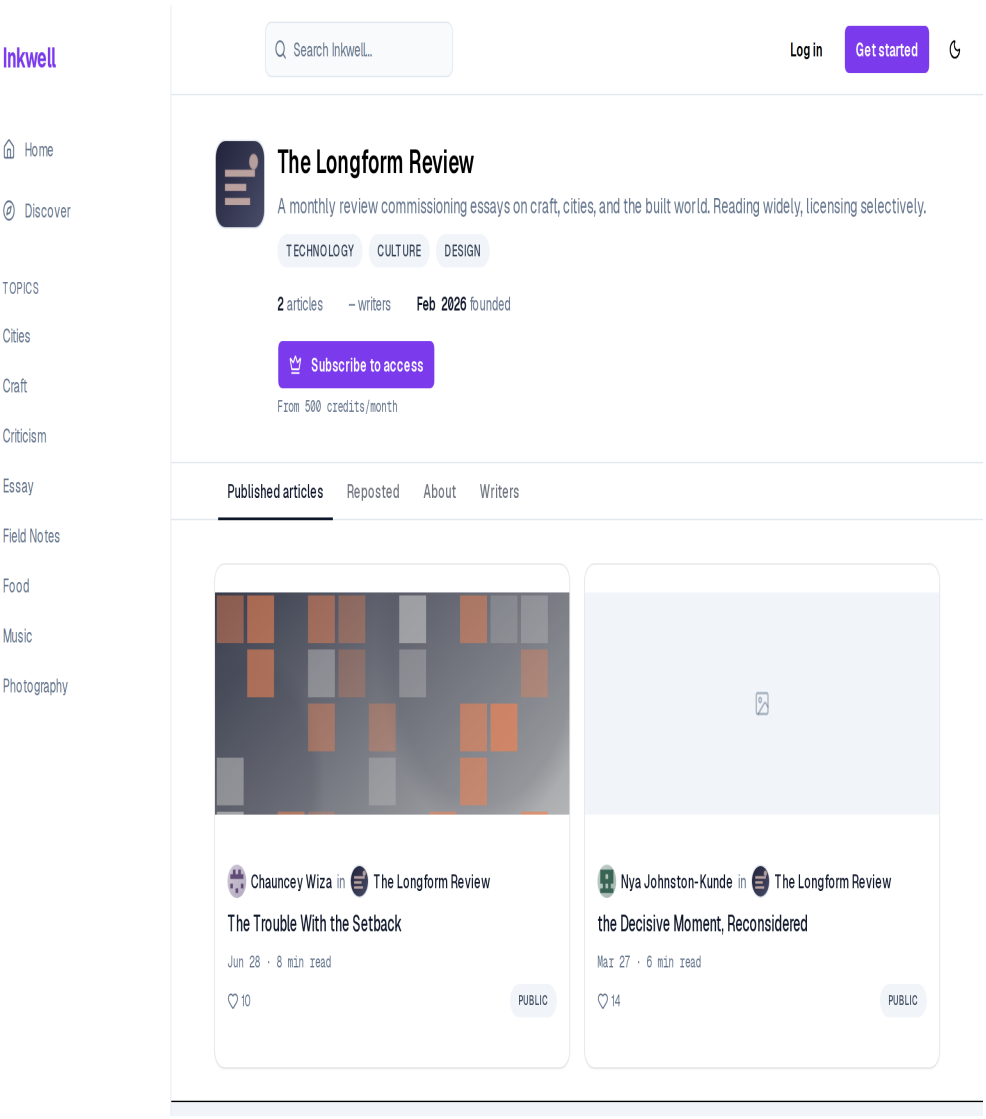


Figure 5.17 – A magazine's public profile and its published articles

The licensed article names both the writer and the publishing magazine, each linking to its profile (FR-76), and the magazine's profile lists the articles it has published (FR-75). These two requirements are attributed to Sprint 5 because a licensed article exists only from this sprint on: the licence buys the magazine a shelf, not just a file.

The writer sees the other side of the same transactions. Figure 5.18 shows the earnings and Figure 5.19 a sold article.

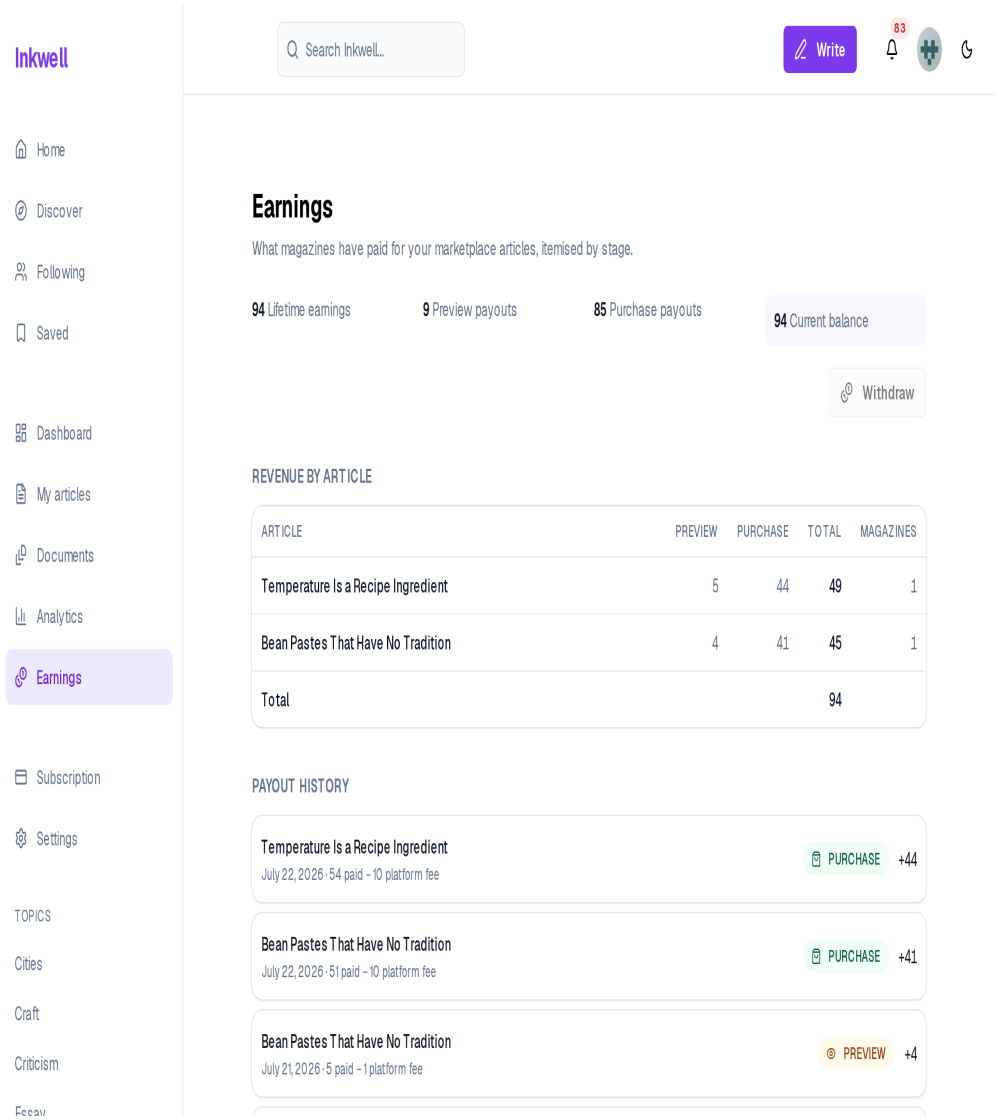


Figure 5.18 – A writer's earnings, itemised by preview and purchase

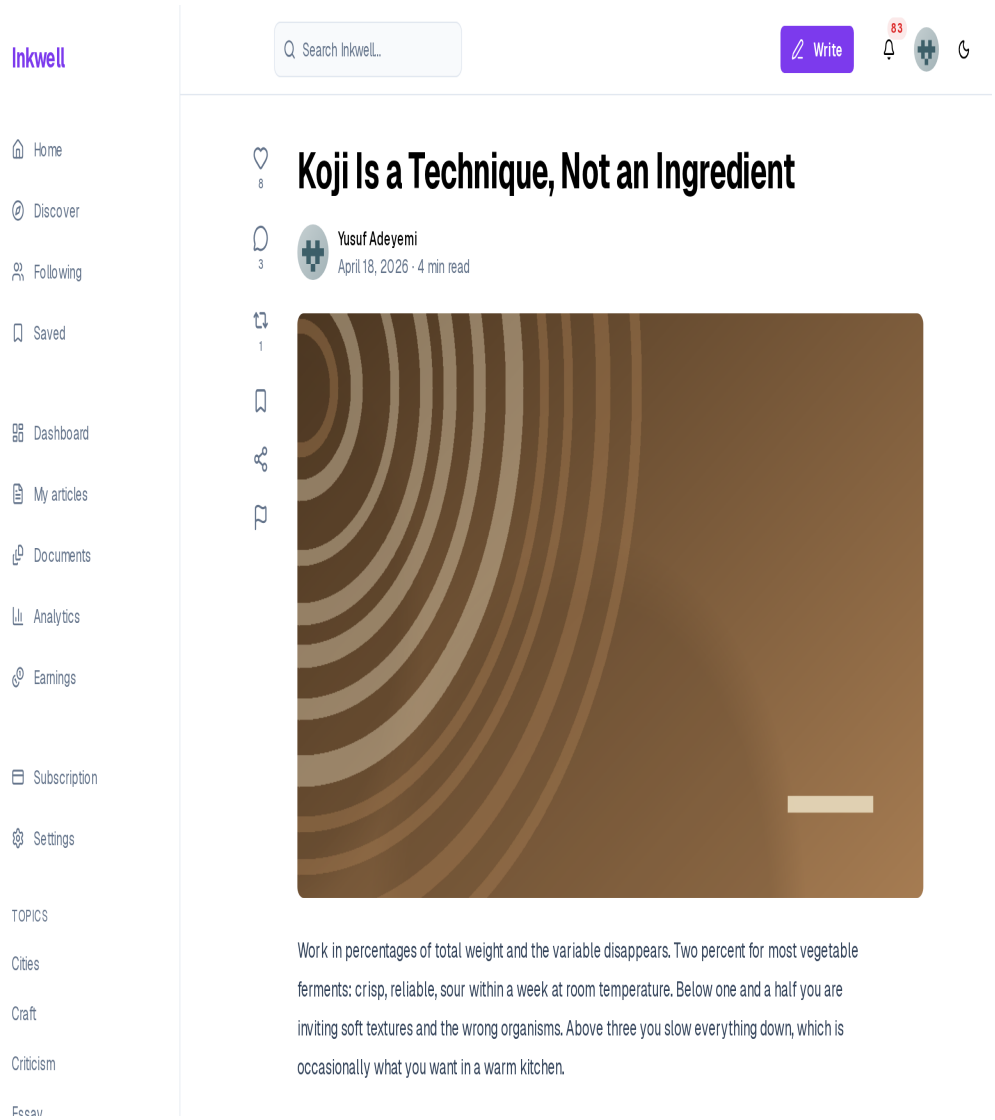


Figure 5.19 – A sold article, as its author sees it

Earnings are itemised by article and by stage, and each line of the payout history shows what the magazine paid and the platform fee: for a purchase, 54 credits paid, 10 credits of fee — 20% rounded down — and 44 credits to the writer (FR-37). The arithmetic of Table 5.2 is therefore visible to the writer, line by line, which is the trust US-42 asks for. A sold article tells its author who owns it, and can no longer be withdrawn or deleted (FR-72), as the lifecycle of Figure 5.7 requires.

The administrator closes the sprint. Figure 5.20 shows a manual eligibility grant, Figure 5.21 user management and Figure 5.22 the report queue.

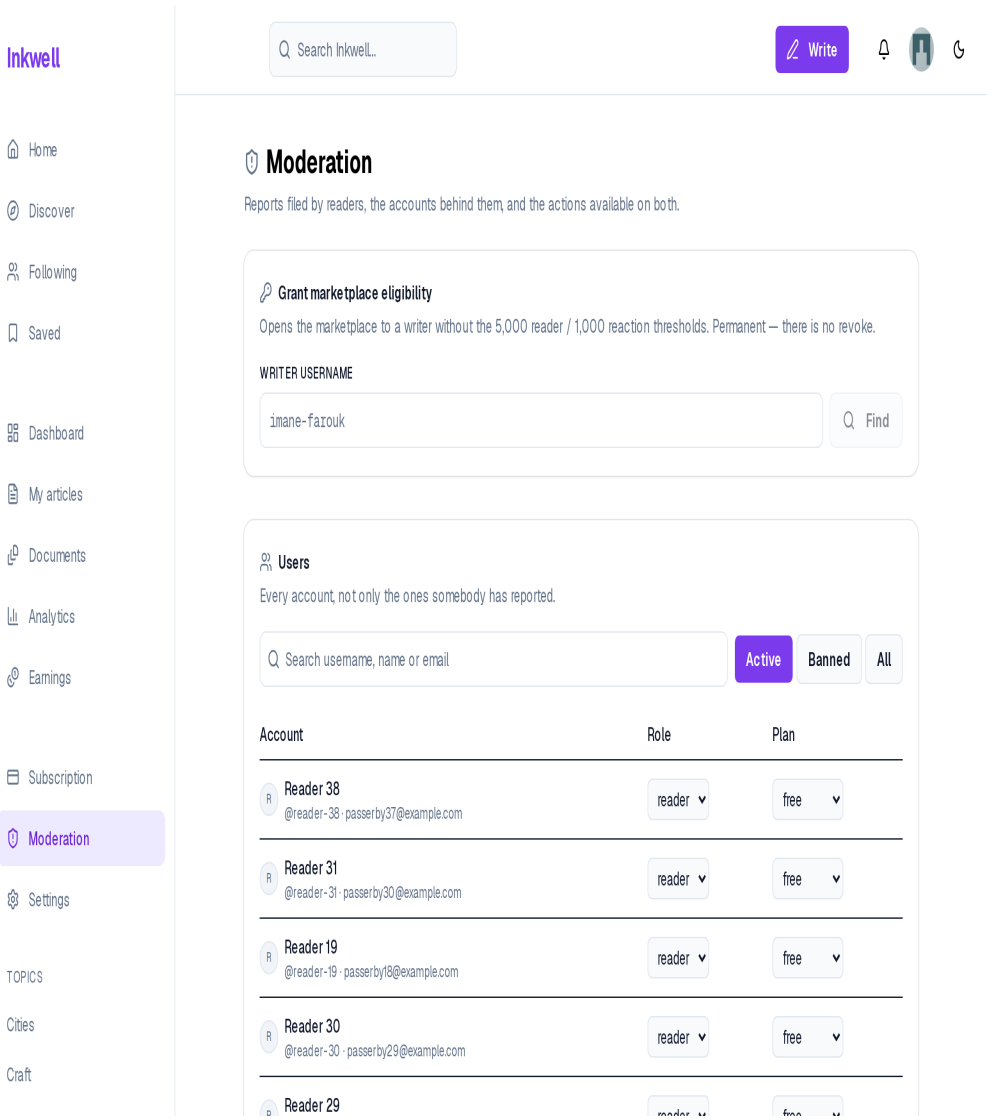


Figure 5.20 – Administration: manual eligibility grant

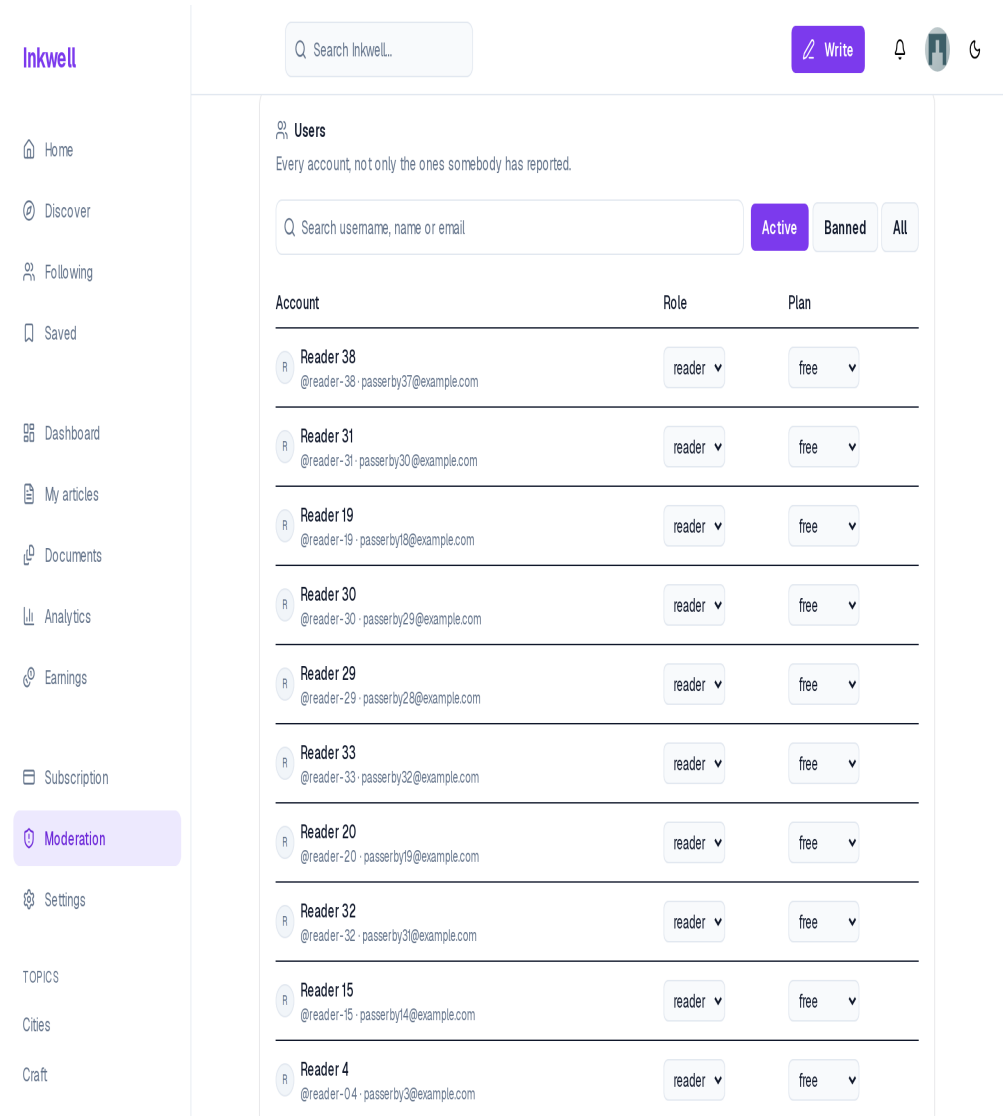


Figure 5.21 – Administration: user management

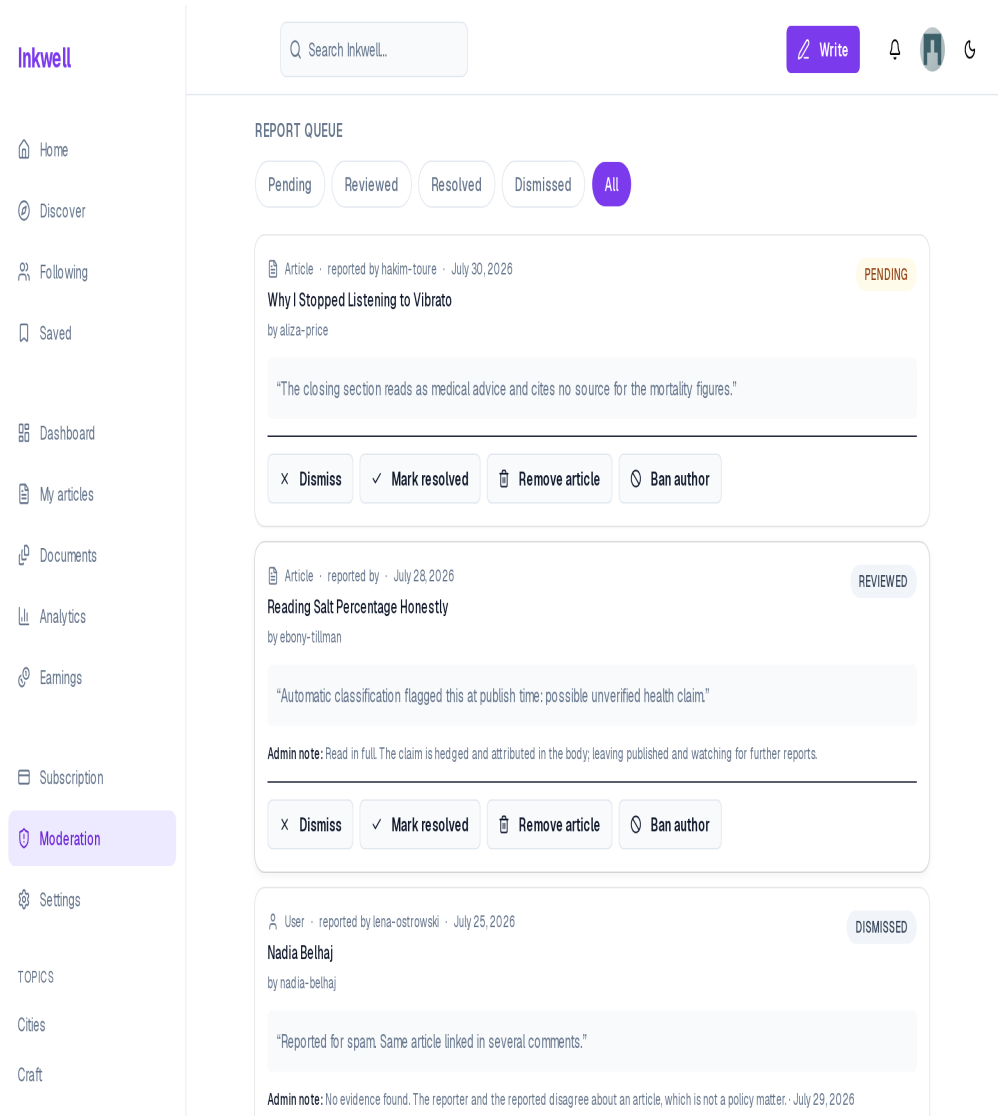


Figure 5.22 – Administration: the report queue

The grant records who made a writer eligible (FR-55); the user table searches and filters accounts and edits a plan (FR-53, FR-54); the report queue lists reports by status with the four actions of Figure 5.5 — dismiss, mark resolved, remove the article, ban the author (FR-51, FR-52). The second report of Figure 5.22 has no reporter: it was filed by the classifier at publish time (FR-57), and the administrator's note records why the article stayed published — the human decision the design reserves for a person.

5.2 Sprint 6 — Tests, demonstration and deployment

5.2.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 6 is to prove the business rules with tests, to make the product demonstrable on a realistic corpus, and to make it deployable with one command and an automated pipeline. Table 5.3 lists the stories.

Table 5.3 – Sprint 6 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-52	Apply migrations automatically before the application starts	Must	5
US-53	Seed a believable corpus	Must	5

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-54	Lower the eligibility thresholds under a flag	Must	2
US-55	Serve the product at a public URL over TLS	Must	8
	4 stories		**20**

The sprint commits only 20 points because its main work is not expressed as user stories: writing the tests that prove the rules of Sprint 5 adds no story, but it is what the definition of done of the previous sprints relies on. The sprint is technical on purpose. Placed after the marketplace and before the last release, it consolidates the rules that move money before more features are built on top of them.

5.2.2 Analysis

A technical sprint has no new actor-facing use case; its analysis states what must be verified and what must be deployable. Three needs follow from the previous sprints.

- **Proof of the money rules.** The ledger, the prices and the exclusivity of Sprint 5 must be shown correct by tests that fail when the code is wrong, not merely pass when it is right (NFR-06, NFR-19, NFR-20, NFR-31).
- **A demonstrable product.** A demonstration needs readers, writers above and below the eligibility thresholds, magazines with and without a subscription, purchases and history — none of which an empty database has (US-53, US-54).
- **A deployable stack.** The services must start in the right order, the schema must be migrated before the application, and the product must be reachable over TLS (NFR-21, US-52, US-55).

5.2.3 Design

Test strategy. Figure 5.23 shows the strategy.

The base is the **unit and service tests** of the backend, which run against a real PostgreSQL database rather than mocks, so that constraints, transactions and row locks are exercised for real; each test runs in a transaction that is rolled back. Above them, **integration tests** go through the API — authentication, publishing, purchasing — and verify the ledger afterwards. At the top, **end-to-end tests** drive a real browser over a seeded corpus. Two families protect the money: the **ledger invariant harness**, whose tests are mostly negative — a fixture builds a coherent purchase, corrupts one column and checks that the right invariant fires — and a **price sweep** that checks every price from 1 to 300 credits, both stages and both splits, reconciling exactly. The figure shows the choice behind the strategy: the database is never mocked, because the guarantees under test — a unique constraint, a row lock, a rollback — live in the database.

Deployment. The deployment follows the physical architecture of Figure 2.3 and the pipeline of Figure 2.4: multi-stage images for the API and worker (one image, two entry points) and for the Next.js server in standalone mode; a production Compose file in which only nginx is published, with certificates from Let's Encrypt; a one-shot migration service that must succeed before the API and worker start; and health and readiness endpoints checked by Compose and by the deployment workflow.

5.2.4 Realisation

Test results. Table 5.4 gives the state of the test suites at the end of the project.

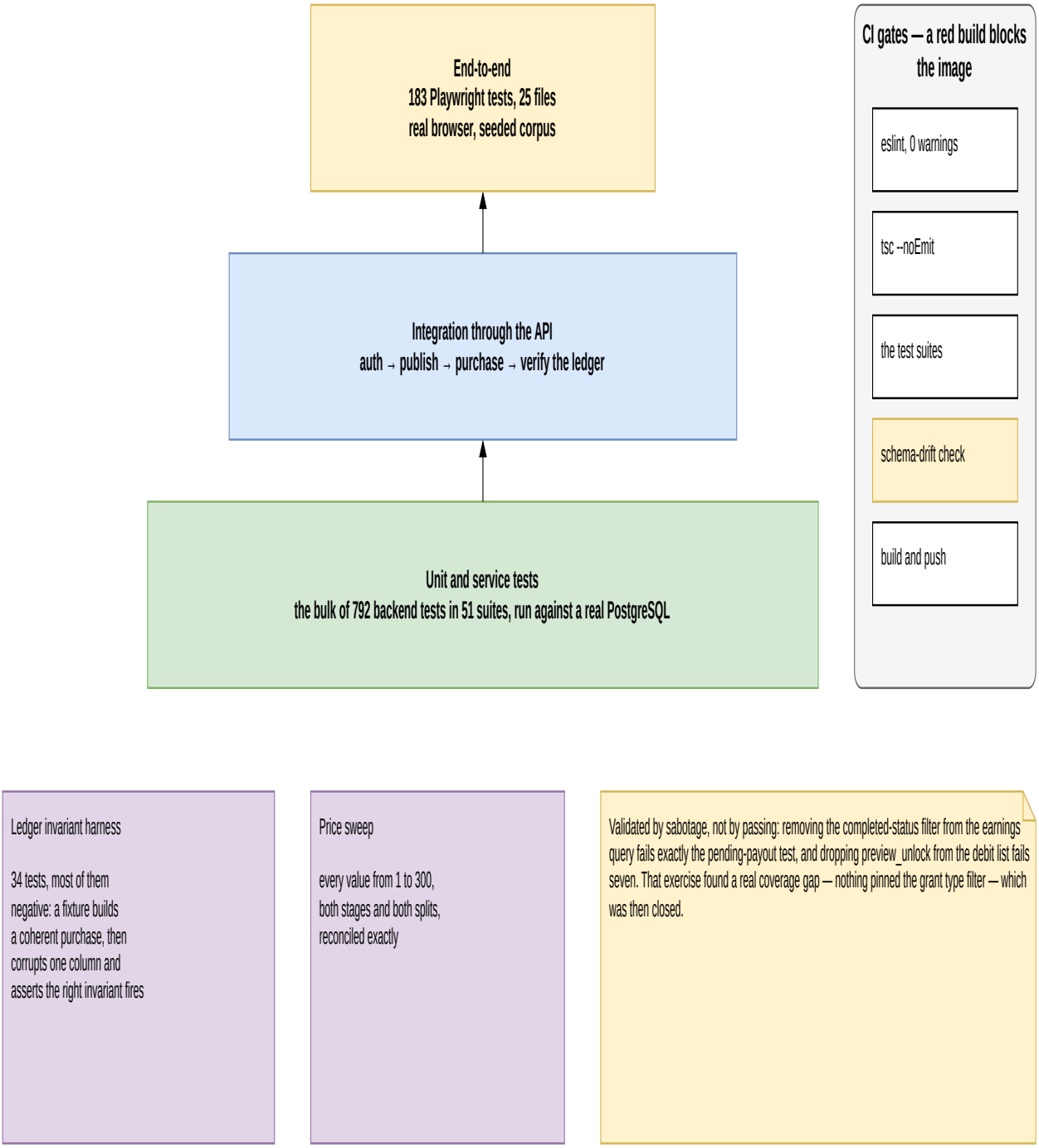


Figure 5.23 – Test strategy

Table 5.4 – Test results

Suite	Scope	Result
Backend (Jest)	52 suites — services, controllers, ledger, purchases, documents, voice, AI pipeline	**796 tests, all passing**
Ledger invariant harness	balance and ledger invariants, seed ledger	34 tests, included above
Price sweep	prices 1–300, both stages, both splits	included above
Backend line coverage	statements executed by the suite	48.5% of lines, 40.6% of branches
End-to-end (Playwright)	25 spec files over the seeded corpus	183 tests, outside the CI gate
Static gates	`tsc --noEmit` and `eslint --max-warnings=0`, both repositories	pass

The 796 tests are not spread evenly, and the coverage per module shows where they are. The moderation module is covered at 92% of its lines, the purchases at 77%, the shared utilities at 73% and the data layer — where the ledger checks live — at 67%: the code that moves money or removes content is the most tested, as the strategy intended. The AI module (21%), authentication (28%) and the analytics aggregation (0%) are the least covered: their logic is largely SQL and provider calls, verified by the end-to-end suite and by the measurements of Chapter 7 rather than by unit tests. Line coverage of 48.5% overall is therefore not a uniform level of confidence but a concentrated one, and extending it to the aggregation queries is the first improvement listed in the conclusion. The harness was itself validated by sabotage: removing a filter from the earnings query or a stage from the debit list fails exactly the tests that should fail, an exercise that found one coverage gap, which was then closed.

Demonstration corpus. A seed command builds a believable dataset in seconds and can rebuild it from scratch: its full preset creates **100 writers and 989 articles**, **50 magazines** (30 with a live subscription), **150 readers**, 110 marketplace listings with real purchases and ledger rows, and more than 15,000 likes, 2,700 reposts and 8,000 comments, with generated cover art and avatars. A fixed cast of named accounts makes every demonstration path reproducible, and a flag lowers the eligibility thresholds so that the gate can be crossed live (US-54). Every seeded date can be bounded below, so the corpus never predates the platform. The same corpus is the one evaluated in Chapter 7.

Deployment. The production stack builds, migrates and starts with one command, and its pipeline runs from a push to a running service (US-52). The domain `inkwell-ai.me` is registered, but no server was provisioned during the project, so the product is not yet reachable at a public address: **US-55 is only partly delivered** — its configuration, TLS setup and pipeline are done, its hosting is not — and its 8 points are not counted as delivered in the velocity of Section 7.7.

Conclusion

Release 3 delivered the marketplace end to end — subscriptions and credits, the eligibility gate, the exclusive two-stage purchase, the magazine's own publication and the writer's itemised earnings, all on a ledger whose invariants are tested after every operation — together with moderation, a test suite of 796 backend tests concentrated on the rules that move money, a demonstration corpus and a production-ready stack whose public hosting remains to be done. The last release deepens the social layer and reworks the assistant.

CHAPTER 6

Release 4: social depth, the reworked assistant and documents

Introduction

The last release deepens what the platform already did. Sprint 7 completes the social layer with comment likes, follower lists, blocking, saving and sharing. Sprint 8 reworks the assistant: it now decides on each request whether to answer or to write into the document, shows its real pipeline as it runs, and accepts and speaks voice; the feed card becomes interactive. Sprint 9 gives the writer a private library of reference documents that the assistant can draw on and cite by page.

6.1 Sprint 7 — Comment likes, lists, block, save and share

6.1.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 7 is that readers like comments, browse and act on follower lists, block accounts, keep articles for later and share them outside the platform. Table 6.1 lists the stories.

Table 6.1 – Sprint 7 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-56	Block an account	Must	5
US-57	Save an article to come back to it later	Must	5
US-58	Pass an article on to people outside the platform	Should	3
US-73	Like a comment	Must	2
US-74	Browse who follows an account and whom it follows, and follow from the list	Must	3
	5 stories		**18**

The sprint commits 18 points, a light load: its five stories reuse the interaction model of Sprint 3 — each is a new many-to-many association with a notification — so they were small to estimate and to build. The sprint was kept light deliberately, as the start of the release that runs alongside the writing of this report.

6.1.2 Analysis

Figure 6.1 gives the use cases of Sprint 7.

Sharing and the follower lists need no account; following from a list extends viewing it. Liking a comment and saving an article include notifying the recipient. A block hides the two accounts from each other — profiles, articles and comments — and the only place to lift it is the blocker's settings. Saves are private: the author is notified, but nobody else can see what a reader keeps. The diagram shows the difference between the two new kinds of relationship: liking, following and sharing are public signals, while saving and blocking are private choices that only their author can see.

6.1.3 Design

Figure 6.2 shows the three new associations and the notification types they emit.

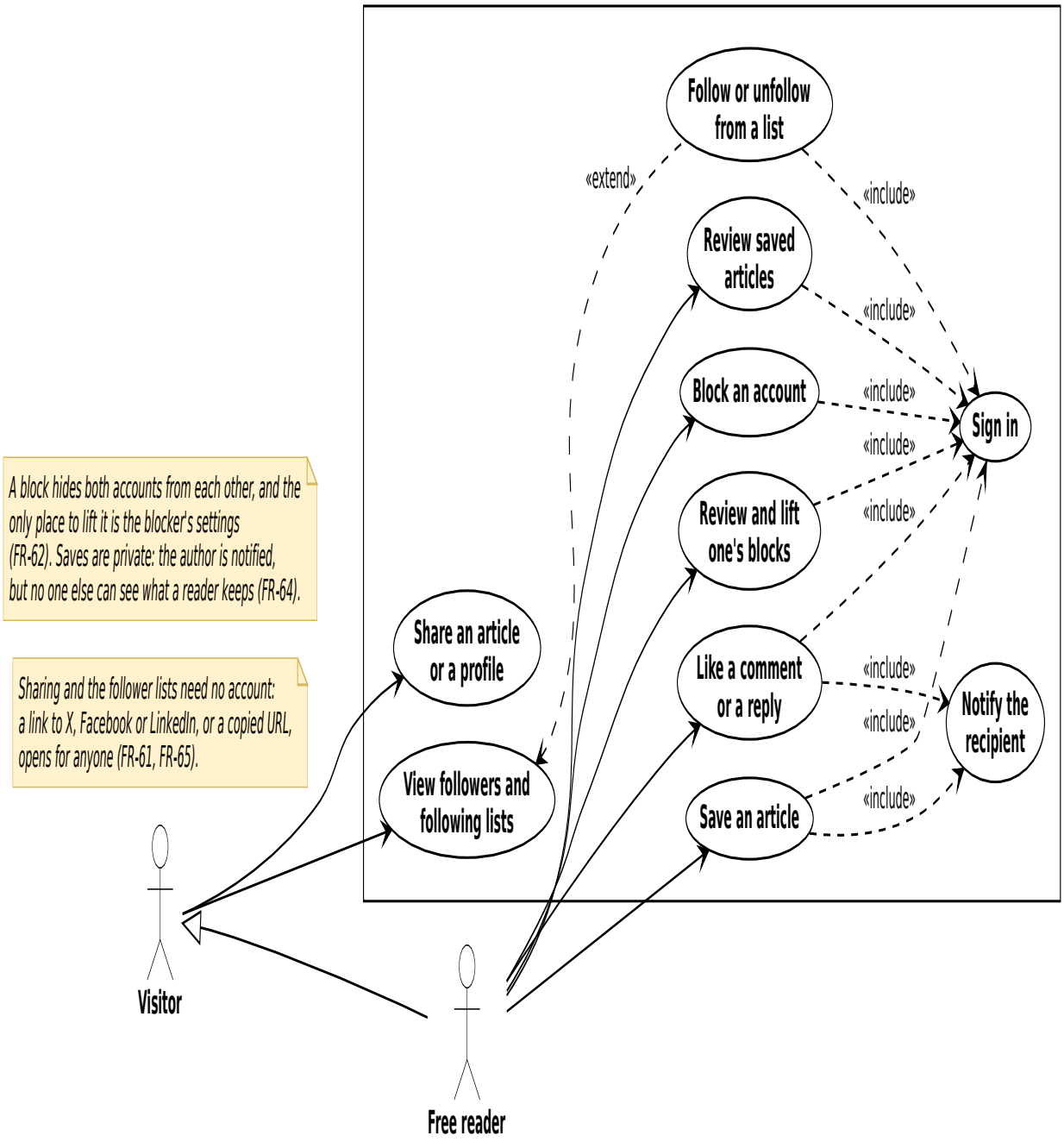


Figure 6.1 – Use case diagram, Sprint 7

Comment likes, blocks and saves are many-to-many associations, each stored as a join table with a unique constraint on its pair, so a repeated request is a no-op, and a notification is emitted only when a row was actually inserted; a check constraint forbids blocking oneself. A block row is directional, but every read treats it both ways. Comment likes are kept apart from article likes, so that by construction they can never count towards a writer’s eligibility. The diagram shows that the sprint changed no existing class: the social layer grew by association only, which is why it could be added at the end without reopening the marketplace rules.

6.1.4 Realisation

Figure 6.3 shows the Saved shelf of a reader.

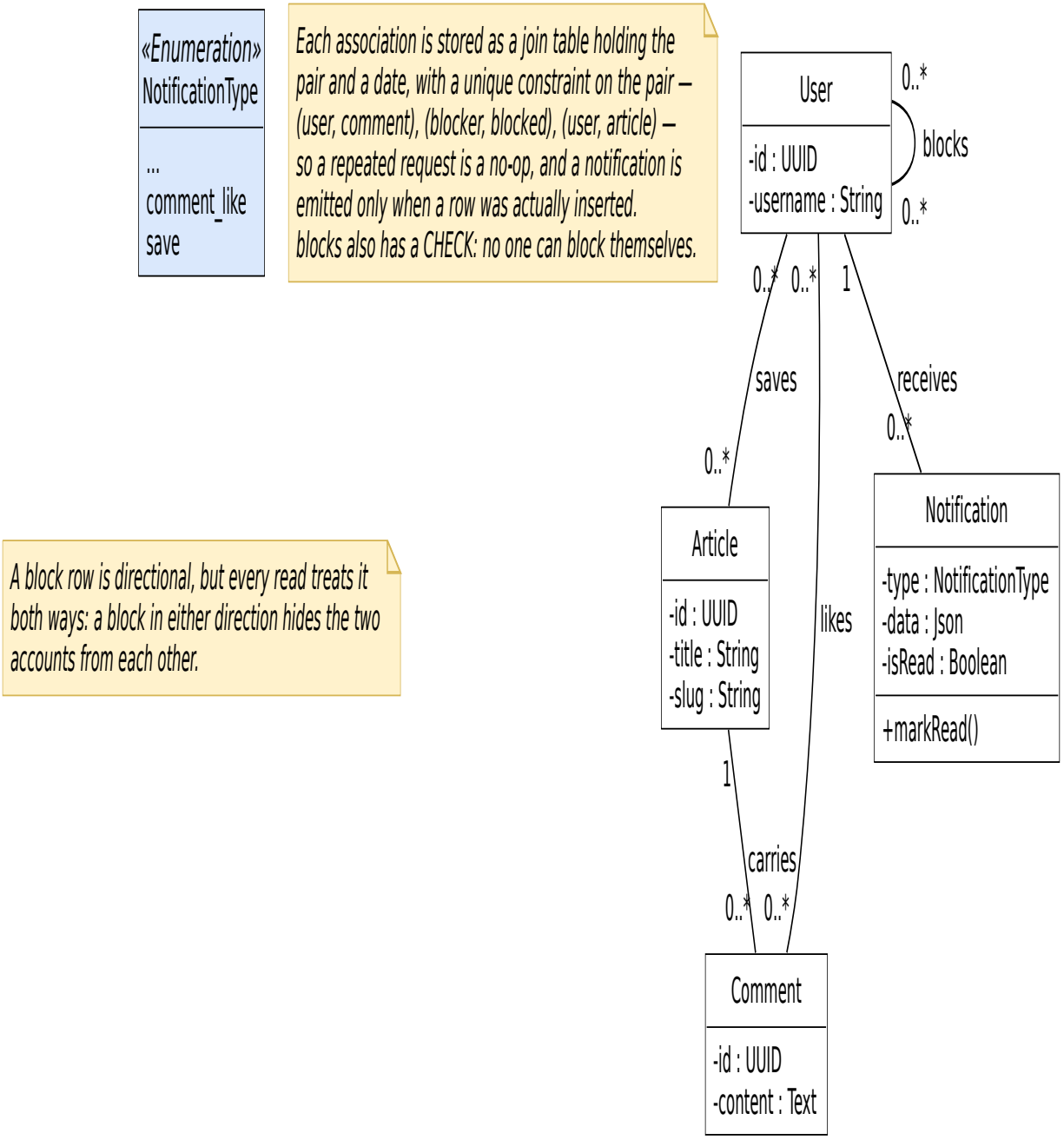
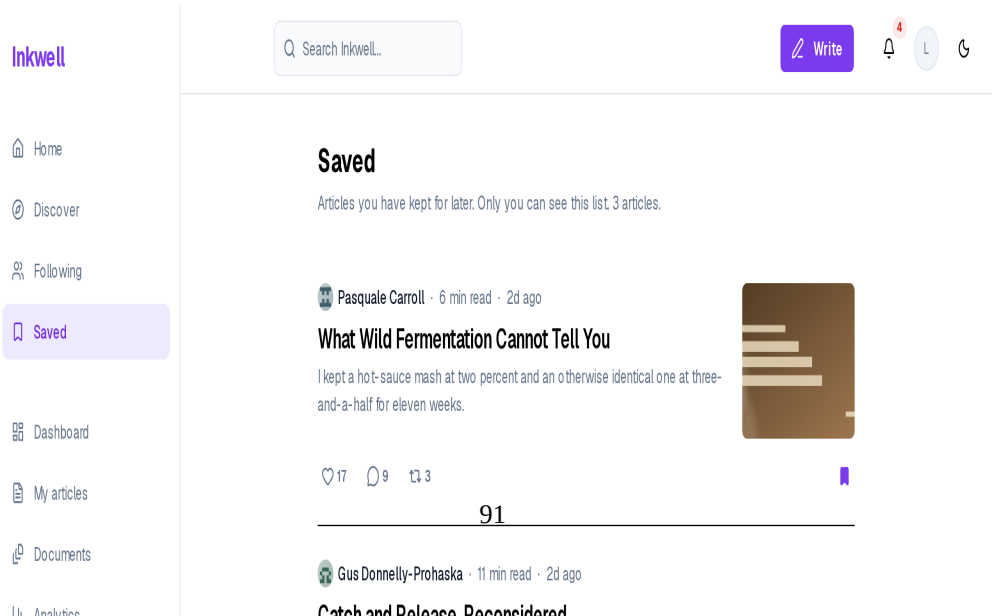


Figure 6.2 – Class diagram, Sprint 7



The page states that only the reader can see the list, and every card keeps its controls, with the save marker filled (FR-63, FR-64). A saved article stays one click away from the sidebar, which is what US-57 asks.

Figure 6.4 shows the blocked accounts in settings.

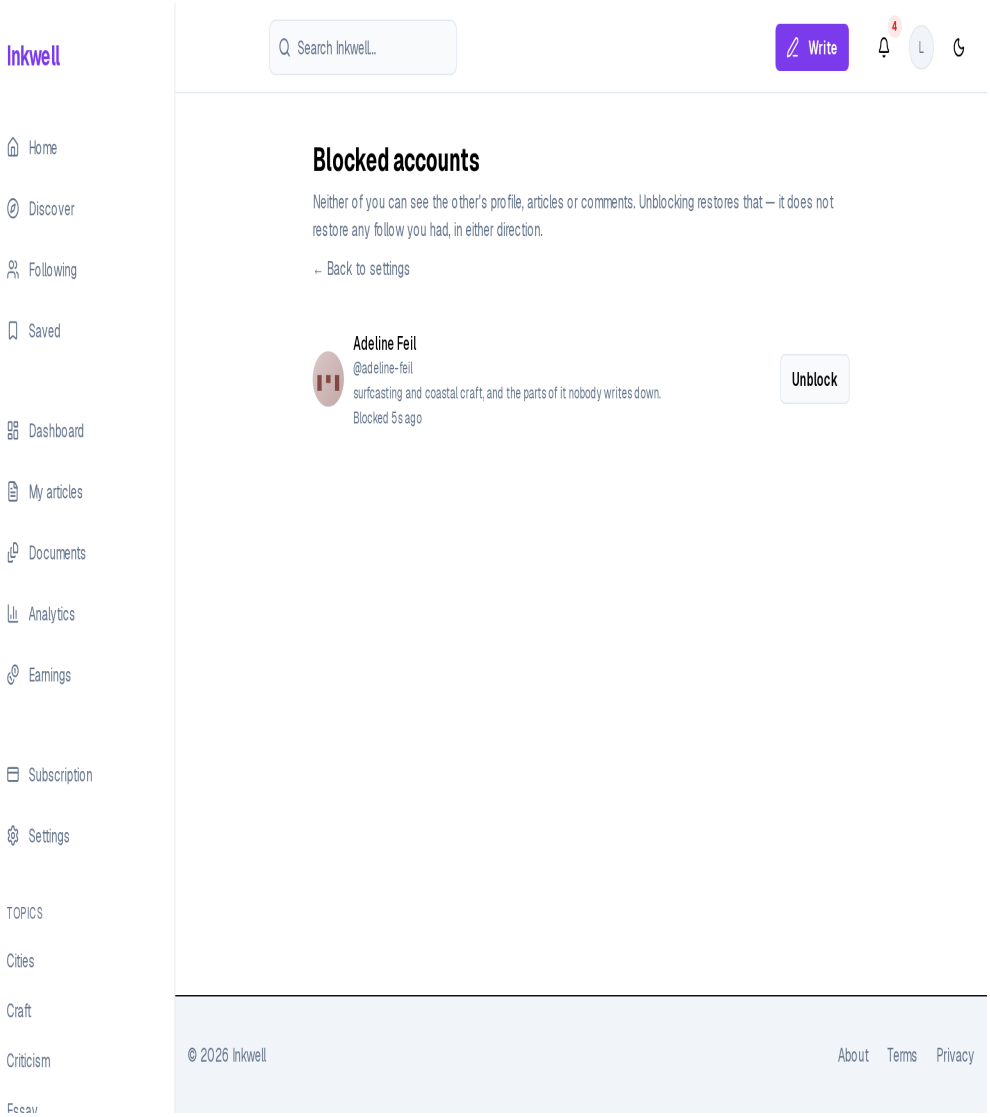


Figure 6.4 – Blocked accounts, in settings

Blocks are listed in one place, each with *Unblock* (FR-62), under a sentence that states the rule: neither account sees the other's profile, articles or comments, and unblocking does not restore a previous follow. Putting the list in settings rather than on profiles follows from the analysis: a block is a private decision, so it is reviewed privately.

Figure 6.5 shows the feed restricted to followed accounts, and Figure 6.6 a follower list being searched.

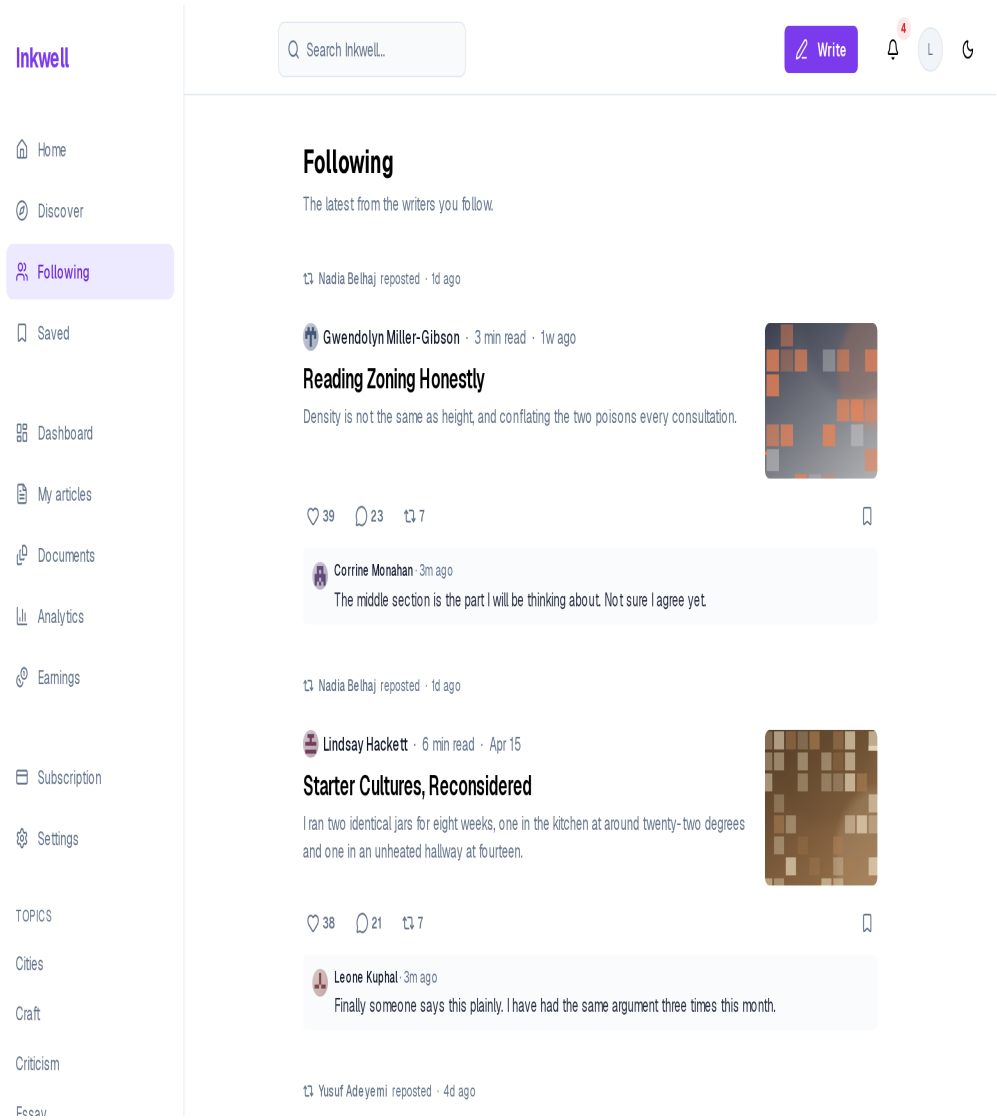


Figure 6.5 – The following feed

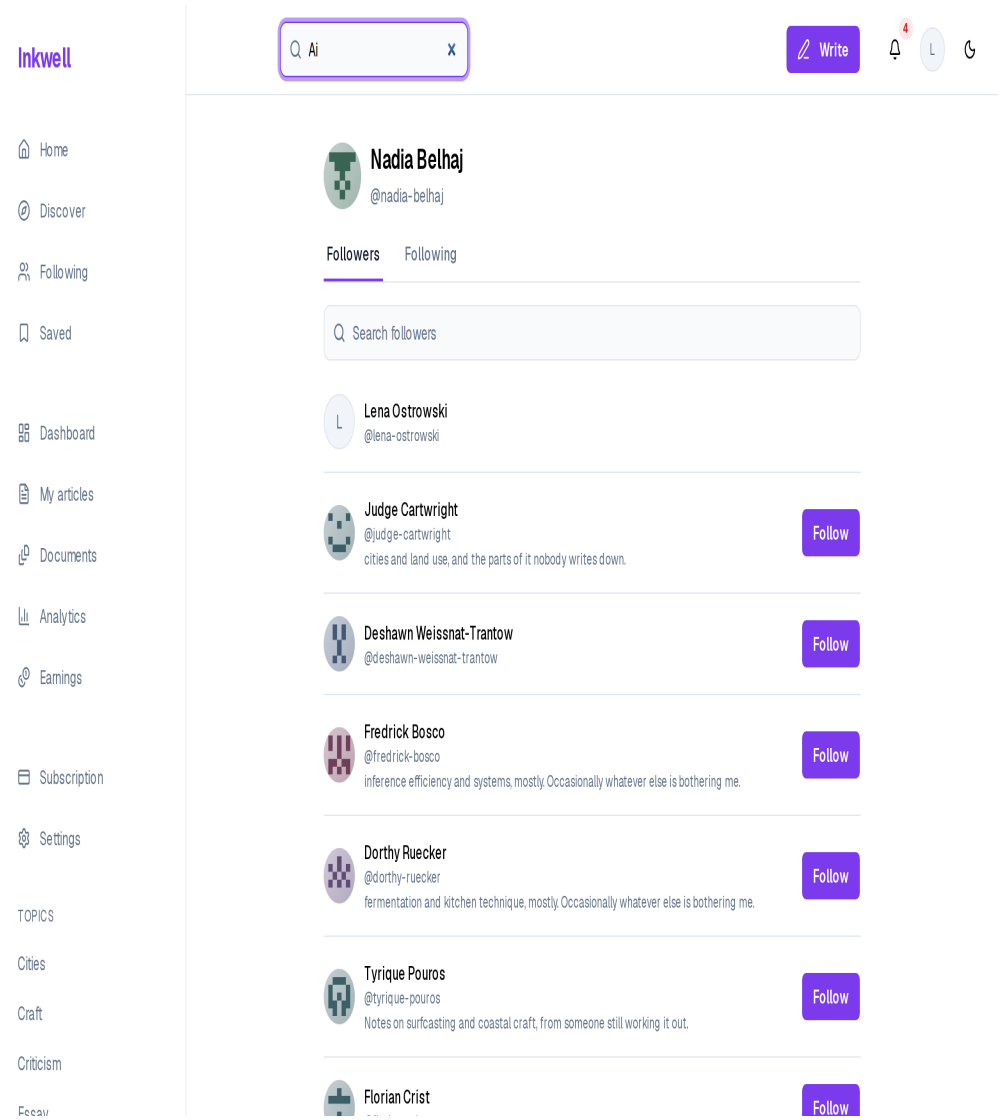


Figure 6.6 – A follower list, searched

The following feed shows only the writers a reader follows, and the follower lists can be browsed, searched and acted on — following back from the list itself (FR-61). Both turn the follow relationship of Sprint 3 into a way to discover people through people.

6.2 Sprint 8 — Live cards, the assistant that writes, and voice

6.2.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 8 is that readers react, repost and comment from the feed card, see recent comments and preview any byline; and that the assistant decides whether to answer or to write into the document, writes into a protected range the writer keeps or discards, shows its steps as they run, sits in a panel docked beside the editor, accepts dictated prompts and reads its replies aloud. Table 6.2 lists the stories.

Table 6.2 – Sprint 8 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Prior-ity	Points
US-59	React to an article from the feed	Must	5
US-60	See what an account has reposted	Should	3

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-61	Reply in the moment from the feed	Could	3
US-62	Keep reading as I scroll	Must	5
US-65	See who a writer or magazine is from where their name appears	Should	3
US-66	Tell the assistant what to write and watch it appear in my draft, then keep or discard it	Must	8
US-67	See what the assistant is doing while it works — and minimize it without losing sight of that	Should	3
US-68	Say my request instead of typing it	Should	5
US-69	Hear the assistant's recap read out	Could	3
	9 stories		**38**

The sprint commits 38 points in two halves of similar size: the live feed card and its neighbours on one side, the reworked assistant and voice on the other. The largest story, US-66 (8 points), is the write into the document, which needed a new editor extension as well as a new kind of model call.

6.2.2 Analysis

Figure 6.7 gives the use cases of Sprint 8.

Briefing the assistant specialises into receiving an answer in the panel and having text written into the document, and includes following the live pipeline steps and consuming the allowance; keeping or discarding the written text includes the write. Dictating extends the brief and is billed; hearing the reply extends the answer. The choice between answering and writing is the assistant's, made per message; it supersedes the manual "insert the answer into the document" of Sprint 2 (FR-30, superseded by FR-78). The diagram shows the change of role: in Sprint 2 the writer copied text from a chat, in Sprint 8 the assistant writes where the writer works and the writer keeps or discards it.

6.2.3 Design

Sequence diagram — one assistant turn. Figure 6.8 shows a turn.

The request carries the conversation, the article and any selection. The system reads the draft, the writer's voice profile and — when documents are attached — passages from them, reporting each stage to the panel as it completes. A single routing call to the model then either answers in the panel, streamed as Markdown, or calls the `write_to_article` tool with a placement (at the cursor or over the selection) and a one-line brief; the model then adds a one-line recap. The tokens of both calls are settled once, at the end; a stopped turn still bills an estimate of what was produced. The diagram shows why the panel can show real steps rather than a spinner: each stage is a part of the response stream, sent as soon as it is done (FR-80).

Sequence diagram — writing into the document. Figure 6.9 shows the write.

The system retrieves passages from the writer's other published articles and streams the article text from a second model call. The panel opens a range in the editor at a block boundary — after the block holding the cursor, or over the selected blocks — tints it and refuses the writer's own edits inside it; each Markdown block is inserted as soon as it is complete, outside the undo history. When the stream ends, the writer keeps the text, which becomes one undo step, or discards it, which restores exactly what was there. The diagram shows the guarantee behind the design: opening the range at a block boundary is what makes the restoration exact, because every node the writer owns stays untouched.

Sequence diagram — voice. Figure 6.10 shows the voice round trip.

A recording of at most five minutes is sent with its length; the system checks the allowance, the format and

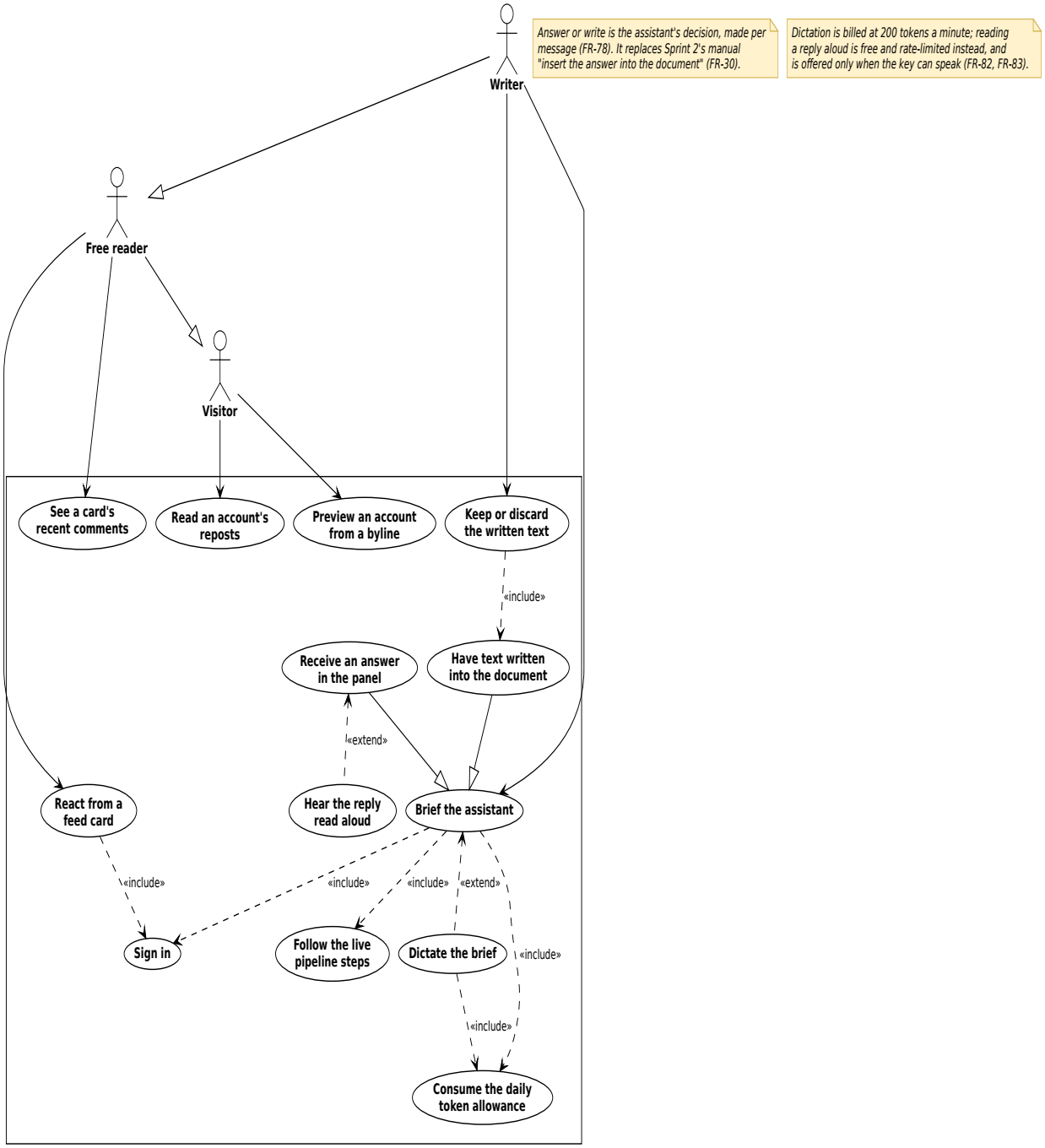


Figure 6.7 – Use case diagram, Sprint 8

the size, transcribes it with Whisper, settles the duration — the provider's when it reports one, otherwise the larger of the client's figure and a floor derived from the file size — and bills 200 tokens per started minute. The transcript lands in the composer, editable. Reading a reply aloud is free to the writer and limited per account instead, to 20 replies a minute and 300 a day. The diagram shows that the client's claim about duration is never trusted alone: the billing uses the larger of what the client says and what the file size proves.

6.2.4 Realisation

Figure 6.11 shows the Reposted tab of a profile.

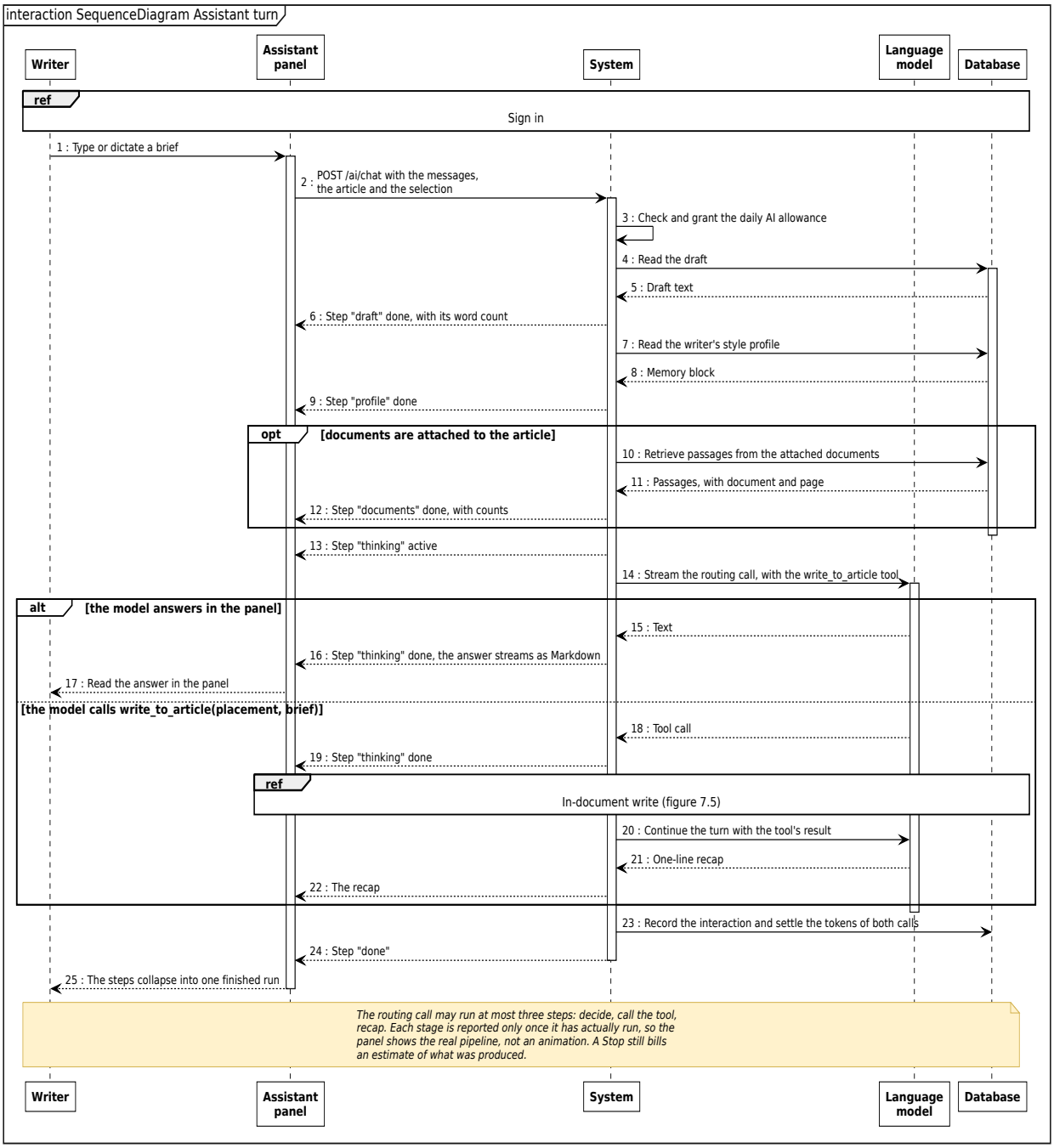
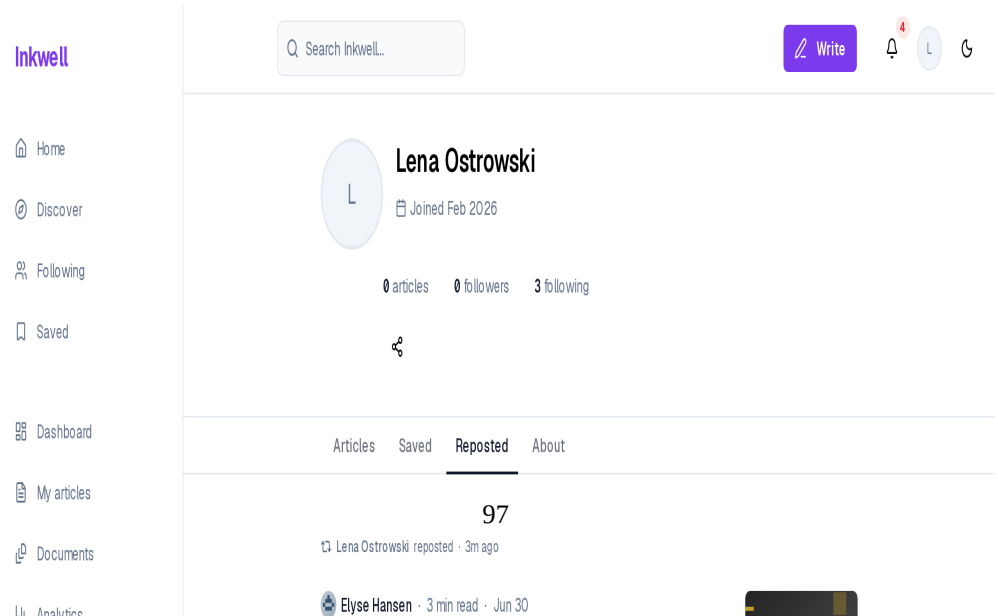


Figure 6.8 – Sequence diagram: one assistant turn



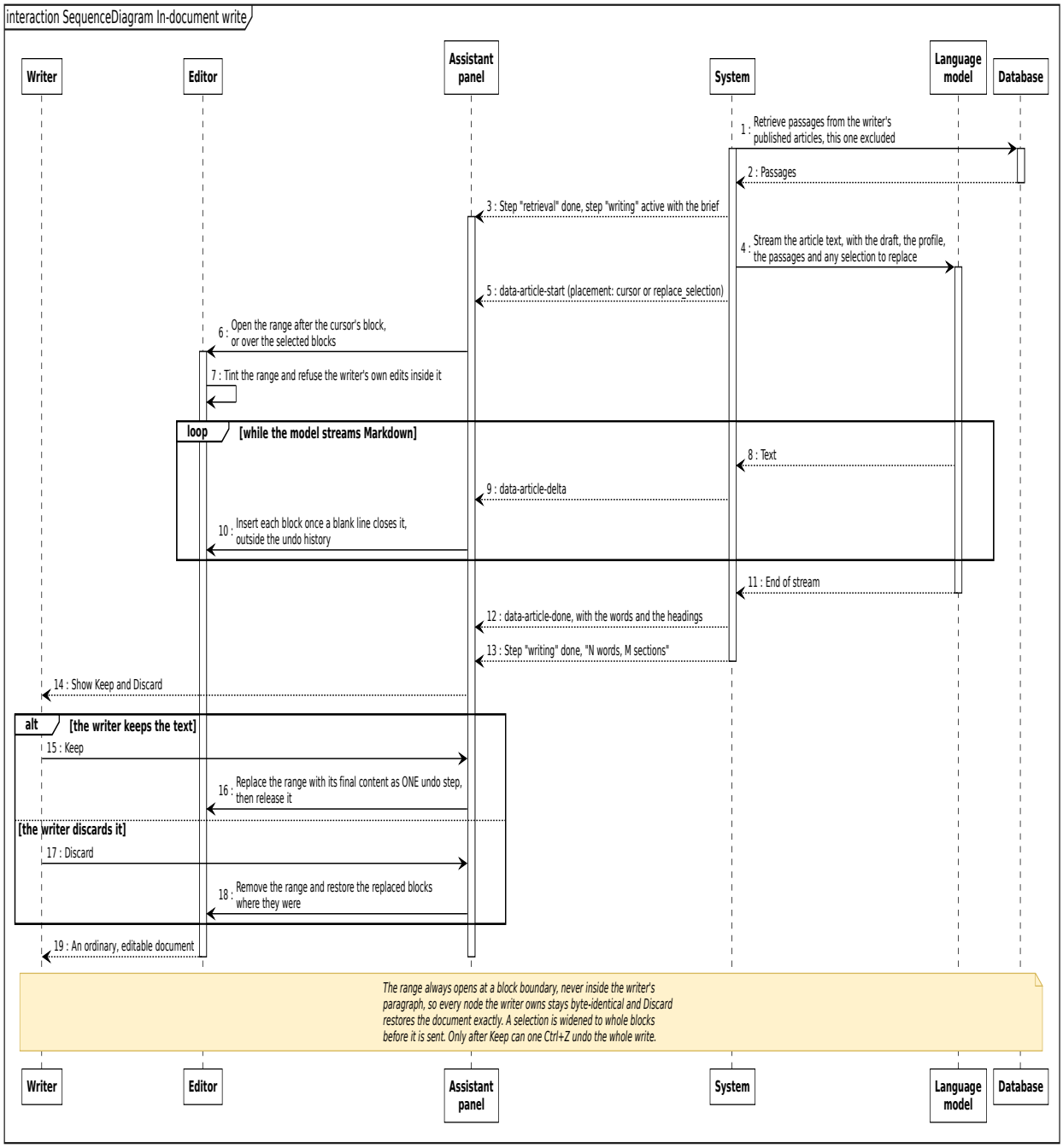


Figure 6.9 – Sequence diagram: writing into the document

Any account's reposts can be read from its profile, without an account (FR-67): what a person passes on is part of how others judge their taste.

Figure 6.12 shows a write awaiting the writer's decision.

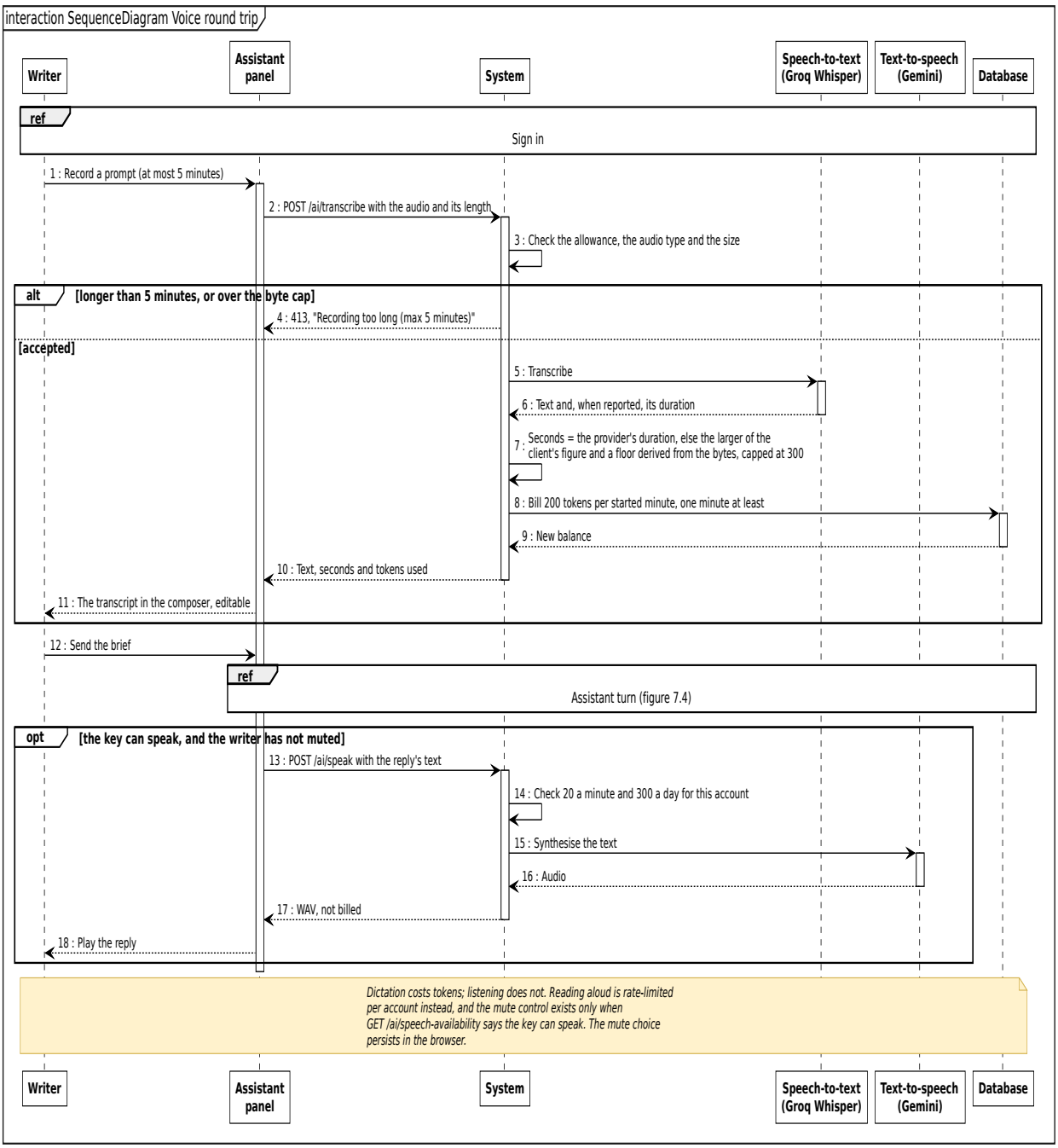
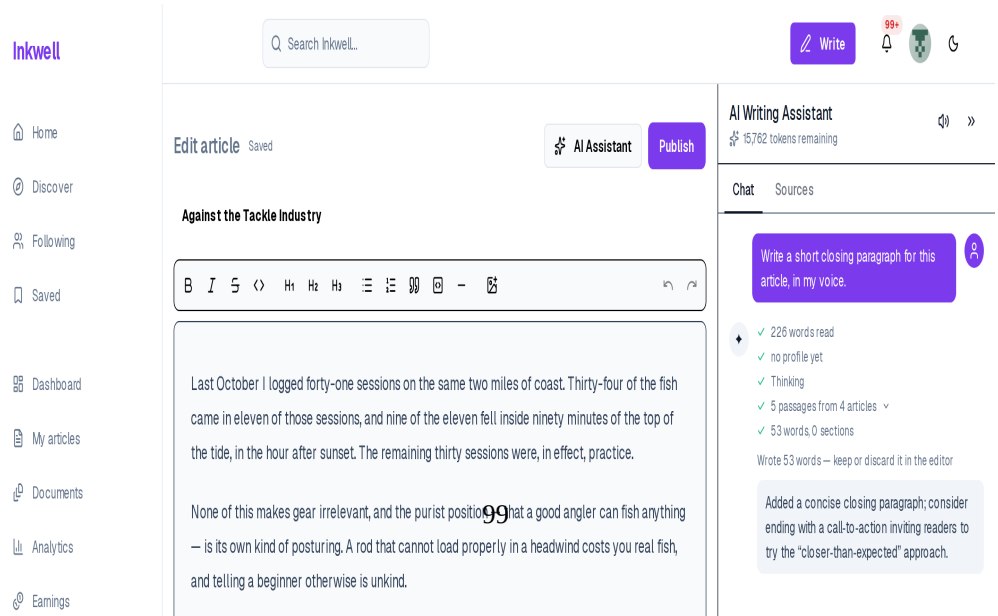


Figure 6.10 – Sequence diagram: the voice round trip



Asked for a closing paragraph “in my voice”, the assistant chose to write rather than answer (FR-78). The panel lists the real steps — words read, profile, thinking, five passages from four articles, the size of the write — and a one-line recap; in the editor, the new paragraph is tinted at the end of the draft with *Keep*, *Discard* and the reminder that Ctrl+Z undoes after keeping (FR-79, FR-80). While the decision is pending, the composer is disabled: the writer cannot start a second write over an undecided one.

Figure 6.13 shows the live step on the collapsed panel.

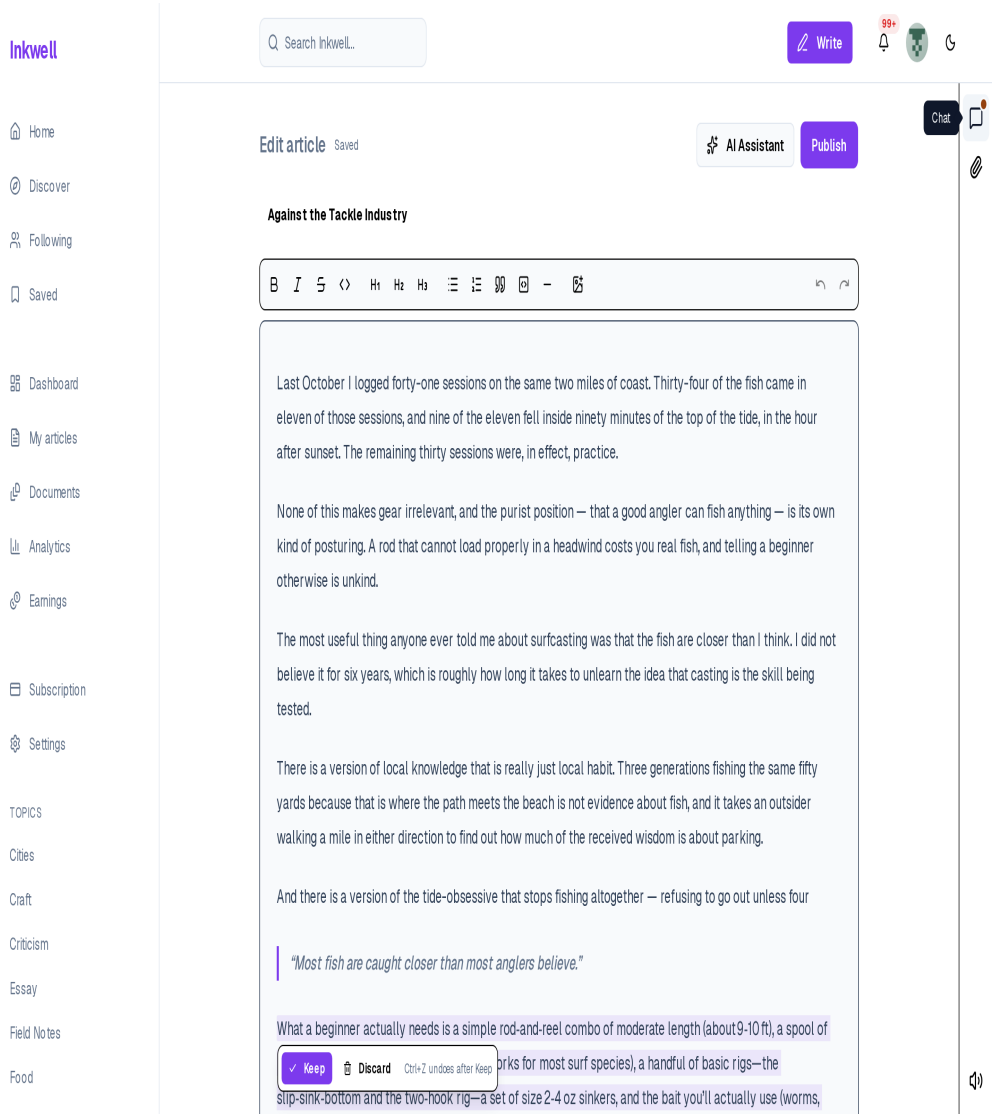


Figure 6.13 – The live step on the collapsed panel

With the panel collapsed to a rail, the editor takes the full width and a write still streams into the document; the rail keeps the chat, the sources and the voice controls one click away, and its marker signals activity (FR-81). A slow step is therefore never mistaken for a frozen screen, as US-67 requires.

Figure 6.14 shows a prompt being recorded.

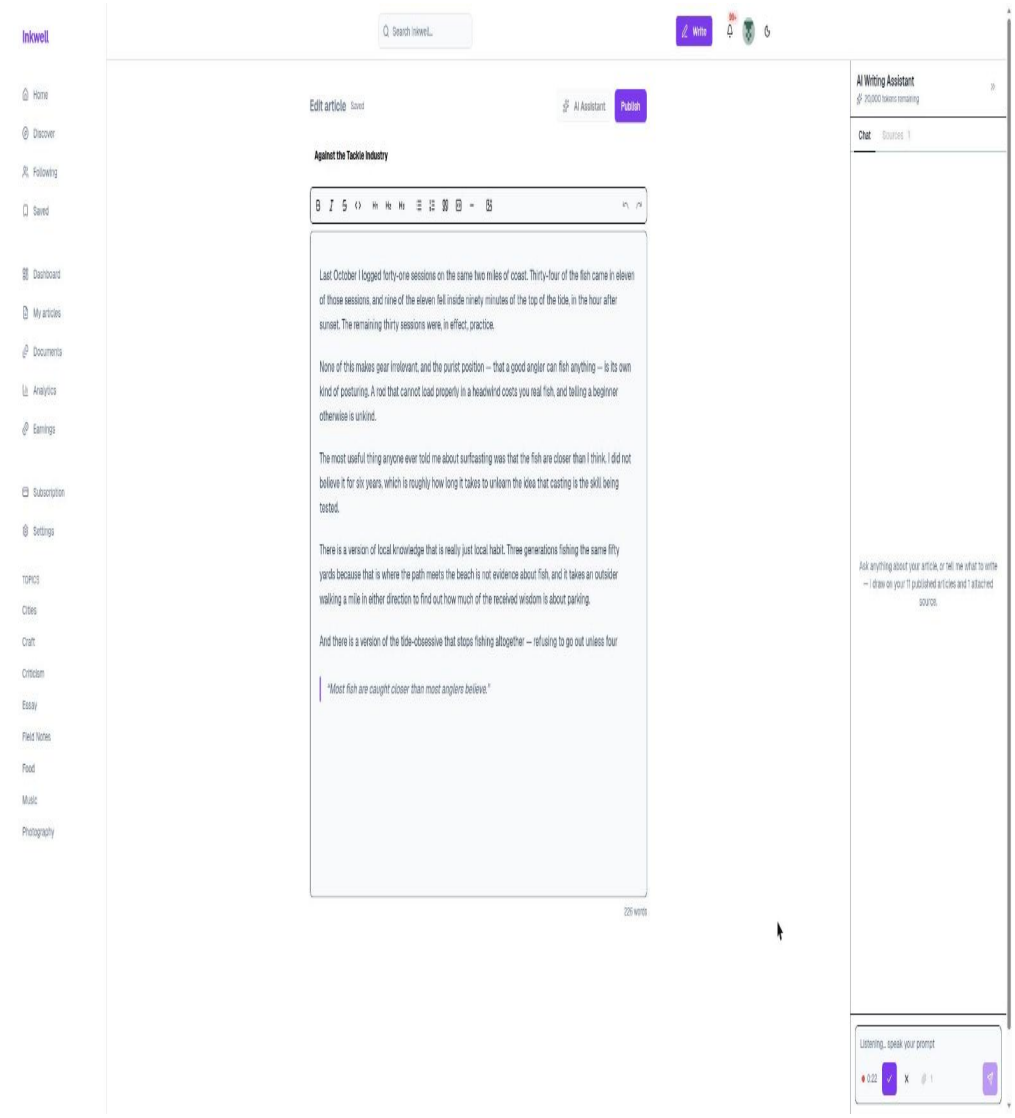


Figure 6.14 – Recording a prompt

While recording, the composer says *Listening… speak your prompt* and shows the elapsed time with a control to confirm and one to cancel; on confirmation the transcript fills the composer, where it can be edited before sending (FR-82). Dictation is billed against the same daily allowance as typed prompts, so voice is a way of writing a prompt, not a separate service.

6.3 Sprint 9 — Document library and citations

6.3.1 Sprint backlog

The goal of Sprint 9 is that a writer uploads reference documents into a private library, attaches them to an article, and that the assistant draws on them for answers and writes, citing each passage by document and page. Table 6.3 lists the stories.

Table 6.3 – Sprint 9 backlog

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
US-70	Upload the documents I am working from	Must	8
US-71	Choose which documents apply to an article	Must	3
US-72	See which document and page a claim came from	Should	5

ID	User story (goal)	Priority	Points
	3 stories		**16**

The sprint commits 16 points, the lightest load of the project after Sprint 7: the ingestion reuses the chunking and embedding pipeline of Sprint 4, so most of the work is the extraction of text page by page and the citation format. It ran alongside the end of the writing of this report.

6.3.2 Analysis

Figure 6.15 gives the use cases of Sprint 9.

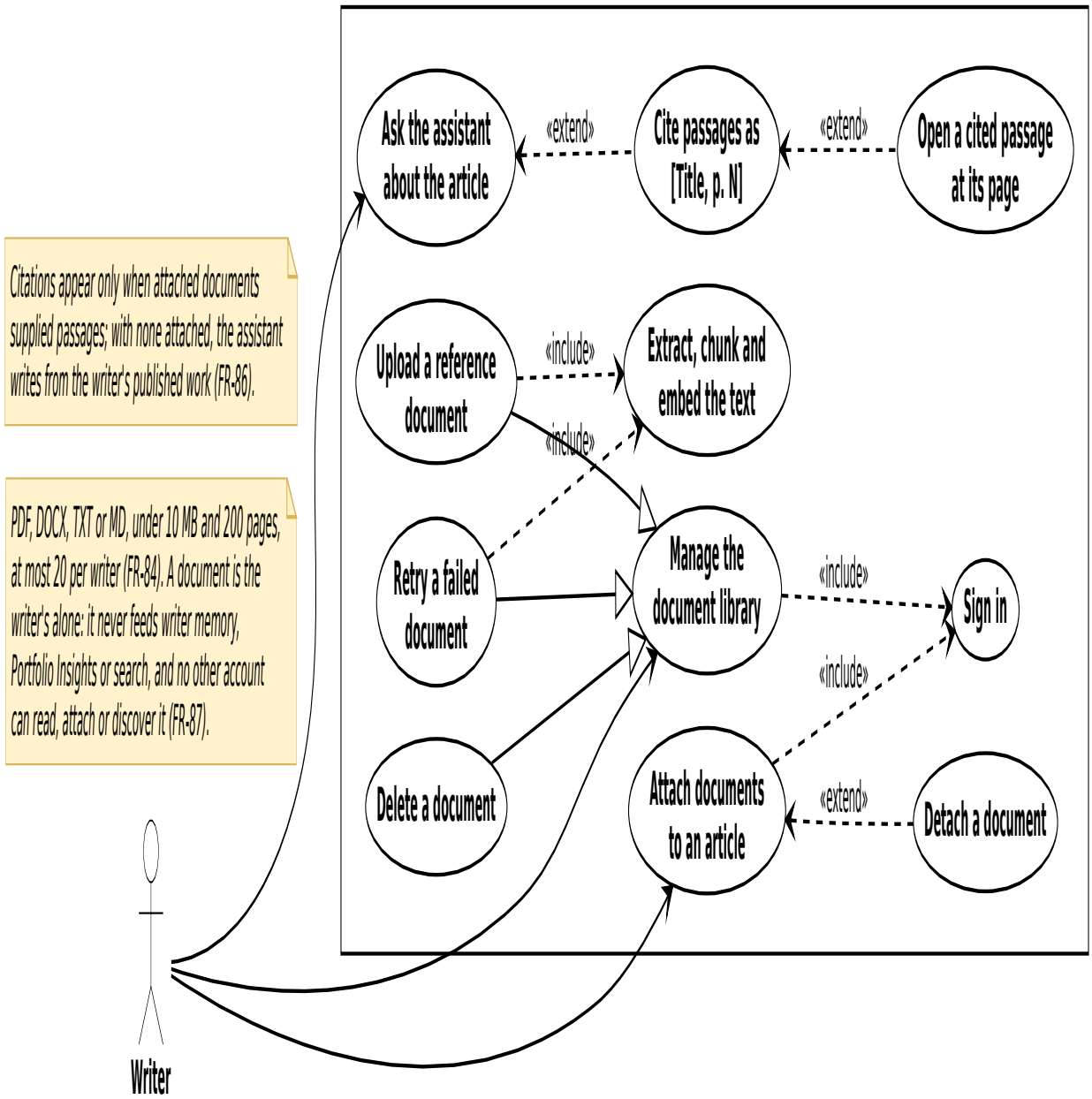


Figure 6.15 – Use case diagram, Sprint 9

Managing the library specialises into uploading, retrying a failed document and deleting; uploading and retrying include extracting, chunking and embedding the text. Attaching documents to an article is extended by detaching one. Asking the assistant is extended by citing passages as *[Title, p. N]*, itself extended by opening a cited passage at its page. Documents are PDF, DOCX, TXT or Markdown files under 10 MB and 200 pages, at most 20 per writer. The diagram shows the privacy boundary of the feature: a document is the writer's alone, and it never feeds the voice profile, portfolio insights or search (FR-87).

6.3.3 Design

Class diagram. Figure 6.16 shows the library.

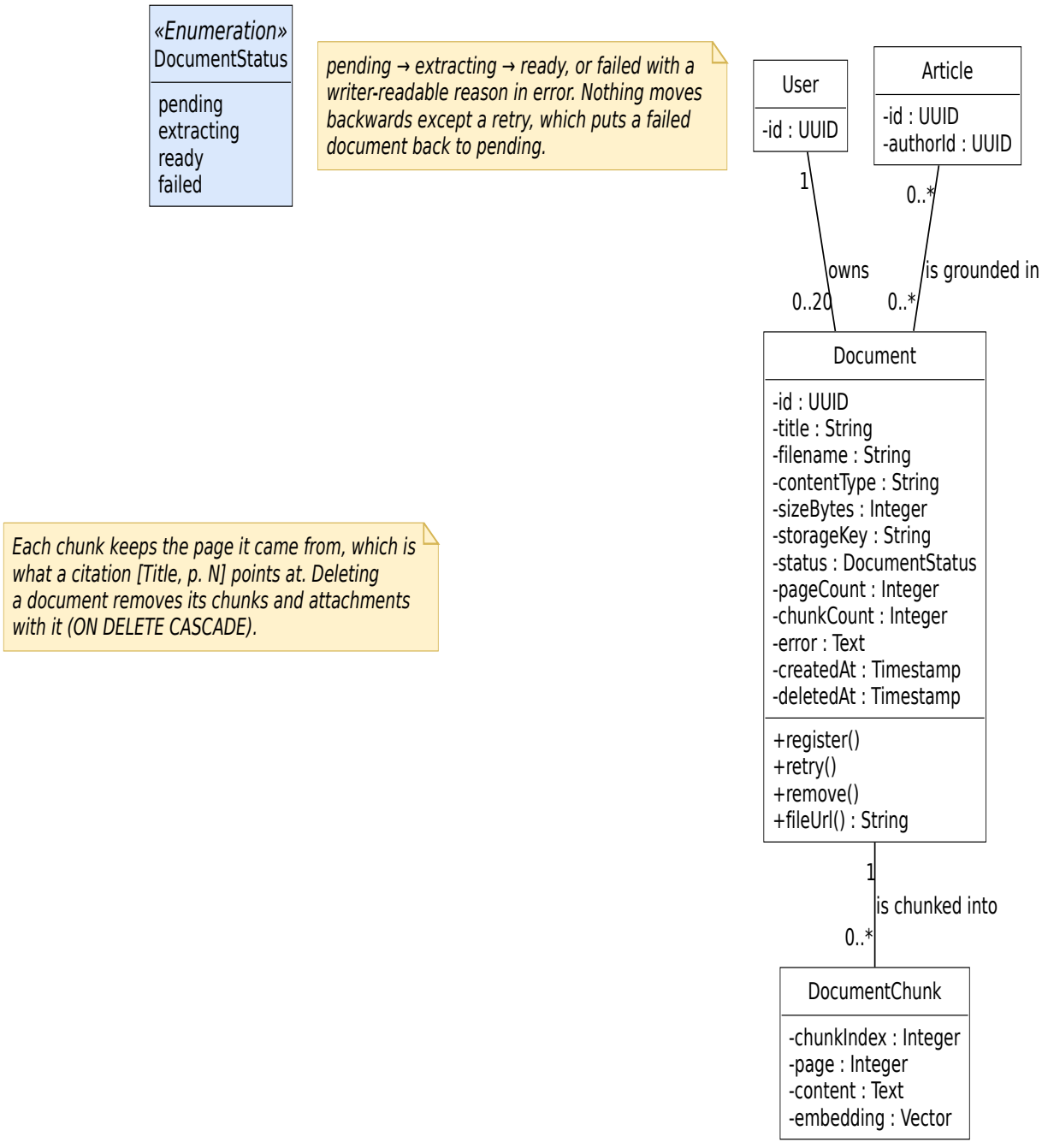


Figure 6.16 – Class diagram, Sprint 9

A `Document` carries its status, page and chunk counts and a readable error; its `DocumentChunks` each keep

the page they came from, which is what a citation points to; and documents are attached to articles by a many-to-many association. The status moves from pending to extracting to ready, or to failed with a reason the writer can act on; the only backward move is a retry. The diagram shows that a citation is a property of the data, not of the model's output: the page number travels with the chunk from extraction to the prompt.

Sequence diagram — ingestion. Figure 6.17 shows a document's path, the companion of the publishing pipeline of Figure 4.14.

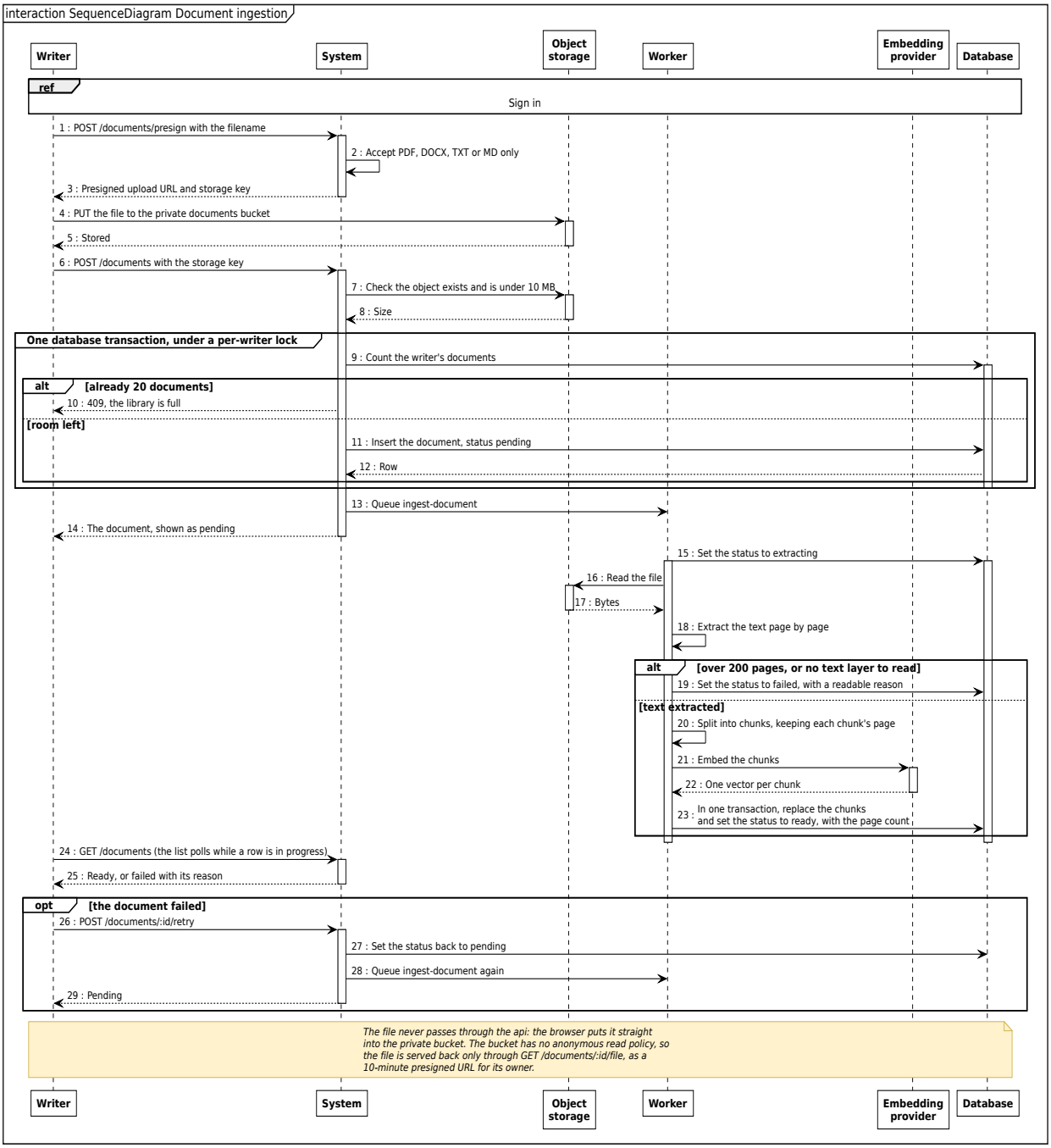


Figure 6.17 – Sequence diagram: document upload and ingestion

The browser asks for a presigned URL and uploads the file straight to a private bucket — the file never passes through the API. The registration checks that the object exists and is under 10 MB, counts the writer's documents under a per-writer lock and queues ingestion. The worker extracts the text page by page, refuses a document over 200 pages or without a text layer with a readable reason, then chunks it, embeds the chunks

and marks it ready in one transaction. The diagram shows that a document is either fully usable or clearly refused: there is no state in which the assistant can retrieve half a document.

6.3.4 Realisation

Figure 6.18 shows the document library.

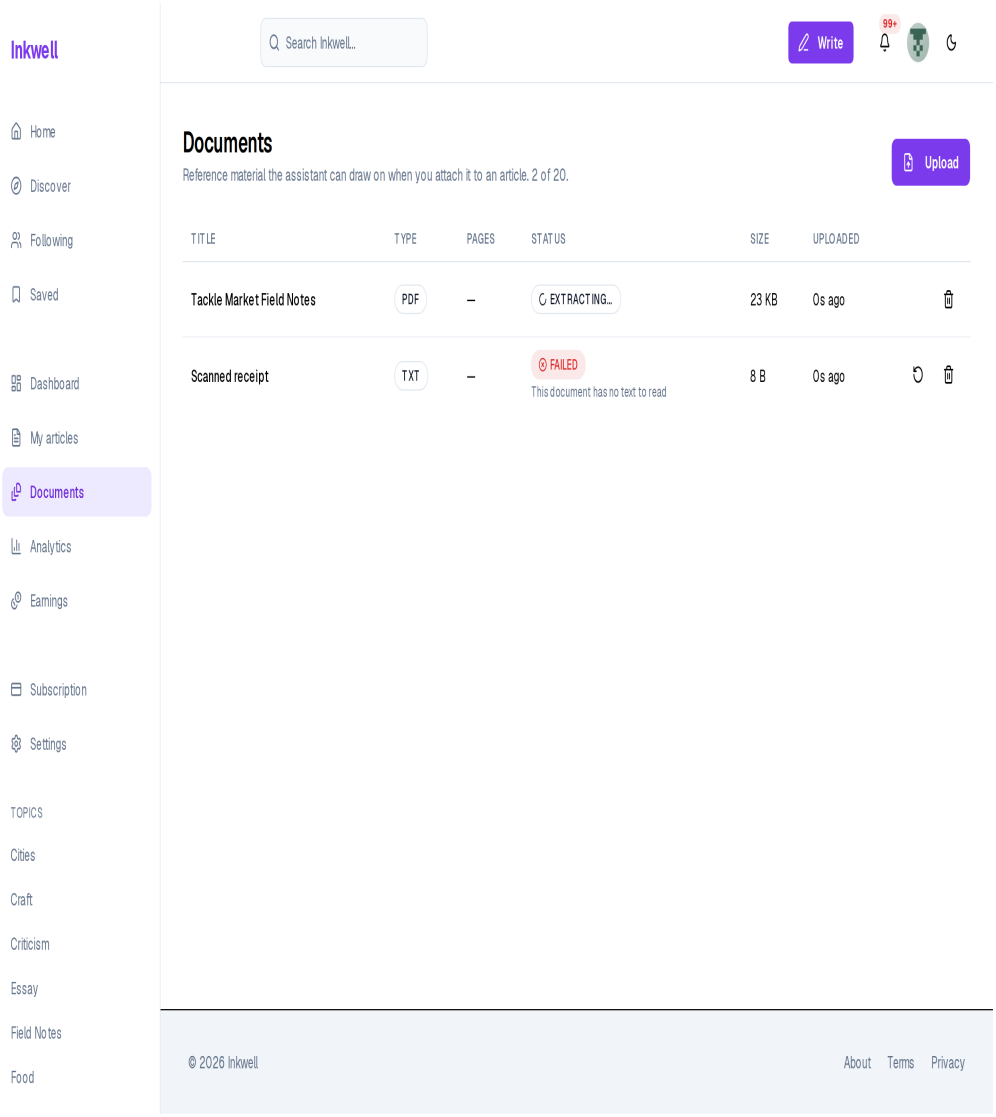


Figure 6.18 – The document library, one document refused with its reason

The library lists each document with its type, pages, status, size and upload time, and counts the documents against the limit — 2 of 20 (FR-84). One document is being extracted; the other is refused with the reason “This document has no text to read” and offers a retry: a failure is stated in words the writer can act on, not as an error code.

Figure 6.19 shows the attachment of a document from the Sources tab of the assistant.

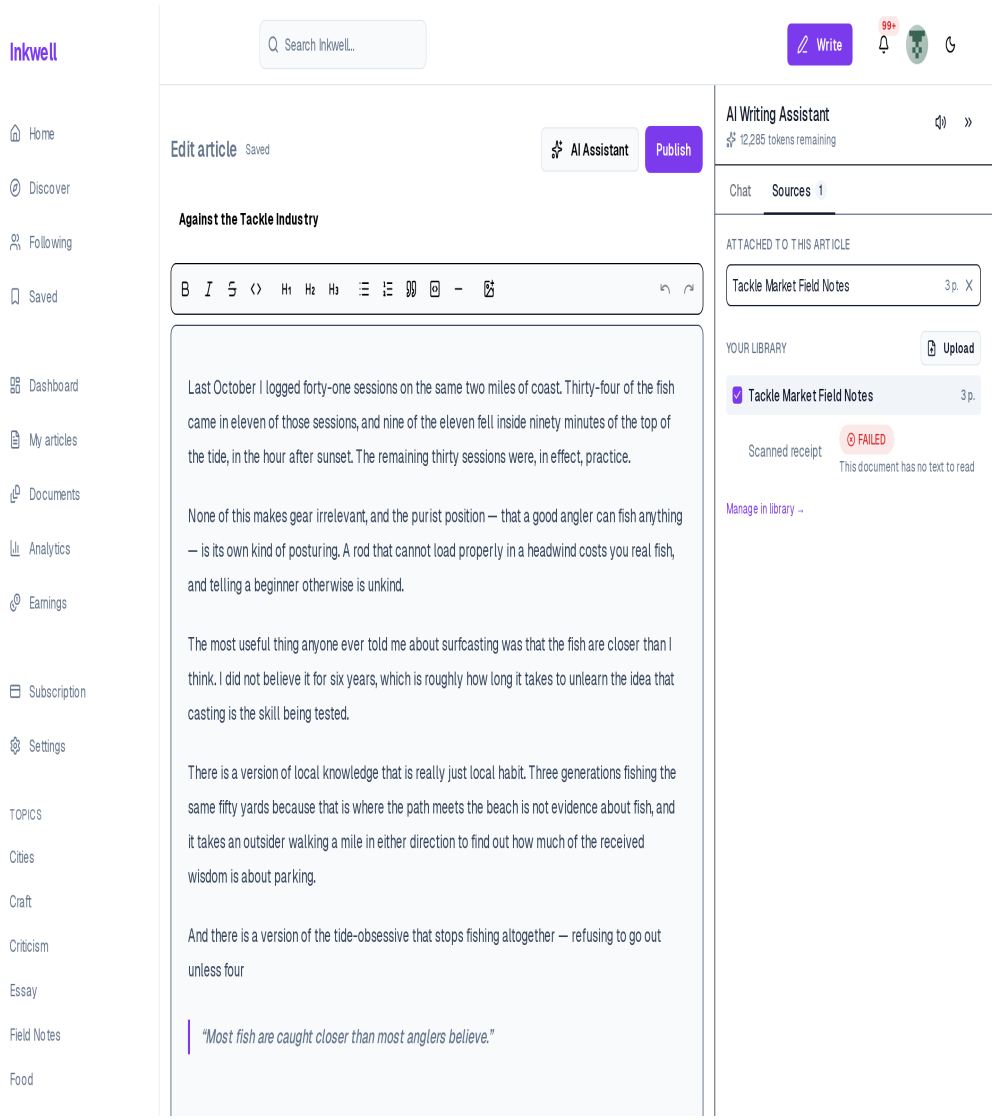


Figure 6.19 – Attaching a document from the Sources tab

The tab separates the documents attached to this article from the writer's whole library, where a checkbox attaches or detaches each ready document and a failed one is shown with its reason; the attachment is saved immediately (FR-85). Attaching per article is what keeps the assistant's material relevant: notes for one piece are not fed into another.

Figure 6.20 shows a reply citing its source.

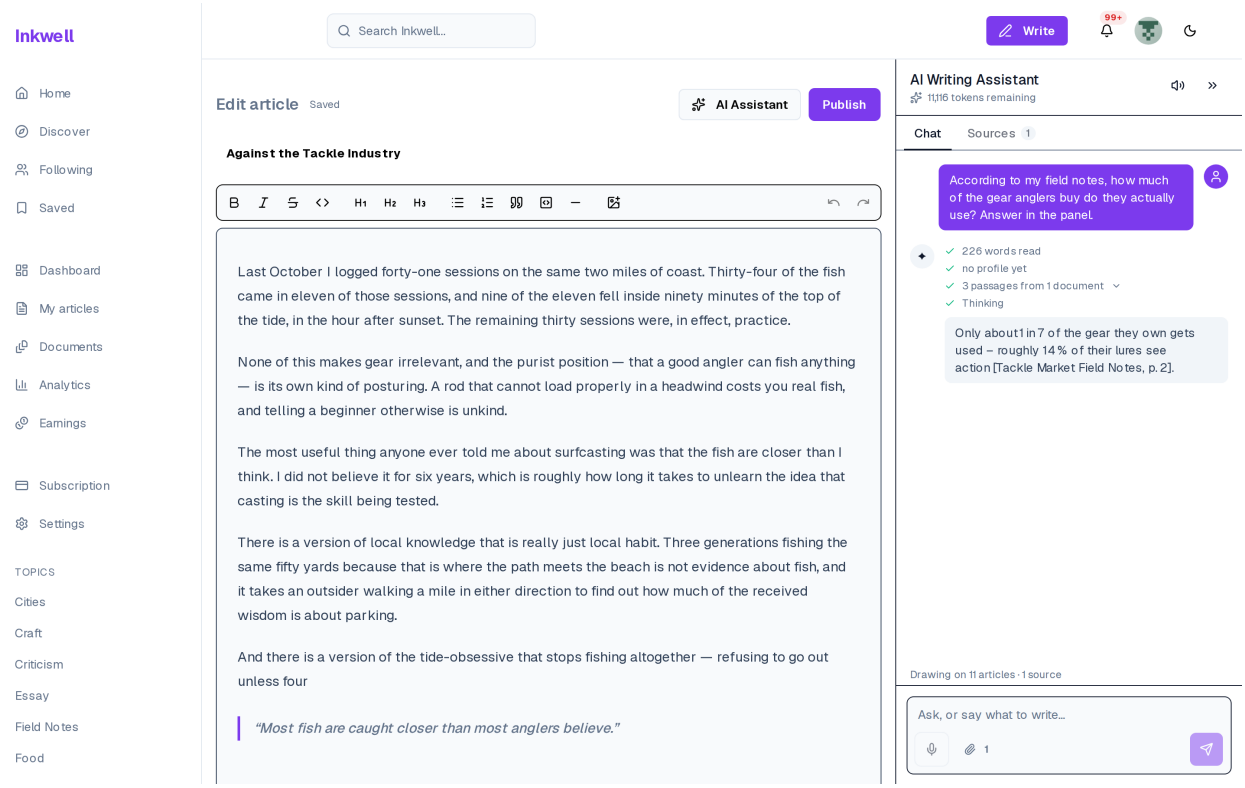


Figure 6.20 – A reply citing its source as [Title, p. N]

Asked a factual question about the writer's field notes, the assistant retrieved three passages from one document and answered with the figure and its source, *[Tackle Market Field Notes, p. 2]* (FR-86). The steps above the answer show where the facts came from before the answer is read. The writer can therefore check a claim before it goes out under their name, which is the purpose of US-72.

Conclusion

Release 4 completed the social layer, turned the assistant from a chat beside the editor into a collaborator that writes into the document under the writer's control, added voice in both directions, and gave the writer a private library of sources the assistant can cite to the page. The next chapter evaluates the result.

CHAPTER 7

Evaluation

Introduction

The release chapters showed what the platform does; this chapter measures how well it does it. It evaluates the three components whose quality cannot be read off a screen — the retrieval behind the assistant, the hybrid search and the moderation classifier — then the performance and accessibility of the platform, and finally the delivery itself: the velocity of the sprints against the plan, and a retrospective of each release. Every measurement was taken on the workstation of Table 2.1, with the full stack running in Docker, and every script and result is kept in the backend repository (`eval/`) so that it can be repeated.

7.1 Evaluation protocol

Corpus. Retrieval and search were evaluated on the demonstration corpus of Section 5.2, restricted to six writers, one for each of the corpus's six subjects (coastal craft, inference systems, cities, fermentation, orchestral music, analogue photography): **56 published articles split into 1,202 embedded passages**. The restriction is imposed by the embedding provider's free tier, which allows about a thousand embeddings a day; it keeps the evaluation within one day's quota.

Questions. The evaluation set is a *known-item* set: 30 target passages chosen from the corpus, five per subject, each asked twice — once with the passage's own distinctive words (the *keyword* query) and once as a paraphrase that avoids them (the *paraphrase* query). A passage or an article is relevant when it contains the target passage. Three targets turned out to appear in none of their writer's embedded articles and were dropped, leaving **27 targets and 54 queries**; because the seeded corpus reuses paragraphs across a writer's articles, a target appears on average in 5.9 articles. The queries were written before any result was seen.

Metrics. The standard measures of ranked retrieval were used [42], [43], [44]:

- **hit@k** — the share of queries for which at least one relevant item is among the first *k* results;
- **MRR** (mean reciprocal rank) — the mean of 1/*r*, where *r* is the rank of the first relevant result (0 when there is none); 1.00 means the first result is always relevant;
- **precision@5** — the share of relevant items among the passages returned;
- **recall@10** — the share of the relevant articles found in the first ten results;
- **nDCG@10** — a rank-weighted score that rewards relevant results placed higher.

The evaluation reuses the production code: queries are embedded by the platform's own embedding service, and the rankings are the SQL of the retrieval and search services. As a check, the production retrieval call was run on every query and returned the same passages as the evaluation in 54 cases out of 54.

7.2 Retrieval behind the assistant

The assistant retrieves the five passages of the writer's own work closest to the question, provided they score above a similarity floor (Section 4.2). Two questions matter: does the right passage come back, and does the floor correctly return nothing when the question is off-topic? The second was measured by asking every

query to a writer of *another* subject, for whom the correct answer is no passage at all. Table 7.1 gives the results for floors from 0.50 to 0.70.

Table 7.1 – Retrieval of the writer's own passages, by similarity floor (54 queries)

Floor	Hit@5, keyword	Hit@5, paraphrase	Hit@5, all	MRR	Precision@5	Passages returned	Off-topic refused
0.50	0.96	0.81	0.89	0.79	0.59	5.0	0%
0.55	0.96	0.81	0.89	0.79	0.59	5.0	7%
0.60	**0.96**	**0.81**	**0.89**	**0.79**	**0.59**	**5.0**	**69%**
0.65	0.96	0.81	0.89	0.79	0.60	4.9	98%
0.70	0.93	0.74	0.83	0.75	0.64	4.1	100%

At the floor used in production (0.60), a relevant passage is among the five returned for 89% of the questions — 96% when the question uses the passage's words, 81% when it paraphrases them — and it is usually the first one (MRR 0.79). The floor is the reason off-topic questions are refused: at 0.60, 69% of the questions asked to the wrong writer retrieve nothing, where a floor of 0.50 would have fed five irrelevant passages to the model every time.

The table also shows that 0.60 is not the best value. Raising the floor to **0.65** keeps every hit and refuses 98% of off-topic questions; only at 0.70 do relevant passages start to be lost. The similarities explain why: the best relevant passage scored between 0.66 and 0.84, and the best off-topic passage between 0.52 and 0.66, so the two ranges barely touch at 0.65. The measurement therefore supports raising the floor from 0.60 to 0.65, which is listed among the perspectives. Precision stays near 0.6 at every floor because a target appears in about six articles but only some of them are among the five passages returned; it is not a sign of irrelevant results.

7.3 Hybrid search

Search fuses a lexical ranking and a semantic ranking with reciprocal rank fusion (Section 4.2). Table 7.2 compares the two rankings alone and fused, with the production constant k = 60 and two other values, on the same 54 queries over the 56 articles.

Table 7.2 – Lexical, semantic and hybrid search (54 queries, 56 articles)

Ranking	Recall@10, keyword	Recall@10, paraphrase	MRR, keyword	MRR, paraphrase	nDCG@10, all
Lexical only (`ts_rank`)	0.95	0.06	0.93	0.07	0.50
Semantic only (embeddings)	1.00	1.00	0.94	0.90	0.94
Hybrid, RRF k = 10	1.00	1.00	0.98	0.90	0.95
Hybrid, RRF k = 60	**1.00**	**1.00**	**1.00**	**0.90**	**0.95**
Hybrid, RRF k = 100	1.00	1.00	1.00	0.90	0.95

The table justifies the hybrid design. Keyword search is excellent when the searcher uses the article's words (recall 0.95) and nearly useless when they do not (0.06): a paraphrase defeats it. Semantic search finds every relevant article in both cases. The fusion keeps the semantic recall and improves the ranking of keyword queries: with k = 60 the first result is relevant for every keyword query (MRR 1.00 against 0.94 for semantic search alone), because an article that matches both by words and by meaning is ranked first. The value k = 60 recommended by the method's authors [39] is confirmed: a smaller constant is slightly worse, a larger one changes nothing.

The limits of this evaluation must be stated. The corpus is small and synthetic, built by a seed that reuses

paragraphs; the queries were written by the author, who knew the corpus; and a known-item set rewards finding one passage, not judging the usefulness of an answer. The results show that retrieval and fusion behave as designed on this corpus, not how they would score on a public benchmark.

Search latency. On the same queries, the stages of a search took a median of 263 ms to embed the query, 7 ms for the lexical ranking and 9 ms for the semantic ranking: about 0.3 s in total, dominated by the call to the embedding provider. One behaviour was also measured that the design did not intend. When the provider's daily quota is exhausted, each search spends about **6.3 s** retrying the embedding three times before falling back to keyword search. The fallback works — the results are still returned — but the retries make it slow; failing fast once the quota is known to be exhausted, and caching the embeddings of frequent queries, are listed among the perspectives.

7.4 Moderation classifier

The classifier reviews every public article after publication and files a report when it judges the content to violate one of six categories (Section 5.1). It was evaluated on a labelled set of 33 texts written for the purpose: **13 violating texts** across the six categories, and **20 safe texts**, of which twelve are *hard negatives* — war reporting, crime news, an addiction memoir, thriller fiction, a suicide-prevention message, instructions on overdose treatment — that a naive classifier would flag because of their subject. The production service was called on each text three times.

Table 7.3 – Confusion matrix of the moderation classifier (identical in the three runs)

	Classified violating	Classified safe
Violating (13)	13 (true positives)	0 (false negatives)
Safe (20)	1 (false positive)	19 (true negatives)

The classifier reaches a **precision of 0.93** and a **recall of 1.00** (F1 0.96), and named the right category for all 13 violating texts; the three runs gave identical results. Its single false positive is instructive: instructions for killing a landed fish quickly, classified as violence — a hard negative about hunting, the kind of text the instruction to judge content rather than subject is meant to pass. The policy chosen in Section 5.1 absorbs exactly this kind of error: a false positive files a report that an administrator dismisses, and never blocks the article.

The median classification took 2.2 s, which is acceptable because it runs after the publication has been answered. The evaluation also had a second outcome. Its first run showed that the model initially configured for the classifier had been withdrawn by the provider, so that every call failed and the service — which fails open by design — passed every article without a word in the logs. The classifier was moved to `gpt-oss-20b`, with an output budget large enough for a reasoning model, and the results above are those of the corrected service. The lesson is that a fail-open component needs a liveness check of its own; the daily model check of the worker now exercises the classifier at the budget it is called with.

7.5 Performance and accessibility

API latency. Table 7.4 gives the response time of the main read routes, measured inside the Compose network with ten concurrent clients and 300 requests per route, each client presenting its own address so that the per-address rate limit applied as it would to distinct readers.

Table 7.4 – Latency of the main API routes under concurrent load

Route	Median	95th percentile	Throughput
Public feed (`GET /articles`, 20 cards)	34 ms	41 ms	285 req/s
Article page (`GET /articles/:slug`)	15 ms	19 ms	652 req/s
Writer evaluation (`GET /writers/:username/evaluation`)	16 ms	20 ms	620 req/s
Writer dashboard (`GET /me/analytics`)	12 ms	17 ms	774 req/s
Search (stages, one query at a time)	≈ 0.3 s	—	bound by the provider quota

Every route that reads the database answers in under 50 ms at the 95th percentile on a laptop, and the two routes backed by the rollups — the evaluation report and the dashboard — are among the fastest, which is the effect NFR-15 was written for. Search is the exception, for the reason given in Section 7.3: its cost is the call to the embedding provider, not the database. The rate limit of NFR-05 was verified on the same occasion: sixty requests from one address within a minute were served, and the sixty-first was answered 429.

Lighthouse and accessibility. NFR-37 asks for a Lighthouse score above 90 and no critical accessibility violation on article pages [45]. A production build of the frontend was audited behind nginx, with Lighthouse's mobile and desktop presets (median of three runs) and with axe-core on the WCAG 2.x A and AA rules at the two designed widths [46], [47]. Table 7.5 gives the results.

Table 7.5 – Lighthouse scores and axe-core violations of the public pages

Page	Performance (mobile / desktop)	Accessibility	SEO	Critical axe violations	Serious axe violations
Article, free	63 / 96	92	100	0	6
Article, premium (paywalled)	74 / 98	91	100	0	5
Home feed	71 / 98	91	100	0	19
Search results	75 / 93	94	63	0	4

NFR-37 is **partly met**. No page has a critical accessibility violation, at either width; every page scores above 90 for accessibility, and between 93 and 98 for performance on desktop. On the mobile preset, which simulates a slow device and network, the pages score 63 to 75: their largest element is painted after about six seconds, because the page loads its fonts, cover image and interactive controls before the text settles. The serious violations are of two kinds only — text whose contrast with its background is too low, and icon-only links without an accessible name (the reaction and share buttons of the cards, which explains the higher

count on the feed). Both are fixes of the design tokens and of a few components, and they are listed with the limitations.

The search page's SEO score of 63 is intended: result pages are marked `noindex`, so that search engines index the articles rather than lists of them.

7.6 Test coverage

Table 5.4 in Section 5.2 gave the test suites; their coverage was interpreted there. In short, the 796 backend tests execute 48.5% of the backend's lines, concentrated on the rules that move money or remove content (moderation 92%, purchases 77%), while the analytics aggregation is verified by the measurements above rather than by unit tests.

7.7 Delivery: velocity and retrospective

Definition of done. A story counted as delivered when its code had been reviewed against the specification, the type check and the linter passed with no warning, the backend tests passed in the container, the feature had been demonstrated in a browser, and the specification had been updated to match what was built.

Velocity. Table 7.6 compares the points committed in each sprint with the points delivered under that definition.

Table 7.6 – Committed and delivered points per sprint

Sprint	Committed	Delivered	Gap
Sprint 1	45	45	—
Sprint 2	45	45	—
Sprint 3	44	44	—
Sprint 4	52	52	—
Sprint 5	85	85	—
Sprint 6	20	12	US-55 (8 points): configuration ready, server not provisioned
Sprint 7	18	18	—
Sprint 8	38	38	—
Sprint 9	16	16	—
Total	**350**	**342**	98% of the committed points

The plan was followed sprint for sprint: 98% of the points were delivered, and the only gap is the public hosting of US-55. The table shows, however, that the loads were uneven, from 16 to 85 points for sprints of the same length. That spread is a consequence of estimating alone: without a team to challenge a figure, the marketplace of Sprint 5 was planned as one block because its stories share one ledger, and the light sprints of Release 4 reflect stories that reused existing pipelines and a release that ran alongside the writing of this report. A velocity averaged over the project (about 38 points per sprint) would have been the better planning

figure, and would have split Sprint 5 in two.

Retrospective. Table 7.7 summarises what each release taught.

Table 7.7 – Retrospective by release

Re-lease	What worked	What to improve	Action taken
R1	The ledger checks and the one-command stack existed before any feature that needed them	The editor waited six weeks for the design track	Later releases built on the design system and needed no separate design track
R2	Rollups kept dashboards fast as events accumulated	The embedding provider's quota limits backfills and search under load	Embed one writer at a time; a query-embedding cache listed as a perspective
R3	Every money rule is tested, including tests designed to fail under sabotage	Sprint 5 was overloaded; the aggregation has no unit tests; hosting was not done	Plan by measured velocity; aggregation tests listed as the first perspective
R4	Voice and documents reused the AI pipeline, so they were small	A provider withdrew a model and the fail-open classifier hid it	A daily check exercises every model as it is called

The retrospective shows a pattern. The rules written down early — the ledger invariants, the access decision, the definition of done — held for the whole project; what went wrong came from outside the code: the quotas and model changes of the AI providers, and the time an individual project leaves for hosting. Those are the points the perspectives address.

Conclusion

The evaluation confirmed the main design decisions with measurements: retrieval finds a relevant passage for 89% of questions and its floor refuses most off-topic ones; hybrid search keeps all relevant articles even when the searcher's words differ from the author's; the moderation classifier reaches a precision of 0.93 and a recall of 1.00; the API answers in tens of milliseconds; and 98% of the planned points were delivered. It also found what remains to be done: a higher similarity floor, a faster fallback when the embedding quota is exhausted, better mobile performance and contrast, tests for the aggregation, and the public hosting of the platform.

General conclusion and perspectives

This project set out to connect two groups the existing platforms leave apart: independent writers, who lack an assistant that writes in their own voice and a direct way to be paid for quality, and magazines, which lack objective evidence to judge a writer before buying. Inkwell.ai answers both with one platform.

Over nine two-week sprints in four releases, the project delivered:

- a **writing environment** — a rich-text editor with automatic saving and images, and an AI assistant grounded in the writer's own published work through retrieval-augmented generation, which decides per request whether to answer or to write into the document, writes into a protected range the writer keeps or discards, shows its real pipeline as it runs, accepts dictated prompts, reads its replies aloud, and cites reference documents to the page;
- an **analytics pipeline** — reading events captured in the browser, aggregated incrementally into per-article and per-writer metrics, presented to writers as dashboards and to magazines as an evaluation report completed by AI portfolio insights;
- a **marketplace** — an eligibility gate, magazine subscriptions with monthly credits, a two-stage exclusive purchase and the magazine's own publication, with every credit movement written to a ledger inside one transaction and three balance invariants asserted after every money-moving test;
- a **social layer** — likes, threaded comments, comment likes, reposts, follows, saves, blocks, sharing and live notifications — and the **moderation** console;
- the **engineering around it** — a containerised stack started by one command, a continuous-integration pipeline with strict typing, zero lint warnings and a schema-drift check, 796 backend tests, a demonstration corpus and a production-ready stack.

The evaluation of Chapter 7 measured the result rather than asserting it: retrieval returns a relevant passage for 89% of questions, hybrid search keeps every relevant article for paraphrased queries that keyword search misses, the moderation classifier reaches a precision of 0.93 and a recall of 1.00, the API answers in tens of milliseconds, and 98% of the planned points were delivered.

Beyond the product, the project was an exercise in engineering discipline: requirements stated per actor with stable identifiers, non-functional requirements tied to the mechanism that provides them and to the way they are verified, business rules proven by tests — including tests designed to fail when the code is sabotaged — and claims checked by measurement, which in two cases corrected the project itself.

Limitations

Some points remain open and are stated as such.

1. **Public hosting.** The production stack, its TLS configuration and its delivery pipeline are ready and the domain is registered, but no server was provisioned, so US-55 is only partly delivered.
2. **Background job retries.** No queue is configured with retries, so a job that fails — an embedding during a provider outage, for instance — is not attempted again (NFR-23).
3. **Pagination.** Lists are paginated by offset; a cursor-based scheme would stay stable when new rows are inserted while a reader scrolls (NFR-14).
4. **Readiness.** The readiness endpoint checks PostgreSQL but not Redis (NFR-25).

5. **Mobile performance and accessibility.** On the mobile preset the article pages score 63 to 74 for performance, and the public pages carry serious — though no critical — accessibility violations: insufficient contrast and icon-only links without a name (NFR-37).
6. **Session revocation.** Refresh tokens are stateless: a password change does not revoke one already issued, which stays valid until its seven days expire. A ban is enforced at the next refresh, within fifteen minutes.
7. **Test coverage of the analytics.** The aggregation queries have no unit tests; they are verified only end to end and by measurement.
8. **Search under quota exhaustion.** When the embedding provider's quota is exhausted, search falls back to keywords only after about six seconds of retries.

Perspectives

- **Go live** on a provisioned server, then measure real traffic against the performance requirements.
- **Harden the background work**: retries with back-off on every queue, and a readiness check that includes Redis.
- **Tune retrieval and search with the measurements of Chapter 7**: raise the similarity floor to 0.65, cache the embeddings of frequent queries, and fail fast to keyword search once the provider's quota is known to be exhausted.
- **Fix the accessibility findings** — contrast tokens and accessible names on icon links — and improve the mobile loading of article pages.
- **Test the aggregation** with fixtures of known events and expected metrics.
- **Real payments** in place of the simulated ones, with the ledger already designed to record them, and **revocable sessions** by storing refresh tokens server-side.
- **Richer AI collaboration**: dictating whole articles, style learning beyond the current voice profile, and feedback on weak sections.
- **Wider audience**: multilingual publishing and a native mobile application on the existing 375 px designs.

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APPENDIX A

Functional requirements

This annex gives every functional requirement of Section 1.4, per actor, with its MoSCoW priority and the sprint or sprints that deliver it. A requirement listed under two sprints is delivered in two steps, as explained in the release chapters.

Table A.1 – Functional requirements — visitor

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-01	Browse the public feed, paginated, with title, excerpt, thumbnail and tags	Must	1
FR-02	Read the full body of a free public article without an account	Must	1
FR-03	Be blocked from premium and marketplace articles, with an explicit prompt to sign up	Must	1
FR-04	Register as a personal account, or as a magazine account	Must	1
FR-05	Authenticate by email/password or Google OAuth	Must	1
FR-06	Search articles and writers, and browse by tag	Should	4
FR-69	Continue any article list as the reader scrolls, with a “Load more” control that remains available and a failed page that neither discards loaded rows nor retries itself	Must	8
FR-71	Not see a marketplace listing on the writer’s public profile at all — the exceptions being the article’s own author and an administrator	Must	5
FR-75	Read a magazine’s published articles on its public profile, paginated, without an account	Must	5
FR-76	See both the writer and the publishing magazine named on a licensed article, each linking to its own profile	Must	5
FR-77	Preview a writer or magazine from any byline by hovering it — name, bio, counts and a follow control for a writer; logo, description and founding date for a magazine — without leaving the page	Should	8

Table A.2 – Functional requirements — free and premium reader

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-07	Manage a profile — display name, bio, avatar upload	Must	1
FR-08	Like an article, and un-like it	Must	3
FR-09	Comment on an article, and reply to a comment (threaded)	Must	3
FR-10	Delete one’s own comment	Must	3
FR-11	Repost an article	Could	3
FR-12	Follow and unfollow a writer	Should	3
FR-13	Receive notifications for follows, likes, comment likes, saves, comments and replies, delivered live	Must	3
FR-14	List past notifications and mark them read	Must	3
FR-15	Upgrade to premium, and downgrade (simulated payment)	Must	5
FR-16	*(A3 only)* Read premium-visibility articles	Must	5
FR-17	*(A3 only)* Consume a daily AI token allowance	Must	2, 5
FR-60	Like a comment or a reply, and un-like it	Must	7
FR-61	View any profile’s followers and following lists, and follow or unfollow from them	Must	7
FR-62	Block an account, and review and lift one’s blocks from settings	Must	7
FR-63	Save an article from the feed card or from the article page, and unsave it	Must	7
FR-64	Review one’s own saved articles, from the sidebar or from the Saved tab on one’s own profile	Must	7
FR-65	Share an article or a writer profile to X, Facebook or LinkedIn, or copy its link, without needing an account	Should	7

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-66	Like, repost and comment on an article from a feed card, and see whether one has already liked or reposted it	Must	8
FR-67	Read any account's reposts from the Reposted tab on its profile, without an account	Should	8
FR-68	See a feed card's most recent comments from the last hour, up to three, without opening the article	Could	8
FR-70	Be refused when liking, commenting on or reposting a marketplace listing, while saving one stays available	Must	5

Table A.3 – Functional requirements — writer and eligible writer

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-18	Create a draft and edit it in a rich-text editor (TipTap, stored as JSON)	Must	2
FR-19	Have drafts saved automatically, debounced, without a save action	Must	2
FR-20	Insert images by paste, drag or file picker, uploaded directly to object storage	Must	2
FR-21	Set a cover image, excerpt and tags	Must	2
FR-22	See live word count and estimated reading time	Should	2
FR-23	Publish an article, choosing its placement: public or marketplace	Must	1, 5
FR-24	Choose a visibility for public articles: free or premium	Must	1, 5
FR-25	Update or soft-delete an own article	Must	1
FR-26	Switch an article from marketplace to public (one-way; the reverse is refused)	Should	5
FR-27	Converse with an AI assistant grounded in the writer's own published corpus	Must	2, 4
FR-28	Apply an inline AI action to a text selection — reformulate, shorten, expand, simplify, improve	Must	2
FR-29	See which passages the assistant retrieved, grouped by source article	Should	4
FR-30	Insert an AI response into the document at the cursor	Must	2
FR-31	See the remaining AI token balance, updated after each action	Must	2
FR-32	View per-article analytics — views, unique readers, average read time, completion, engagement, retention curve	Must	3
FR-33	Rank own articles by views or engagement, server-side across the whole body of work	Should	3
FR-34	See progress toward marketplace eligibility	Must	5
FR-35	*(A5 only)* Publish to the marketplace with a price in credits	Must	5
FR-36	*(A5 only)* Publish premium-visibility articles	Must	5
FR-37	View earnings — lifetime, per article, itemised by preview and purchase	Must	5
FR-38	Be notified when a magazine previews or purchases an article, and when earnings are credited	Must	5
FR-78	The assistant decides, per message, whether to answer in the panel or write into the document — superseding the manual insert of FR-30	Must	8
FR-79	Written text streams into the document at the cursor or over the selection, marked and protected until the writer keeps or discards it; Keep is one undo step; Discard restores what it replaced	Must	8
FR-80	Show the pipeline's real steps as they run, with counts, and a one-line recap after a write	Must	8
FR-81	The assistant is a panel docked beside the editor with Chat and Sources tabs; it collapses to a rail that carries the live step, and opens as a bottom sheet below desktop width	Should	8
FR-82	Record a prompt with the microphone (≤ 5 min) and have it transcribed into the assistant's input, editable, billed at 200 tokens a minute against the daily allowance	Should	8
FR-83	Hear each assistant reply read aloud, with a persisted mute; the control exists only when the key can speak	Could	8
FR-84	Upload PDF, DOCX, TXT or MD reference documents (≤ 10 MB, ≤ 200 pages, 20 per writer) into a private library, with text extracted and embedded by the worker and a readable failure reason when it cannot be	Must	9
FR-85	Attach library documents to an article from the assistant and detach them; attachments are saved immediately	Must	9

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-86	The assistant draws on attached documents for both answers and writes, cites passages inline as [Title, p. N], and shows the passages used with a link opening the file at the page	Must	9
FR-87	A document is the writer's alone: it never feeds writer memory, Portfolio Insights or search, and another account cannot read, attach or discover it	Must	9

Table A.4 – Functional requirements — magazine

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-39	Register with magazine fields — name, slug, logo, website, description	Must	1
FR-40	*(A6)* Be stopped at a subscription wall before any marketplace surface	Must	5
FR-41	Subscribe, receiving a monthly credit allowance (simulated payment)	Must	5
FR-42	Top up credits outside the monthly grant	Should	5
FR-43	See the credit balance, the renewal date and the transaction history	Must	5
FR-44	Browse eligible writers, filtered by topic, searchable, with four sort orders	Must	3, 5
FR-45	Read a writer evaluation report — audience, content, quality panels	Must	3
FR-46	Request AI Portfolio Insights for a writer, as an explicit action	Must	4
FR-47	Browse a writer's marketplace-listed articles with prices	Must	5
FR-48	Unlock a preview for 10% of the price, and read the full article	Must	5
FR-49	Purchase the remainder (90%) and gain republish rights	Must	5
FR-50	See the curated library of fully purchased articles	Must	5
FR-72	Be refused when previewing, buying, switching to public, or deleting an article another magazine has already purchased exclusively	Must	5
FR-73	Publish an article it has purchased, under its own masthead — making it public and free, clearing the price, and recording the publisher	Must	5
FR-74	See the library split into what has been published and what is still waiting, and act only on the second	Must	5

Table A.5 – Functional requirements — administrator

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-51	Review a queue of reports on articles, users and comments	Must	5
FR-52	Dismiss a report, delete the reported article, or ban its author	Must	5
FR-53	List and search users, filtered by role and by active/banned	Should	5
FR-54	Edit a user's plan (both directions), logged	Should	5
FR-55	Grant marketplace eligibility manually, with an audit-log entry	Must	5

Table A.6 – Functional requirements — cross-cutting

ID	Requirement	Priority	Sprint
FR-56	Every article body access decision is taken server-side against the article access decision (the activity diagram of Sprint 5); locked content arrives as null	Must	5
FR-57	Content is classified at publish time; a flag files a pending report but never blocks publication	Should	5
FR-58	Any credit movement writes ledger rows inside one transaction, under a row lock	Must	5
FR-59	Report an article, a user or a comment	Must	5

APPENDIX B

Product backlog

This annex gives the full product backlog of Section 1.8, epic by epic, sorted by identifier. Each story is stated as *"As an ⟨actor⟩, I want ⟨goal⟩ so that ⟨benefit⟩"*; the actor column gives the actor of Table 1.2, and the technical stories of E9 have none.

E1 — Accounts and authentication

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-01	Register with an email and a password so that I can have an identity on the platform	A1	Must	3	1
US-02	Sign in with Google so that I do not manage another password	A1	Should	3	1
US-03	Register as a magazine with my branding so that writers recognise my publication	A1	Must	5	1
US-04	Stay signed in across a long writing session so that I do not lose a draft	A4	Must	3	1
US-05	Edit my profile and avatar so that my public page represents me	A2	Should	3	1

E2 — Writing and publishing

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-06	Write in a rich editor so that structure and emphasis survive publication	A4	Must	8	2
US-07	Have my draft saved as I type so that I never lose work	A4	Must	3	2
US-08	Paste or drag an image into the article so that illustrating is not a detour	A4	Must	5	2
US-09	Set a cover image so that my article looks deliberate in the feed	A4	Should	3	2
US-10	Tag an article so that readers find it by topic	A4	Should	2	1
US-11	Choose at publish time whether an article is public or for sale	A4	Must	5	1
US-12	Restrict an article to premium readers so that my best work is worth a subscription	A5	Should	3	5
US-13	See word count and reading time so that I can judge length as I write	A4	Could	1	2

E3 — AI assistance

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-14	Ask an assistant that has read my published work so that suggestions sound like me	A4	Must	13	2, 4
US-15	Reformulate, shorten, expand, simplify or improve a selection so that editing is one click	A4	Must	8	2
US-16	Insert an answer into my document so that I do not copy by hand	A4	Must	2	2
US-17	See which of my passages the assistant used so that I can trust the answer	A4	Should	5	4
US-18	See my remaining allowance so that I can pace my usage	A3	Must	2	2
US-19	Have my voice profile extracted from my corpus so that the assistant stays consistent when retrieval finds nothing	A4	Should	8	4
US-66	Tell the assistant what to write and watch it appear in my draft, then keep or discard it, so that generation happens where I write rather than in a chat I copy from	A4	Must	8	8
US-67	See what the assistant is doing while it works — and minimize it without losing sight of that — so that a slow step is not a frozen screen	A4	Should	3	8

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-68	Say my request instead of typing it so that I can brief the assistant while my hands are busy or my thoughts are faster than my typing	A4	Should	5	8
US-69	Hear the assistant’s recap read out so that I can keep my eyes on the draft — and mute it when I would rather not	A4	Could	3	8
US-70	Upload the documents I am working from so that the assistant can use their facts without my retyping them	A4	Must	8	9
US-71	Choose which documents apply to an article so that a piece on tides is not fed my notes on fermentation	A4	Must	3	9
US-72	See which document and page a claim came from so that I can check it before it goes out under my name	A4	Should	5	9

E4 — Discovery and search

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-20	Search by keyword so that I find an article I half-remember	A1	Must	5	4
US-21	Find articles that match my meaning even when they share none of my words	A1	Must	8	4
US-22	Browse by tag so that I can follow a topic	A1	Should	2	4
US-23	Find writers, not only articles, so that I can follow a person	A1	Should	3	4

E5 — Social interactions and notifications

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-24	Like an article so that I can signal quality	A2	Must	2	3
US-25	Comment and reply in a thread so that discussion has structure	A2	Must	5	3
US-26	Follow a writer so that I keep up with them	A2	Should	3	3
US-27	Repost an article so that my followers see it	A2	Could	2	3
US-28	Be told the moment someone reacts to my work, without reloading	A4	Must	5	3
US-29	Review notifications I missed so that nothing is lost between sessions	A2	Must	3	3
US-57	Save an article to come back to it later, without anyone else seeing what I keep	A2	Must	5	7
US-58	Pass an article on to people outside the platform so that they can read it without signing up	A1	Should	3	7
US-59	React to an article from the feed so that I can engage without losing my place	A2	Must	5	8
US-60	See what an account has reposted so that I can judge what they rate	A2	Should	3	8
US-61	Reply in the moment from the feed so that a fresh conversation is easy to join	A2	Could	3	8
US-62	Keep reading as I scroll so that a list does not end at an arbitrary point I have to click past	A1	Must	5	8
US-65	See who a writer or magazine is from where their name appears so that I can decide to follow without leaving the feed	A1	Should	3	8
US-73	Like a comment so that I can credit a good reply without writing one	A2	Must	2	7
US-74	Browse who follows an account and whom it follows, and follow from the list, so that I find people through people	A1	Must	3	7

E6 — Analytics

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-30	See how many people read an article and how far they got so that I can write better	A4	Must	8	3
US-31	Rank my articles by performance so that I learn what works	A4	Should	3	3
US-32	Evaluate a writer on audience, content and quality so that I can commission with evidence	A7	Must	13	3
US-33	Read an AI assessment of a writer's voice and range so that I can shortlist quickly	A7	Must	8	4

E7 — Marketplace and subscriptions

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-34	Upgrade to premium so that I can read everything and use the assistant	A2	Must	5	5
US-35	Subscribe as a magazine so that I can access the marketplace	A6	Must	8	5
US-36	Receive a monthly credit budget so that spending is predictable	A7	Must	5	5
US-37	Top up credits so that a good month is not capped	A7	Should	3	5
US-38	Pay 10% to read an article in full so that I can judge before buying	A7	Must	8	5
US-39	Pay the remainder to acquire republish rights so that I can publish it	A7	Must	8	5
US-40	Keep purchased articles in a library so that my acquisitions are in one place	A7	Must	3	5
US-41	List an article for sale at my own price so that I am paid for exclusivity	A5	Must	5	5
US-42	See my earnings itemised by preview and purchase so that I trust the accounting	A4	Must	5	5
US-43	See how far I am from eligibility so that the gate feels reachable	A4	Should	3	5
US-63	Publish an article I have bought when I am ready, rather than the purchase publishing it for me, so that my masthead stays mine to decide	A7	Must	5	5
US-64	Have the articles I publish appear on my public profile under my masthead so that licensing buys me a shelf and not just a file	A7	Must	5	5

E8 — Moderation and administration

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-44	Report content so that abuse has a channel	A2	Must	3	5
US-45	Work a queue of reports so that moderation is systematic	A8	Must	5	5
US-46	Remove an article or ban an author so that decisions are enforceable	A8	Must	3	5
US-47	Grant eligibility manually so that a promising writer is not held back by a counter	A8	Must	3	5
US-48	Search and filter users so that I can act on the right account	A8	Should	5	5
US-56	Block an account so that I stop seeing someone without having to explain myself	A2	Must	5	7

E9 — Quality and operations (technical stories)

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-49	Prove that every balance equals its ledger sum, after every money-moving operation	—	Must	8	1
US-50	Bring the whole stack up with one command, reproducibly	—	Must	8	1
US-51	Fail the build on a lint error, a type error, a failing test or schema drift	—	Must	5	1
US-52	Apply migrations automatically before the application starts	—	Must	5	6
US-53	Seed a believable corpus so that the product can be demonstrated cold	—	Must	5	6

ID	User story	Actor	Priority	Points	Sprint
US-54	Lower the eligibility thresholds under a flag so that the gate can be crossed live	—	Must	2	6
US-55	Serve the product at a public URL over TLS	—	Must	8	6